



**GREEN
CLIMATE
FUND**

Meeting of the Board
30 June – 3 July 2025
Port Moresby, Papua New Guinea
Provisional agenda item 11

GCF/B.42/02/Add.16

9 June 2025

Consideration of funding proposals – Addendum XVI

Funding proposal package for FP274

Summary

This addendum contains the following six parts:

- a) A funding proposal titled “Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)”;
- b) No-objection letter issued by the national designated authority(ies) or focal point(s);
- c) Secretariat’s assessment;
- d) Independent Technical Advisory Panel’s assessment;
- e) Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel’s assessment; and
- f) Gender documentation.

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Disclaimer:

The designations and the presentation of the materials used in this document, including their respective citations, maps and references, have been included by the relevant Accredited Entity and do not imply the expression of any opinion whatsoever on the part of the Green Climate Fund concerning the legal status of any country, territory, city or area or of its authorities, or concerning the delimitation of its frontiers or boundaries. Also, the boundaries and names shown, and the designations used in this document have been included by the relevant Accredited Entity and do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the Green Climate Fund.

Funding Proposal

Project/Programme title: *Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)*

Country(ies): *Cambodia, South Sudan, Tonga*

Accredited Entity: *Save the Children Australia*

Date of first submission: *[2024/10/18]*

Date of current submission *[2025/05/09]*

Version number *[v.B.42]*



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Note to Accredited Entities on the use of the funding proposal template

- Accredited Entities should provide summary information in the proposal with cross-reference to annexes such as feasibility studies, gender action plan, term sheet, etc.
- Accredited Entities should ensure that annexes provided are consistent with the details provided in the funding proposal. Updates to the funding proposal and/or annexes must be reflected in all relevant documents.
- The total number of pages for the funding proposal (excluding annexes) **should not exceed 60**. Proposals exceeding the prescribed length will not be assessed within the usual service standard time.
- The recommended font is Arial, size 11. out
- Under the [GCF Information Disclosure Policy](#), project and programme funding proposals will be disclosed on the GCF website, simultaneous with the submission to the Board, subject to the redaction of any information that may not be disclosed pursuant to the IDP. Accredited Entities are asked to fill out information on disclosure in section G.4.

Please submit the completed proposal to:

fundingproposal@gcfund.org

Please use the following name convention for the file name:

“FP-[Accredited Entity Short Name]-[Country/Region]-[YYYY/MM/DD]”

Acronym List

ACE	Action for Climate Empowerment
BRACE	Building the Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector
CIS	Climate Information System
COP	Conference of the Parties
CSESI	Climate Smart Education Systems Initiative
CSSF	Comprehensive School Safety Framework
DAC	Development Assistance Committee
DAE	Direct Access Entity
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
ECW	Education Cannot Wait
EiE	Education in Emergencies
ESS	Environmental and Social Safeguards
EWS	Early Warning System
FCDO	U.K. Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office
GADRRRES	Global Alliance for Disaster Risk Reduction and Resilience in the Education Sector
GCE	Global Campaign for Education
GCF	Green Climate Fund
GEC	Global Education Cluster
GEF	Global Environment Facility
GEP	Greening Education Partnership
GESI	Gender equality and social inclusion
GPE	Global Partnership for Education
GPE KIX	Global Partnership for Education's Knowledge and Innovation Exchange
INEE MS	Inter-Agency Network for Education in Emergencies Minimum Standards
INGO	International Non-Governmental Organization
IPCC	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
IISD	International Institute for Sustainable Development
LEG	Local Education Group
MCF	Multilateral Climate Fund
MEIDECC	Tonga, Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change, and Communications
MET	Ministry of Education and Training, Tonga
MoE	Ministry of Education
MoEYS	Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport
MoGEI	Ministry of General Education and Instruction, South Sudan
MYRP	Multi-Year Resilience Programme
NAP	National Adaptation Plan
NCQG	New Collective Quantified Goal on Climate Finance
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution
OECD	Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development

PCASS	Pacific Coalition for Advancement of School Safety
PTA	Parent Teacher Association
SAP	Simplified Approval Process
SCA	Save the Children Australia
SCIKHM	Save the Children International in Cambodia
SCISSD	Save the Children International in South Sudan
SCTON	Save the Children in Tonga
SDGs	Sustainable Development Goals
SIDS	Small Island Developing State
SIP	School Improvement Plan
SMC	School Management Committee
ToT	Training of Trainers
TSRSP	Tonga Safe and Resilient Schools Project
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
UNFCCC	United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
WASH	Water, sanitation and hygiene

A. PROJECT/PROGRAMME SUMMARY							
A.1. Project or programme	Project	A.2. Public or private sector	Public				
A.3. Request for Proposals (RFP)	If the funding proposal is being submitted in response to a specific GCF Request for Proposals, indicate which RFP it is targeted for. Please note that there is a separate template for the Simplified Approval Process and REDD+. <u>Not applicable</u>						
A.4. Result area(s)	Check the applicable GCF result area(s) that the <u>overall</u> proposed project/programme targets below. For each checked result area(s), indicate the estimated percentage of GCF and Co-financers' contribution devoted to it. The total of the percentages when summed should be 100% for GCF and Co-financers' contribution respectively.						
	-	GCF contribution	Co-financers' contribution¹				
	Mitigation total	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	☐ Energy generation and access	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	☐ Low-emission transport	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	☐ Buildings, cities, industries and appliances	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	☐ Forestry and land use	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	Adaptation total	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %				
	☒ Most vulnerable people and communities	50 %	50 %				
	☒ Health and well-being, and food and water security	25 %	25 %				
	☒ Infrastructure and built environment	25 %	25 %				
☐ Ecosystems and ecosystem services	<u>Enter number</u> %	<u>Enter number</u> %					
A.5. Expected mitigation outcome (Core indicator 1: GHG emissions reduced, avoided or removed / sequestered)	Indicate greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reductions or removals in tCO₂eq over total lifespan of the project/programme²	A.6. Expected adaptation outcome (Core indicator 2: direct and indirect beneficiaries reached)	9,249,037 total beneficiaries <table border="1"> <tr> <td>608,193 direct</td> <td>8,640,844 indirect</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2.2% of total population reached</td> <td>30.7% of total population reached</td> </tr> </table>	608,193 direct	8,640,844 indirect	2.2% of total population reached	30.7% of total population reached
608,193 direct	8,640,844 indirect						
2.2% of total population reached	30.7% of total population reached						
A.7. Total financing (GCF + co-finance³)	46,737,340 USD	A.9. Project size	Small (Upto USD 50 million)				
A.8. Total GCF funding requested	<u>40,751,264</u> USD For multi-country proposals, please fill out annex 17.						

¹ Co-financer's contribution means the financial resources required, whether Public Finance or Private Finance, in addition to the GCF contribution (i.e. GCF financial resources requested by the Accredited Entity) to implement the project or programme described in the funding proposal.

² The total lifespan of the project/programme is defined as the maximum number of years over which the outcomes of the investment are expected to be effective. This is different from the project/programme implementation period.

³ Refer to the Policy of Co-financing of the GCF.

A.10. Financial instrument(s) requested for the GCF funding	<i>Mark all that apply and provide total amounts. The sum of all total amounts should be consistent with A.8.</i> ☒ Grant 40,751,264 ☐ Equity <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Loan <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Results-based payment <u>Enter number</u> ☐ Guarantee <u>Enter number</u>		
A.11. Implementation period	5 years / 60 months	A.12. Total lifespan	10 years
A.13. Expected date of AE internal approval	<i>This is the date that the Accredited Entity obtained/will obtain its own approval to implement the project/programme, if available.</i> 10/18/2024		A.14. ESS category <i>Refer to the AE's safeguard policy and GCF ESS Standards to assess your FP category.</i> C
A.15. Has this FP been submitted as a CN before?	Yes ☒ No ☐	A.16. Has Readiness or PPF support been used to prepare this FP?	Yes ☒ No ☐
A.17. Is this FP included in the entity work programme?	Yes ☐ No ☒	A.18. Is this FP included in the country programme?	Yes ☒ No ☐
A.19. Complementarity and coherence	<i>Does the project/programme complement other climate finance funding (e.g. GEF, AF, CIF, etc.)? If yes, please elaborate in section B.1.</i> Yes ☐ No ☒		
A.20. Executing Entity information	<i>Also indicate if an Executing Entity is the National Designated Authority.</i> Entity: Save the Children Australia (SCA). Registered in Australia. International Non-Governmental Organisation. Entity: Save the Children International in Cambodia (SCIKHM). Registered in Cambodia. International Non-Governmental Organisation. Entity: Royal Government of Cambodia, acting through the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport (MoEYS). Governmental Organisation. Entity: Save the Children International in South Sudan (SCISSD). Registered in South Sudan. International Non-Governmental Organisation. Entity: Save the Children Tonga Trust (SCTON). Registered in Tonga. International Non-Governmental Organisation.		
A.21. Executive summary (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)			

1. Globally, one billion children, nearly half the world's children, live in countries at extreme vulnerability to the impacts of climate change⁴. All three countries targeted by BRACE through Component 1 - Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga - are exposed to increasing temperatures, changing rainfall patterns, and extreme events (e.g., droughts, floods, and high/extreme temperature events) which result in a range of education-related impacts. The main impacts the project will address include climate-related increases in: children dropping out of school, children and teachers absent from school, learning loss and impacts on learning outcomes, and gender-related impacts (e.g., increases in gender-based violence), and physical impacts that climate hazards have on school facilities (e.g. water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) impacts, etc).
2. **Component 1** will directly address and respond to the impacts of climate change on the education sector and address future climate risks in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga. The project combines national-, sub-national-, and school-level interventions to create sufficient conditions for scalability, and sufficient integration to catalyse the transition to a climate-resilient education system. In Output 1.1 – Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported, climate and education policies, plans and guidelines will be prepared with Ministries of Education and Environment (Activity 1.1.1), and coordination on climate change within Ministries of Education (MoEs), and other relevant line ministries will be strengthened (Activity 1.1.2). Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) plans will be facilitated, tested and updated (Activity 1.1.3), and children will be supported to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives (Activity 1.1.4). In Output 1.2, school facilities are safer and greener, national standards for climate-resilient school facilities will be prepared (Activity 1.2.1), and school facilities, including WASH, retrofitted to strengthen climate resilience (Activity 1.2.2). To ensure sustainability, school communities and education officials will be supported to operate and maintain the retrofitted school facilities (Activity 1.2.3). In Output 1.3, school safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively, master trainers from the Ministry of Education will be supported (Activity 1.3.1) to train school management, teachers and children in how to prepare climate-related school safety plans (Activity 1.3.2), with schools supported to implement their plans and update their plans annually throughout the duration of the project (Activity 1.3.3). Climate resilience tools, equipment and kits will also be distributed to schools (Activity 1.3.4), and Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) access and use in schools will be strengthened (Activity 1.3.5). In Output 1.4, climate change resilience teaching and learning embedded in national systems will be supported through the development of teaching and learning materials on climate change (Activity 1.4.1), building the capacity of teachers and education managers to implement climate change lessons inside the classroom (Activity 1.4.2), support to child clubs to lead climate change initiatives in schools and communities (Activity 1.4.3), and uploading climate change teaching and learning materials to e-learning and other platforms (Activity 1.4.4). Learning documents and events with Ministries of Education to share experience of integrating climate change into the curriculum will also be held (Activity 1.4.5). The project will directly benefit 607,098 people in Component 1, including 392,185 people (188,373 female) in Cambodia, 201,242 (104,929 female) in South Sudan, and 13,671 (6,631 female) in Tonga and a total of 850 schools across all three countries (see Annex 2: Section 6.2: Target Areas and Beneficiaries and Annexes 17a and 17b).
3. In **Component 2**, the project will support Ministries of Education in the three countries – Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga - supporting them to further access climate finance and to lead climate-resilient sustainable development in the education sector. This will include the development of education sector risk analyses on the impact of climate change on the education sector and children's learning (Activity 2.1.1), MoEs to engage in National Adaptation Plan (NAP) processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the UNFCCC. MoEs will also be supported to develop and implement climate finance mobilization road maps, with Direct Access Entities (DAEs) supported to prepare concept notes for the GCF focused on the education sector. Direct beneficiaries will be 210 Ministry of Education and other education and climate change officials from the three countries, with the impact potential to reach children and education personnel in each country.
4. **Component 3**, will support the education community to better coordinate, collaborate, and share lessons learned and experiences with a focus on climate finance. The project will ensure that education and climate stakeholders are connecting, coordinating and cross-learning on climate finance for the benefit of the BRACE countries and future scaling up through the GPE parallel project finance and broader education systems strengthening work. This will be done by establishing a BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform, including a steering committee and core team, to drive forward the interventions (Activity 3.1.1). In addition, Ministries of Education and Environment from Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga will participate in face-to-face meetings to support cross-learning and build political momentum for climate and education (Activity 3.1.2). Global climate finance opportunities in the education sector will be mapped and tracked (Activity 3.1.3), and adjustments to international climate finance reporting to reflect the dual-benefit of investments in climate and education will be undertaken (Activity 3.1.4). The parallel project finance-supported knowledge management platform in a climate change space will also be leveraged to support the three countries access and share learning (Activity 3.2.1) and guidance developed on climate change and education for the GCF, as well as the global education community on climate

finance (Activity 3.2.2) will be developed. Webinars, thematic sessions and learning events will also be held to support the BRACE countries (Activity 3.2.3), and strategic communications materials on climate and education prepared and disseminated (Activity 3.2.4). Component 3 of BRACE will directly reach 1,000 beneficiaries including education and climate change actors in the three target countries. The project's goal statement is **IF** the education stakeholders in climate-vulnerable countries are better informed of climate risks and adaptation options for the education sector, as well as have access to global knowledge, policy exchange and financing, and **IF** the target schools are teaching children about climate change and become safer and greener, **THEN** the school systems of the target countries and beyond, including children and communities, become more resilient, **BECAUSE**, policies of the education sector becomes more responsive to climate change, there will be increased climate finance for the sector, Ministry of Education staff, students and communities will become more knowledgeable and engaged in climate adaptation actions and advocacy.

⁴ UNICEF 2021. The Climate Crisis Is a Child Rights Crisis: Introducing the Children's Climate Risk Index. Available [here](#).

B. PROJECT/PROGRAMME INFORMATION

B.1. Climate context (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

5. **South Sudan** is expected to face significant climate impacts under the SSP2-4.5 scenario from 2020 to 2050, with critical implications for school-age children. These impacts include increased rainfall variability, heightened risks of flooding, intensified heat extremes, and changes in drought severity, all of which will profoundly affect water availability, agriculture, and health.
6. Rainfall is projected to increase slightly, with annual totals averaging around 1,236 mm and modest upward trends. Extreme rainfall events, such as one-day and five-day maximum rainfall, are expected to intensify significantly. Regions like Rumbek North and Akobo in the central areas face heightened flood risks, with severity anomalies reaching up to 100 mm during peak events. Southeastern areas, such as Kapoeta East, are likely to experience moderate rainfall increases. The variability in rainfall patterns and extremes will exacerbate flood risks, disrupting infrastructure and access to schools, especially during the wet season.
7. South Sudan will experience a significant warming trend, with mean temperatures rising by 0.33°C per decade. By mid-century, maximum temperatures will exceed 42°C in some areas, with extreme heat days above 35°C projected to increase by over 9 days per decade. These changes will disproportionately affect northern regions like Rubkona and Twic, where temperature anomalies are expected to exceed +1.25°C. For school-age children, extreme heat will heighten risks of heat-related illnesses, dehydration, and reduced ability to concentrate, particularly in poorly ventilated or outdoor learning environments.
8. Despite projected increases in rainfall, drought intensity is expected to decrease in many areas, reflected by improvements in the SPEI drought index. However, rainfall variability and changes in wet and dry spell duration present challenges. Central and northern regions will see slight reductions in consecutive dry days, but the southeastern regions will face more significant decreases in dry spell durations. These changes may improve water availability but could disrupt traditional planting cycles, impacting food security and nutrition—a critical concern for children's development and learning.

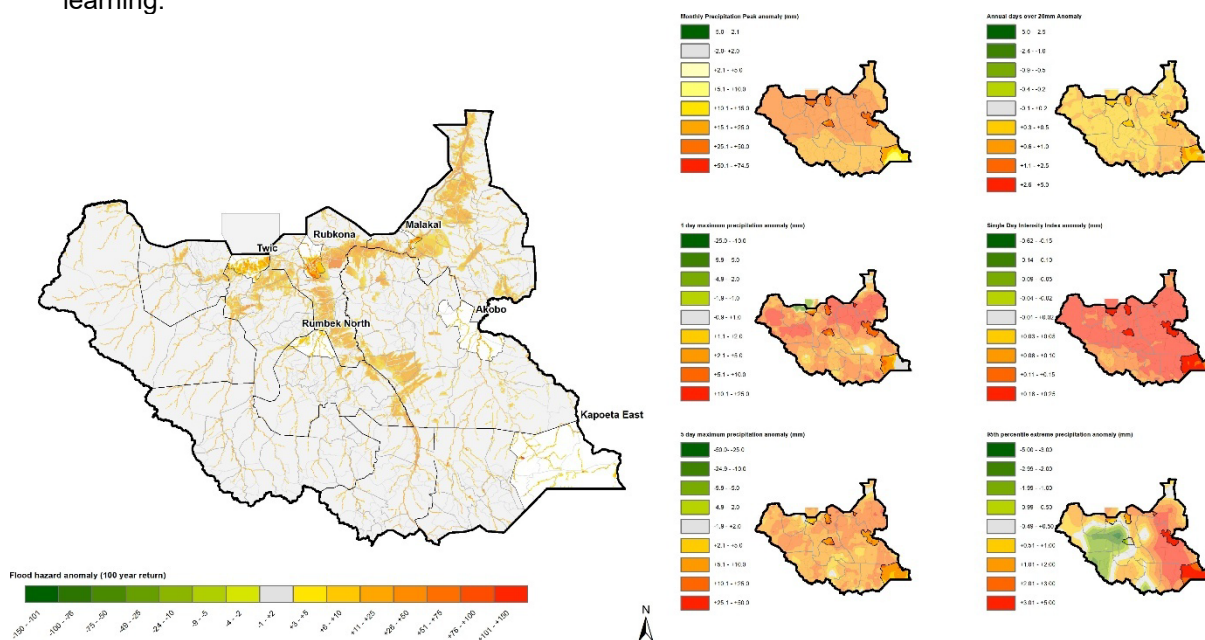


Figure 1-1: Projected flooding and extreme rainfall characteristics. Flood areas (left), extreme rainfall anomaly characteristics (right) (Map source: United Nations OCHA HDX Platform, 18 Dec 2024)

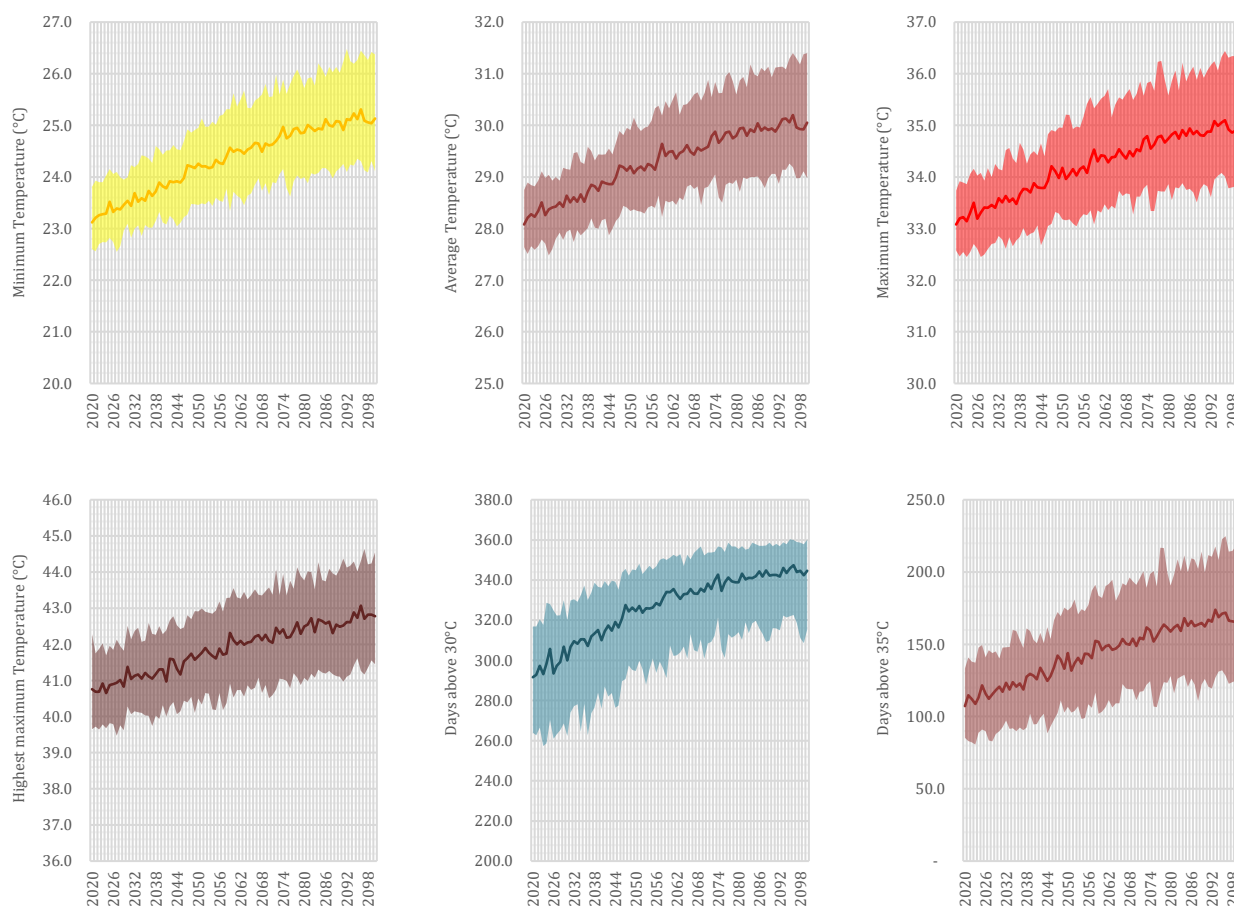


Figure 1-2. Longitudinal change in temperatures from 2020-2100 (SSP2-45). Minimum (top left), Mean (top centre), Maximum (top right) temperatures, Peak maximum temperature (bottom right), days above 30 °C (bottom middle), and the days above 35 °C (bottom right)

For more data, maps and graphs on projected climate change impacts in South Sudan see Annex 2 feasibility study section 3.2.

9. **Cambodia's** climate projections under the SSP2-4.5 scenario from 2020 to 2050 indicate significant changes in rainfall patterns, temperature increases, and heightened risks of extreme weather events. These changes will profoundly affect water management, agriculture, and public health, with notable impacts on school-age children.
10. Annual rainfall is projected to increase slightly, averaging 1,791.78 mm with a 1% per decade upward trend, but regional and seasonal differences will result in uneven impacts. Central regions are expected to receive more rainfall, while parts of the northeast, southeast, and northwest may face declines. Seasonal rainfall patterns will shift, with wetter monsoons from July to October and reduced rainfall in critical planting months like April and May. Extreme rainfall events, such as five-day and one-month maximums, are projected to intensify, increasing flood risks, particularly in southern and northeastern areas.
11. Cambodia will experience a significant warming trend, with minimum, mean, and maximum temperatures increasing by 0.27–0.28°C per decade. By mid-century, average maximum temperatures will reach 32.62°C, with inland areas seeing the highest anomalies. The number of hot days exceeding 35°C will rise dramatically, from 67 days annually to over 90 days, particularly in central and northwestern regions. Days above 40°C, though rare, will also increase.
12. This sustained heat poses significant risks to school-age children, including heat-related illnesses, dehydration, and reduced learning performance due to discomfort in poorly ventilated classrooms. Prolonged exposure to extreme temperatures can also disrupt sleep, affecting children's cognitive function and academic achievement.
13. While the drought index (SPEI) shows an overall improvement, indicating fewer and less severe droughts, regional disparities persist. The northwest may face increased drought severity, while other areas experience moderate improvements. Rising aridity and evaporation rates in the northwest could exacerbate water scarcity, impacting agriculture and household water supply.

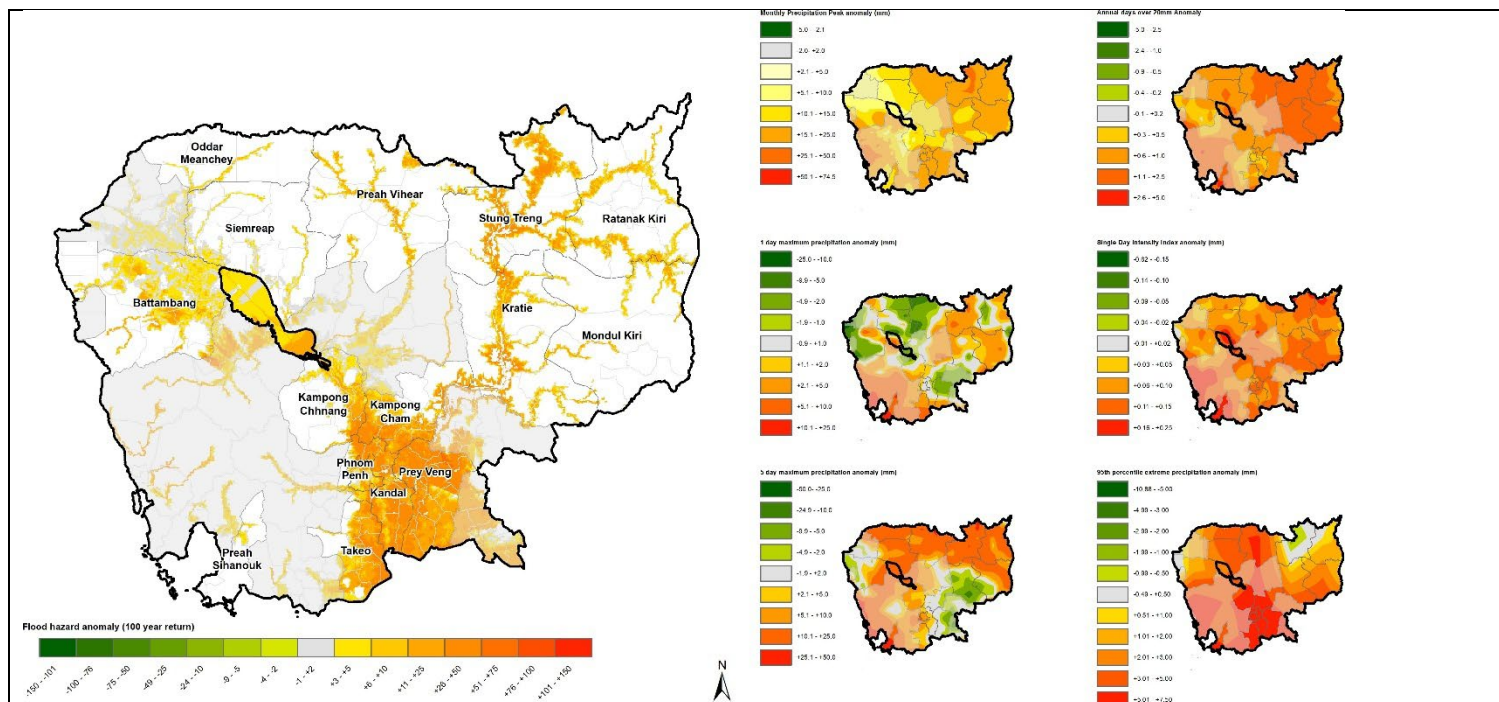


Figure 1-3: Projected flooding and extreme rainfall characteristics. Flood areas (left), extreme rainfall anomaly characteristics (right) (Map source: United Nations OCHA HDX Platform, 18 Dec 2024)

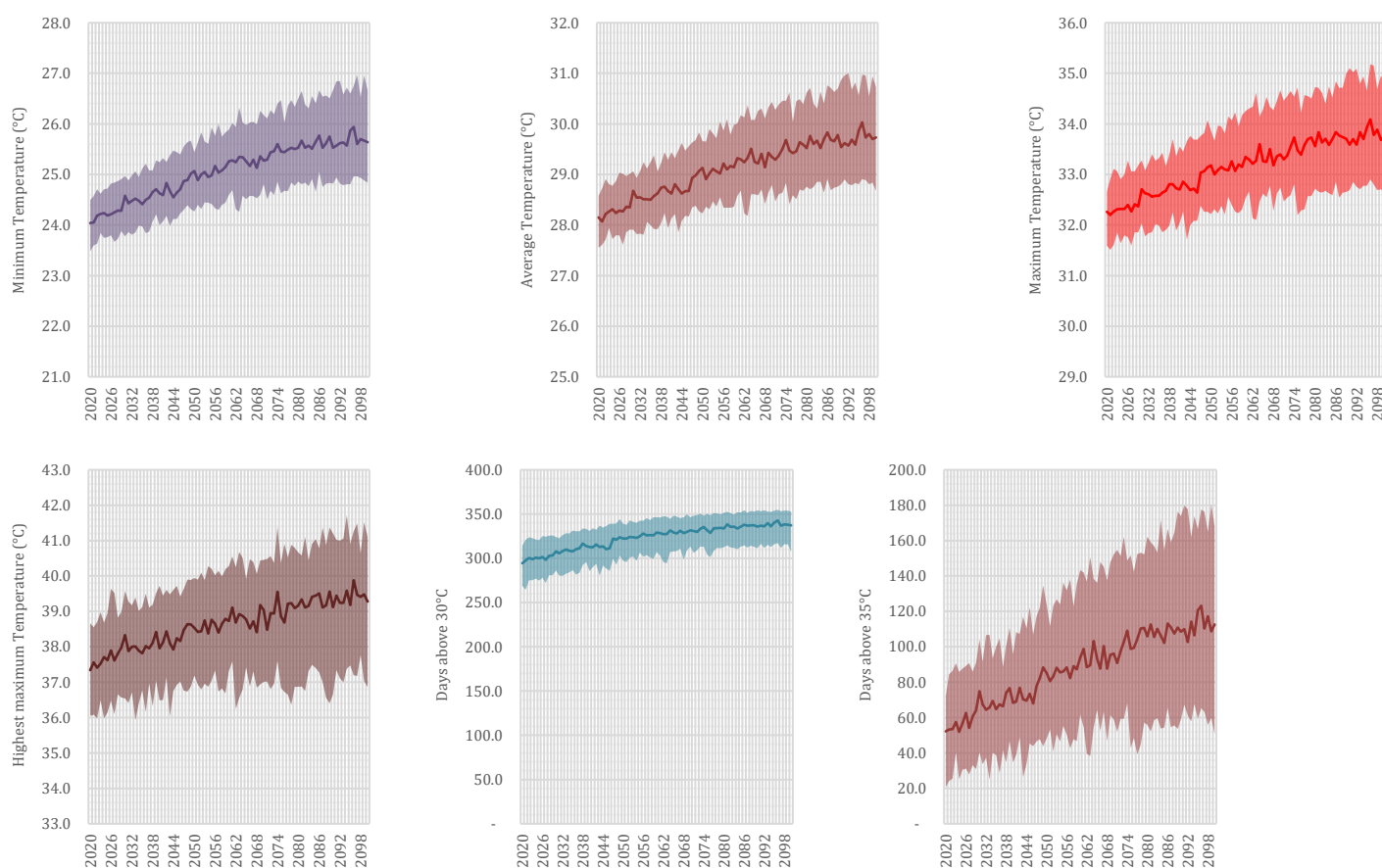


Figure 1-4: Longitudinal change in temperatures from 2020-2100 (SSP2-45). Minimum (top left), Mean (top centre), Maximum (top right) temperatures, Peak maximum temperature (bottom right), days above 30 °C (bottom middle), and the days above 35 °C (bottom right)

For more data, maps and graphs on projected climate change impacts in Cambodia see Annex 2 feasibility study section 2.2.

14. **Tonga's** climate projections under the SSP2-4.5 scenario reveal nuanced changes in rainfall, extreme weather events, and temperature patterns that will significantly affect its people and ecosystems. These changes pose distinct challenges for school-age children, who are particularly vulnerable to disruptions in education, health, and well-being. Tonga is expected to experience a slight decrease in annual rainfall, averaging 1,732.93 mm, with more pronounced variability and intensified extreme rainfall events. The northern islands are likely to face higher extremes, with one-day and five-day maximum rainfall totals increasing by nearly 1 mm and 1.36 mm per decade, respectively. Rainfall seasonality will intensify, causing greater year-to-year variability and potentially disrupting water availability and agricultural cycles. For children, this could mean disruptions to schooling due to infrastructure damage or unsafe travel conditions during extreme rainfall events, especially in remote areas.
15. While drought conditions are projected to improve slightly, increasing aridity and evaporation in some regions could strain water resources, essential for both schools and households. Such conditions may lead to water shortages, which can directly impact hygiene and nutrition—key determinants of children's health and cognitive development.
16. Tonga will face significant warming trends, with minimum, mean, and maximum temperatures rising by approximately 0.17°C per decade. By 2050, the number of days with temperatures above 25°C is expected to rise substantially, with such conditions becoming the norm for over 270 days annually. Northern regions will experience longer warm spells, with durations extending by 50 days per year, while maximum daytime temperatures are projected to exceed 29°C in western areas.
17. The frequency of category 3 cyclones is projected to decrease slightly, but tropical cyclones remain a significant threat to Tonga, given their potential for widespread destruction. Schools are particularly vulnerable to damage from cyclones, which can displace children, interrupt education, and exacerbate mental health challenges due to the trauma of extreme weather events.

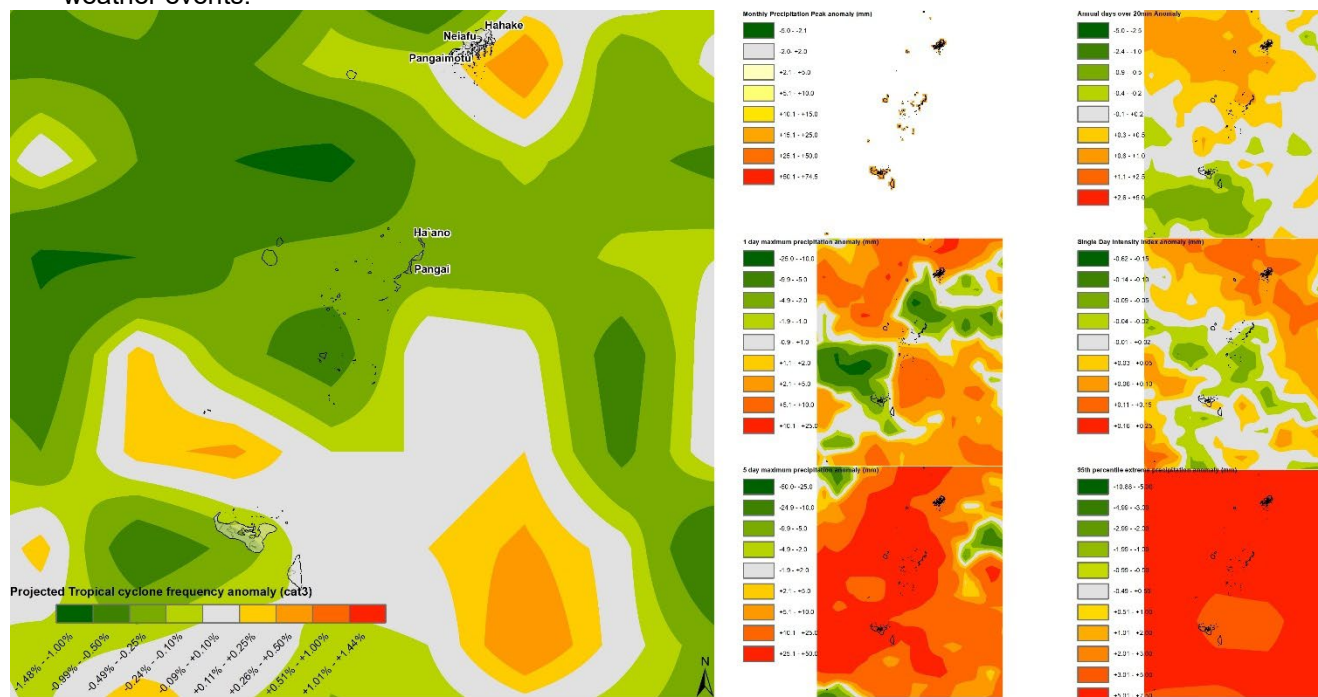


Figure 1-5: Projected flooding and extreme rainfall characteristics. Flood areas (left), extreme rainfall anomaly characteristics (right) (Map source: United Nations OCHA HDX Platform, 18 Dec 2024)

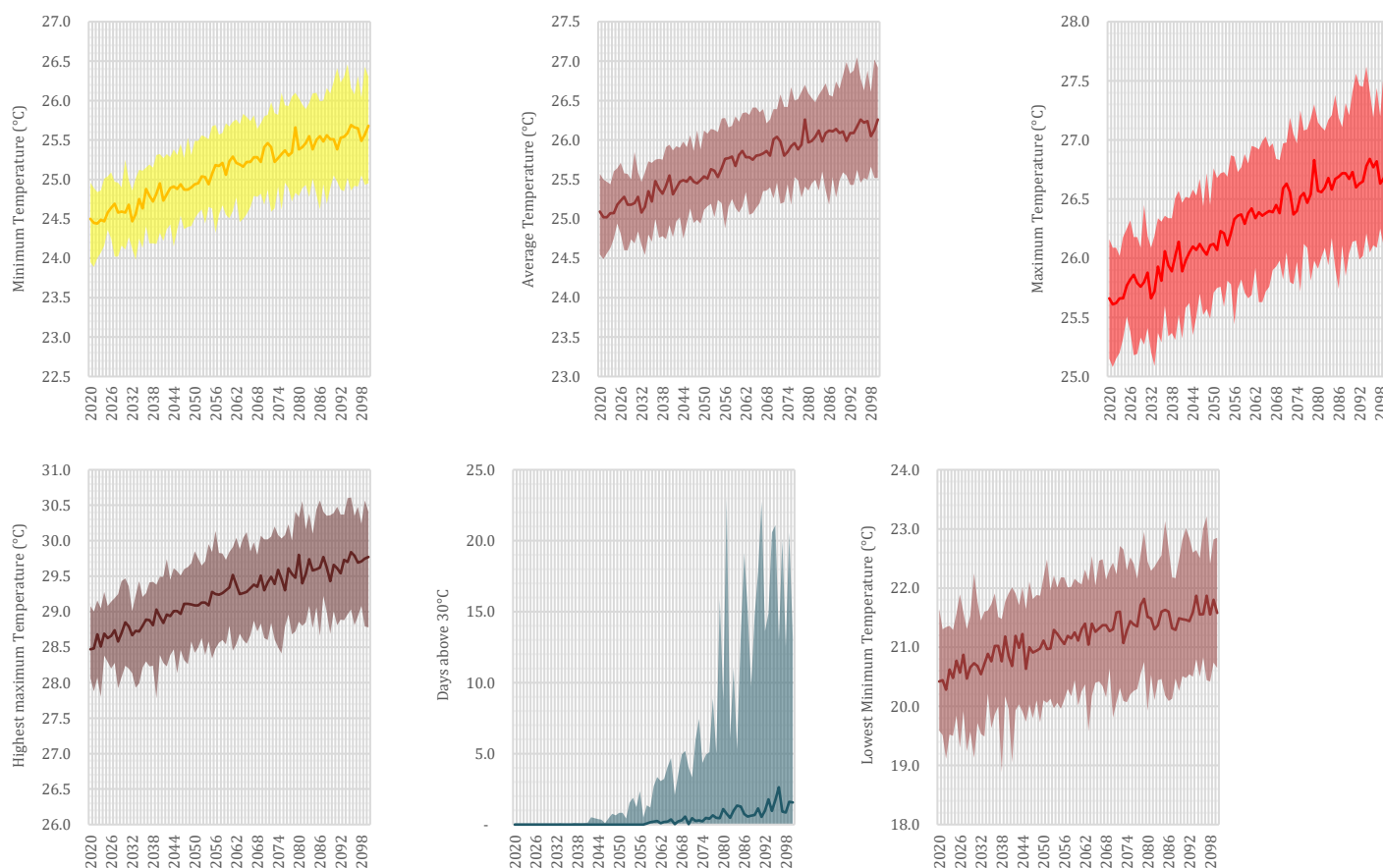


Figure 1-6. Longitudinal change in temperatures from 2020-2100 (SSP2-4.5). Minimum (top left), Mean (top centre), Maximum (top right) temperatures, Peak maximum temperature (bottom right), days above 30 °C (bottom middle), and lowest nighttime temperatures (bottom right)

For more data, maps and graphs on projected climate change impacts in Tonga see Annex 2 feasibility study section 4.2.

Impacts on School-Age Children, School Infrastructure, and Learning

18. The projected climate changes for South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga under the SSP2-4.5 scenario highlight significant challenges for school-age children, school infrastructure, and learning environments, with shared themes of extreme weather events, rising temperatures, and rainfall variability posing threats to education.
19. **In South Sudan**, increasing rainfall extremes and heightened flood risks will likely disrupt school attendance and damage educational infrastructure. Regions prone to flooding, such as central and northern areas, may experience repeated closures or unsafe conditions, limiting consistent access to education. Rising temperatures, with days exceeding 35°C and extended heat waves, will exacerbate health issues like dehydration and heat stress for children, impacting their ability to focus in classrooms that often lack adequate cooling. Prolonged heat and food insecurity from disrupted agriculture will further affect children's cognitive performance and overall well-being.
20. **Cambodia** faces similar challenges, with intensified monsoons and increased frequency of extreme rainfall events leading to higher flood risks, especially in southern and northeastern regions. Flooding could damage schools, disrupt access, and pose sanitation challenges, increasing the risk of waterborne diseases. Rising temperatures, with an average increase of 0.28°C per decade and a dramatic rise in days exceeding 35°C, will create challenging learning environments. Heat stress and lack of proper cooling systems will affect students' focus and attendance. Droughts and shifting rainfall patterns during critical agricultural periods could strain food security, affecting children's nutrition and learning capabilities, especially in rural areas.
21. **In Tonga**, extreme rainfall events and tropical cyclones will continue to be significant threats to school infrastructure, with damage to buildings and disruptions to access during storms. While rainfall variability may lead to localized droughts, the primary concern is the rising temperatures, with extended warm spells increasing risks of heat-related illnesses and

discomfort in learning environments. Increased reliance on cooling measures will strain resources, particularly in remote areas with limited access to electricity. The heightened frequency of extreme weather events will also add stress to families, potentially leading to higher absenteeism and school dropouts.

22. Across all three countries, climate-induced disruptions to school infrastructure, health, and family livelihoods will affect learning continuity and quality. Shared vulnerabilities include flooding and extreme heat, which damage facilities, disrupt access, and create unhealthy or uncomfortable conditions for children. For rural areas, where children often walk long distances to school, these impacts are magnified. Food and water insecurity resulting from climate disruptions add burden, impairing children's physical and cognitive development. Such links between the climate and non-climate drivers, hazards and impacts are shown in the Table below. There are a multitude of climate impacts related to specific country contexts and their hazards provided in the table, with some specific examples well-evidenced e.g.: flood impacts in Cambodia leading to longer commute times for children and thereby reducing hours of learning. It's also important to acknowledge that while there may be differences country-to country, some hazards result in a common set of impacts as far as our understanding and scientific evidence shows when it comes to climate affected education. In paragraph 1 we describe these as: children dropping out of school, children and teachers absent from school, learning loss and impacts on learning outcomes, and gender-related impacts (e.g., increases in gender-based violence), and physical impacts that climate hazards have on school facilities (e.g. water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) impacts, etc.). These climate-education impacts are broadly agreed and acknowledged and often referred to in global documentation⁵. The most recent collection and presentation of what data is currently available on the climate change impacts on the education sector can be found in the World Bank report 'The Impact of climate change on education and what to do about it' April 2024, which can be found [here](#). This includes reference to Tonga "The duration of school closures is prolonged when school infrastructure is vulnerable or when schools are used as evacuation centers. For example, between 50 to 90 percent of 6,000 school buildings across Samoa, Tonga, and Vanuatu may not withstand a strong cyclone." These climate-education impacts are broadly agreed and acknowledged and often referred to in global documentation.⁶ On the other hand, very downscaled documented scientific evidence climate education impacts can be challenging to find, with often a prevalence of qualitative evidence gained through lived experiences and feedback from teachers, children and Ministry of Education stakeholders during field meetings and consultations; though some of these testimonies and lived experiences are outlined in the in the recently published report by the Geneva Global Hub for Education in Emergencies: 'Leveraging Education in Emergencies for Climate Action', which can be found [here](#). Please also see Annex 2: Feasibility Study sections 2.2 (Cambodia), 3.2 (South Sudan) and 4.2 (Tonga).

Table. Linkages between climate drivers, hazards and impacts

Country	Climate driver and hazards	Climate evidenced impacts	Contributing non-climate drivers
Cambodia	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazards: - Drought - Increased evaporation rates	Food insecurity related to child malnutrition; water scarcity impacts at school levels – increased dehydration, reduced hygiene, increased incidence of illness (e.g., diarrhea) ⁷ ; loss of concentration amongst schoolchildren ⁸ ; negative emotional and psychological impacts on children due to direct exposure to climate-related shocks ⁹ – psycho-social stresses from climate impacts on family/community/hunger reducing mental health and school performance; school absenteeism due to fetching household water needs, supporting parents in fields/business ¹⁰ ; inability of families to pay for secondary school fees due to loss of livelihoods, leading to increased drop-out rates; forced early marriage; protection issues and GBV increases related to attacks when fetching water/ escalating domestic violence	- Poverty: household economic status, child-headed household, hunger - Poorest children and children from Indigenous and ethnic minority groups are the most likely to be out of school¹³ - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing girls and forced early marriage; withdrawing children to contribute labour to household economy/food growing - Geographical location: drought exposure levels higher in the north-west, moderate in the north-east and south-east - Geographical location: Last mile / remote communities often result in longer commutes to schools, fetching water, and working fields

⁵ UNICEF, January 2025. Learning Interrupted: Global Snapshot of Climate-related School Disruptions in 2024, Available [here](#).

⁶ UNICEF, January 2025. Learning Interrupted: Global Snapshot of Climate-related School Disruptions in 2024, Available [here](#).

⁷ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

⁸ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

⁹ Ministry of Environment and UNICEF (2024). Children's Climate Risk Index for Cambodia. Available [here](#)

¹⁰ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

¹³ World Vision (2019). Unlocking Cambodia's Future: Improving Access to Quality Basic Education. Available [here](#)

		due to climate impacts on land and water resources ¹¹ ; degradation/decrease of natural resources on school site e.g. vegetation/trees, arable soils; school closures and/or disruptions ¹² .	Deforestation, especially linked to illegal logging may lead to change in microclimate and Tonlé Sap hydrology changes, reduced biodiversity and exacerbate the drying effect.
	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazards: - Heat stress/heat waves - Hotter days - Hotter nights	Child malnutrition due to heat-stressed food system; heat stroke; increased incidence of heat-related illnesses ¹⁴ , dehydration, and reduced ability to concentrate ¹⁵ , particularly in poorly ventilated or outdoor learning environments, sleep disruption, discomfort to body, reduced learning ability, cognitive function affected, underperformance in academic achievement; negative emotional and psychological impacts on children due to direct exposure to climate-related shocks ¹⁶ – psycho-social stresses from climate impacts on family/community/hunger reducing mental health; low levels of concentration by school teachers; absenteeism of both teachers and students ¹⁷ ; national reduction in school hours or enforced school closures ¹⁸ .	- Poverty: household economic status, child-headed household, hunger - Poorest children and children from Indigenous and ethnic minority groups are the most likely to be out of school¹⁹ - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing girls and forced early marriage; withdrawing children to contribute labour to household economy/food growing - Geographical location: exposure levels higher in the central and northwestern regions - Deforestation, especially linked to illegal logging may result in: a) loss of biodiversity, b) microclimate changes and reduced shading at specific locations.
	Driver: Erratic rainfall Hazards: Rainfall patterns shift: wetter monsoons (Jul-Oct); drier planting months (Apr-May)	Shifts in rainfall patterns fundamentally disturb growing cycles ²⁰ resulting in food insecurity and child malnutrition, possible water security and water-borne diseases – all of which disrupts a child's ability to learn and develop in a safe school setting.	- Poverty: household economic status, child-headed household, hunger - Poorest children and children from Indigenous and ethnic minority groups are the most likely to be out of school²¹ - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing girls and forced early marriage; withdrawing children to contribute labour to household economy/food growing - Geographical location: exposure levels for Jul-Oct across most of the country, particularly northeast. - Deforestation, especially linked to illegal logging may result in: a) loss of biodiversity b) destabilised river banks, c) microclimate changes.
	Driver: Erratic rainfall Hazards: - Extreme rainfall events in 5-day and 1-month maximums - Floods/flash floods	Food insecurity related to child malnutrition; reduced learning time in schools due to longer commuting times to school due to inaccessible roads ²² ; water- and vector-borne disease outbreaks ²³ on schools and communities impacting child health and reducing learning time/levels of concentration; damage to school infrastructure and learning materials, damage	- Poverty: household economic status, child-headed household, hunger - Poorest children and children from Indigenous and ethnic minority groups are the most likely to be out of school²⁷ - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing girls and forced early marriage;

¹¹ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

¹² IBRD / The World Bank Group (2024). Choosing Our Future: Education for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

¹⁴ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

¹⁵ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

¹⁶ Ministry of Environment and UNICEF (2024). Children's Climate Risk Index for Cambodia. Available [here](#)

¹⁷ Save the Children (2016). El Niño-Induced Drought in Cambodia: Rapid Assessment Report. Available [here](#)

¹⁸ UNICEF (2025) Learning interrupted: Global snapshot of climate-related school disruptions in 2024. Available [here](#)

¹⁹ World Vision (2019). Unlocking Cambodia's Future: Improving Access to Quality Basic Education. Available [here](#)

²⁰ The World Bank Group and Asian Development Bank (2021). Climate Risk Country Profile – Cambodia. Available [here](#)

²¹ World Vision (2019). Unlocking Cambodia's Future: Improving Access to Quality Basic Education. Available [here](#)

²² World Bank (2023): Country Climate and Development and Report, Cambodia

²³ The World Bank Group and Asian Development Bank (2021). Climate Risk Country Profile – Cambodia. Available [here](#)

²⁷ World Vision (2019). Unlocking Cambodia's Future: Improving Access to Quality Basic Education. Available [here](#)

		to school data/records including teacher certificates; damage to telecommunications and essential services making at-home lessons challenging with smart devices; education continuity disrupted and loss of school days when schools used as community emergency centres or children and teachers cannot access the school due to flood waters, or national enforcement of school closures²⁴ (approx. 1% of Cambodia's students could be disrupted each year by flooding, with up to 33% affected in some areas²⁵); establishment of temporary schools not necessary fit for best outcomes in learning (e.g. location/conditions); psychosocial and mental health deterioration²⁶ due to stresses related to family/community situation and reduced performance at school; child injury or loss of life due to drownings.	withdrawing children to contribute labour to household economy/food growing • Geographical location: intense rainfall exposure levels higher in south-west and northeast • Geographical location: flood exposure levels higher in southern region and isolated parts of north-east • Deforestation may exacerbate the flooding effects and result in changes to Tonlé Sap hydrology.
South Sudan	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazards: • Drought • Increased evaporation rates	Food insecurity related to child malnutrition²⁸; water scarcity impacts at school levels – increased dehydration, reduced hygiene, possible outbreak of diseases (diarrhea), reduced school attendance due to lack of water facilities on lengthy walks to school²⁹; school closures leading to learning losses³⁰; school absenteeism due to families having to travel in search of food, water, and fertile pastures for their livestock³¹; protection issues and GBV increases related to attacks when fetching water³²; violence against women and girls (VAWG) due to increased food insecurity³³; degradation/decrease of natural resources on school site e.g. vegetation/trees, arable soils.	• Poverty: household economic status, child-headed households, limited financial resources within communities to enroll their children in school³⁴ • Refugee and migrant child influx in northern states and associated educational needs • Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing children to contribute labour for the household economy; early marriage and sexual exploitation/GBV leads to loss of access to education for women and girls³⁵ • Socio-cultural: absenteeism of menstruating girls³⁶ • Socio-politics: withdrawing boys for child soldiers • Socio-politics: Conflict affects attendance in schools and ability to concentrate³⁷ • Pastoralist children lack opportunities to attend school due to continual relocation³⁸ • Geographical location and topography (close to equator and low-lying)

²⁴ The World Bank Group (2023). Blog – Floods pose significant risk to education and healthcare in Cambodia. Available [here](#)

²⁵ The World Bank Group (2023). Country Climate and Development Report – Cambodia. Available [here](#)

²⁶ Ministry of Environment and UNICEF (2024). Children's Climate Risk Index for Cambodia. Available [here](#)

²⁸ Global Partnership for Education (2018). Prolonged Drought In East Africa Forces Millions of Children Out of School. Available [here](#)

²⁹ EIE Hub (2023). Leveraging Education in Emergencies for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

³⁰ IBRD / The World Bank (2024). Choosing Our Future: Education for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

³¹ Global Partnership for Education (2018). Prolonged Drought In East Africa Forces Millions of Children Out of School. Available [here](#)

³² UN Women (2024). South Sudan: Women Weathering Climate Impact and Increased Violence. Available [here](#)

³³ UN Women (2024). South Sudan: Women Weathering Climate Impact and Increased Violence. Available [here](#)

³⁴ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

³⁵ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

³⁶ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

³⁷ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

³⁸ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazards: - Heat stress/heatwaves - Hotter days - Hotter nights	Heat-related illness (including students collapsing³⁹); dehydration; indoor classroom environments unfit for learning and teaching due to negative impacts on teacher/student concentration and motivation⁴⁰; outdoor learning environments (e.g., in the shade of trees or in flimsy tents) expose teachers and students to harsh weather conditions, with disproportionate impacts on girls⁴¹; loss of educational gains due to school closures⁴².	- Poverty: limited financial resources within communities to enroll their children in school⁴³ - Refugee and migrant child influx in northern states and associated educational needs - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing children to contribute labour for the household economy; early marriage and sexual exploitation/GBV leads to loss of access to education for women and girls⁴⁴ - Socio-cultural: absenteeism of menstruating girls⁴⁵ - Socio-politics: withdrawing boys for child soldiers - Socio-politics: Conflict affects attendance in schools and ability to concentrate⁴⁶ - Pastoralist children lack opportunities to attend school due to continual relocation⁴⁷ - Geographical location: highest temperatures are concentrated in the northeast and southeastern regions
	Driver: Variable rainfall Hazards: - Extreme rainfall events in 5-day and 1-month maximums - Floods/flash floods	Damage to school infrastructure⁴⁸ leading to school closures (190 schools closed due to flooding in 2021⁴⁹) and learning losses⁵⁰; increased likelihood of school drop-outs – children out of school for a long time become less likely to return to school⁵¹; damage to transport infrastructure to schools (e.g., roads and bridges)⁵²; compromised access to education for schoolchildren due to use of schools as shelters for flood-displaced people⁵³; reduced school attendance due to dangers in commuting (e.g., mud and flooded roads) during the rainy season.⁵⁴	- Geographical location: intense rainfall exposure levels higher in Rumbek North, Akobo, and to a lesser extent Kapoeta. - Refugee and migrant child influx in northern states and associated educational needs - Poverty: limited financial resources within communities to enroll their children in school⁵⁵ - Socio-cultural-economics: withdrawing children to contribute labour for the household economy; early marriage and sexual exploitation/GBV leads to loss of access to education for women and girls⁵⁶ - Socio-cultural: absenteeism of menstruating girls⁵⁷

³⁹ EU-Africa Chamber Group (2025). South Sudan: Heatwave forces schools to shut for second year running. Available [here](#)

⁴⁰ EIE Hub (2023). Leveraging Education in Emergencies for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

⁴¹ EIE Hub (2023). Leveraging Education in Emergencies for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

⁴² UNICEF (2024). Press Release – Rising Heat, Drought and Disease: Climate Crisis Poses Grave Risks to Children in Eastern and Southern Africa. Available [here](#)

⁴³ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

⁴⁴ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

⁴⁵ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁴⁶ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁴⁷ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁴⁸ UN OCHA (2023). South Sudan: On the front line of climate change. Available [here](#)

⁴⁹ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁵⁰ IBRD / The World Bank (2024). Choosing Our Future: Education for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

⁵¹ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁵² UN OCHA (2023). South Sudan: On the front line of climate change. Available [here](#)

⁵³ UN OCHA (2023). South Sudan: On the front line of climate change. Available [here](#)

⁵⁴ EIE Hub (2023). Leveraging Education in Emergencies for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

⁵⁵ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

⁵⁶ UN OCHA (2022). South Sudan Humanitarian Needs Overview. Available [here](#)

⁵⁷ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

			- Socio-politics: withdrawing boys for child soldiers - Socio-politics: Conflict affects attendance in schools and ability to concentrate⁵⁸ - Pastoralist children lack opportunities to attend school due to continual relocation⁵⁹
Tonga	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazard: - Drought - Increased evaporation rates	Food insecurity related to child malnutrition; water scarcity impacts at school levels – reduced water availability for school gardens and hygiene facilities impacts on children's nutrition and sanitation; ⁶⁰ heat stress due to insufficient water for classroom cooling systems.	- Geographical location: Ha'apai is likely to experience higher drought severity in the future - Reliance of schools on rainwater catchments for water supply increases vulnerability to drought⁶¹ - Poverty, especially for children in outer islands; Children and young people are more likely to be living in poor households⁶²
	Driver: Increasing temperature Hazard: - Heat stress - Hotter days - Hotter nights	Heat-related medical conditions, including heat exhaustion, particularly amongst children ⁶³ ; failure to concentrate, including as a result of sleep disruption, negatively impacts on academic performance and risks learning outcomes; walking to school in heat also impacts learning potential; school closure or shorter school days leading to reduced teaching and learning time; dehydration; reduced physical activity tolerance; water- and vector-borne diseases (specifically dengue fever) ⁶⁴ .	- Geographical: western regions are projected to experience the highest peak temperatures - Poverty, especially for children in outer islands; Children and young people are more likely to be living in poor households⁶⁵ - Increased risk of school dropout for boys in secondary schools due to pressure to support family income - Low literacy and numeracy levels, especially in rural areas where resources are limited - Violence in school leads to children refusing to go to school, truancy, or children dropping out of school completely⁶⁶
	Driver: Erratic rainfall Hazard: Floods	Impacts to transport infrastructure to school (roads, river crossing, walking tracks); increased risk of injury and death; health-related issues – spread of water- and vector-borne diseases, especially to ECE and primary; destruction of classrooms and WASH facilities impacts on access to fresh water; increased prevalence of child sexual abuse and other forms of violence against children amongst those living in evacuation centres or camps in the aftermath of floods ⁶⁷ .	- Poverty, especially for children in outer islands; Children and young people are more likely to be living in poor households⁶⁸ - Disability increases the risk of abuse against children, including child sexual abuse⁶⁹ - Gender and sexual diversity: Increased risk of violence against children who identify as gender or sexually diverse⁷⁰

⁵⁸ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁵⁹ World Vision (2022). The impact of South Sudan's crises on education. Available [here](#)

⁶⁰ UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁶¹ WHO (2016). Sanitation, Drinking-Water and Health in Pacific Island Countries: 2015 Update and Future Outlook. Available [here](#)

⁶² UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁶³ The World Bank (2021). Climate Risk Country Profile – Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁶⁴ WHO (2016). Sanitation, Drinking-Water and Health in Pacific Island Countries: 2015 Update and Future Outlook. Available [here](#)

⁶⁵ UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁶⁶ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁶⁷ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁶⁸ UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁶⁹ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁷⁰ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

			Violence in school leads to children refusing to go to school, truancy, or children dropping out of school completely⁷¹
	Driver: Sea-level rise (SLR) Hazards: - Sea intrusion and saline inundation - Coastal erosion	Damage to school infrastructure; loss of land available for school infrastructure/ encroachment on existing education land especially in low lying areas near the capital Nukūlofa; land instability leading to increased risk of injury and death; psychosocial harm/mental distress; increased incidence of vector-borne diseases ⁷² .	- Poverty, especially for children in outer islands; Children and young people are more likely to be living in poor households⁷³ - Undersea volcanic activity - Land subsidence
	Driver: Strong or severe winds Hazard: Cyclones	Damage to school infrastructure resulting in school closures, which in turn negatively impacts on ability to learn (Tropical Cyclone Gita in 2018 damaged 72% of all schools on the main island of Tongatapu, severely impacting the education of approx. 23,000 students ⁷⁴); impacts to transport infrastructure to school (blocking roads, river crossing, walking tracks); flying debris during increasingly severe cyclones leading to increased risk of injury and death; psychosocial harm/mental distress; prolonged school closures lead to significant disruptions in learning; destruction of water and sanitation systems result in school closures, even if classrooms are undamaged ⁷⁵ ; damage to or destruction of school resources and furniture ⁷⁶ ; increased incidence of child neglect by parents and caregivers ⁷⁷ ; increased prevalence of child sexual abuse and other forms of violence against children amongst those living in evacuation centres or camps in the aftermath of a cyclone. ⁷⁸	- Poverty, especially for children in outer islands; Children and young people are more likely to be living in poor households⁷⁹ - Poor general maintenance and building conditions leading to unsafe school infrastructure (between 50 to 90% of school buildings may not withstand a strong cyclone⁸⁰) - Disability increases the risk of abuse against children, including child sexual abuse⁸¹ - Gender and sexual diversity: Increased risk of violence against children who identify as gender or sexually diverse⁸² - Violence in school leads to children refusing to go to school, truancy, or children dropping out of school completely⁸³

23. BRACE offers a holistic solution to the climate vulnerabilities faced by the education sector; it is a first and has an ambitious goal. Given the uniqueness of BRACE, there are no predecessors in terms of like-for-like initiatives. Existing projects have addressed narrow aspects of climate change resilience in the education sector but have been limited in conceptual scope and/or geographical coverage. For example, in Cambodia, initiatives such as Green Generation and the Local Life Skills Education (LLSE) project have focused on climate change and environmental teaching and education and equipping students with the skills to solve local climate-related challenges. South Sudan has faced chronic underinvestment in climate-resilient education, with interventions focused on humanitarian needs (Education in Emergencies) and disaster risk reduction, such as those supported by the Education Cannot Wait (ECW) Multi-Year Resilience Programme and NORAD Framework Agreement. In Tonga, the Safe and Resilient Schools Project (SRSP) is working in selected locations and educational programmes to enhance the safety and resilience of education facilities and improve the quality of education management, curricula and assessments and BRACE specifically builds on the targeting

⁷¹ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁷² The World Bank (2021). Climate Risk Country Profile – Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁷³ UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁷⁴ World Bank (2022). Feature Story – Securing a Future with Safer Schools: Building Resilience in Pacific Schools. Available [here](#)

⁷⁵ Government of Tonga (2018). Post Disaster Rapid Assessment – Tropical Cyclone Gita. Available [here](#)

⁷⁶ Government of Tonga (2018). Post Disaster Rapid Assessment – Tropical Cyclone Gita. Available [here](#)

⁷⁷ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁷⁸ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁷⁹ UNICEF (2017). Situation Analysis of Children in Tonga. Available [here](#)

⁸⁰ IBRD / The World Bank (2024). Choosing Our Future: Education for Climate Action. Available [here](#)

⁸¹ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁸² Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

⁸³ Save the Children (2023). Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#)

of this project extending the reach of SRSP. BRACE is designed to complement and collaborate with synergistic education and climate initiatives, building on any foundational achievements from past/current programming in the three countries to fill gaps in climate action in education and deliver a holistic solution at scale to maximise impact. Further details on complementarity with existing initiatives is provided in Annex 2: Feasibility Study (Sections 2.1.3, 3.1.4, and 4.1.5).

24. Without the BRACE intervention, the 'business-as-usual' scenario will ensure targeted countries remain ill-equipped to cope with and adapt to current and projected climate change and extreme weather events, resulting in increased climate vulnerability, school closures, children dropping out of school, gender inequality, and learning losses. Furthermore, Ministries of Education will not have the necessary resources to prioritise and access climate finance, nor develop national-level and realistic climate-related education policies, targets and programming to support strengthened resilience at this critical time. However, with the BRACE intervention in place, targeted countries and wider global education and climate networks will be engaged to support implementation of evidence-based climate adaptation actions that support school communities fighting exacerbated climate change, secure a more optimistic and productive future for school children and their learning and development opportunities, and increase the resilience of school assets.

B.2 (a). Theory of change narrative and diagram (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagram)

25. The project's paradigm shift goal statement is:

IF the education stakeholders in climate-vulnerable countries are better informed of climate risks and adaptation options for the education sector, as well as have access to global knowledge, policy exchange and financing, and **IF** the target schools are teaching children about climate change and become safer and greener, **THEN** the school systems of the target countries and beyond, including children and communities, become more resilient, **BECAUSE**, policies of the education sector becomes more responsive to climate change, there will be increased climate finance for the sector, Ministry of Education staff, students and communities will become more knowledgeable and engaged in climate adaptation actions and advocacy.

26. This goal will be achieved via implementation of activities under three components, each with an associated outcome:

- **Component 1:** Building Climate-Resilient School Infrastructure and Systems with outputs and activities leading to **Outcome 1** – The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change. *Sub-activities under this component are designed to address country-specific nuances in climate change vulnerability and the barriers faced.*
- **Component 2:** Enhancing Access to Climate Finance for Education, with outputs and activities leading to **Outcome 2** – Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change *Sub-activities under this component address vulnerabilities and barriers common to all three project countries.*
- **Component 3:** Coordination and Knowledge Sharing on Climate and Education, with outputs and activities leading to **Outcome 3** – Education and climate stakeholders are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector. *Sub-activities under this component address vulnerabilities and barriers common to all three project countries.*

27. BRACE causal links are indicated in the ToC figure below. These causal links represent a dynamic relationship between the activities that directly address the identified barriers, enabling the climate risks to be reduced. This relationship allows for the output results to be achieved, feeding into the higher-level outcomes, while delivering co-benefits across the education sector and ultimately delivering the paradigm shift ambition. The project is designed to address multiple climate-related hazards (including heatwaves, flooding, extreme rainfall, drought, and sea-level rise) and barriers to climate change adaptation in the education sector that, while nuanced, are generally common to all three countries.⁸⁴ Component 1 is designed to address these nuances through country-specific sub-activities, which are commonly clustered at the output/activity level; whereas Components 2 and 3 comprise sub-activities common across all three countries. Project Outputs under each component will be mutually supportive with **Output 1.1** on enabling systems and policies supporting and informing action under **Output 1.2** on safer and greener school facilities, **Output 1.3** on school safety and educational continuity management systems, and **Output 1.4** on embedding climate change resilience teaching and learning. These Outputs, delivered through country-specific interventions, will collectively address the full range of barriers outlined (i.e., governance, social, informational, financial, technological, institutional, and gender and social inclusion). Also causally linked is **Output 2.1** on climate risk-informed decision-making and influencing, which targets information and institutional barrier, and supports achievement of **Output 1.1** (especially Activities 1.1.1-1.1.3 on cross-sectoral coordination and integration of climate change into education sector policies and plans). **Output 3.1** which establishes a climate resilient

⁸⁴ N.B. As a landlocked country, South Sudan is not directly affected by sea-level rise.

education co-investment platform and **Output 3.2** on peer learning and exchange will serve as enablers to enhance achievement of **Output 2.1** on climate risk-informed decision-making and influencing, **Output 2.2** on finance for climate action in the education sector, and **Output 1.1** on enabling systems and policies. In addition, all four Outputs under **Outcome 1** on resilience of the education sector at national and sub-national levels will enhance the optimisation of **Output 3.2** on peer learning and exchange. In particular, this will be achieved through the evidencing of interventions, which in turn allows for new knowledge on what works and where the gaps remain on the ground based on different contexts and climate hazards. **Output 2.2** and **Output 3.1** will primarily address governance, financial and institutional barriers; while **Output 3.2** will primarily address information, technological and institutional barriers. This project logic demonstrates the links between outputs and outcomes and the change required in the enabling environment through reducing the barriers to operate a strengthened climate resilient education sector.

28. The project will also have three co-benefits (see Section D.3 for more detail), including:

- **Co-benefit 1: Gender equity and social inclusion** increases in the education sector. This co-benefit will be achieved via activities that contribute to Outcome 1.
- **Co-benefit 2 (Environmental):** Clean and green environment promoted in the targeted schools. School greening through reduced emissions from school infrastructure and Natural Resource Management (NRM) initiatives contributing to school-ground shading, windbreaking and cooling effects. This co-benefit will be achieved via activities that contribute to Outcome 1 (particularly Output 1.2).
- **Co-benefit 3 (Social): Increased Locally-led Adaptation (LLA)** – Influencing the LLA agenda working at the local school level with children, resident teachers and parents/community members. This co-benefit is achieved through Outcomes 1, 2 and 3.

29. The project will work to address a range of key barriers to scaling up climate action in the education sector in the target countries, as well as more broadly through Component 2 (Enhancing access to climate finance for education) and Component 3 (Coordination and knowledge sharing). An overview of how the project interventions are designed to overcome these barriers is provided in the Table below. These underlying barriers limit the options available to the education sector in responding to climate change and extreme events. In addition, it is likely that unmitigated barriers increase cases of maladaptation practices as a short-term cost-effective coping mechanism. This is something clearly that the project would both address and seeks to avoid.

Table. Barriers to adaptation in the education sector that the project will address

Barriers	How the project intends to overcome the barriers through country-specific activities
Governance: Lack of resources and capacity for effective enabling environment and institutional governance for climate action in the education sector.	Activity 1.1.1 “Facilitate preparation and endorsement of climate and education policies, plans and guidelines” and Activity 1.1.3 “Facilitate integration of DRR into existing and/or new plans with education authorities” specifically seek to address the governance barrier in the three countries. Specific sub-activities in each country were designed in partnership with relevant ministries to enable them to overcome the current challenges preventing them from building an enabling environment that allows for more effective integration of climate change into the education sector.
Social: No culture of resilience in educational institutions which reduces uptake of available resources.	Activity 1.1.2 “Strengthen coordination on climate change within Ministries of Education (MoEs) and other relevant line ministries at national and sub-national level” seeks to link MoEs with those responsible for climate change and disaster risk reduction (i.e., national disaster management agencies) and meteorological departments to enable MoEs to better understand and own their roles in supporting resilience building in the education sector. Activity 1.1.4 “Support children to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives” will also enable children to provide their voice to the MoEs on the importance of safety and climate resilience in the education sector and schools for children.
Information: Limited access to relevant, high quality climate information for decision making in the education sector.	Activity 1.3.5 “Strengthen access to and use of Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) in schools” has a comprehensive list of sub-activities in each country specifically aimed at ensuring that relevant actors in MoEs have access to quality climate information for evidence-based and risk-informed decision making.
Financial:	All of the outputs/activities under Outcome 2 “Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the

Low or no flows of finance for climate in education at the national level (domestic or international).	education sector to climate change” and Outcome 3 “Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector” are specifically designed to drive ‘bottom up’ demand by MoEs to access climate finance and enable ‘global to national’ supply of financing through enhanced coordination and collaboration of donors, UN agencies and NGOs in supporting national priorities.
Technological: Low level of technical expertise with limited availability to support effective action.	Technological solutions are deployed in Activity 1.3.5 “Strengthen access to and use of Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) in schools” and across all activities under Output 1.2 “School facilities are safer and greener”. Both interventions include capacity building and training to increase the technical expertise to effectively used the technological solutions deployed (EWS and building design). Under Output 1.2 , building and construction expertise, including best practice design using traditional and vernacular construction approaches, will be integrated into design and construction cycles, ensuring that MoE construction supervisors and local contractors can effectively deploy the improved roof designs.
Institutional: No central and interconnected ‘home’ for coordinating approaches and ensuring cross-learning.	Output 3.2 “Key stakeholders are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through south-south collaboration” includes a suite of interconnected activities that support, promote and enable south-south learning and collaboration, and provide a ‘home’ for hosting information and materials (such as, but not limited to, best practices information sheets) and enable engagement across countries, and between countries and subject matter experts.
Gender and social inclusion: Inequalities in access and educational attainment for girls and children with disability	Please see Annex 8 “Gender Assessment and Action Plan” for a comprehensive overview of the gender and social inclusion barriers and the strategies and activities designed to overcome them.

30. There are a range of specific climate drivers that generate key risks to climate resilience and sustainability of the education sector. These are summarised in the Figure below.

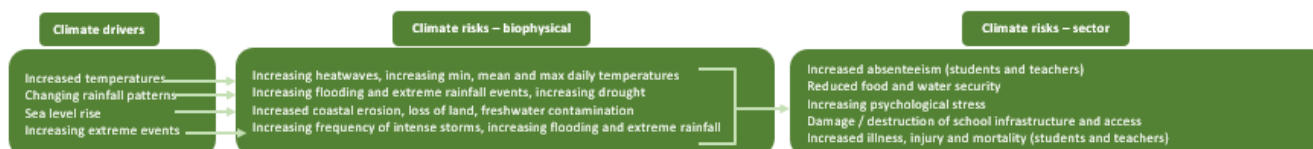
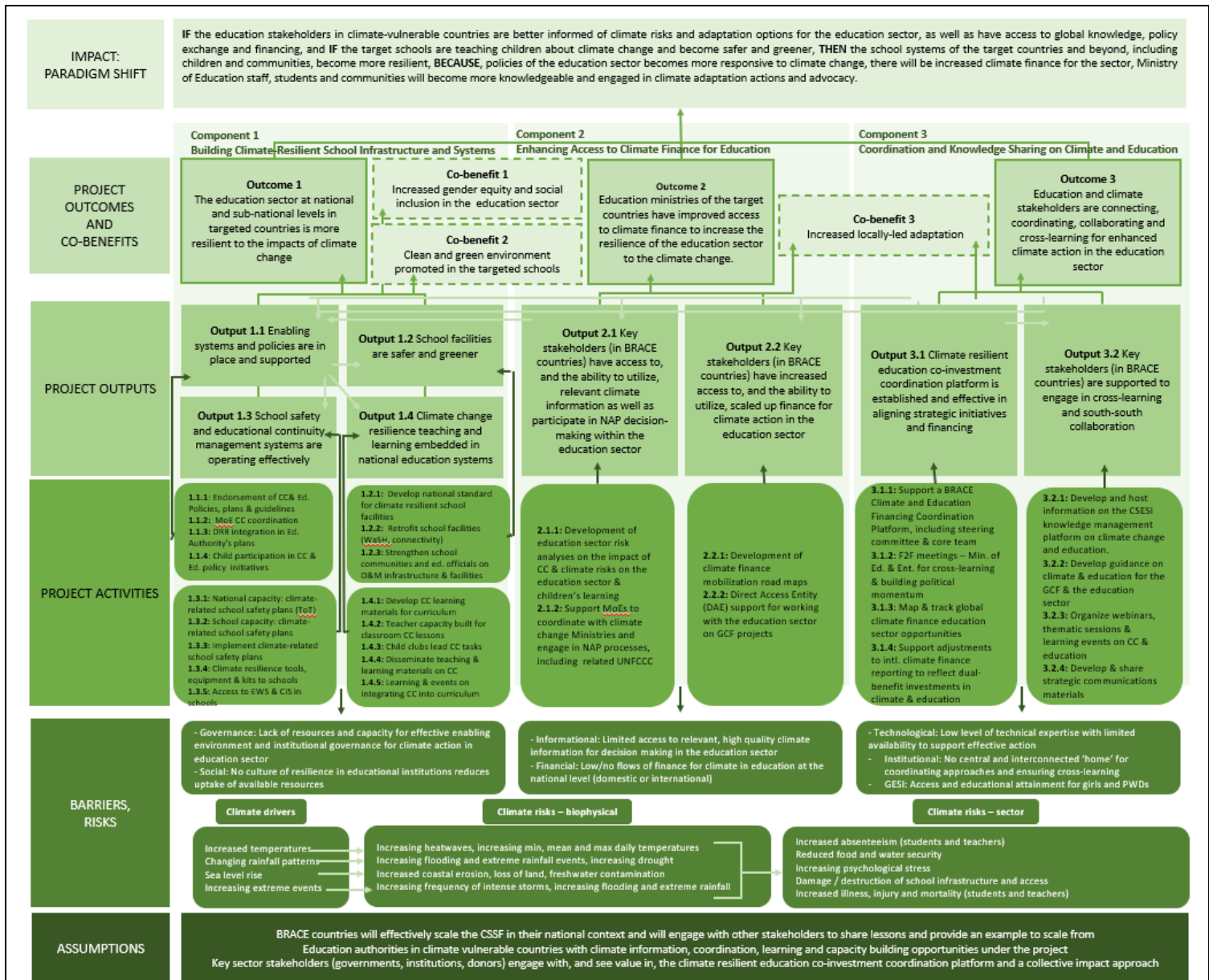


Figure 1: Key climate drivers resulting in biophysical and sector specific risks

31. A number of assumptions will also need to hold true, including that:
- Target countries will effectively scale the CSSF in their national (and local) context and will engage with other stakeholders to share lessons and provide an example to scale from.
 - Education authorities in climate vulnerable countries engage with climate information, coordination, learning, and capacity building opportunities under the project.
 - Key sector stakeholders (governments, institutions, donors, civil society at all scales) engage with, and see value in, the having a platform to coordinate co-investment in the integration of climate change into the education sector and a collective impact approach.
32. The project’s theory of change is summarised in the Figure below.



B.2 (b). Outcome mapping to GCF results areas and co-benefit categorization

Fill in the GCF results area table below to map each project/programme outcome identified in section B.2(a) to the contributing GCF results area(s) by referring to the description of eight results areas provided in the guidance note.

Outcome number	GCF Mitigation Results Area (MRA 1-4)				GCF Adaptation Results Area (ARA 1-4)			
	MRA 1 Energy generation and access	MRA 2 Low-emission transport	MRA 3 Building, cities, industries, appliances	MRA 4 Forestry and land use	ARA 1 Most vulnerable people and communities	ARA 2 Health, well-being, food and water security	ARA 3 Infrastructure and built environment	ARA 4 Ecosystems and ecosystem services
Outcome 1:					X	X	X	
Outcome 2:					X	X		
Outcome 3:						X		

If any co-benefits have been identified in section B.2(a), fill in the Co-benefit table below to map each co-benefit to the corresponding category as defined in the FP guidance note.

Co-benefit number	Co-benefit					
	Environmental	Social	Economic	Gender	Adaptation	Mitigation
Co-benefit 1: Gender: Increased gender equity and social inclusion in the education sector		X		X		
Co-benefit 2: Environment: Clean and green environment is promoted in the targeted schools	X					
Co-benefit 3: Social: Increased Locally-led Adaptation		X				

B.3. Project/programme description (max. 2500 words, approximately 5 pages)

33. BRACE focuses on enhancing the climate resilience of the education sector and addressing risks and impacts from droughts, heat stress, and floods. In Component 1 BRACE will be implemented in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga combining climate-resilient interventions at national, sub-national, and school levels. Component 2 will work directly with Ministries of Education in the three target countries to strengthen their access to climate finance through the preparation of easy-to-use guidance and engagement in National Adaptation Planning processes. Component 3 will strengthen coordination on climate change and education with a focus on financing to support sustainability of the interventions in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga. BRACE will directly benefit 607,098 people in Component 1, including 392,185 people (188,373 female) in Cambodia, 201,242 (104,929 female) in South Sudan, and 13,671 (6,631 female) in Tonga. The nature of the work in Component 2 and Component 3 means the direct reach will be lower as the project will support and work with a select group of ministry officials, their partners and international organizations, but the indirect reach, will cover all school-aged children in the three target countries of BRACE. Therefore, it is estimated that Component 2 will directly benefit 210 beneficiaries and Component 3 will benefit 1,000 beneficiaries. The project will achieve climate-resilient education systems and support children's learning through a multi-pronged approach as set out in the project ToC outlined in section B.2. More information on the outcomes, outputs, and activities can be found in the feasibility study (Annex 2). Furthermore, the BRACE project will be complemented by parallel project finance from the Global Partnership for Education (GPE) and with UNESCO will help to address border drivers of the challenges that children face in being educated in climate stressed environments, such as absenteeism and dropping-out, as the GPE and UNESCO support governments broader system strengthening initiatives of the education systems which includes tackling the broader causes of absenteeism and dropping-out.

34. Component 1

OUTCOME 1: The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.

The activities under this outcome will enable policies to be in place to support climate-resilient education to ensure that school facilities are safer and more climate resilient, that school safety systems are in place and educational continuity is protected, and that climate-resilient teaching and learning is supported in schools. These activities will address governance, social, informational, financial, technological, institutional, and gender and social inclusion barriers.

35. **Output 1.1 Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported**

The activities under this output will support Ministries of Education to incorporate climate change within their education sector plans and policies and to strengthen internal coordination within the Ministry of Education on climate change and cross-sectoral

coordination with other line ministries. Girls and boys, including those with disabilities, will participate in policy dialogues on climate change and education so that their priorities are heard in policy discussions.

36. Activity 1.1.1 Facilitate preparation and endorsement of climate and education policies, plans, and guidelines

This activity will work with Ministries of Education and the Environment, and other stakeholders to prepare national climate change and education plans, policies, and guidelines based on the priorities identified in each country. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will support the MoEYS to establish a National Climate Resilience in Education Framework, along with annual reviews of climate-related education budget allocations. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will work with MoGEI to develop a climate change and education policy with implementation guidelines and update the Inter-Agency Network for Education in Emergencies (INEE) Minimum Standards (MS) to include climate change and the environment.

37. Activity 1.1.2 Strengthen coordination on climate change within Ministries of Education and other relevant line ministries at national and sub-national level

This activity will support the Ministry of Education to have stronger internal and cross-sectoral coordination with Ministries of Environment and other line ministries responsible for climate change and DRR. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will organize annual multi-stakeholder dialogue events on climate change within the education sector. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will strengthen coordination between education and environment government officials at sub-national level, including the identification of climate change focal points, building on the work initiated through CSEI.

38. Activity 1.1.3 Facilitate integration of Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) into existing and/or new plans with education authorities

Education authorities at national and sub-national level in Cambodia and South Sudan will be supported to prepare and test through simulations their own DRR plans. These plans will support education authorities to have procedures in place to minimise the impact of future climate-related emergencies on the education sector.

39. Activity 1.1.4 Support children to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives

Girls and boys, including those with disabilities, will be supported to participate in climate change and education policy dialogues. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will develop a moderated virtual web-based platform that will serve as a hub for young people to connect, and children will also be supported to engage in policy dialogues with MoEYS on climate change. In **South Sudan**, children will participate in child parliaments – an existing structure in South Sudan - to champion climate change in education policies through regular dialogues with MoGEI.

40. Output 1.2 School facilities are safer and greener

The activities under this output will focus on ensuring that school facilities are safer and climate-resilient for children, including boys and girls and those with disabilities, as well as educational personnel (teachers, school staff), and School Management Committees (SMCs), as well as caregivers.

41. Activity 1.2.1 Develop a national standard for climate-resilient school facilities

Global guidance exists on how to strengthen the climate resilience of school infrastructure, including classrooms, and WASH facilities, but this guidance has not always been developed at country level. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will work with the MoEYS to upgrade their school design standards and construction guidelines to incorporate climate change and the environment. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will use the climate change and environment review of MoGEI's Basic Construction Standards and Guidelines conducted as part of CSEI. In **Tonga**, BRACE will utilise the existing World Bank infrastructure assessments.

42. Activity 1.2.2 Retrofit school facilities, including WASH and internet connectivity, to strengthen climate resilience

This activity will apply the country-level standards developed in Activity 1.2.1 to strengthen the climate resilience of school facilities in Cambodia, South Sudan, Tonga through retrofitting. Physical interventions will be in line with Save the Children Australia's ESS Category C Accreditation and be gender-responsive and disability inclusive. The infrastructure planning to address the needs of each school targeted by BRACE will be led by suitably qualified technical experts. This will result in an infrastructure plan for each school that will be integrated into the School Improvement Plan (SIP). The school retrofits are anticipated to include, for example, cooling systems (Cambodia, Tonga) and improved ventilation (South Sudan), solar photovoltaic (PV) systems to improve access to renewable and reliable energy, lighting, and internet connectivity (Tonga), providing shade through tree planting within school grounds (South Sudan), rainwater harvesting and upgrading of drinking water systems and handwashing stations and latrines. In **Cambodia and South Sudan**, to prevent outbreaks of waterborne diseases that keep children out of school, awareness-raising sessions for students will be organized to promote handwashing and hygiene. In South Sudan, girls will receive sessions on menstrual health and hygiene.

43. Activity 1.2.3 Strengthen school communities and education officials to operate and maintain school infrastructure and facilities

As part of the retrofit and upgrading of school facilities, school communities, including education officials (**Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga**) will be trained in operations and maintenance of the school facilities. Joint monitoring and supervision will also be conducted by BRACE project staff and government officials throughout the project lifecycle.

44. Output 1.3 School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively

The activities under this output will focus on ensuring that school safety management and educational continuity systems are in place. This will be done through building the capacity of education officials to provide training and on-going support to teachers, SMCs, Parent Teacher Associations (PTAs) and children on how to develop and implement climate-related school safety plans and link those plans to overall School Improvement Plans (SIPs). Climate resilient kits and equipment will also be distributed, and access to Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Services (CIS) strengthened.

45. Activity 1.3.1 Build capacity of national and sub-national education officials to be master trainers on climate-related school safety

This activity uses a “Train the Trainer (ToT)” approach to build the capacity of education officials at national and/or subnational level to be master trainers in climate-related school safety. Education officials selected as master trainers for the BRACE project and beyond will be identified in partnership with the Ministry of Education in each country.

46. Activity 1.3.2 Build knowledge and capacity of school management, teachers, and children to prepare climate-related school safety plans

Following the implementation of Activity 1.3.1, SMCs/PTAs, and teachers and children will be trained by education officials in how to implement school safety and educational continuity. In South Sudan, traditional and religious leaders will also be involved as they play a key role in the wider school community. Refresher training and on-going support will be provided throughout the implementation of BRACE.

47. Activity 1.3.3 Implement school-level climate-related school safety plans.

In this activity, SMCs, teachers and children from target schools trained in Activity 1.3.2 will be supported to implement what they have learned. The approach will depend on the guidance in each country but will broadly include undertaking a gender-inclusive climate risk assessment of the school and preparing a climate-related school safety plan. The plans will also be implemented by, for example, practicing drills, reaching out to the wider community to share climate resilience knowledge and information, and integrating the school safety plan into the overall SIP, and in the case of Cambodia linking with commune investment and community DRR plans. Plans will be updated annually.

48. Activity 1.3.4 Provide climate resilience tools, equipment and kits to schools.

Schools will be provided with climate resilience kits specific to the needs in each context. It is anticipated these kits will include, for example, buckets for sand to put out fires, whistles for guiding emergency drills in the school, flags for early warning, and other equipment such as megaphones, as required.

49. Activity 1.3.5 Strengthen access to and use of Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) in schools.

This activity will focus on improving the availability of climate and early warning information to schools. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will support school-level EWS that link to community EWS, and the development of a web-based dashboard that will integrate various data sources and provide visual aids including maps to support decision making by MoEYS. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will establish and maintain a school-based early warning network system by linking trained SMCs/PTAs outlined in Activity 1.3.2 and sharing early warning information on extreme events including floods, droughts and heatwaves via multiple channels including SMS, radio stations, and broadcasts. In full collaboration with the MEIDECC in **Tonga**, EWS and CIS products and materials will be developed and distributed to schools to ensure they are reached by EWS. EWS and CIS modules will also be uploaded onto the government e-learning platform.

50. Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedded in national systems

The activities under this output will support the development and distribution of climate change educational materials for schools in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga. It will also strengthen teachers' capacity to deliver climate change lessons through training and mentorship and curriculum engagement. Child clubs, involving girls and boys, including those with disabilities will be engaged to lead climate-resilience initiatives in their schools and communities. The project will also use digital platforms for wider dissemination of climate change information.

51. Activity 1.4.1 Develop teaching and learning materials on climate change ready to implement through national, non-formal, and informal curriculum

This activity will support the development, printing, and distribution of teaching and learning materials for children and teachers on climate change for use in school. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will utilise the existing green generation approach endorsed for nationwide scale-up by the MoEYS and as required, develop additional materials on topics such as green skills, child

protection, and psychosocial first aid. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will conduct a review of the climate change teaching and learning materials developed through CSESI and develop and distribute additional materials, as required. Out-of-school children and children in pastoral communities will be reached through mobile units that disseminate materials to children. In **Tonga**, BRACE will develop an elective climate change subject for integration into the curriculum for the final two years of secondary school. This will include undertaking labour market research to understand current and future climate-related needs in the workforce.

52. Activity 1.4.2 Build knowledge and capacity of teachers and education managers to implement climate change lessons inside the classroom

Teachers and education managers in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga will be trained and provided with on-going mentoring and coaching support to deliver climate change lessons inside the classroom. Before the delivery of any training, a training needs assessment will be undertaken. In **Cambodia**, teachers will be trained in how to use the green generation materials and incorporate green generation into routine classroom instruction, along with ongoing mentoring and coaching support. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will conduct a needs assessment to determine the most relevant training content in the target schools, and work with relevant bodies to develop and validate a teacher training plan. Teacher training will then be rolled out and aligned to the World Bank Building Skills for Human Development in South Sudan programme. In **Tonga**, teacher training on the climate change elective subject will be rolled out, along with a review and updating of the climate change materials.

53. Activity 1.4.3 Strengthen capacity of child clubs to lead climate change initiatives in their school and community

Child clubs involving both girls and boys, including children with disabilities, provide an ideal space for children to practice what they have learned about climate change in their homes and wider community. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will work with existing school structures, including school councils and child clubs that currently focus on literacy and numeracy, and expand their scope to encompass climate change. Child club members will be trained and supported to implement their activities and run environmental campaigns. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will work with existing or establish new child clubs focused on climate change and the environment to encourage children to participate in climate-resilient actions.

54. 1.4.4 Disseminate climate change teaching and learning materials through Ministry of Education e-learning and other platforms

Each country will upload the climate change materials to existing government e-learning platforms or other platforms. In **Cambodia**, BRACE will establish a virtual community of practice of green generation teacher facilitators to facilitate future peer-to-peer support and learning. The green generation materials will also be integrated into MoEYS online platform for other teachers to access. In **South Sudan**, BRACE will share climate change teaching and learning materials through MoGEI's radio platform. In **Tonga**, the training for climate resilience focal points, as well as the climate change elective subject will be uploaded to the government e-learning platform.

55. 1.4.5 Prepare learning documents and hold events with Ministries of Education and other partners to share experience of integrating climate change into the curriculum

National curriculum revisions provide an opportunity to integrate climate change into different subjects, as is the case in Tonga. However, Cambodia and South Sudan will not undertake curriculum revisions during the project timeframe so BRACE will instead document experience and lessons learned of integrating climate change and environmental education in classroom activities to share with Ministry of Education and other actors.

56. Component 2

OUTCOME 2: Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change

The activities in this outcome will work with key stakeholders at national level – especially Ministries of Education, Direct Access Entities, and government departments responsible for national adaptation planning to strengthen access to climate finance and to contribute to national adaptation capacity. This outcome will focus on addressing the institutional and financial barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2).

57. Output 2.1 Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have access to, and the ability to interpret and utilize relevant climate information as well as participate in decision-making and influence national adaptation planning processes including within the education sector

The activities in this output will address the financial and institutional barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2) and support Ministries of Education to access technical support to enhance their capacities to further integrate climate change into policies and plans, including accessing future climate finance scaling up the BRACE project, that will ultimately allow education systems to more comprehensively adapt to climate change therefore building a more resilient education system.

58. Activity 2.1.1: Development of education sector risk analyses on the impact of climate change and climate risks on the education sector and children's learning

Ministries of Education in Tonga, Cambodia and South Sudan will be supported with analysis that explores the expected impact of climate change and environmental degradation on the education sector and children's learning. This will include mapping and understanding the nature of climate risks, including through country-specific analysis of climate change impacts and overlaying these impacts on the education system in terms of access, quality, and education management as well as on different populations/groups of children, including girls. Existing institutional, organizational, and individual education sector capacities for climate change action, and identifying needs for additional capacities, will also be explored.

59. Activity 2.1.2: Support Ministries of Education to coordinate with climate change Ministries and engage in NAP processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the UNFCCC.

This activity will support MoEs in BRACE countries to advocate and ensure education is reflected in climate change adaptation plans at national and subnational levels, including in National Adaptation Plans (NAPs), where possible. This activity will involve providing training and capacity building support for Ministries of Education on UNFCCC processes and how to engage with Ministries responsible for climate change. In addition, this activity will support a secondment of an education specialist to the NAP Global Network (GN). This secondment will support initiatives including conducting a thematic scan of NAPs for their inclusion of education, children, and youth as well as supporting national action on education, children, and youth as requested by countries through the NAP GN. This scan will help the BRACE countries to use success from other countries to inform how they integrate education in NAPs. Cross-country peer-to-peer learning exercises for the three countries will also be supported so that Ministries of Education, Environment, and Finance can share good practices and experience (linked to Activity 3.2.3 which focus on south-south exchanges such as webinars and learning events).

60. Output 2.2 Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have increased access to, and the ability to utilize, scaled up finance for climate action in the education sector to replicate and scale BRACE to a greater percentage of the country

Climate finance is increasing but Ministries of Education in the BRACE countries are not accessing their fair share. The activities in output 2.2 focus on enabling education ministries to understand and access further climate finance to scale the projects and adapt to climate change and address the informational and financial barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2).

61. Activity 2.2.1: Development of climate finance mobilization road maps

Through a better understating of the impacts of climate change on the education sector (Activity 2.1.1), this activity will support MoEs to prepare forward looking climate finance mobilization road maps for beyond the end of BRACE. This will be done by determining the accessibility of all climate finance mechanisms in each country, mapping of co-financing and partnership opportunities, and development and dissemination of a climate finance mobilization road map for the education sector.

62. Activity 2.2.2: Direct Access Entity (DAE) support for working with the education sector on GCF projects

This activity will target DAEs and emerging DAEs in the BRACE countries. It will focus on building the DAE's engagement with Ministries of Education to support them to access climate finance. Activities will include socialization of the climate finance road maps (Activity 2.2.1), the development of education sector Simplified Approval Process (SAP) templates, the development of tools and guidance for DAEs to work with MoEs, and the provision of technical support to the DAEs to develop concept notes focused on or including education for the GCF.

Component 3

63. OUTCOME 3: Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector

This outcome will strengthen collaboration between education and climate change actors through the establishment of a BRACE climate and education financing coordination platform that will guide implementation of activities to support the further scaling up of climate finance in BRACE countries. Peer learning and knowledge sharing will also be enhanced through the production of guidance materials on climate change and education financing, and the dissemination of those materials through peer learning events, and through strategic communication. The activities will address governance, informational, financial, technological, institutional, and gender and social inclusion barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2). Lessons learned and success in Component 3 will be available to other organisations to replicate and scale up, for example through the GPE parallel project finance 'Climate Smart Education Systems Initiative' that will be reaching 35 countries in total.

64. Output 3.1: Climate resilient education co-investment platform is established and effective in aligning strategic initiatives and financing

This output will target the governance, institutional, and informal barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2). Under this output, BRACE, in partnership with global climate change and education stakeholders, will establish a BRACE climate and education coordination platform, steering committee, and core team focused on climate finance. This platform will contribute

to ensuring that climate action in education is strengthened through greater political recognition, enhanced coordination, and increased financing in Cambodia, Tonga and South Sudan. This output will also contribute to ensuring sustainability of the BRACE program in the three countries by strengthening coordination of the education sector around climate finance. Successes in BRACE countries will be replicable to other countries in the future.

65. Activity 3.1.1: Support a BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform, including steering committee and core team

BRACE will establish a climate and education coordination platform focused on financing to strengthen climate action in education. This platform will bring together global donors and implementers from climate change and education sectors to strengthen alignment of diverse investments in the climate/education nexus, and to bring education into climate change spaces. A voluntary steering committee co-led by a high-profile climate actor and a high-profile education actor will guide the activities of the platform. In addition, a core team will be established to deliver on the activities outlined below and in Output 3.2. Timebound working groups will be established, as required, to co-develop and deliver specific activities that will directly benefit Cambodia, Tonga and South Sudan and be prepared for replication and scaling up more broadly through the CSESI parallel project finance.

66. Activity 3.1.2: Face-to-Face meetings between Ministries of Education and Environment for cross-learning and building political momentum

This activity will focus on bringing Ministries of Education, Environment, and Finance together for cross-learning and building political momentum for climate change and education. This will involve showcasing early successes in the BRACE countries to build momentum in those countries and in the future influence the GPE CSESI parallel project finance in a further 32 countries. This will include supporting the implementation of the 'Declaration on the Common Agenda for Education and Climate Change' launched at the Conference of Parties (COP) 28 in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. The activities will include face-to-face meetings at key moments, including COP 30 and beyond, identified by the steering committee outlined in Activity 3.1.1 above and will result in a roadmap to support implementation of the Declaration.

67. Activity 3.1.3 Map and track global climate finance opportunities in the education sector

This activity involves the mapping and tracking of global climate finance needs and opportunities from global climate funds (GCF, Adaptation Fund (AF), Global Environment Facility (GEF)), bilateral donors, the private sector, philanthropies, etc. Findings will be translated into easy to understand and use guides with information by country that is updated regularly and housed on the BRACE coordination platform knowledge management site outlined in Activity 3.2.1 for easy access in Tonga, Cambodia and South Sudan.

68. Activity 3.1.4: Support adjustments to international climate finance reporting to reflect dual-benefit investments in climate and education

This activity will support the development of common methodologies to track the volume of education investments which include dual benefits for climate change adaptation and influence the Organization for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Development Assistance Committee (DAC) climate finance tracking to better reflect the role of education in climate change designing and testing the methodologies in the BRACE countries to ensure they can be replicated and scaled more broadly.

69. Output 3.2: Key stakeholders are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through south-south collaboration

This output will focus on ensuring that key stakeholders in Tonga, Cambodia and South Sudan from the global education and climate change communities can access and exchange knowledge and cross-learning on climate change and education. This includes leveraging the CSESI knowledge management platform, the development of guidance and knowledge products on topics focused on climate finance and education in Tonga, Cambodia and South Sudan, webinars, thematic sessions and learning events, and the development and dissemination of strategic communications materials. The activities will address informational, financial, and institutional barriers outlined in the feasibility study (annex 2).

70. Activity 3.2.1: Develop and host information on the CSESI knowledge management platform on climate change and education for improved evidence and learning

The GPE parallel project financed CSESI project will build an education and climate change specific knowledge management platform while BRACE will support the development of information based on experience from the BRACE project in the 3 countries. This will enable cross country learning between BRACE countries and access to this information by the CSESI countries to further promote its utilisation in scaling up efforts on climate change and education. This will build on and support the BRACE coordination platform outlined in Activity 3.1.1 and provide a space to engage donors to further support BRACE countries through dissemination of guidance materials (Activity 3.2.2), hosting webinars (Activity 3.2.3) and maps (Activity 3.1.3), and link to other climate change and education sites and platforms.

71. Activity 3.2.2: Develop guidance on climate and education for the GCF and the global education sector

Based on the BRACE experience and lesson learned, with support and guidance from the steering committee (Activity 3.1.1), this activity will support the GCF to develop an education sector guide, using the experience of implementation in the three BRACE focus countries. Additionally, BRACE will also produce a set of guidance documents for the BRACE countries on climate finance, including a step-by-step guide on how to further engage with and access climate funds from the GCF, and a knowledge product on how to engage in NAPs. These materials will be disseminated via the CSESI knowledge management platform (see Activity 3.2.1), and webinars, thematic sessions and peer learning events (Activity 3.2.3). This activity will contribute to a paradigm shift in scaling up of the BRACE interventions in the three focus countries by sharing and disseminating guidance materials. This activity will also have influence beyond the three focus countries of BRACE with the potential to reach a further 32 countries through the parallel project finance provided through the CSESI project.

72. Activity 3.2.3: Organize webinars, thematic sessions and learning events on climate change and education

To share learning and best practice amongst climate change and education stakeholders in the three countries, BRACE will organize webinars, and cross-country peer learning events workshops. The topics covered will include the guidance documents developed in Activity 3.2.2, as well as findings and lessons learned from the implementation of BRACE Component 1 and 2, and other topics as identified throughout the course of the implementation of BRACE. The events will be shared through the Knowledge Management platform outlined in Activity 3.2.1 and other identified networks and platforms. Up to 12 webinars and peer learning events will be conducted throughout the project implementation period. The countries who are part of the CSESI parallel project finance will also be able to access these webinars and learning events thus sharing the learning beyond the BRACE focus countries.

73. Activity 3.2.4: Develop and share strategic communications materials

Strategic communications materials will be developed and disseminated through the preparation of a communications plan and include social media outreach, op-eds and blog posts, case studies, lessons learned, and videos to engage donors and partners to support the further scaling of activities in BRACE countries.

B.4. Implementation arrangements (max. 1500 words, approximately 3 pages plus diagrams)

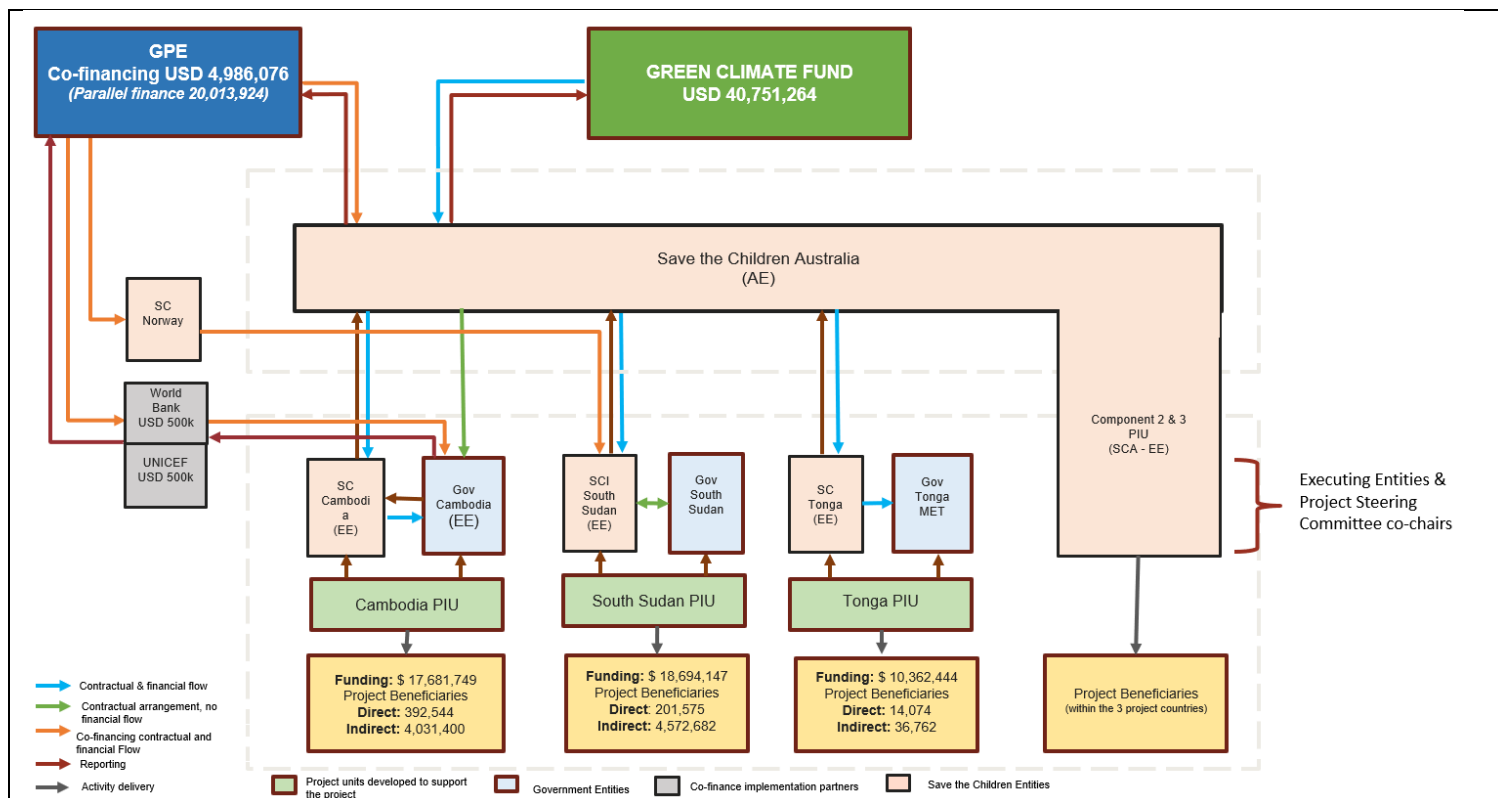
74. As a multi-country project BRACE will have multiple Executing Entities (EEs). Each country's project implementation will be considered as separate, country-specific, and country-owned and each accorded an EE to manage fund flows with fiduciary requirements in accordance with GCF standards. In Tonga, the EE is a newly registered legal entity with Save the Children Tonga Trust (SCTON). In Cambodia the EE will be Save the Children International in Cambodia and the MoEYS. In South Sudan the EE will be Save the Children International in South Sudan. SCTON, SCI South Sudan, and SCI Cambodia (jointly with MoEYS) will all sign Subsidiary Agreements (SAs) with Save the Children Australia as the Accredited Entity (AE). In South Sudan, the Ministry of General Education and Instruction (MoGEI) is an implementing partner, co-chairing the Project Steering Committee (PSC) and leading education sector coordination, policy alignment, and technical oversight. In Tonga, the Ministry of Education and Training (MET) serves as an implementing partner, co-chairing the PSC and hosting the Project Implementation Unit (PIU), ensuring government leadership in planning and oversight. MoGEI in South Sudan and MET in Tonga have no discretion in implementing the funded activities and in the usage of GCF Proceeds. The discretion will always remain with the SCISSD and SCTON, respectively. In Cambodia, the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sport (MoEYS) is a co-Executing Entity (EE) alongside Save the Children Cambodia, responsible for policy development, sectoral coordination, and technical leadership. The co-financing agreement with GPE is secured as are the co-finance agreement with the World Bank and UNICEF in Cambodia.

75. Implementing partner UNESCO is a sole-sourced procured party for this project. UNESCO will have no discretion in implementing the funded activities and in the usage of GCF Proceeds. The discretion will always remain with the EEs. SCA will be the procuring entity, and the procurement will be done in accordance with the requirements under the AMA. UNESCO and its International Institute for Educational Planning (IIEP) have been closely supporting Education authorities in all countries and leads the global Greening Education Partnership (GEP) and provide technical assistance to ministries of education to address climate change through education policies, plans, curriculum and teacher professional development. UNESCO and Save the Children Australia are the implementing partners of the Global Partnership for Education 'Climate Smart Education System Initiative' (CSESI) and were selected by the GPE through an open competitive tender process of the GPE's Grant Agents. The CSESI project will provide parallel project finance for Component 2 and 3 of BRACE contributing to scaling up, sustainability and replication of good practices supported through BRACE.

76. A high-level Project Steering Committee (PSC) will be established and responsible to provide strategic direction to Components 2 and 3 including providing directions to the overarching Project Implementation Unit (PIU). The country PSCs will be co-chaired by Save the Children country offices and the government in each country. The AE will ensure that decisions taken by the PSC are consistent with the AMA, FAA, and FP by regularly holding meetings with the core project team, including the Project Team lead and the Country Director of SC country offices. This way, the AE will be updated on all key decision points, both during and ahead of time, so that they can inform the implementing partners of any risk of potential inconsistencies with the AMA, FAA, and FP. The AE will also run a learning and knowledge session during the

- project inception period on the AMA and the FAA so that all partners understand their responsibilities ahead of project implementation and understand what amendments may be needed prior to AE and / or donor approval. No financial flows will take place between Save the Children and the PSCs; the working relationship will be solely based on reporting and consultation.
77. To meet the fiduciary requirements and standards of the GCF, legal and management oversight of the PIUs will be held by SC Tonga, SCI Cambodia and SCI South Sudan in the three countries respectively. All have the legal standing necessary to implement GCF activities in each of the three countries. They are also legally and organizationally bound to SCA, which acts as AE and holds the AMA with the GCF on behalf of the SC movement.
 78. Based on the due diligence assessments of all EE in all three countries, as AE, SCA will channel GCF resources to a project-specific bank account managed by the PIU in Tonga, Cambodia, and South Sudan. The PIUs will use these resources and co-financing to manage project governance and implementation and will manage all downstream flows to the countries' Ministries, implementing partner UNESCO, and any other procured partners. (Note: Implementing partners will be selected and subcontracted as procured parties in accordance with the AE's procurement guidelines.)
 79. SCA will act as the international channelling executing entity for the project and will provide account management support to Save the Children Tonga (SCTON), Save the Children International Cambodia (SCIKM) and Save the Children International South Sudan (SCISSD) in accordance with the account management system employed by the Save the Children Association to ensure compliance and high-quality delivery of projects. SCA will also act as the Executing Entity for Components 2 and 3. A small technical team within Save the Children's Climate Change Division Technical Team will have responsibility for this work while AE oversight responsibilities will sit with the Division's Operations Team. SCA have a long-term specialization (15 years) of working with Ministries of Education to integrate both DRR and Climate Change Adaptation (CCA) into the Education Sector policies, plans and programming. This has included the design and delivery of education sector DRR and climate change projects in Somaliland, Kenya, Timor Leste, the Philippines, Bangladesh, Vietnam, Cambodia, Laos, Vanuatu, Solomon Islands, Fiji, Tuvalu and Kiribati. For two years SCA held a partnership agreement with the Global Fund for Disaster Risk Reduction (GFDRR) of the World Bank to support the development of their Global Program for School Safety. SCA had a staff member seconded to the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) secretariat for several years to support their leadership in regional school safety work. SCA are a founding member of the Global Alliance for Disaster Risk Reduction and Resilience in the Education Sector (GADRRES) and lead author of the Comprehensive School Safety Framework. Globally, Save the Children is the co-cluster lead of the Education in Emergencies (EiE) cluster and accreted to both Education Cannot Wait (ECW) and the Global Partnership for Education (GPE).
 80. Tonga. In Tonga, SCTON will sign an implementing partner agreement with MET. MET will enter into a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with other implementing partner ministries including the MEIDECC, departments within the Ministry of Health (responsible for WASH), and Ministry of Internal Affairs (responsible for women's affairs). Any other formal project agreements with other ministries will be managed through established government systems.
 81. The project steering committee in Tonga will be co-chaired by Save the Children Tonga and MET. A Project Steering Committee and National Technical Working Group will guide and advise on implementation. Membership will be agreed with the Government and implementing ministries during inception and will include the EEs and MEIDECC.
 82. The Tonga PIU will manage and oversee delivery of the agreed project activities reporting into both Executing Entities (Save the Children Tonga and MET). The PIU lead (Project Manager) will formally report to Save the Children Tonga as the designated Executing Entity (EE) in Tonga. The Project Manager will also have accountability to the Project Steering Committee (PSC) to ensure that all key decisions are in alignment with the strategic direction provided by the PSC. The PIU core team will be located in MET as the lead agency. The Operations Manager will lead finance, risk, human resources, procurement and general administration. A provincial project coordinator will work closely with the outer island government representatives to coordinate activity implementation in outer island locations.
 83. SCA has been operating in Tonga since 2021. SCA's Board of Directors established a newly registered legal entity in Tonga in 2024. With the establishment of a registered legal entity, SCA will establish a fully functional organisation similar to existing operations that currently implement GCF projects Vanuatu (FP184) and the Solomon Islands (SAP027). Recent programming in Save the Children Tonga (SCTON) includes the Tonga Volcano Recovery Program (TARP II), which strengthens disaster risk resilience by enhancing access to educational materials through the Hama E-learning Platform (HeLP) including offline access for remote islands. IHunga Ha'apai Disaster and COVID19 Recovery and Resilience Activation which established a National School Safety and Resilience Coordination Committee, provides tools and training and implements safety self-assessments in 50 schools to inform School Development Plans. The Pacific Coalition for the Advancement of School Safety (PCASS) project focuses on regional Safe Schools coordination, creating a Community of Practice, and implementing a regional monitoring mechanism aligned with Pacific frameworks. The GPE funded Climate Smart Education Systems Strategic Capability Initiative seeks to enhance countries' capacities to mainstream climate change adaptation and environmental sustainability into education sector plans, budgets and strategies and to enhance education ministry capacity for cross-sectoral coordination on climate and environment-related policy and programming.
 84. Cambodia. Save the Children Cambodia and MoEYS will sign a tripartite Subsidiary Agreement with Save the Children Australia as the AE. In Cambodia, MOEYS will follow standard practice within the Government of Cambodia to establish relationships with the Ministry of the Environment and any other Government partners that may be supporting the project.

85. The project steering committee in Cambodia will be co-chaired by Save the Children International Cambodia (SCIKHM) Country Director and MOEYS Project Director. Members of the committee will include the Deputy Project Directors from key MOEYS Departments, and a representative from the Ministry of the Environment. In Cambodia, the PIU will be called a Project Secretariat and will be a joint team comprising MOEYS and Save the Children Cambodia project staff who will report to the PSC. The Project Manager will formally report to SCKHM and will provide regular updates and have accountability to the Project Steering Committee (PSC) ensuring project governance and strategic guidance from the PSC.
86. Save the Children Cambodia has extensive experience delivering climate resilience and education projects, positioning the organization as a key player in implementing programmes similar to BRACE. Notably, Save the Children led the Green Generation programme, a successful initiative integrating environmental education into formal and informal learning settings across Cambodia and other countries. This programme engaged children and communities to address local environmental challenges, with a focus on climate change education, waste management, and water conservation. Its success was built on strong collaboration with local schools and government agencies, including MoEYS, and involved the development of teaching units and hands-on eco-projects in schools.
87. Additionally, Save the Children Cambodia has contributed to school safety and disaster preparedness through its work under the ASEAN Safe Schools Initiative and the development of Cambodia's School Safety Guidelines. These projects have equipped schools with DRR strategies, such as contingency planning and climate-proofing infrastructure, ensuring educational continuity during extreme weather events. Save the Children Cambodia's strong partnerships with the Cambodian government and grassroots organizations further highlights its capability to scale up climate adaptation efforts, ensuring vulnerable children continue learning even in the face of environmental crises.
88. South Sudan. In South Sudan Save the Children will be the sole Executing Entity but will work in close collaboration and coordination with the Ministry of General Education and Instruction (MoGEI) as an implementing partner. SCI South Sudan will sign a partner agreement with MoGEI.
89. The project steering committee in South Sudan will be co-chaired by Save the Children International South Sudan (SCISSD) and MoGEI and comprise the following ministries: Ministry of Environment and Forestry, Ministry of Water Resources and Irrigation, Ministry of Gender, Ministry of Children and Social Welfare, and Ministry of Disaster Management and Humanitarian Affairs. The purpose of the steering committee will be to provide overall guidance to the programme, and make crucial decisions as a governance body.
90. The South Sudan PIU will manage and oversee delivery of the agreed project activities reporting to SCISSD. The Project Manager of the PIU will formally report to SCISSD as the EE, while maintaining close coordination with MoGEI. The Project Manager will also have accountability to the Project Steering Committee (PSC) ensuring alignment with overall project objectives and governance frameworks. The PIU core team will be hosted by SCISSD.
91. Save the Children South Sudan is well positioned to deliver the BRACE program, having extensive experience in managing education initiatives, including the GPE Accelerated Funding floods response programme integrated within the Education Cannot Wait (ECW) Multi-Year Resilience Programme (MYRP-2023-2026). With an overall portfolio of over \$90 million for this program, Save the Children has proven its capacity to work with diverse donors such as GPE, ECW, EU, UNICEF, and USAID, among others. These programmes are implemented in collaboration with key South Sudanese ministries like MoGEI and MGCSW, as well as a wide range of international and local partners, ensuring the effective reach and sustainability of its education interventions. The organisation also engages grassroots community-based organisations to ensure that even the most marginalized children are reached.
92. The collaboration between Save the Children and MoGEI under the GPE Accelerated Funding modality emphasizes shared responsibilities in planning, implementation, and monitoring, enhancing accountability and sustainability. This partnership strengthens MoGEI's capacity to provide oversight and ensure the delivery of quality education services. Save the Children's education programme focuses on addressing the protection and developmental rights of vulnerable children, improving access to education, and supporting initiatives such as continuous teacher development, inclusive education for children with disabilities, and Education in Emergencies (EIE). Additionally, it builds climate-resilient education systems to ensure long-term sustainability.



93. All activities will be implemented in line with the project's Gender Assessment and Action Plan (see Annex 4), which is aligned with the GCF's Gender Policy and SC's gender, inclusive development, and child safeguarding policies and Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse policy and guidelines. Per the Gender Action Plan, all project activities prioritise building the resilience of the most vulnerable community members (e.g., women, children, and ethnic minorities). Activities will contribute to gender transformation, ensure community and child participation, and ensure universal access principles are incorporated into health facility upgrades where possible.
94. All activities will be implemented in line with the project's country Environmental and Social Action Plans (ESAPs), which is aligned with the GCF's safeguards policies and includes a Grievance Redress Mechanism.

B.5. Justification for GCF funding request (max. 1000 words, approximately 2 pages)

95. As announced at COP28 with the GCF, the GPE CSESI project will invest USD 21 million to support 35 countries to integrate climate change into the education sector. This funding is essential to enable Least-Developed Country (LDC) resource-poor Ministries of Education to undertake the necessary analysis of the impact and risks of climate change on the education sector in order to plan what they can and should be doing to protect education sector investment.
96. Whilst GPE funds, as parallel project finance to the BRACE project, will enable sector-based analysis and priorities planning, there is a gap in funds available for action at scale. Due to no clear financial return on investment, private sector financing is lacking to date. However, the GCF's ability to provide investment to de-risk the BRACE interventions, will demonstrate a strong investment case in the face of a changing climate (see Annex 3 EFA).
97. Funding a climate resilience programme in education aligns with several SDGs, particularly SDG 4 (Quality Education) and SDG 13 (Climate Action). It demonstrates a commitment to promoting quality education while addressing the urgent need for climate action in vulnerable settings. Education has been shown to contribute to economic resilience. By equipping young people with the skills and knowledge to adapt to climate change, the programme contributes to the development of a more resilient workforce capable of driving sustainable economic activities.
98. Ministries of Education in Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga and beyond in CSESI countries lack sufficient finance to integrate climate change into the education sector (see Component 1).

Component 1

Cambodia

99. Cambodia is highly vulnerable to climate change, facing recurrent natural hazards such as floods, droughts, and extreme weather events. These climate impacts, as detailed in the National Action Plan for Disaster Risk Reduction (NAP DRR) 2024-2028, disrupt educational services, destroy infrastructure, and displace communities, compounding existing challenges in the education sector. Despite being a low emitter of greenhouse gases, Cambodia is disproportionately

affected by climate change. This creates an urgent need for targeted interventions that not only protect the current education system but also embed resilience measures to future-proof it against ongoing and future climate risks.

100. Cambodia has limited access to financial resources to fund climate change mitigation and adaptation needs. Cambodia's capacity to leverage domestic public and private sector funding to meet Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC) needs of US\$5.8 billion for mitigation and US\$2 billion for adaptation NDC needs largely depends on Cambodia's ability to mobilize international funding from donors¹⁸⁷. The proportion of education expenditure as a share of total government expenditure has steadily declined over the past 4 years and recurrent expenditure on education remains below the recommended level of 20%.
101. Currently, the Royal Government of Cambodia faces significant challenges in securing adequate funding and capacity to address the critical intersection of the education sector with climate risks and challenges. While there have been strides in education reform and expansion, as outlined in the Education Strategic Plan (ESP) 2024-2028, the integration of climate resilience measures within the education system remains insufficient. Both public and private sector investment in climate resilience in education is minimal, and existing donor funding prioritizes basic education without ensuring that education systems are equipped to withstand and adapt to climate impacts.
102. Investing in climate resilience within the education sector in Cambodia is essential not only for safeguarding educational progress but also for promoting sustainable community practices and preparing future generations to address the challenges of climate change. This investment will not only address immediate educational needs but will also contribute to long-term national resilience, as Cambodia navigates the dual challenges of development and climate vulnerability.

South Sudan

103. The Government of South Sudan does not currently have sufficient funding and required capacity to address the urgent needs of the education sector in relation to climate risks and challenges. Budget allocation to education is currently low, with geographic disparities in access to education resources. Despite the education budget increase over the past three fiscal years, the government's severe under-funding of its education system leaves it inadequate to achieve universal quality primary education and support system transformation. Current donor funding focuses on basic education support to ensure children go to school and stay in school without any necessary support to ensure climate resilience of the education system, nor school children's safety when facing extreme weather events.
104. South Sudan is aligned to GCF geographic priorities as it is an LDC facing severe climate change risks and is highly vulnerable, despite negligible Greenhouse Gas (GHG) emissions. Climate change results in extreme weather events, including floods and droughts that disrupt educational services, displace populations, and exacerbate existing challenges within the education sector, creating an urgent need for a climate resilience programme.
105. Funding a climate resilience programme under the education sector in South Sudan is crucial for safeguarding education, promoting sustainable community practices, and preparing future generations to address the challenges of a changing climate. Such an investment not only addresses immediate educational needs but also contributes to long-term resilience and sustainable development in South Sudan.

Tonga

106. In Tonga, the Government has been generally reliant on foreign funding and remittances (of a significant number of citizens who have left the country to work abroad), which contributed to nearly 45% of the total national budget. The Government does not currently have sufficient funding or capacity to meet the immediate adaptation needs of the education sector and schools do not have the resources to support required adaptation actions. Current donor funding is not covering these needs, making it necessary to ensure climate resilience of the education sector.
107. Tonga is a SIDS, in alignment with GCF geographical priority areas, and has particular vulnerabilities to climate change. Tonga's contribution to global GHG emissions is negligible, yet Tonga is one of the most vulnerable countries in the world to climate change due to its geographic location, status as a SIDS, and the importance of natural resources to its main economic sectors of fisheries".¹²⁵
108. The risk of debt distress rating for Tonga is high.¹²⁶ Tonga's indebtedness gradually declined from 2015 to 2019. However, the economy has been hit by multiple shocks: cyclone Gita in 2015, the Covid-19 pandemic, cyclone Harold in 2020 and the Hunga Tonga-Hunga Ha'apai volcanic eruption and tsunami in 2022. The budget deficit is expected to rise sharply in the coming years due to a gradual decrease in grants under the current commitments and growing spending needs for the SDGs and climate resilience. Debt service payments are spiking in 2024 and the following years due to scheduled repayments to other countries; 80% of Tonga's upcoming debt payments will flow to other countries as it owes other countries more than USD 120 million (approximately a quarter of Tonga's GDP).¹²⁷ The bulk of this debt must be repaid by 2028. These current repayments will severely hamper Tonga's recovery and crowd out much-needed funds for climate change adaptation. For example, the volcanic eruption and tsunami alone led to damages equivalent to 36% of GDP.
109. The lack of global climate finance is a significant challenge for Tonga. It is apparent that SIDS' status as representing a special need for climate resilient development "does not translate into effective prioritization or allocation of funds".¹²⁸ Firstly, SIDS' public sectors inherently face major human and technical capacity constraints to design and implement

climate projects. The complexity of the climate finance landscape and lack of harmonisation among the requirements of multilateral climate funds and donors further exacerbate this challenge. Secondly, the current climate and development finance systems fail to adequately accommodate SIDS' unique needs, realities and vulnerabilities, resulting in fewer funding opportunities for SIDS. Data limitation for adaptation projects, high transaction costs, and small project sizes make it difficult for SIDS to attract investment and compete for access to climate finance.

110. While adaptation initiatives have been developed in Tonga, climate change adaptation remains fundamentally underfunded. Even though the World Bank is currently implementing the Tonga Safe and Resilient Schools Project (TSRSP) reaching approximately 62 schools with infrastructural retrofits and replacements, this not enough to cover the needs of 36,008 school-aged children (age 4 to 18). The private sector is underdeveloped and faces difficulties in Tonga, especially in reaching the outer islands most vulnerable for climate change and cannot be relied on to build adaptive capacity.
111. Difficulties in accessing climate finance, the current financial situation of Tonga, and the urgent need to strengthen climate resilience of Tonga's education sector justifies the GCF funding request. Without such climate finance support, Tonga's education model including the school children, their futures and the education sector and systems, will fall further and possibly more rapidly into climate vulnerability with very little opportunity to cope or adapt to projected climate change and extreme weather events.

Component 2

112. According to the World Bank, education is a powerful but under-used instrument for climate action. Yet only 1.5 per cent of climate finance went to the education sector in 2021. The CSEI project has held consultations with more than 20 countries and Ministries of Education consistently requesting support for understanding and engaging in national climate change processes and accessing climate finance – including Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. There is currently no specific mechanism to provide support to Ministries of Education and Direct Access Entities to access climate finance. Most national efforts to support climate change adaptation or mitigation focus on agriculture, food security, energy, and transport with little to no public funds being invested in the education sector being enabled to access climate finance, other than GPE CSEI which is providing parallel project finance to this project. This is largely due to the education sector not being seen as an obvious investment to tackle the climate crisis⁸⁵. An NDC Partnership assessment of NDC shows that only 17 county NDC plans mention Ministries of Education. Furthermore, a recent study of multi-lateral climate funds between 2006 and 2023 showed only one education sector- focused project out of 591 funded⁸⁶. This highlights the current barriers the education sector faces in accessing climate finance. Component 2 of BRACE will focus on working directly with Ministries of Education and Direct Access Entities (DAEs) in the three focus countries of BRACE (Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga), supporting them to access climate finance and addressing the market failure of ensuring climate finance reaches Ministries of Education through demand-driven and country-owned processes.

Component 3

113. Component 3 aims to directly support the activities of Component 2 by galvanising international support of donors and Ministry of Education partners in support of country-level demand-driven climate change and education sector action. As noted above there is a current and chronic underinvestment by all financial instruments to support Ministries of Education to build the climate resilience of the education system. Ministries of Education in Africa, SIDS, and LDCs are rarely able to secure public financing beyond minimum provision of basic education services. UNESCO estimate that there is currently a USD 97 billion annual financing gap to achieve national SDG4 Benchmarks (Quality Education)⁸⁷, and it is impossible for countries to allocate public finances to address the impact of climate change on the education sector with competing needs. Activities under Component 3 will specifically address this gap by building an international platform for collaboration, coordination and timely financing. As outlined in the Feasibility Study (Annex 2) all the organisations consulted (donors, multilateral banks, CSOs and network organisations) unanimously highlighted that whilst there was great interest in coordination and collaboration on financing climate change investments in the education sector, there is no existing platform that has the membership or mandate to facilitate these exchanges. The BRACE project will kick start such a platform with the aim of integrating it into an existing mechanism for long-term sustainability.

B.6. Exit strategy (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

⁸⁵ Save the Children and Global Partnership for Education (2023), Climate-Smart Education Financing: A review of the evidence and new costing framework.

⁸⁶ Ibid

⁸⁷ Global Education Monitoring Report Team (2023) Global Education Monitoring Report, 2023: technology in education: a tool on whose terms? Available at: [Home - 2023 GEM Report \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/gem-report/2023)

114. The BRACE project in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga focuses on achieving climate resilience while ensuring long-term sustainability and local ownership. The exit strategy aims to transition from project implementation to local stewardship, ensuring that established practices endure and evolve. This strategy emphasises scaling successful practices, integrating climate actions into national policies and budgets, and building institutional and community capacities.

National Policy Alignment

115. The project is aligned with national policies in each country to promote long-term sustainability. In South Sudan, BRACE supports the South Sudan Development Plan (SSDP) and the Revised National Development Strategy (R-NDS) 2021–2024. It focuses on gender-responsive policies, safer and greener school facilities, and the development of robust school safety and educational continuity systems. These efforts are designed to make the education sector more resilient to climate change, ensuring minimal disruption to learning even during climate-related crises.
116. In Cambodia, the project integrates with the Comprehensive School Safety Framework (CSSF) and the Child-Friendly School Program, enhancing education policies with a focus on climate-smart systems, environmental sustainability, and disaster risk management. By establishing platforms for knowledge sharing and coordination, the project enables the MoEYS and other relevant ministries to integrate climate resilience into educational planning and access climate finance.
117. In Tonga, BRACE aligns with the Tonga Strategic Development Framework 2015-2025, the Joint National Action Plan for Climate Change Adaptation and Disaster Risk Management (JNAP II) 2018-2028, and the Tonga Education Policy Framework. The project addresses key climate drivers such as sea level rise, temperature increases, and extreme weather by enhancing the physical resilience of school buildings and infrastructure. It mainstreams climate change into educational curricula and improves access to climate education through e-learning platforms. These efforts ensure that the project supports Tonga's strategic priorities, contributing to a sustainable and resilient education sector.
118. Components 2 and 3 of BRACE align with the Declaration on the Common Agenda for Education and Climate Change, particularly the key area commitments of adapt and invest.

Local ownership and capacity building

119. Building local ownership and strengthening institutional capacity are critical to ensuring the sustainability of the project's outcomes. In South Sudan, BRACE enhances the capacity of the MoGEI by establishing robust systems and supportive policies that facilitate climate change adaptation and resilience within the education sector. This includes training programmes in climate risk assessment, disaster risk management, and climate-resilient infrastructure planning. The project also involves appointing focal points at national and sub-national levels to ensure coordination between climate change adaptation efforts and educational initiatives. These steps are crucial for ensuring that local institutions are well-prepared to manage and scale climate adaptation initiatives, leading to sustainable project outcomes.
120. In Cambodia, the project strengthens the capacity of MoEYS and other relevant ministries by establishing a platform for knowledge exchange and coordination. This platform facilitates the implementation of climate education and disaster risk management within the education sector, supported by the development of a National Climate Resilience in Education Framework. This framework will enable MoEYS to integrate climate actions into educational policies and access climate finance, ensuring the long-term sustainability of the project's outcomes. Through CSESI, a consolidated framework for school-based risk reduction and adaptation will be developed and tested with MoEYS. This framework will be implemented with and through education government officials and in schools through BRACE.
121. In Tonga, BRACE builds the institutional capacity of the MET and MEIDECC by providing training in CIS and EWS. The project also focuses on improving the physical resilience of schools through infrastructure upgrades and support to e-learning and climate information dissemination. These efforts ensure that local institutions are equipped to manage and scale climate adaptation initiatives, contributing to sustainable project outcomes.

Scaling best practices

122. The project is designed to scale best practices across regions, ensuring maximum impact. In South Sudan, best practices in climate-resilient education, WASH management, and disaster preparedness will be scaled through knowledge-sharing platforms and the development of school-specific improvement plans. This includes initiatives such as the integration of climate resilience and disaster risk reduction education into the national curriculum, the establishment of green school initiatives, and the improvement of WASH facilities to support climate adaptation efforts.
123. In Cambodia, the project scales successful models in climate-resilient education and school safety by retrofitting schools, enhancing WASH infrastructure, and rolling out the Green Generation initiative. This initiative integrates environmental education and resilience into school curricula and non-formal education activities, promoting environmental awareness. These efforts ensure that best practices in climate resilience and education are shared, adapted, and scaled to enhance sustainability across the education sector.
124. In Tonga, the project builds on previous assessments and initiatives, such as the Outer Island Renewable Energy Project (OIREF) and the World Bank's disaster risk assessment of school infrastructure. The project focuses on retrofitting and upgrading the most climate-vulnerable schools, enhancing their resilience to extreme weather events, and ensuring inclusive WASH facilities. The integration of solar PV systems will improve energy efficiency and support Internet

connectivity, which is crucial for accessing climate information services and early warning systems. The project also aims to increase access to climate education through the development of an elective climate change subject for secondary schools, linked to the Hama e-learning platform. This approach ensures that best practices in infrastructure resilience, renewable energy integration, and climate education are scaled and adapted to the unique context of Tonga, enhancing the sustainability of project outcomes.

125. Component 2 focuses on supporting Ministries of Education in the three BRACE countries to access climate finance and influence national climate change plans and policies. Best practices will be scaled up through templates that countries can use and adapt to access climate finance and through cross-country learning opportunities on climate finance. Component 3 will capture and disseminate best practices through a dedicated knowledge management platform, face-to-face meetings, and through webinars that will provide a space to disseminate best practices and facilitate cross-country learning across the three BRACE focus countries.

Operations and Maintenance Strategy

126. A robust operations and maintenance (O&M) plan is vital to the sustainability of the project's infrastructure and activities. In South Sudan, community-led maintenance committees will manage the upkeep of water systems and climate-resilient school buildings, supported by ongoing monitoring and supervision to maintain effectiveness. The project includes conducting comprehensive WASH and infrastructure assessments, developing tailored improvement plans, and implementing the Green School Initiatives within school systems.
127. In Cambodia, O&M plans will be established for retrofitted schools, ensuring gender and disability inclusivity. The project will provide training to school staff and local administration on maintaining school infrastructure, while linking these efforts to broader school safety management systems. Community-based monitoring systems will further ensure the continued functionality of these infrastructures, supported by local government plans and budgets.
128. In Tonga, the O&M plan emphasizes the long-term functionality of climate-resilient school buildings and systems. The project delivers training on basic upkeep and maintenance of school infrastructure and WASH facilities to prevent common issues that undermine climate resilience, such as poor ventilation and sea spray corrosion. Additionally, the project will train school staff in problem-solving for Internet connectivity issues, ensuring the sustainability of the Internet and renewable energy systems installed in schools. These efforts are designed to ensure that the infrastructure improvements remain effective and resilient over time, with local stakeholders equipped to manage ongoing maintenance.
129. This exit strategy for BRACE in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga is designed to ensure that the project's benefits and practices are sustained and scaled beyond its duration. By focusing on transitioning to local ownership, scaling best practices, and integrating climate actions into national policies, the BRACE project aims to create lasting impact and resilience in each country. The exit strategy for Component 2 will ensure that Ministries of Education either have access to climate finance, or a roadmap in place to support them to access climate finance by the end of the project. This approach will ensure sustained results where Ministries of Education are leading efforts to build resilience and adapt to the impacts of climate change. In Component 3, the BRACE coordination platform will initially be dedicated to the project, but throughout the course of implementation, the most appropriate place for the platform to be housed will be identified as a part of the exit strategy. This will ensure that coordination efforts around the climate and education finance nexus continue after the end of the project. Furthermore, knowledge management assets will remain accessible to climate and education actors.

C. FINANCING INFORMATION						
C.1. Total financing						
(a) Requested GCF funding (i + ii + iii + iv + v + vi + vii)	Total amount			Currency		
	40,751,264Enter amount			million USD (\$)		
GCF financial instrument	Amount	Tenor	Grace period	Pricing		
(i) Senior loans	Enter amount	Enter years	Enter years	Enter %		
(ii) Subordinated loans	Enter amount	Enter years	Enter years	Enter %		
(iii) Equity	Enter amount			Enter % equity return		
(iv) Guarantees	Enter amount	Enter years				
(v) Reimbursable grants	Enter amount					
(vi) Grants	40,751,264Enter amount					
(vii) Results-based payments	Enter amount					
(b) Co-financing information	Total amount			Currency		
	5,986,076Enter amount			million USD (\$)		
Name of institution	Financial instrument	Amount	Currency	Tenor & grace	Pricing	Seniority
Global Partnership for Education (GPE)	Grant	4,986,076	million USD (\$)	Enter years Enter years	Enter%	Options
United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF)	Grant	500,000	million USD (\$)	Enter years Enter years	Enter%	Options
World Bank	Grant	500,000	million USD (\$)	Enter years Enter years	Enter%	Options
(c) Total financing (c) = (a)+(b)	Amount			Currency		
	46,737,340			million USD (\$)		
(d) Other financing arrangements and contributions (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)	Please explain if any of the financing parties including the AE would benefit from any type of guarantee (e.g. sovereign guarantee, MIGA guarantee). Please also explain other contributions such as in-kind contributions including tax exemptions and contributions of assets. Please also include parallel financing associated with this project or programme (refer to the co-financing policy).					
C.2. Financing by component						
Please provide an estimate of the total cost per component and output as outlined in section B.3. above and disaggregate by source of financing. More than one co-financing institution can fund a single component or output. Provide the summarised cost estimates in the table below and the detailed budget plan as annex 4.						

Component	Output	Indicative cost million USD (\$)	GCF financing		Co-financing		
			Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Amount million USD (\$)	Financial Instrument	Name of Institutions
<u>Component 1</u>	Output 1.1	2,699,186	2,168,569	Grants	530,617	Grants	GPE
	Output 1.2	21,843,504	20,942,385	Grants	901,119	Grants	GPE + World Bank
	Output 1.3	6,893,143	5,607,009	Grants	1,286,134	Grants	GPE + World Bank
	Output 1.4	7,245,877	5,342,933	Grants	1,902,945	Grants	GPE + UNICEF
<u>Component 2</u>	Output 2.1	595,093Enter amount	358,093	Grants	237,000	Grants	GPE
	Output 2.2	495,810	315,810	Grants	180,000	Grants	GPE
<u>Component 3</u>	Output 3.1	971,804	913,304	Grants	58,500	Grants	GPE
	Output 3.2	1,380,301	1,150,601	Grants	229,700	Grants	GPE
<u>M&E</u>	M&E	2,215,013	1,965,939	Grants	249,075	Grants	GPE
<u>PMC</u>	PMC	2,397,607	1,986,621	Grants	410,986	Grants	GPE, UNICEF, World Bank
Indicative total cost (USD)		46,737,340	40,751,264 Enter amount		5,986,076 Enter amount		

This table should match the one presented in the term sheet and be consistent with information presented in other annexes including the detailed budget plan and implementation timetable.

In case of a multi-country/region programme, specify indicative requested GCF funding amount for each country in annex 17, if available.

C.3 Capacity building and technology development/transfer (max. 250 words, approximately 0.5 page)

C.3.1 Does GCF funding finance capacity building activities?	Yes ☒ No ☐
C.3.2. Does GCF funding finance technology development/transfer?	Yes ☒ No ☐

Technology Development/transfer

130. In Tonga the school retrofits are anticipated to include solar photovoltaic (PV) systems to improve access to renewable and reliable energy, lighting, and internet connectivity. This is anticipated to be seven schools in total. The estimated funding for these activities is USD\$351,357.

D. EXPECTED PERFORMANCE AGAINST INVESTMENT CRITERIA

This section refers to the performance of the project/programme against the investment criteria as set out in the GCF's [Initial Investment Framework](#).

D.1. Impact potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

131. **Component 1.** The project will make a contribution to GCF's overarching adaptation impact, contributing to increased climate-resilient sustainable development by directly increasing the climate resilience of people in Cambodia, Tonga and South Sudan. BRACE's total direct beneficiary population is 607,098 (comprising 299,933 females) and total indirect beneficiary population is 8,640,844 (comprising 4,266,850 females). BRACE will address climate impacts and risks in 850 schools. The breakdown by countries under Component 1 is:
132. **Cambodia:** At least 240 primary schools are selected as target schools in 3 provinces of Kampong Chhang, Kampong Cham and Koh Kong where geographical risks are heightened and climate impacts on the education sector are significant, particularly due to the provinces' vulnerability to extreme weather events, especially flooding. Direct beneficiaries include primary school children, their teachers, school principals, school management committees, parents, caregivers and other community members, education officials from the MoEYS, and Province and District Office of Education, Youth and Sport, local administration office staff who receive capacity building training and directly engage with our project activities. A total of 392,185 direct beneficiaries will be reached (188,373 female) amounting to 2.3% of the population. A total of 4,031,400 indirect beneficiaries will be reached (1,962,128 female) amounting to 24% of the population.
133. **South Sudan:** Children within a total of 510 schools across the project, with an estimated total of 201,242 direct beneficiaries (based on average school enrolments per school, and including additional beneficiaries from the wider communities). Of these, just over half (52%) will be women and girls. BRACE in South Sudan will also impact an estimated 4,572,682 indirect beneficiaries (50% female), which is the total population of the six target counties, minus the direct project beneficiaries. The direct beneficiaries comprise 1.8% of the total population, and indirect beneficiaries comprise 41% of the total population⁸⁸
134. **Tonga:** The climate resilience of 100 remote schools will be strengthened to better cope with climate hazards such as sea level rise, droughts, floodings, extreme weather including tropical cyclones and heatwaves, and ongoing climate change. This includes 13,671 direct beneficiaries (6,631 female) equivalent to 13% of the total population; in addition to 36,762 indirect beneficiaries (18,381 female) equivalent to 33% of the total population.
135. **Component 2** of BRACE will target Ministries of Education in the three BRACE focus countries supporting them to access climate finance and to lead climate-resilient sustainable development in the education sector. Direct beneficiaries will be 210 Ministry of Education and other government officials from the three focus countries, with the impact potential to reach children and education personnel in each country. This will be complemented by the CSESI project that works in a total of 35 countries by sharing learning from the implementation of BRACE project with other countries.
136. **Component 3** of BRACE will directly reach 1,000, including the education and climate change actors and organisations in each of the three countries, including civil society. As with Component 2, the parallel project financed CSESI project will support replication of the activities supported through Component 3 to a further 32 countries.

D.2. Paradigm shift potential (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

⁸⁸ Worldometer, [South Sudan population](#), accessed 29/07/2024

137. As described in the Project description section and the overall ToC, the BRACE project will lead to a paradigm shift and transformative change resulting in lasting impacts, building on the interconnected pillars of the Comprehensive School Safety Framework (CSSF). The outputs and activities of the project will contribute to significant results with regards to the safety of students. This will be due to school infrastructural improvements and school safety and educational continuity management systems, and strengthened knowledge, skills, and capacities on climate change preparing students to consider how climate change will impact their lives and careers and what they can do to anticipate and adapt to projected climate impacts and still thrive in life. The BRACE project also contributes to the strengthening of the enabling environment and mitigation of key barriers such as governance, gender and social inclusion, financial, technological, and institutional barriers;

- **Governance:** resources and capacity for an improved enabling environment will contribute to improved governance for climate change action in the education sector, e.g. through Component 3 coordination and collaboration will take place at scale.
- **Gender and social inclusion:** Special attention will be paid to gender and social inclusion ensuring that youth, children, women, girls, and people with disabilities will be represented in decision-making, that interventions will pay specific attention to their needs and capacities and that, as a result of the project, their capabilities will be strengthened.
- **Financial:** The project will partially close the existing financial gap in resources required to increase the climate resilience of the education sector. Additionally, it will build on and enhance initiatives, such as CSESI and country-specific initiatives e.g. PCASS in Tonga, to bring more climate finance to least developed and climate vulnerable countries (the CSESI project targets 35 of the world's most climate vulnerable countries).
- **Institutional:** Support to school safety and educational continuity management systems will normalise and institutionalise climate resilience practices from central Ministry of Education school management teams to schools. Additionally, the project will build institutional capacity through tool development, enhanced coordination (building on existing coordination systems such as the Education in Emergencies Clusters) as well as targeted capacity development. Trainings and refresher trainings will be recorded for institutional memory so they can be reused beyond the life of the project.
- **Technological and informational:** Through BRACE investments into school safety and educational continuity mechanisms, students will be prepared for a climate-resilient future and climate-related career pathways. E.g. in Tonga, through offering Internet connectivity, schools will be able to access CIS and EWS as well as the Hama e-learning platforms, an innovative digital educational continuity mechanism. Additionally, through the development of a new climate change elective, students will be able to build their technical and practical skills and knowledge on climate change, preparing them for climate-related jobs.

138. The BRACE project contributes to climate-resilient development pathways consistent with sustainable development, climate change, and educational strategies and plans. The project's paradigm shift will also be achieved through the delivery of 4 project co-benefits and will be underpinned by:

- Targeted school-aged children and teachers with significantly increased knowledge of current and projected climate change impacts, increased skills for anticipating and adapting to future climate change impact and foundations for climate-related professions/careers through climate change-related curriculum and climate electives.
- Targeted schools with safer and more climate-resilient facilities supported by enhanced access to climate information and early warnings
- Targeted schools with strengthened climate and disaster preparedness and awareness, and school safety and resilience plans to ensure educational continuity in time of climate-induced disasters.
- Targeted Ministries of Education and Ministries of Climate in particular, working in alignment to access climate finance, to refine NAPs and to embed climate-related educational policies, plans, programming and budgeting to support resilience strengthening.
- Targeted engagement and communications through coordination platform and South-South shared learnings.

Scalability and replicability

139. This project has been designed from the outset with both scalability and replicability in mind, in alignment with, supporting the achievement of national policy objectives. BRACE also has high complementarity and coherence with other relevant climate-focused projects. The CSSF model will be scaled up to ensure additional schools will receive infrastructural improvements (output 1.2), implementation of school safety and educational continuity management systems (output 1.3), and development of climate education curriculum and teacher training (output 1.4) which will support and reach more students. Outcome 1 will also deliver specific materials which can be used for scaling and replicating elsewhere and adapted to relevant country contexts – this includes standards, guidelines and plans, ToT approaches, approaches in strengthening CIS and EWS, Climate-related School Safety Plans and

how to embed climate knowledge and action through formal and informal educational settings. The climate finance tools and resources produced and disseminated through Components 2 and 3 will also ensure scalability and replicability.

Knowledge sharing and learning agenda

140. Part of each Component will be dedicated to knowledge sharing and learning engagement between different stakeholders focused on school safety. This will be through annual lessons learned and reflection workshops, a learning agenda that will be implemented and shared internally in the three countries, and recordings on e-learning platforms that can share knowledge more broadly. Lessons will be shared across all the regions through PCASS and CSESI, leveraging existing regional information and coordination platforms. This will also ensure that BRACE has a high potential for knowledge sharing and learning and the CSSF will simultaneously be rolled out in three different countries.
141. Through Components 2 and 3, BRACE will showcase how climate action can be scaled up in the education sector by successfully applying the CSSF model in different contexts with diverse climate risks and vulnerabilities and different educational systems. Components 2 and 3 have a strong focus on knowledge sharing and cross-country learning through capacity building to Ministries of Education on climate finance and engaging in other UNFCCC processes such as NAP development in the three target countries. Knowledge products on these topics will be prepared and disseminated through a dedicated climate change and education knowledge management platform and through webinars and cross-country learning events for the three target countries.
142. The project will evaluate the impact of interventions, and studies are envisaged within the MEAL framework, to identify causal impact of the interventions. Both BRACE and CSESI will support learning events as part of the research studies, which will be attended by a range of government, NGO, and institutional stakeholders. Many of the interventions are relatively new within the country contexts and as such BRACE is in a unique position to test the ideas on a moderate scale and share key findings with all relevant bodies.

D.3. Sustainable development (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

143. BRACE aligns with several Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Specifically: SDG4: Quality education for all; SDG5: Achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls; SDG 6: Ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all; SDG11: Sustainable cities and communities, through making human settlements inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable; SDG13: Take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.

144. There are three co-benefits delivered through the BRACE project:

Co-benefit 1: Gender and social inclusion BRACE will indirectly benefit 4,128,574 females during implementation. However, it is expected that the focus on gender in BRACE should result in wider GESI benefits within the education sector, beyond what is delivered in the core project, based on social attitude and behavioural changes arising from the interventions. This also includes the engagement of stakeholders during Components 2 and 3 and the learning and knowledge sharing opportunities through which the continued advocacy of gendered climate needs, impacts and action will be raised. In alignment with the logframe's co-benefits school gendered, age appropriate and disability-friendly WASH facilities will be provided. These are also likely to be used by the community, either at times of extreme weather events or during community forums. There will be further **gender co-benefits**, as the project will implement activities promoting menstrual hygiene, and creating dignity kits for girls and teachers at schools, allowing for knock-on capacity building at a wider community level. Improving the WASH facilities in close proximity to schools and communities could reduce the burden on women and girls who bear the brunt of activities related to water collection and washing. BRACE will deliver gender empowerment through community participation in activities, particularly forming community-wide DRR committees which involve children, women and people with disabilities in remote communities. New or updated risk assessments and DRR plans will include needs and recommendations on GESI. Equally, GESI specific needs will be addressed in climate-related school safety plans. EWS information dissemination will adopt language which is age, gender and disability responsive.

Co-benefit 2: Environmental impact through school greening via reduced emissions from infrastructure paired with the use of PV panels for lighting and connectivity; in addition to Natural Resource Management (NRM) initiatives including tree planting and water efficient irrigation systems, for shading, windbreaks and cooling effects. Supporting school food gardens may encourage wider community uptake of positive environmental management practices. Also, through improved WASH facilities, including latrines, improved waste management systems and improved hygiene practices.

Co-benefit 3: Social: Increased Locally-led Adaptation (LLA) - Influencing the LLA agenda working at the local school level with children, resident teachers and parents/community members. LLA can be amplified through project deliverables such as the building and implementation of school safety plans, child clubs, NAP participation, finance roadmap development and collaboration/south-south learning. Such interventions lend themselves to LLA such as through devolved decision-making and inclusion of marginalised people. School community-led initiatives and engagement may amplify further through knowledge sharing as well as opportunities for advocacy at key events such as climate dialogues e.g. COPs, Community Based Adaptation events. Ground-up design and implementation of climate action is strongly aligned with the principles of Locally-led Adaptation which will empower children as key stakeholders in decision-making and taking climate action. This co-benefit is achieved through Outcomes 1, 2 and 3.

D.4. Needs of recipient (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

The recipients of BRACE include schools, school communities (children, parents, teachers and those living nearby to the school) and the education sector as a whole. The education sector's vulnerability to climate change is evident in the direct impact on school infrastructure, the indirect effects on learning and health, and the broader economic and social consequences. These vulnerabilities underscore the urgent need for climate-resilient investment and action in education systems to withstand and adapt to the continued and worsening challenges posed by a changing climate. The vulnerabilities are caused by increasing temperatures and erratic rainfall leading to hazards in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga of: droughts, heatwaves, drought-related wildfires, rising sea levels, coastal erosion, floods and flashfloods and storms/strong winds. Such hazards impact schools, their communities and the system as a whole, leading to increased vulnerability. Lack of financial investment in the education system to address these needs exacerbates the vulnerability.

In order to foster a society that is informed and capable of responding to climate change challenges, the climate change vulnerabilities in the education sector must be addressed. The education sector must integrate climate resilience into planning and operations, which includes constructing climate-resilient infrastructure, developing disaster risk reduction strategies, incorporating climate change into the curriculum, build pedagogical capacity and content knowledge among teachers and educators, and supporting communities to adapt to climate change impacts.

Cambodia

145. Cambodia is one of the poorest countries among the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) characterised by limited educational opportunities, high income inequality and poor job prospects.⁸⁹ The country's vulnerability to climate change is linked to its characteristics as a post-civil war, least developed, predominantly agrarian country, with 76% of the population living in rural areas.⁹⁰ Along with the Philippines, Cambodia is regarded by the United Nations and the International Development Research Center as Southeast Asia's most vulnerable nation to the consequences of climate change.⁹¹ The ND-GAIN ranks Cambodia 149th most vulnerable country out of 187, with equally low rankings for vulnerability (130) and climate readiness (158)⁹². Cambodia faces severe climate change vulnerabilities, ranking as the second most vulnerable country globally to climate hazards according to the 2024 INFORM risk index.⁹³

146. Additionally, Cambodia ranks 46th out of 163 countries⁹⁴ in UNICEF's Children's Climate Risk Index based on climate and environmental shocks, which is in the top third of countries with a high risk to climate change. The UNICEF media release found that Cambodian children are highly exposed to water scarcity, riverine flooding and vector-borne disease. Furthermore, the Global Climate Risk Index ranks Cambodia as 14th most climate risk prone country globally⁹⁵. The country is particularly vulnerable to the hazards of floods, droughts, heatwaves, cyclones, and seawater intrusion due to its geographic location. During these climate events, school infrastructure is damaged, children are increasingly absent losing learning and development opportunities and school communities suffer climate related health illnesses.

South Sudan

147. As an LDC, South Sudan is recognised as being particularly vulnerable to economic shocks while having urgent and immediate adaptation needs. South Sudan is ranked by the ND-GAIN as the 8th most vulnerable country in the world to climate shocks, and the 175th most ready country to adapt to the impacts of climate change. South Sudan is also close to the bottom of all countries in terms of Human Development, ranking 185th out of 189 countries on the Human Development Index and an estimated 80% of the population live beneath the absolute poverty line.⁹⁶ Conflict is also still extremely prevalent in South Sudan, and is a core driver of humanitarian needs.

148. This project focuses on adaptation needs for recipients in six counties extreme flooding, drought, temperature related wildfires and heatwaves which render learners unable to go to school. South Sudan's topographic context – extreme lowlands and swamps – mean that schools and communities are extremely vulnerable to flooding, which is growing increasingly worse due to erratic and intense rainfall, leading hundreds of schools across the country to close and become damaged beyond repair.

Tonga

149. Tonga's school children, surrounding communities and the educational system is already - and will continue to - face sea level rise, droughts, floodings, and extreme weather including tropical cyclones and heatwaves. Climate change generates intense challenges to Tonga's education system. Tonga does not have any climate change specific courses in schools and during stakeholder consultations, government stakeholders emphasized the need to guide and prepare students for climate professions.

150. A World Bank report⁹⁷, confirmed by consultations with government stakeholders, indicated that schools especially on the outer islands are highly vulnerable to climate risks and urgently need infrastructural support. Past climate

⁸⁹ Center for Strategic and International Studies. Spotlight-Cambodia. [Available here](#)

⁹⁰ Ibid

⁹¹ "UN Reports: Cambodia At High Risk From Climate Change – Cambodia's Official Climate Change Website". Available [here](#)

⁹² ND-GAIN Index, 2022. [Available here](#). /.:

⁹³ INFORM risk index for Cambodia. Available [here](#)

⁹⁴ UNICEF, Media Release, 2021. Available [here](#).

⁹⁵ Global Climate Risk Index, 2021. [Available here](#).

⁹⁶ Relief web, [South Sudan Unified Plan - Mid-year report 2023](#), accessed 29/07/2023

⁹⁷ Strengthening the resilience of public facilities in Samoa, Tonga, and Vanuatu: Final Report on the Assessment of Schools in Tonga. 2022.

events in 2018 and 2020, were highly disruptive of children's education and associated with high financial costs. Although there are previous projects focused on school safety and continuity related to disasters, the climate lens has been missing.

151. Unfortunately, domestic and international funding sources are insufficient to meet the adaptation needs of the education sector and the dispersed school system. Most international donor-supported programmes focus on immediate development priorities with only a minor focus on climate change, and often with a mitigation focus.
152. Components 2 and 3 focus on mobilising climate finance and building knowledge and networks which are greatly lacking in the target countries. It's clear that as climate impacts and risks increase, the viability of any investments in the education sector will be compromised. Stakeholders need to be engaged and coordinated in order to collaborate, access finance, prioritise climate actions and share knowledge and lessons with a view to strengthen the country's climate resilience in the education sector.

D.5. Country ownership (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

153. BRACE is designed to enhance the resilience of the education sectors in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga to the impacts of climate change. Country ownership is embedded through BRACE's strong partnerships with government ministries and extensive stakeholder engagement, in addition to alignment with the national policies, climate change strategies, and gender action plans of these countries. BRACE aims to support national climate and education priorities while addressing common challenges faced by these diverse regions.

Policy Alignment and Support

154. BRACE aligns with the national climate change strategies and educational policies of South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga ensuring that the project supports each country's efforts to build climate-resilient education systems. In **South Sudan**, the project aligns with the NAP and the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), prioritizing climate adaptation in education. Similarly, in **Cambodia**, BRACE supports the Cambodia Climate Change Strategic Plan (CCCSP) 2014 - 2023 and the National Action Plan for Disaster Risk Reduction (NAP-DRR), which emphasize integrating climate resilience into the education sector. **Tonga's** alignment is reflected through its Strategic Development Framework (TSDF) 2015-2025 and the Joint National Action Plan for Climate Change Adaptation and Disaster Risk Management (JNAP II) 2018-2028, which prioritize building resilience across all sectors, including education.
155. In each country, BRACE will support the implementation of national strategies by improving the climate resilience of school infrastructure, integrating climate change education into curricula, and enhancing disaster preparedness. By aligning with these policies, BRACE contributes directly to the broader climate adaptation goals of South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga ensuring that educational continuity is maintained despite increasing climate risks.

Alignment with Gender Action Plans and Policies

156. Please see **Annex 8** for more information. The project is designed to be gender-responsive and more broadly inclusive to address the unique needs of girls, children with disabilities, women, and internally displaced people. In **South Sudan**, the project aligns with the National Gender Policy, ensuring that gender perspectives are integrated into all aspects of climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction. **Cambodia's** Gender Mainstreaming Strategic Plan in Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management is supported by BRACE's efforts to ensure that both girls and boys have equal access to climate-resilient educational facilities. Similarly, in **Tonga**, BRACE aligns with the national education policy framework, ensuring that interventions are inclusive of all genders and children with disabilities.

Complementarity and Coherence with Government Policies and Plans

157. BRACE is designed to complement existing government initiatives and frameworks, ensuring coherence with national development plans and sectoral strategies in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga. The project leverages ongoing efforts such as the Climate Smart Education Systems Initiative (CSESI) in **South Sudan**, which supports climate-resilient infrastructure and educational continuity. In **Cambodia**, BRACE complements the National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (NBSAP) and the Rectangular Strategy Phase IV, which prioritize environmental sustainability and natural resource management. **Tonga** benefits from the project's alignment with previous initiatives like the Outer Island Renewable Energy Project (OIREP) and the GCF FP090 Tonga Renewable Energy Project (TREP), which focus on enhancing the resilience of school infrastructure and improving access to renewable energy and internet connectivity.
158. By building on these initiatives, BRACE maximizes its impact and contributes to a coordinated national response to climate change in each country. The project's design ensures that interventions are integrated into existing frameworks, allowing for the efficient use of resources and ensuring that project activities are sustainable and scalable.

Key Partner Engagement and Government Leadership

159. The successful implementation of BRACE depends on strong partnerships with government ministries and leadership from local authorities in each country. In **South Sudan**, the Ministry of General Education and Instruction (MoGEI), the Ministry of Environment, and the Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Management provide strategic oversight, ensuring that project activities align with national priorities. Similarly, in **Cambodia**, the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sport (MoEYS) leads the project's implementation, working closely with local governments and development partners to integrate climate resilience into the education sector. In **Tonga**, the Ministry of Education and Training (MET) and the Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications (MEIDECC) provide leadership, ensuring that BRACE aligns with national climate adaptation goals.
160. In each country, BRACE engages local governments, community organizations, and school management committees ensuring that interventions are contextually relevant and sustainable. By fostering a sense of ownership among local stakeholders the project ensures that the benefits of climate resilience are maintained long after the project's completion.

Ownership and Stakeholder Consultations

161. Please see **Annex 7** for more information. Stakeholder engagement has been a critical component of BRACE's development and implementation in all three countries. Extensive consultations with government agencies, local communities, non-governmental organizations, and development partners have ensured that the project aligns with local needs and priorities. In **South Sudan**, consultations informed the project's focus on strengthening the resilience of school infrastructure and integrating climate change education into the curriculum. In **Cambodia**, discussions with national and sub-national stakeholders helped identify key areas of intervention, ensuring that the project is responsive to local capacities and vulnerabilities. Similarly, in **Tonga**, participatory processes involving government agencies and local communities ensured that the project is well-aligned with local challenges and opportunities related to climate change adaptation.
162. These consultations have not only shaped the project's design but also fostered broad support for its implementation. BRACE will continue to engage stakeholders throughout the project implementation, ensuring ongoing alignment with national and community priorities, and enabling adaptive management based on stakeholder feedback.
163. The involvement of local communities and educational institutions in the project's design and implementation will further ensure that interventions are contextually appropriate and have a lasting impact.

D.6. Efficiency and effectiveness (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

The BRACE Project's expected impact. With an estimated total budget of USD 46.7 million, the project's GCF grant is estimated at USD 40.7 million, with a grant-co-financing ratio of 0.85 to 1. The project is expected to deliver to 8.6 million overall beneficiaries out of which over 608,000 will be directly influenced and 8.64 million will see indirect benefits.

Concessional justification. The proposed concessional financing level for the BRACE project is justifiable based on the ongoing need for highly concessional financing in these three target countries. This type of financing is vital for implementing interventions that will not only enhance the educational environment for students in public schools in three target countries but also bring about a positive societal change. These countries are particularly vulnerable to the impacts of climate change and require increased public investment to adapt their education systems accordingly. Since basic education shows qualities of public good⁹⁸, it is typically funded by governments using national taxes or other grant funding, as the public good attributes make it difficult or costly for private firms to appropriate rents⁹⁹. As a result, the displacement of the private sector is not expected to be a concern in these target countries once the BRACE project is underway.

Budgetary constraints in target countries. Various factors, including budgetary, macroeconomic, and internal government organization aspects, contribute to this need for grant financing:

1. **Cambodia:** The country's fiscal deficit widened in 2023 due to extended support to households and firms affected by the COVID-19 pandemic. This unprecedented crisis and increased spending associated with the elections and the 2023 South-East Asia Games have significantly strained the country's resources. The public debt ratio to GDP is expected to increase moderately in the next ten years, further limiting funding options for public goods, including climate change adaptation of the education system.¹⁰⁰
2. **South Sudan:** South Sudan continues to experience severe humanitarian and economic challenges resulting from several shocks, including the Red Sea crisis, the war in Sudan, domestic policy deficiencies, and climate change calamities (e.g., flooding). The country has significant financing needs, including social and development spending needs, debt service obligations on a large stock of non-concessional external debt, reserve coverage of below one month of imports against a background of a projected decline in oil prices, and a continued downward global trend for international aid. The public resources for education and climate adaptation remain scarce.¹⁰¹
3. **Tonga:** Despite the challenges, Tonga's economy has been recovering well from the COVID-19 pandemic. The tourism sector, a key contributor to Tonga's economy, is in the process of rebuilding after the pandemic and climate-related shocks. However, the need for infrastructure rebuilding and labour shortages may slow down this process. Tonga's long-term growth is projected at 1.2 percent, given its exposure to natural disasters and

⁹⁸ The public good concept encompasses non-rivalrous and non-excludable goods. While some argue that private basic education or higher education exists, it may not fit this definition due to the existence of private schools or universities. Basic schooling is generally considered a public good. Education benefits every member of society, making it essential for all of us to contribute to its funding through taxes. This investment in education is crucial as it leads to a more educated population, ultimately benefiting society.

⁹⁹ Stiglitz, J. (1989). "The Economic Role of the Government in Education." *Handbook of Public Economics*; Besley, T., & Ghatak, M. (2005). "Competition and Incentives with Motivated Agents." *American Economic Review*, 95(3), 616-636.

¹⁰⁰ Source: <https://www.imf.org/en/Publications/CR/Issues/2024/01/29/Cambodia-2023-Article-IV-Consultation-Press-Release-and-Staff-Report-544276>

¹⁰¹ Source: <https://www.imf.org/en/Publications/CR/Issues/2024/06/10/Republic-of-South-Sudan-2023-Article-IV-Consultation-and-First-and-Second-Reviews-under-the-550191>

persistent loss of workers to emigration. The public resources for education and climate adaptation remain uncertain but they might improve with the overall economic growth.¹⁰²

Consequently, taking into consideration (i) the significant climate-related vulnerabilities of these target countries that require urgent adaptation measures to be implemented in their education systems, (ii) the nature of the project with its public good type of interventions, and (iii) the fact that target countries suffer from serious budgetary pressures, the proposed grant financing for the BRACE project is justified.

EFA modelling results. The ex-ante EFA was pursued separately for each of the three target countries in economic terms from two perspectives: (1) the perspective of direct beneficiaries (in individual/per average and indicative public primary school type and in aggregate per assumed number of similar schools to obtain BRACE interventions in each of the three countries, and (2) the perspective of the entire BRACE project with an embedded accounting of the budgetary implementation framework of 5 (4 in the case of South Sudan) years. These two modelling perspectives (1) and (2) were additionally appraised using two different climate scenario assumptions, RCP 4.5 and RCP 8.5, to show how the results might change under differing climate hardships. The EFA results were calculated over 15 years using a conservative discount rate of 9%. The aggregate Economic estimates from the entire project perspective to be targeted by the BRACE project are listed in the Table below. The detailed per-target-country results can be seen in Annex 3 of the FP package.

Table: Overall BRACE Project Results (all countries s) with GCF funding accounted for

Aggregate Economic Results		Aggregate Economic Results	
RCP 4.5 assumed. Analytical timeframe: 15 years, discount rate: 9%		RCP 8.5 assumed. Analytical timeframe: 15 years, discount rate: 9%	
ENPV (USD)	\$ 87,844,031	ENPV (USD)	\$ 86,012,237
ERR (%)	36%	ERR (%)	35%
EMIRR (%)	20%	EMIRR (%)	20%

Application of the best practices. The BRACE project is dedicated to maximizing impact by implementing proven interventions and best practices in targeted schools. Using a participatory and integrated approach, our objective is to create virtuous cycles of implementation, testing, and feedback to scale up efforts and generate economic returns for the intended beneficiaries and the entire economy.

¹⁰² Source: <https://www.imf.org/en/Publications/CR/Issues/2023/11/03/Tonga-2023-Article-IV-Consultation-Press-Release-and-Staff-Report-541117>

E. LOGICAL FRAMEWORK

This section refers to the project/programme's logical framework in accordance with the GCF's Integrated Results Management Framework to which the project/programme contributes as a whole, including in respect of any co-financing.

1. GCF Impact level: Paradigm shift potential (max. 300 words)

This section of the logical framework is meant to help a project/programme monitor and assess how it contributes to the paradigm shift described in section D.2 above by applying three assessment dimensions - scale, replicability, and sustainability.

Accordingly, for each assessment dimension (see the definition per assessment in the accompanying guidance note), describe the current state (baseline) and the potential scenario (target) and rate the current state (baseline) by using the three-point-scale rating (low, medium, and high) provided in the guidance note. Also describe how the project/programme will contribute to that shift/ transformation under respective assessment dimensions (scale, replicability and sustainability). In doing so, please refer to section D.2 (paradigm shift potential).

Assessment Dimension	Current state (Baseline)		Potential target scenario (Description)	How the project/programme will contribute (Description)
	Description	Rating		
Scale	The Ministry of Education in South Sudan, Cambodia and Tonga have complete authority over developing and standardizing national policies and overseeing the national, provincial, district and the local platforms that operationalize them. Yet substantial barriers continue to inhibit the development and implementation of climate-smart education	Low	Two dimensions of a potential target scenario exist with regards to the scale the project will address. In relation to the scale of the work in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga, delivering the project will be the largest investments made to date in building the climate resilience of each country's education system. Each Ministry of Education will be supported at the national level to build capacity used to reinforce the enabling environment (policies and planning) to support sub national	<i>Describe key applicable outputs and or resulting outcomes relevant to increasing (scaling up) quantifiable results within and beyond the scope of the intervention</i> Component 1, Output 1.1 will exclusively focus on the enabling environment to allow Ministries of Education to scale up the work in their respective countries. The suite of activities in each country are designed to support the Ministries of Education to integrate climate change into existing policies and systems and, where needed, develop new ones to enable their Ministries to deliver the work at scale across the project's target geographies and beyond.

	policies and strategies at scale. These barriers include: 1) limited intra-governmental coordination; 2) lack of capacity and resources to develop, implement, and enforce policies and plans; 3) limited understanding of climate-education linked issues (e.g., on appropriate infrastructure and how climate impacts access to education); and 4) persistent challenges in equitable (gender, ability, etc.) access to and use of education services at community level. These challenges result in a lack of financial and technical resources and missed opportunities to integrate climate change risks impacts and risk considerations into existing education policies and strategies		implementation in the targeted geographies of each country. This will be at a scale never before achieved, and will also be a stepping stone for Ministries of Education to try, test, and learn from the experience to replicate and scale the activities into other geographies not reached by the BRACE project. The second dimension of scale is the impact the project will have on a wider group of countries in Component 2 in the parallel project financed CSESI project. (32 additional countries). The project has purposely chosen three countries with different needs, capacities, climate vulnerabilities and geopolitical contexts. By demonstrating impact through Component 1 in these varied contexts, Component 2 will provide the enabling environment to scale up the work through supporting their access to climate finance and sharing the tools and resources needed to design tailored intervention in their unique national contexts.	Output 1.2 includes a suite of activities that supports the enabling environment at scale with regards to greening and making school infrastructure more climate resilient, for example developing national standards for climate resilient schools. Output 1.3 will strengthen central and sub-national management systems to enhance educational continuity across the country wide system in the face of climate-induced disasters. Output 1.4 focuses on the training of teachers of school children. The activities under this output are all designed to be used at scale. The project will be rolled out in the project's target geographies but tools, resources, and capacities developed will be applied to the whole country. Component 2 is designed to scale up this work. All activities used throughout Component 1 will be contextualised and applied in countries that are engaged through both the CSESI co-financing and parallel project finance and Component 2. Component 3 lays the foundation for further scaling up of the work of Component 1 and 2 by enhancing coordination and collaboration. This involves facilitating potential mobilisation of funds towards financiers, technical partners, and ministries of education in support of scaling up the work in more countries that are seeking to build the climate resilience of their education systems.
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	and to develop new, future-oriented, and data-informed climate and education policies and strategies that are tailored to each countries national context-			
Replicability	Government structures in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga should enable unified planning, roll out, and implementation of climate resilient, and gender equitable policies and strategies. However, institutional capacity constraints at local, sub-national, and national levels hamper effective adaptation planning processes in the education sector, inter- and intra-ministerial coordination, access to climate and education finance, and implementation of adaptation actions at scale. These constraints also mean that governments have limited focus on internal knowledge sharing and dissemination across	<u>Low</u>	Ministries of education specialise in the replication of systems and processes, and train teachers to educate children though Kindergarten to 12 (or similar) cycles. They apply standardised methods and tools (e.g., curriculum and testing) and are expert in the replication of their usage. The BRACE project will provide ministries of education with the knowledge, capacities, tools, and systems to integrate climate resilience (through improved infrastructure, management and curriculum) into their existing systems, which are designed for replication. The project will support the development, testing, assessment, and adaptation if needed in preparation for rollout at scale. The BRACE design is focused on supporting the education system so activities can be replicated and scale up, as	The replication of output 1.1 is intended to spread beyond the 3 countries of implementation. Policies, plans, and systems established in the 3 countries do not require national replication but rather periodic updating. However, Components 2 & 3 will seek to replicate good practice through sharing lessons learned in the 3 countries, and more broadly through interested institutions (UN agencies, development banks, donors, and NGOs) engaged in Component 3. The activities and outcomes of output 1.2 (infrastructure), output 1.3 (continuity management), and output 1.4 (curriculum) will be designed for replication nationally in geographies not reached by the project intervention. In some circumstances resources will be required (such as infrastructure) and if not available, this could hinder the replication of activities. However management practices and curriculum can be replicated at a relatively low cost by embedding them in existing systems that benefit the country as a whole (such as teacher training or the development of management capacity).

	sectors and limited participation efforts in global learning focused on climate change and education.		designed for all other educational activities.	
Sustainability	The introduction of new strategies and solutions in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga often fail due to the following: a lack of official government endorsement; insufficient investment in training and capacity strengthening; weak systems and procedures to maintain infrastructure; and a lack of widespread community participation, particularly from groups in rural and remote areas, women, girls, and boys, PWDs and other groups that experience inequality and discrimination.	<u>Low</u>	The target scenario is to effectively embed into the education system an understating of the impacts of climate change, and to provide the tools, systems, policies, plans, capacities, and capabilities for respective ministries of education to make necessary strengthening and adaptations to their existing ways of working. This will build the climate resilience of the education system, schools, and the children they teach. As noted above ministries of education are set up to replicate and scale up systems and process sustainably. Therefore, the project will focus on embedding the work deep into education systems and processes where knowledge and understanding will be sustained.	Output 1.1 focuses on the enabling systems that will allow for the sustainability of actions. If climate resilient systems and policies are integrated into standard ways of working in ministries of education they are likely to be sustained long term. Work to date through the CSESI parallel project shows overwhelming relevance and timeliness to ministries of education, which will support the sustainability of ongoing work in these 3 countries. Work will be sustained, when designs and standards for school facility construction, operation, and maintenance (as part of Output 1.2) are updated, used, and monitored, and include considerations of climate change impacts. When activities of Output 1.4 are complete, and curriculum and teacher training material developed, disseminated and tested, teacher training and its practical application and impacts will be sustainable. The Component 3 design consultation highlighted that there is no obvious organisation, body, or existing coordination mechanism that is currently

				suited to sustain coordination of efforts on integrating climate change and education. Therefore Component 3 will focus on enriching dialogue and collaboration and exploring the suitability of existing mechanisms to take on global coordination in the long term. The Steering Committee of Component 3 will be drawn from the key organisation invested in this area of work, and will be tasked with identifying the most suitable home for climate and education to be sustained in the long term.
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2.1. GCF Outcome level: Reduced emissions and increased resilience (IRMF core indicators 1-4, quantitative indicators)						
Select appropriate IRMF core and supplementary indicators to monitor project/programme progress. More than one IRMF (core and or supplementary) indicators may be selected as applicable for each GCF results area and project/programme outcome (as defined in the table in section B.2.2). If IRMF indicators are unable to measure any given project/programme outcomes, project/programme-specific indicators should be developed under section 3 ("Project/programme specific indicators").						
GCF Result Area	IRMF Core Indicators (1-4) ^[1]	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final ^[2]	
		Sources of information and methods used to collect and report data /information to measure progress against targets	The starting point or current value of the indicators before the implementation of the project	The estimated value of the indicator at the mid-point of the implementation	The estimated value of the indicator at the completion of the implementation	Externalities and factors outside project management's control that may impact the outcomes Data sources and methodologies applied

						<i>for estimating baseline and targets</i>
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Total project beneficiaries (Components 1,2,3)	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Record of project/programme activities Yearly progress reports and final evaluation Education enrolment and staffing data Government or non-government population surveys	Program Direct: 0 Indirect: 0	Program Direct: 243,277 total (120,191 F) Indirect: 3,456,338 total (1,706,740 F) (- 40% reach by midterm	Program Direct: 608,193 total (300,477F) Indirect: 8,640,844 total (4,266,850 F)	Total direct beneficiaries include all children, school staff and community members identified as direct beneficiaries across Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga in Component 1 activities as defined below in ARA1, in addition to direct beneficiaries from Components 2 and 3. Indirect beneficiaries are children, school staff, and community members that don't receive targeted support, but are likely to see adaptation benefits and enhanced resilience through cascading from project deliverables. According to the GCF's definitions, the project anticipates that Component 1 will report both direct and indirect beneficiaries, while Components 2 and 3 will report only direct beneficiaries. Thus total indirect beneficiaries are from Component 1 activities in South Sudan, Cambodia and Tonga, as defined below for ARA1. Since there are no Output 1.1 activities in Tonga, we include indirect beneficiaries from ARA2.
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ARA1 Most vulnerable people and communities	Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached	Record of project/programme activities	Cambodia	Cambodia	Cambodia	Direct beneficiaries for ARA1 are those people who benefit directly from project activities in Component 1 in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. In output 1.2, they are defined as children enrolled, two of their caregivers, and school staff working at, schools that receive targeted support through school facility upgrades. In output 1.3, this includes additional school staff and community members trained on climate-related school safety, and children enrolled in schools that receive support on school safety and educational continuity management systems. In output 1.4, this includes school staff trained on updated pedagogical approaches to risk reduction and resilience education, and children enrolled schools receiving these pedagogical updates (Output 1.4).
		Yearly progress reports and final evaluation	Direct: 0	Direct: 156,856 total (75,339 F)	Direct: 392,185 total (188,373 F)	
		Education enrolment and staffing data	Indirect: 0	Indirect: 1,612,560 total (784,851 F)	Indirect: 4,031,400 total (1,962,128 F)	
		Government or non-government population surveys		- Around 40% reach by midterm		
			South Sudan	South Sudan	South Sudan	Indirect beneficiaries are defined as all school aged children in South Sudan and Cambodia benefitting from policy and enabling environment changes in the education sector (Output 1.1) - excluding direct beneficiaries as defined above. Since there are no
			Direct: 0	Direct: 80,468 total (41,957 F)	Direct: 201,242 total (104,929 F)	
			Indirect: 0	Indirect: 1,829,072 (914,536 F)	Indirect: 4,572,682 total (2,286,341 F)	
			Tonga	Tonga	Tonga	
			Direct: 0	Direct: 5,468 (2,652 F)	Direct: 13,671 total (6,631 F)	
			Indirect: 0	- 40% reach by midterm		

				Indirect: 14,704 (7,352 F)	Indirect: 36,762 (18,381 F)	Output 1.1 activities in Tonga, we define indirect beneficiaries for ARA1 as the same as in ARA2.
			Program	Program	Program	
			Direct: 0	Direct: 242,793 total (119,949 F)	Direct: 607,098 total (299,933 F)	
			Indirect: 0	Indirect: 3,456,337 total (1,706,740 F)	Indirect: 8,640,844 total (4,266,850 F)	
				- Around 40% reach by midterm		
<u>ARA2 Health, well-being, food and water security</u>	<u>Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached</u>	Record of project/programme activities Yearly progress reports and final evaluation Education enrolment and staffing data Government or non-government population surveys	Cambodia Direct: 0 Indirect: 0	<u>Direct:</u> <u>Cambodia: 31,360 (15,094 F)</u> <u>Indirect:</u> <u>(298,770 F)</u>	<u>Direct:</u> <u>Cambodia: 62,745 (30,198 F)</u> <u>Indirect: 1,187,955 (597,540 F)</u>	Direct beneficiaries for ARA2 are those from project Component 1 in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga who benefit from improved health and safety due to improved risk management and early warning systems (output 1.3). They are defined as children enrolled, two of their caregivers, and school staff working at, schools that receive targeted support through school facility upgrades, plus school staff and community

			South Sudan Direct: 0 Indirect: 0	South Sudan <u>South Sudan: 10,893 (5,695 F)</u> Indirect: 521,049 total (260,524 F) - 40% reach by midterm	South Sudan <u>South Sudan: 27,233 (14,238 F)</u> Indirect: 1,302,624 total (651,312 F)	members trained on school safety and disaster risk management, and children in schools that receive support on school safety and educational continuity management systems Indirect beneficiaries are defined as those that don't receive targeted support, but are likely to see adaptation benefits and enhanced resilience. Here indirect beneficiaries for improved health and safety are defined as the population of subnational areas targeted by Output 1.3 which benefit from subnational and school-based early warning systems and emergency preparedness and contingency plans introduced by the BRACE program. In South Sudan, this is the population of the 6 target districts, in Cambodia the population of the 3 target provinces, and in Tonga it is estimated to be 37% of the total country population based on the proportion of total schools covered in the country, as the program does not follow a district or province-based approach.
			Tonga Direct: 0 Indirect: 0	Tonga <u>Tonga: 4,868 (2,352 F)</u> Indirect: 14,704 (7,352 F) - 40% reach by midterm	Tonga <u>Tonga: 12,171 (5,881 F)</u> Indirect: 36,762 total (18,381 F)	
			Program Direct: 0	Program Direct: 40,859 total (20,126 F)	Program Direct: 102,149 total (50,317 F)	

			Indirect: 0	Indirect: 1,010,936 total (506,893 F) - 40% reach by midterm	Indirect: 2,527,341 total (1,267,233 F)	
	<u>Supplementary 2.4: Beneficiaries (female/male) covered by new or improved early warning systems</u>	Record of project/programme activities Government or non-government population surveys	<u>Indirect beneficiaries:</u> Cambodia: 0 South Sudan: 0 Tonga: 0 Total: 0	<u>Direct:</u> <u>Cambodia: 31,360 (15,094 F)</u> <u>South Sudan: 13,615 (7,240 F)</u> <u>Tonga: 6,085 (2,940 F)</u>	<u>Direct:</u> <u>Cambodia: 62,745 (30,198 F)</u> <u>South Sudan: 27,231 (14,481F)</u> <u>Tonga: 12,171 (5,881 F)</u> <u>Indirect:</u> <u>Cambodia: 318,109 (158,054)</u> <u>South Sudan: 191,563 (95,781 F)</u>	The project anticipates direct beneficiaries for this results area. The direct beneficiaries include all children, school staff and community members who are targeted by output 1.3 of Component 1. Indirect beneficiaries here include children and adults that live in districts/counties where BRACE works to establish new or improved early warning systems, scaled down by the proportion of schools covered by the interventions in Output 1.3. Assumes that schools and communities can access internet connection(s) and CIS/EWS, including out of school children. Indirect beneficiaries are calculated through the following assumption:

					<u>Tonga: 36,762 total (17,278 F)</u> In Cambodia, we estimate those covered directly by the EWS/CIS to only be a fraction of the population of the state. That fraction is defined as the ratio of schools covered in output 1.3 (240) by the total number of schools in the 3 provinces (813), multiplied by the total population of the three provinces. In South Sudan, we estimate those covered indirectly by the EWS/CIS to only be a fraction of the population of the state. That fraction is defined as the ratio of schools covered in output 1.3 (75) by the total number of schools in the counties (510). In Tonga, the figures are a proportion of the entire country as Tonga does not take a district-based approach as is the case in Cambodia and South Sudan.
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ARA3 Infrastructure and built environment	Core 2: Direct and indirect beneficiaries reached	Record of project/programme activities	Cambodia	Cambodia	Cambodia	According to the GCF's definitions, the project anticipates only direct beneficiaries for this results area. This includes children enrolled in, two primary caregivers who visit, and staff working in, schools that receive targeted support through school facility upgrades (Output 1.2).
		Yearly progress reports and final evaluation	Direct: 0	Direct: 12,238 (6,040 F)	Direct: 30,595 total (15,102 F)	
		Education enrolment and staffing data		- 40% reach by midterm		
			South Sudan	South Sudan	South Sudan	
			Direct: 0	Direct: 12,606 (6,383F)	Direct: 31,514 total (15,958 F)	
			Tonga	Tonga	Tonga	
			Direct: 0	Direct: 1,020 total (539 F)	Direct: 2,550 total (1,349 F)	
			Program	Program	Program	
			Direct: 0	Direct: 25,864 total (12,963 F)	Direct: 64,659 total (32,409 F)	

				- 40% reach by midterm		
	<u>Core 3: Value of physical assets made more resilient to the effects of climate change and/or more able to reduce GHG emissions</u>	Record of project/programme activities Ministry of Education records	Cambodia: \$0 South Sudan: \$0 Tonga: \$0 Program: \$0	Cambodia: \$1,982,405 South Sudan: \$2,504,000 Tonga: \$ 650,000 Program: \$5,386,622	Cambodia: \$3,964,810 South Sudan: \$5,008,435 Tonga: \$1,800,000 Program: \$10,773,245	This represents the dollar value (USD) of school facilities made more resilient to climate change (Output 1.2). Estimates are based on budget projections for infrastructure upgrades, and are subject to change based on detailed infrastructure needs assessment.

^[1] The IRMF Indicators are set out in the [Integrated Results Management Framework](#)

^[2] The final target means the target at the end of project/programme implementation period. However, for core indicator 1 (GHG emission reduction), please also provide the target value at the end of the total lifespan period which is defined as the maximum number of years over which the impacts of the investment are expected to be effective.

2.2. GCF Outcome level: Enabling environment (IRMF core indicators 5-8 as applicable)

Select at least two relevant IRMF core (enabling environment) indicators to monitor and elaborate the baseline context and ,project/programme's targeted outcome against the respective indicators. Rate the current state (baseline) vis-à-vis the target scenario and select the geographical scope of the outcome to be assessed. Describe how the project/programme will contribute towards the target scenario. Refer to a case example in the accompanying guidance to complete this section.

IRMF Core Indicators (5-8) ^[1]	Baseline context (Description)	Rating for current state (Baseline)	Target scenario (Description)	How the project will contribute	Coverage
Core Indicator 5: <u>Degree to which GCF investments contribute to strengthening institutional and regulatory frameworks for low emission climate-resilient development pathways in a country-driven manner</u>	Ministries of Education institutional and regulatory frameworks do not yet effectively integrate climate change adaptation or resilience building across the full scope of infrastructure, management practices and curriculum work.	<u>Low</u>	Institutional and regulatory frameworks in Ministries of Education address the projected impact of climate change on: 1) school infrastructure; 2) educational continuity management systems; 3) and pedagogy and curriculum.	Project activities under Output 1.1 will facilitate the preparation and endorsement of policies, plans and guidelines to implement the policies strengthening the institutional and regulatory frameworks Component 2 will support countries integrate education into NAP and NDC processes Component 3 will develop guidelines and tools to support the strengthening of education and climate policies and programs	<u>Multi-countries</u>
Core Indicator 6: <u>Degree to which GCF investments contribute to technology deployment, dissemination, development or transfer and innovation</u>	Minimal access to project-relevant technologies to support the delivery of climate resilient education	<u>Low</u>	Ministries of education and schools have access to climate information service and early warning systems to enable educational continuity during times of climate induced disasters.	Project activities under Output 1.2 will strengthen school infrastructure including electrification and connectivity. Project activities under output 1.3 will strengthen access to and use of Early Warning System and Climate Information Services. Project activities under output 1.4 will disseminate teaching and	<u>Multi-countries</u>

				learning materials through the e-learning platforms.	
<u>Core indicator 8:</u> <u>Degree to which GCF investments contribute to effective knowledge generation and learning processes, and use of good practices, methodologies and standards</u>	No systematic approach to sharing knowledge and good practice on climate resilient education.	<u>Low</u>	Ministries of Education are coordinating within their ministries and with other relevant national ministries to enhance the resilience of the education system based on shared good practice. There are international platforms sharing good practices and collaboration in support of helping national ministries of education build the resilience of their education systems.	Activities under output 1.1 will strengthen the coordination between ministries of education and ministries of climate change Activities under output 1.3 include capacity building at national and sub-national level supporting education authorities manage educational continuity based on good practice. Activities under output 1.4 specifically include the preparation of learning documents and holding shared learning events on climate and education Components 3 is focused on knowledge management and shared learning (including developing guidance and materials and running webinars and session sharing learning and experience)	<u>Multi-countries</u>

^[1] The IRMF Indicators are set out in the [Integrated Results Management Framework](#)

3. Project/programme specific indicators (project outcomes and outputs)

*This section should list out project/programme-specific performance indicators (outcomes and outputs) that are not covered in sections above (1-2). List down tailored indicators to monitor /track progress against relevant project/programme results (outcomes/outputs). AEs have the freedom to decide against which outcomes they would like to set project/programme specific indicators. If any co-benefits are identified in sections B.2.2, and D.3, AEs are encouraged to add and monitor co-benefit indicators under the “**Project/programme co-benefit indicators**” section in table below. Add rows as needed.*

Please number each outcome and output as shown below to indicate association of outputs to the contributing outcome. The numbering for outputs under this section should correspond to the output numbering in annex 3 (budget plan that provides breakdown by type of expense).

Project/programme results (outcomes/ outputs)	Project/programme specific Indicator	Means of Verification (MoV)	Baseline	Target		Assumptions / Note
				Mid-term	Final	
		<i>Sources of information and methods used to collect and report data/information to measure progress against targets</i>	<i>The starting point or current value of the indicators before the implementation of the project</i>	<i>The estimated value of the indicator at the mid-point of the implementation</i>	<i>The estimated value of the indicator at the completion of the implementation</i>	<i>Externalities and factors outside project management's control that may impact on the Component. Data sources and methodologies applied for estimating baseline and targets</i>

Outcome 1: The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.

Outcome 1: The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.	# of policies and action plans that have been endorsed by the education sector (national and subnational) to enhance its resilience to climate change	Review of approved education policies, budgets, M&E frameworks, implementation reports and annual sector reviews	Cambodia	Cambodia:0	Cambodia: 2	May include standards, strategies, implementation guidelines, education sector analysis, budgets, M&E frameworks.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan:0	South Sudan:2	
			Program: 0	Program: 0	Program: 4	In South Sudan this includes the development of climate change and education policy & implementation guidelines for climate change adaptation

						and updating Inter-Agency Network for Education in Emergencies (INEE) Minimum Standards (MS). Cambodia will establish 1) National Climate Resilience in Education Framework and 2) anticipatory action funding mechanism guideline for the education sector. Factors impacting the project will depend on government priorities for drafting and revising policies and plans over the program period.
	# of education authorities with disaster risk reduction plans in place	Project records	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 3	Cambodia: 9	Will depend on willingness of state and county government to engage with project
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 6	South Sudan: 12	In South Sudan, six state education authorities and six county level education authorities will be targeted. In South Sudan, This is a total of 12 education authorities targeted in South Sudan. 3 Province Education Offices and 6 District level education offices will be targeted. This is a total of 9 education authorities in Cambodia. .
			Program: 0	Program: 3	Program: 21	
	# of school days closed per year due to climate-related reasons	Quarterly school survey	TBD	TBD	TBD	Through the program we assume that target schools will have increased ability to remain safely open due to climate resilient measures. Days tracked to be disaggregated by 1. Climate hazards 2. Other forms of school violence 3. Use of

						schools as temporary evacuation centres 4. Everyday hazards Assumes that school safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively (output 1.3). Will depend on macro trends and national and subnational policies and directives on school closures due to climate events. School days open will be tracked in target schools via quarterly survey along with climate events affecting the school area. This estimate will be drawn from an evaluation sample of project beneficiaries, not all beneficiaries.
	<i>% of average annual school dropout rate in target schools</i>	Quarterly school survey	TBD	TBD (reduction of 3%)	TBD (reduction of 6%)	Will depend on other macro education trends affecting dropout, as well as potential conflict. Dropout rates will be tracked in target schools through a quarterly survey, along with climate events affecting the school area. This estimate will be drawn from an impact evaluation sample of project beneficiaries, not all beneficiaries.
	<i>% of average annual absence of students and teachers in target schools</i>	Quarterly school survey	TBD	TBD (reduction of 5%)	TBD (reduction of 10%)	Will depend on other macro education trends affecting absenteeism, as well as potential conflict.

	<i>^ disaggregate by student, teacher, gender</i>					Student and teacher absenteeism will be tracked in target schools, along with climate events affecting the school area. This estimate will be drawn from an impact evaluation sample of project beneficiaries, not all beneficiaries.
Output 1.1: Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported	# national and subnational education sector policy and planning documents drafted to include climate change adaptation or environmental sustainability measures	Review of education policies, budgets, M&E frameworks, implementation reports and annual sector reviews	Cambodia	Cambodia:0	Cambodia: 2	May include standards, strategies, implementation guidelines, education sector analysis, budgets, M&E frameworks.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan:0	South Sudan:2	
			Program: 0	Program: 0	Program: 4	In South Sudan this includes the development of climate change and education policy & implementation guidelines for climate change adaptation and updating Inter-Agency Network for Education in Emergencies (INEE) Minimum Standards (MS). Cambodia will establish 1) National Climate Resilience in Education Framework and 2) anticipatory action funding mechanism guideline for the education sector. Factors impacting the project will depend on government priorities for drafting and revising policies and plans over the program period.
	# MoEs that strengthen cross-sectoral and internal coordination on climate-related	Review of decrees/organigrams of MoEs, cross-sectoral coordination	0	0	2	South Sudan and Cambodia only, as Tonga is not engaging in Output 1.1.

	<i>policy and programming</i>	meeting reports, list of participants in working groups, agenda				Eligible measures may include putting in place organizational structures for internal and cross-sectoral coordination, and regular participation in cross-sectoral or internal collaboration and planning. Assumes ability of government to support a more effective enabling environment that is responsive to climate change.
	# children participating in climate change and education policy influencing activities	Project records Media	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 200 (100F)	Cambodia: 500 (250F)	In Cambodia, children advisory groups engage in conducting advocacy and policy dialogue. In South Sudan this includes national and state level workshops for children to discuss policies with government officials Assumes that government officials are willing to engage with children, and that children are willing to engage in project activities.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 110 (55 F)	South Sudan: 230 (115F)	
			Program: 0	Program: 310 (155F)	Program: 730 (365F)	
Output 1.2: (CSSF Pillar 1): School facilities are safer and greener	# target schools retrofitted to improve climate resilience	Project records	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia:20	Cambodia:40	The school retrofits will be tailored to the needs in each individual school. It is anticipated that the retrofits might include: cooling systems, improved ventilation, solar photovoltaic (PV) systems, providing shade through tree planting, water and sanitation interventions, etc. Assumes that schools see benefit of implementing resilience improvements
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan:15	South Sudan:30	
			Tonga: 0	Tonga: 3	Tonga: 7	
			Program: 0	Program: 38	Program: 77	

	# school staff and community members with reported better skills in maintaining school infrastructure	Project Training Report Pre/post test	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: SS: 80 (45F) CM: 100 (50F) Total: 180 (95F)	Cambodia: SS: 160 (89 F) CM: 200 (100 F) Total: 360 (189F)	In Cambodia, 4 school staff and 5 non-staff SMC members (SMCs include parents and community members) trained per school.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: SS: 90 (36F) CM: 90 (45F) Total: 180 (81F)	South Sudan: SS: 195 (78 F) CM: 195 (98F) Total: 390 (176F)	In South Sudan, a total of 13 school staff members and parents from school management committee and parent teacher association are trained per school. This includes 3 school staff members and 10 school management committee and parent teacher association members (parents and community members).
			Tonga: 0	Tonga: SS: 3 (1F) Total: 3 (1F)	Tonga: SS: 7 (3F) Total: 7 (3F)	Targets for female school staff are low representation of female teachers in the country.
			Program: 0	Program: 363 (177 F)	Program: 757 (368F)	In Tonga, one school staff member from each school is trained on operations and management maintenance.
Output 1.3: (CSSF Pillar 2) School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively	# government staff with reported skills to act as master trainers in climate-related school safety	Project Training Report Pre/post test	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 10 (5F)	Cambodia: 25 (10F)	Assumes willingness of government to nominate staff and provide time off to attend trainings, availability of female stakeholders.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 90 (45F)	South Sudan: 180 (90F)	The number of government staff trained in Cambodia is 25 (10 female), and in South Sudan the figure is 180 (90 female). This is a total for the program of 205 (100F)
			Program: 0	Program: 100 (50F)	Program: 205 (100F)	
	# school staff and community members		Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: SS: 480	Cambodia: SS: 960 (536F)	

	<i>with reported skills in climate-related school safety and educational continuity</i>	Project Training Report Pre/post test		(268F) CM: 600 (300F) Total: 1080 (568F)	CM: 1200 (600F) Total: 2,160 (1136F)	In Cambodia, 4 school staff and 5 non-staff SMC members trained per school.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: SS: 224 (97F) CM: 224 (112F) Total: 448 (206F)	South Sudan: SS: 448 (195F) CM: 448 (244F) Total: 896 (439F)	In South Sudan, teachers and members from parent-teacher association, school management committee are trained. We assume 13 members of Parent Teacher Association (PTA)/School Management Committee (SMC) per school - split between school staff (SS) and parents and community members. This equates to a total of 488 school staff (195 female) from the target schools and 448 community members (CM). Low targets for female school staff due to low representation of female teachers in the country (15%).
			Tonga: 0	Tonga: SS: 75 (35F) Total: 75 (35F)	Tonga: SS: 150 (75F) Total: 150 (75F)	In Tonga 1 climate resilient focal points will be trained on school safety.
			Program: 0	Program: 1,603 (809F)	Program: 3,206 (1,650F)	Will depend on willingness of stakeholders to engage in training and the number of female school staff available.
	# schools with climate-related school safety plans in place	Project records	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 120	Cambodia: 240	Climate-related school safety plans may include emergency preparedness and contingency plans, anticipatory action plans, disaster risk management plans etc
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 30	South Sudan: 75	
			Tonga: 0	Tonga: 50	Tonga: 100	

			Program: 0	Program: 200	Program: 415	Will depend on engagement and priorities of school, including perceived benefit of developing climate-related school safety plans.
Output 1.4: (CSSF Pillar 3) Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedded in national systems	# schools receiving teaching and learning materials on climate change, disaster risk reduction and the environment	Project procurement and distribution reports	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 400	Cambodia: 1300	Will depend on ability to deliver educational products teaching and learning materials to schools in remote areas, with seasonal access challenges, or conflict-affected areas. Seasonal access challenges will be responded to by utilizing weather and security related information.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 255	South Sudan: 510	
			Tonga:0	Tonga: 25	Tonga: 50	
			Program: 0	Program: 400	Program: 800	The total target number of schools for this indicator is the following: Cambodia: 240 schools. In addition, a further 1,060 schools will receive teaching and learning materials on climate change as part of the co-financing in Cambodia. South Sudan: 510 schools will receive teaching and learning materials. This is based on all schools in the six counties targeted by the BRACE program.

						Tonga: 50 schools will receive teaching and learning materials on climate change as part of the elective climate change subject developed through BRACE. The target here is lower as the materials target secondary schools only.
	# teachers and education managers with reported skills to deliver on pedagogy for climate change, disaster risk reduction and environmental education	Project Training Report Pre/post test	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia: 600 (300F)	Cambodia: 1600 (893F)	Will depend on willingness of school staff to engage in training and the number of female school staff available. The total target number of teachers and education managers by country is: Cambodia: For Cambodia, this includes 720 (378 female) from 240 schools targeted by BRACE. This is based on the assumption of three teachers per school targeted by BRACE. In addition, as part of the co-finance for BRACE, there are additional schools targeted and teachers which takes the total to 1,600 teachers (893 F) who will be trained in climate change curricula materials. South Sudan: 1,530 (612 female) teachers and education managers. This is based on the assumption that three teachers per school will receive training from all schools in the country (a total of 510 schools across the six targeted counties).
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan: 765 (306F)	South Sudan: 1530 (612F)	
			Tonga: 0	Tonga: 25 (12F)	Tonga: 50 (25F)	
			Program: 0	Program: 1,390 (618F)	Program: 3,180 (1530F)	

						Tonga: 50 (25 female) teachers and education managers. This assumes 50 teachers, one per school, will be trained in the climate change elective subject.
	# child groups mobilized to engage in education on climate change, risk reduction and the environment	Project records	Cambodia: 0	Cambodia:120	Cambodia:240	In South Sudan and Cambodia child clubs and student councils implement Green School initiatives to learn about climate change, disaster risk reduction and the environment. Will depend on perceived value on engaging from children and their families.
			South Sudan: 0	South Sudan:30	South Sudan:75	
			Program: 0	Program: 150	Program: 315	
Outcome 2: Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change.						
Outcome 2: Education ministries of the target countries and beyond have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change	# MoEs reporting confidence in securing climate finance for the education sector	Evaluation	0	0	3	
	# of projects/programmes targeting climate adaptation in the education sector that benefit from BRACE's interventions and receive funding	Project Records	0	0	3	

Output 2.1: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have access to, and the ability to interpret and utilize relevant climate information as well as participate in NAP decision-making within the education sector						
	<i># of countries with climate change policy frameworks that have integrated the education sector</i>	Project records	0	0	3	This may include climate change adaptation and mitigation plans at national and subnational levels such as Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC) and National Adaptation Plans (NAPs) and Disaster Risk Reduction plans include considerations of the education sector. Will depend on engagement of non-education government stakeholders with the education sector, and political considerations and priorities.
Output 2.2: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries and beyond) have increased access to, and the ability to utilize, scaled up finance for climate action in the education sector	<i># of MoEs that have developed a climate finance roadmap that identifies funding sources and includes strategies to access them</i>	Project records	0	0	3	The focus of this indicator is on the Ministries of Education in the three countries targeted by BRACE: Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga.

Outcome 3: Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector

Outcome 3: Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector	<i># of south-south cooperations or initiatives enhancing climate actions in the education sector</i>	Project records	0	10	20	This indicator will measure any cooperation or initiatives as a result of peer-to-peer learning, collaboration, online learning and online platform, and knowledge exchange supported by the project. The target of 20 is made up of an estimated 12 webinars, 7 guidance documents, including dissemination through the knowledge management platform, and 1 face-to-face learning event.
Output 3.1: Climate resilient education co-investment coordination platform is established and effective in aligning strategic initiatives and financing	<i># Education and climate finance steering committee adopting best practices in governance, accountability and communications</i>	Project Records	0	0	1	Eligible changes include establishing a ToR, agreed roles and responsibilities and standing agenda Assumes members see benefit of engaging in steering committee so that meetings can be held
	<i># of countries represented in global map tracking climate finance investments directed to education</i>	Project Records Analytics from global map	0	3	3	The target is the three countries targeted by the BRACE project.
	<i># of countries represented in face-to-face meetings on roadmap for implementation of the Declaration on the Common Agenda for</i>	After meeting reports and minutes	0	3	3	Will depend on willingness of country representatives to engage in this meeting, including the perceived benefit.

	<i>Education and Climate Change</i>					
Output 3.2: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through south-south collaboration	<i># of people who access the climate change and education knowledge management platform</i>	Analytics from platform	0	3,500	10,000	Platform will host guidance and best practices, as well as the global education climate finance map
	<i># of guidance documents produced for education and climate stakeholders on programming, policy influencing and climate finance</i>	Project Records Review of guidance documents	0	3	7	The focus of the guidance documents to be produced will be verified with the BRACE target countries
	<i># of people who participate in online education sector stakeholder consultations on how to access climate finance</i>	Project Records After meeting reports and minutes	0	300	600	Will depend on attendance of sessions. We are assuming 12 webinars over 5 years with an average of 50 people attending.
Project/programme co-benefit indicators						
Co-benefit 1: Gender: Increased gender equity and social inclusion in the education sector	<i>% of target schools with gender-segregated, age appropriate and disability-accessible WASH facilities</i>	Project records	0	50%	100%	The denominator is the number of schools. In this case the final target is 100% which represents 77 schools in absolute terms. 40 schools in Cambodia, 30 in South Sudan and 7 in Tonga. May include toilets, handpumps, water points, ramps etc In each country context, the number of WASH facilities targeted for construction or

						rehabilitation may change based on needs assessment undertaken for schools. Conduct consultations with girls, women, all ages of children in the school and people with disabilities to determine whether there are specific considerations in the retrofitting of school facilities that would impact their use. Infrastructure and WASH assessments include age, gender and disability-specific needs, and include questions that specifically reference marginalized groups and how they access and interact with physical infrastructure, as well as the separate risks they face. Ensure that retrofitted school facilities are gender, age and disability responsive.
	<i># random reviews per country of early warning information dissemination to ensure inclusion of age-, gender- and disability-responsive language</i>	Project records and review of guidance documents	0	5	10	The number of random reviews undertaken in each country to spot check inclusion of age, gender and disability language across all channels of EWS dissemination. Use of inclusive language and communication channels to disseminate information that recognizes the different needs of girls, boys, men, women, and people with disabilities

	<i>% of new or updated risk assessments and disaster risk reduction plans including needs and recommendations on GESI</i>	Review of plans	0	100%	100%	The denominator is the number new and updated risk assessments and DRR plans In this case the final target is 100% which represents 415 assessments and plans in absolute terms. This is 240 schools in Cambodia, 75 in South Sudan, and 100 in Tonga. May include recognizing the different needs of girls, boys, men, women, and people with disabilities
	<i>% of climate-related school safety plans addressing GESI specific needs</i>	Review of plans	0	100%	100%	The denominator is the number of school safety plans plans addressing GESI In this case the final target is 100% which represents 415 plans in absolute terms. This is 240 schools in Cambodia, 75 in South Sudan, and 100 in Tonga. May include recognizing the different needs of girls, boys, men, women, and people with disabilities

Co-benefit 2: Environmental: Clean and green environment is promoted in the targeted schools	<i># of schools with solar photovoltaic systems installed</i>	Project records	0	3	7	Only in Tonga, where there is a specific activity providing solar systems to ensure electrification to enable use of CWS systems PV operation contributes marginal GHG emissions reduction with the wider intent being an adaptation core project benefit.
	<i># schools establishing tree planting and water-efficient irrigation systems, for shading, windbreak and cooling effects</i>	Project records	0	30	75	Only in South Sudan, where the green school initiative will make these upgrades.
Co-benefit 3: Social: Increased locally-led adaptation	<i>% school safety plans that have been informed by local school community to a high extent (BRACE engaged children, teachers, parents)</i>	Project records	0	30%	90%	Target BRACE-engaged school communities including: school children such as those in Child-led clubs, parents active in PTAs/SMCs and resident teachers. Children, parents and teachers willing to respond to project reporting through qualitative feedback. Low, medium and high extents are defined in advance.
	<i>% target schools that contribute to the NAP process through CSO and public dialogues</i>	Project records	0	25%	70%	Ministries of Education will encourage and help facilitate school children from target schools, to be engaged in NAP processes.

						School children in target schools will be willing to lend their voices and be engaged in the NAP process when invited.
	# knowledge platforms that capture LLA initiatives/case studies within the climate and education space	Project records	0	0	1	Relates to the establishment of a knowledge management platform under Activity 3.2.1. Adequate knowledge on LLA exists as well as the capturing and dissemination of these initiatives by the project team.

4. Project/programme activities and deliverables			
All project activities should be listed here with a description and sub-activities. Significant deliverables should be also reflected in the project/programme Timetable (Annex 5). Add rows as needed. Please number the activities as shown below to indicate association of activities to the related outputs provided above in section 5. Similarly, please number sub-activities as shown below to associate to the related activity.			
Output	Activities	Description	Deliverables
Please number each Output Output 1.1, Output 1.2)	List of the project activities below.	Provide a brief description of each of the activity listed in the previous column.	

Outcome 1: The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.			
Output 1.1: Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported	Activity 1.1.1 Facilitate preparation and endorsement of climate	Cambodia	
		1.1.1.1 a Establish National Climate Resilience in Education Framework. 1.1.1.2.a Implement climate change adaptation and environmental sustainability strategies developed by CSESI.	3 new strategies developed with education and climate stakeholders and validated by the Ministry

	and education policies, plans and guidelines	1.1.1.3.a Establish Anticipatory Action Funding Mechanism and Guideline linked to existing social protection and MoEYS. 1.1.1.4.a Generate evidence on the climate finance adaptation gap to support education sector policy recommendations and best practices. 1.1.1.5.a Conduct annual review of climate-related education budget allocations from national to sub-national levels. South Sudan 1.1.1.1.b Conduct review of existing policies on climate change with different ministries, including policies on climate and education in different countries. 1.1.1.2.b Conduct needs assessment with key stakeholders including children at national, state and county levels about current implementation of policies and climate change impacts on education, delivering summary report with recommendations based on 1.1.1.1. 1.1.1.3.b Disseminate findings of review and needs assessment including EiE needs assessments to relevant line ministries at national level and conduct meetings to devise strategy, ensuring gender mainstreaming and needs of the most vulnerable are considered throughout. 1.1.1.4.b Based on strategy meetings, SCI and MoGE&I finalize write-up of strategy, ensuring critical section for climate-related gender and social inclusion actions, and follow-up mechanisms to ensure implementation.	of Education (1 Cambodia, 2 South Sudan)
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		1.1.1.5.b Hold short final validation meeting with ministries and children to endorse new strategy. 1.1.1.6.b Present strategy to minister for finalization and endorsement through the Government of South Sudan. 1.1.1.7.b Incorporate messaging and strategies developed for DRR under activity 1.3.1 into the education and climate policy. 1.1.1.8.b SCI and MoGE&I nominate a task team including South Sudan Education Cluster (SSEC) to lead the process of updating minimum standards. 1.1.1.9.b Analyse existing assessment under 1.1.1, consult with teachers, children and parents in vulnerable areas to understand current practices regarding EiE. 1.1.1.10.b Prepare a report with recommendations for minimum standards based on the needs assessment. 1.1.1.11.b Conduct meetings at national and state levels to discuss findings and agree on actions for updating the minimum standards. 1.1.1.12.b Submit the revised minimum standards to relevant stakeholders at all levels, including the Payam education office.	
	Activity 1.1.2: Strengthen coordination on climate change within Ministries of education and other relevant line	Cambodia 1.1.2.1. a Re-establish the functioning of the Disaster Management Secretariat and the Disaster Management Mechanism of MoEYS. 1.1.2.2.a Establish and strengthen a sharing and coordination platform for the relevant Ministries on	Establishment of a cross sectorial working group with agreed ToR (Cambodia-specific)

	ministries at national and sub-national level	climate-smart education systems for sub-national and national government levels. 1.1.2.3.a Comprehensively map existing policies and key stakeholders in climate-resilient education to support operationalization of BRACE. 1.1.2.4.a Establish Annual Multi-stakeholder dialogue on inclusion, climate change, disaster risk, and environmental safeguarding in the education sector and community of practices. 1.1.2.5.a: Integrate climate-resilient education initiatives into MoEYS existing annual Operations Plan to ensure implementation. 1.1.2.6.a Facilitate the development of agreed recommendations by INGOs/CSOs on climate issues in education, in support of local school communities. South Sudan 1.1.2.1.b Using assessment budgeted under 1.1.1, consult with stakeholders at sub-national level to understand coordination at state, county and community levels 1.1.2.2.b Based on findings of assessment, develop report on sub-national coordination. 1.1.2.3.b Work closely with MoGEI to establish national focal point for climate and education. 1.1.2.4.b Conduct inter-agency follow up meetings (with different regularity at national, state, county and Payam level) with agreed action points and monitoring of BRACE implementation plan. 1.1.2.5.b Establish focal points at the national level and in targeted states and counties, including child focal points at schools, supported by religious and	8 multi-stakeholder dialogues held on climate change and education (4 Cambodia, 4 South Sudan) 70 climate focal points established at sub-national level (South Sudan-specific)
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		community leaders, linked to school environment clubs (output 1.1).	
	Activity 1.1.3: Facilitate integration of DRR into existing and/or new plans with education authorities	Cambodia 1.1.3.1.a Strengthen Disaster Management Mechanism at sub-national level and at targeted schools. 1.1.3.2.a Support POE, DOE and local administration offices in BRACE target locations to embed climate-related DRR planning into existing Emergency Preparedness and Response Plans (EPRP). 1.1.3.3.a As a preparedness intervention, complete a consolidated sector-wide education needs assessment tool. 1.1.3.4.a Undertake mock drills in targeted schools and simulations to test effectiveness of DRR planning under the EPRP. South Sudan 1.1.3.1.b Provide training sessions for state and county officials established under 1.1.2 on emergency preparedness and contingency planning. 1.1.3.2.b Perform state-level hazard vulnerability assessments to identify areas of risk. 1.1.3.3.b Support the development of participatory emergency preparedness and contingency plans with state-level officials. 1.1.3.4.b Test contingency plan with simulations at national and state level, working with all key ministries. 1.1.3.5.b Refresher training and simulation on contingency plan.	15 education plans integrated with DRR by education authorities addressing relevant climate change hazards (9 Cambodia, 6 South Sudan)

		1.1.3.6.b Enhance the capacity of National MoGE&I and State MoGE&I county officials on minimum standards for EiE.	
	Activity 1.1.4: Support children to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives.	Cambodia	730 children participated in climate and education policy initiatives (500 in Cambodia, 230 South Sudan)
		1.1.4.1.a Create key messages and joint statements for advocacy at both school and national levels.	
		1.1.4.2.a Establish platforms for children to exchange and engage in child-friendly policy advocacy, connecting with existing initiatives like the Youth Debate Forum.	
		1.1.4.3.a Facilitate child-led campaign for appropriate budget allocations based on the findings from Sub-activity 1.1.1.4.a.	
		1.1.4.4.a Collect youth voices and facilitate participation in major climate and education forums.	
		South Sudan	
		1.1.4.1.b Conduct workshop / event at national level with children (girls and boys) and government officials to allow children (girls and boys) to influence policies and best practices of MoGEI. MoGEI to take up actions as recommended by the children.	
		1.1.4.2.b Conduct workshops at state level with children and government officials to allow children to influence best practices and policies of MoGEI.	
		1.1.4.3.b Identify key stakeholders within existing child parliaments to champion the integration of climate change impacts into wider government policy.	
		1.1.4.4.b Follow up monitoring of children's inputs into policy.	

Output 1.2: School facilities are safer and greener	Activity 1.2.1: Develop a national standard for climate-resilient school facilities	Cambodia	National standard for climate-resilient school facilities approved by Ministry of Education (Cambodia-specific)
		1.2.1.1.a: Review and upgrade school design standards and construction guidelines to adopt climate change and other holistic considerations linked to health, safety, sustainability and inclusive design. 1.2.1.2.a: Develop an online tool to test the climate resilience of BRACE targeted schools for integration into EMIS.	
	Activity 1.2.2: Retrofit school facilities, including WASH and internet connectivity, to strengthen climate resilience	Cambodia	Infrastructure assessment completed in 77 schools (40 Cambodia, 30 South Sudan, 7 Tonga) Infrastructure improvement plan validated by school representatives and education officials for 77 schools (40 Cambodia, 30 South Sudan, 7 Tonga)
		1.2.2.1.a Conduct an infrastructure assessment of targeted schools to identify the priority retrofitting needs. 1.2.2.2.a Conduct a hackathon to crowdsource innovative school climate resilient solutions that are affordable and locally suitable. 1.2.2.3.a Based on the infrastructure assessment, retrofit, schools according to needs and based on a menu of options. E.g. WASH facilities. 1.2.2.4.a Organize child-friendly awareness-raising sessions for students to promote handwashing and proper hygiene. South Sudan 1.2.2.1.b Conduct school infrastructure assessments which consider physical and psychological safety for children - including existing WASH infrastructure and water testing - of each target school using the MoGEI existing guidelines and the recommendations prepared as part of the CSEI project, with a focus on integrating climate change considerations.	

		1.2.2.2.b Based on assessments, create an inclusive school-specific infrastructure improvement plan including inputs to procure and construct for each school, within Save the Children's accredited risk category. 1.2.2.3.b Validate improvement plans at both national and school level (incorporating county and payam officials where appropriate) 1.2.2.4.b Based on a plan created under 1.2.2.3.b, source and procure relevant items and equipment for school infrastructure improvements. 1.2.2.5.b Conduct school infrastructure improvements including WASH facilities retrofit/rehabilitation at each target school, responding to needs identified under assessment and aligning with the green model schools' initiatives conducted under the CSEI project, ensuring that infrastructure remains within Category C. 1.2.2.6.b Promote hygiene in schools located in flood and drought-affected areas to prevent outbreaks of water and vector-related diseases during and after floods. 1.2.2.7.b Plant trees and drought-resistant plants (both fruit-bearing and non-fruit-bearing) to mitigate the risks of floods, heatwaves, and droughts. 1.2.2.8.b Provide agricultural tools and drought resilient seeds for school gardens. 1.2.2.9.b Supply and Install water-efficient irrigation systems in support for school gardens initiatives run by DRR/Environment clubs (outlined in output 1.4). Tonga	Cambodia, 30 South Sudan, 7 Tonga)
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		1.2.2.1.c Physical infrastructure risk/resilience assessment undertaken (WASH, cycle resilience, airflow) in collaboration with World Bank work 1.2.2.2.c Physical infrastructure resilience action plan developed and validated by school representatives and education officials 1.2.2.3.c School WASH systems upgraded and infrastructure retrofits actioned to increase climate resilience. 1.2.2.4.c Undertake internet connectivity option research for targeted schools. 1.2.2.5.c Installation of identified internet connectivity and solar PV systems in schools in outer islands.	
	Activity 1.2.3: Strengthen school communities and education officials to operate and maintain school infrastructure and facilities	Cambodia 1.2.3.1.a Provide training to school staff, SMCs and local administrators, on maintaining infrastructure, linked to implementation of the school improvement plan. 1.2.3.2.a Organize School inauguration/hand-over ceremony. South Sudan 1.2.3.1.b Appoint focal points within existing school structures to be responsible for overseeing operations and maintenance. 1.2.3.2.b Joint monitoring and supervision of new infrastructure between project staff and officials throughout project lifecycle. Tonga	756 school staff and community members trained in school infrastructure and facility operations and maintenance (360 Cambodia, 390 South Sudan, 7 Tonga)

		1.2.3.1.c Design training and deliver workshops to focal points in schools in outer Islands on basic operations and maintenance of school infrastructure, WASH facilities and PVs to address common issues that compromise climate proofing ability 1.2.3.2.c Record Training on basic upkeep and maintenance HAMA e-learning platform Sub-activity 1.2.3.3.c Roll-out and promotion of HAMA e-learning training on basic upkeep and maintenance 1.2.3.4.c Development and recording video training activities on problem solving for internet connectivity for HAMA e-learning platform. 1.2.3.5.c Roll-out and promotion of HAMA e-learning Training on problem solving for internet connectivity.	
Output 1.3: School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively	Activity 1.3.1: Build capacity of national and sub-national education officials to be master trainers on climate-related school safety	Cambodia	205 education officials trained to become master trainers on climate-related school resilience (25 Cambodia, 180 South Sudan)
		1.3.1.1.a Government stakeholders identify the Master Trainers and agree the training approach. 1.3.1.2.a Provide Training of Trainers (ToT) to MoEYS at national level on the standard framework for school-based risk reduction and adaptation. 1.3.1.3.a Sub-national training delivered by trained MoEYS master trainers to POE, DOE, and local administration.	
		South Sudan	
		1.3.1.1.b Train master trainers at state level, who then train county-level officials to deliver training at schools.	
		Cambodia	

	Activity 1.3.2: Build knowledge and capacity of school management, teachers and children to prepare climate-related school safety plans	1.3.2.1.a Strengthen and/or establish the Preparedness and Response system and function in targeted School Management and SMC. 1.3.2.2.a Provide training to school management (teachers) and SMCs (including community) on how to implement the school-based risk reduction and adaptation framework. 1.3.2.3.a Support and operationalize climate-linked Psychological First Aid in schools.	3,206 school staff and community members trained in climate-related school safety (2,160 Cambodia, 896 South Sudan, 150 Tonga)
		South Sudan	
		1.3.2.1.b County-level officials provide training on DRR/CCA and green school initiatives for PTAs, SMCs, and teachers.	
		Tonga	
		1.3.2.1.c Inception workshop for entire BRACE workshop	
		1.3.2.2.c Develop and adjust training material for focal points based on School Safety Handbook for Tonga, ensuring coverage climate change risks	
		1.3.2.3.c Training Workshops for 150 focal points in each of the 5 Regional Centres	
		1.3.2.4.c Development, filming and production of refresher training on school safety on HAMA e-learning platform	
		1.3.2.5.c Roll out and promotion of Hama e-learning refresher training on school safety.	
		Cambodia	

	Activity 1.3.3: Implement school-level climate-related school safety plans	1.3.3.1.a Work with the student council and the SMC on the climate-hazard risk assessment (including child protection). 1.3.3.2.a Develop a climate-related school safety plan from the climate-hazard risk assessment linked to school improvement plan, commune investment plan, and EPRP (DRR planning). 1.3.3.3.a Local schools implement activities identified in the climate-related school safety plan. 1.3.3.4.a Conduct annual participatory school-level risk assessment, and update climate-related school safety plans. 1.3.3.5.a Provide mentoring support to school management and additional refresher training to SMCs.	School-level climate risk mapping and climate resilience plan completed in 415 schools (240 Cambodia, 75 South Sudan, 100 in Tonga)
		South Sudan	
		1.3.3.1.b Conduct annual mapping of schools' risks associated with schools in vulnerable areas. 1.3.3.2.b Develop school-level resilience action plan. 1.3.3.3.b Carry out community outreach programs to raise awareness on the plans.	
		Tonga	
		1.3.3.1.c. Based on sub-activity 1.3.2.2.c facilitate the development of school safety and resilience plans 1.3.3.2.c. Print and distribute the school safety and resilience plans.	
		Cambodia	

	Activity 1.3.4: Provide climate resilience tools, equipment and kits to schools	1.3.4.1.a Provide DRR/CCA tool kits and materials for targeted schools and SMC.	DRR tools, equipment and connectivity package delivered in 415 schools (240 Cambodia, 75 South Sudan, 100 in Tonga)
		South Sudan	
		1.3.4.1.b Supply DRR / CCA tools and materials for school committees formed under Activity 1.3.2.	
		Tonga	
		1.3.4.1.c Compile and distribute climate resilience school safety toolkits.	
	Activity 1.3.5: Strengthen access to and use of Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) in schools	Cambodia	3,206 of school focal points trained in how to use early warning systems (2,160 Cambodia, 896 South Sudan, 150 in Tonga)
		1.3.5.1.a Support EMIS to integrate the climate and child protection indicator at school level.	
		1.3.5.2.a Prepare a dashboard, linked to UNICEF CCRI and risk mapping from the National Committee for Disaster Management prepared by WFP.	
		1.3.5.3.a Support the education sector to prepare an agreed trigger for climate related education linked to social protection for anticipatory action.	
		1.3.5.4.a Present an economic analysis to the Ministry of Economy and Finance based on projections of climate impact and the adaptation finance gap on the education sector.	
		1.3.5.5.a Develop online platform (i.e. Chatbot) and offline platform with audio and information to translate early action early warning to targeted schools.	
		1.3.5.6.a Establish and implement a School Early Warning System in collaboration with the NCDM, MoE and the MoEYS.	

		1.3.5.7.a Conduct a campaign on education learning continuity focused on climate adaptation and shocks.	
		South Sudan	
		1.3.5.1.b Establish and maintain a school-based early warning network system by organizing schools into clusters.	
		1.3.5.2.b Disseminate early warning information via multiple channels such as SMS, radio stations, and broadcasts.	
		1.3.5.3.b Ongoing joint monitoring and supervision to assess effective use of early warning materials.	
		Tonga	
		1.3.5.1.c Workshops in collaboration with MEIDECC to identify CIS and EWS products and materials to be developed	
		1.3.5.2.c Product and materials development by Communications Manager and local consultant	
		1.3.5.3.c Distribution and promotion of products and materials in collaboration with MEIDECC and MET.	
		1.3.5.4.c Preparation and technical training material on CIS & EWS.	
		1.3.5.5.c Deliver technical training on CIS & EWS to 150 participants in 5 of regional centers.	
		1.3.5.6.c Development and recording of E-learning refresher modules on CIS and EWS on HAMA e-learning platform	
		1.3.5.7.c Role out and promotion of HAMA E-learning refresher modules on CIS & EWS	

Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedded in national education systems	Activity 1.4.1: Develop teaching and learning materials on climate change ready to implement through national, non-formal and informal curriculum	Cambodia	Teaching and learning materials on climate change distributed to 1,860 schools (1,300 Cambodia, 510 South Sudan, 50 Tonga) 1 elective climate change subject developed (Tonga specific)
		1.4.1.1.a Initial assessment to agree additional climate-related green generation content and materials (topics might include green skills, child protection and child rights). 1.4.1.2.a Develop additional quality learning materials and modules, linked to specific climate and environmental solutions. 1.4.1.3.a Develop climate-sensitive PFA training package for school education, student council, SMC and community leader. 1.4.1.4.a Support the roll-out of the teacher training module and curriculum review conducted by UNESCO through CSESI.	
		South Sudan	
		1.4.1.1.b Review learning materials created under CSESI and conduct initial testing of materials with key stakeholders. 1.4.1.2.b Update materials if required and engage local illustrators and storytellers to adapt materials into content suitable for different tribes and languages. 1.4.1.3.b Facilitate printing and distribution of materials to target states, counties, and schools, ensuring different versions are available for different audiences. 1.4.1.4.b Develop mobile units to facilitate rollout of materials to the most vulnerable communities, including pastoralists and people with disabilities.	

		Tonga 1.4.1.1.c Assessment of existing efforts and best practices to develop an elective climate change subject and integrate climate change into the curriculum 1.4.1.2.c Undertake rolling labour market research to identify current and future climate-related demands to inform relevant curriculum development materials for the Pacific context: 1.4.1.3.c Develop elective climate change subject for final two years of secondary school. 1.4.1.4.c Development of teacher training materials 1.4.1.5.c Pilot testing of teacher training and refinement of materials.	
	Activity 1.4.2: Build knowledge and capacity of teachers and education managers to implement climate change lessons inside the classroom	Cambodia 1.4.2.1.a Enhance pre-service and in-service teacher capacity to deliver climate resilient module and green generation activities in the classroom, including project-based learning, and child-led learning. 1.4.2.2.a Conduct a follow up training on how to integrate climate resilient module and green generation activities into routine instruction in the classrooms. 1.4.2.3.a Establish a virtual professional community of practice on climate resilience for green generation facilitators. 1.4.2.4.a Working with the existing mentoring programme developed by MoEYS, embed green generation materials for coaching and mentoring support.	3,180 teachers and education managers trained on pedagogy for climate change, DRR and environmental education and supported to deliver lessons in the classroom (1600 Cambodia, 1530 South Sudan, 50 Tonga)

		1.4.2.5.a Provide training on the climate-related PFA to teachers and peer student.	
		1.4.2.6.a Establish comprehensive Peer-to-Peer Support and Community-Linked Safe School Initiative.	
		South Sudan	
		1.4.2.1.b Conduct needs assessment and consultation on teacher training manual developed under CSEI with key actors at national and state level across formal and non-formal education to determine relevant training content.	
		1.4.2.2.b Work with relevant bodies (e.g. higher institutions, other relevant line ministries, civil society, child representatives and education partners), to develop and validate training plan rollout for key actors, considering differing needs for different groups, e.g. pastoralists, women/men, girls/boys, PWDs etc.	
		1.4.2.3.b Facilitate rollout of training at different levels (National, State, County, Payam), ensuring training is aligned to World Bank 'Building skills for human development in South Sudan' program.	
		1.4.2.4.b Rollout training to schoolteachers and conduct ongoing teacher mentorship focused on climate change among target counties and schools.	
		Tonga	
		1.4.2.1.c Roll out teacher training on Climate Change Subject	
		1.4.2.2.c Review materials and implementation progress in year four	
		1.4.2.3.c Update materials, if needed, based on review.	

	Activity 1.4.3: Strengthen capacity of child clubs to lead climate change initiatives in their school and community	Cambodia	315 child groups mobilized to engage in education on climate change, DRR, and the environment (240 Cambodia, 75 South Sudan)
		1.4.3.2.a Training and on-going coaching and mentoring to assigned teachers who will act as facilitators to the Student’s Councils, including local government. 1.4.3.3.a Capacity building to the child clubs, including how to strengthen club functioning to undertake environmental education campaigns and other activities in the school and community. 1.4.3.4.a Support child-led initiatives related to climate and education inclusive of community for scale-up with GPE target areas. 1.4.3.5.a Develop mentoring and coaching support to child clubs and student council. 1.4.3.6.a Develop and increase access to child-centred materials to support child clubs implement their activities in the school or community.	
		South Sudan	
		1.4.3.1.b Identify existing children’s clubs at school-level and if no clubs exist, select suitable staff to facilitate running. 1.4.3.2.b Mobilise environment clubs at target schools including initial meetings and defining scope. 1.4.3.3.b Facilitate ongoing meetings of environment clubs and oversight of other project activities, especially 1.2.32 and 1.3.2. 1.4.3.4.b Facilitate and support environmental events and days.	

		1.4.3.5.b Train girls and focal point teachers on making menstrual hygiene management kits in schools.	
	Activity 1.4.4: Disseminate climate change teaching and learning materials through Ministry of Education e-learning and other platforms	Cambodia	3 climate change teaching and learning materials uploaded to e-learning platforms (2 Cambodia, 1 Tonga) 6 radio jingles created and played at least 10 times each (South Sudan specific)
		1.4.4.1.a Integrate green generation materials into MoEYS online platform to support scale-up to other teachers in Cambodia. 1.4.4.2.a Work with teachers, and education authorities in each targeted district to support continued embedding of climate change into classroom instruction.	
		South Sudan	
		1.4.4.1.b Based on research under CSESI, utilise messaging and materials to raise awareness on climate change and DRR key messages and family emergency plans- e.g. radio jingles, leaflets, advertising campaigns. 1.4.4.2.b Create a television documentary to act as an educational video on climate change for students. 1.4.4.3.b Facilitate rollout of documentary and other materials through SCI's Tech 4 development unit. 1.4.4.4.b Ongoing joint monitoring and supervision to ensure messaging is understood and media techniques are utilized effectively.	
		Tonga	
		1.4.4.1.c Review climate-related topics in secondary national curriculum and identify topics to be recorded in HAMA e-learning platform	

		1.4.4.2.c Support the media centre and teachers to record climate change-related curriculum on HAMA e-learning platform 1.4.4.3.c Production of any supporting materials to be used together with the HAMA e-learning courses 1.4.4.4.c Promotional Events x 2	
	Activity 1.4.5: Prepare learning documents and hold events with Ministries of Education and other partners to share experience of integrating climate change into the curriculum	Cambodia	2 learning documents created and 2 advocacy events completed (1 Cambodia, 1 South Sudan)
		Sub-activity 1.4.5.1.a Document and share with MoEYS, and other actors how to integrate climate change and environmental content in the classroom context.	
		South Sudan 1.4.5.1.b Conduct assessment of current best practices and materials related to climate change education in the curriculum. 1.4.5.2.b Based on assessment, create guidance document with recommendations for updating the curriculum. 1.4.5.3.b Conduct an advocacy event to promote the integration of climate change into the curriculum, showcasing best existing practices and presenting recommendations for the future.	
Outcome 2: Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change.			
Output 2.1: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have access to, and the ability to interpret and utilize	Activity 2.1.1: Development of education sector risk	2.1.1.1: Mapping to identify the nature of climate risks to the education sector, and examine existing institutional, organizational and individual capacities	3 country reports that document the impact of

relevant climate information as well as participate in decision-making and influence national adaptation planning including within the education sector	analyses on the impact of climate change and climate risks on the education sector and children's learning.		climate change on the education sector
	Activity 2.1.2: Support MoEs to coordinate with climate change Ministries and engage in NAP processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the UNFCCC	2.1.2.1: Capacity building to Ministry of Education staff to understand and engage in national UNFCCC processes, including NAPs. 2.1.2.2: Second an education specialist to the NAP GN. . 2.1.2.3 Knowledge product on NAP engagement prepared with the NAP GN. 2.1.2.4: Peer-to-peer learning event for Ministries of Environment, finance and education on including education within NAPs. 2.1.2.5: Support cross-sector coordination and alignment between the education ministry and climate change ministries.	100 government officials, CSOs and other partners working on climate change and education in the three focus countries participate in learning event on education within UNFCCC processes
Output 2.2: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have increased access to, and the ability to utilize, scaled up finance for climate action in the education sector to replicate and scale BRACE to a greater percentage of the country	Activity 2.2.1: Development of climate finance mobilization road maps	2.2.1.1 Determine the accessibility of all climate finance mechanisms in each country. 2.2.1.2 Mapping of climate change and education co-financing and partnership opportunities. 2.2.1.3 Develop guidance and tools to pursue climate finance opportunities. 2.2.1.4 Development and dissemination of climate finance mobilization road maps.	3 country climate finance roadmaps produced for Ministries of Education
	Activity 2.2.2: Direct Access Entity (DAE) support for working with the education	2.2.2.1 Socialization of education sector plans for climate finance (linked to climate finance roadmaps in Activity 2.2.1) including awareness raising and training on the impact of climate change on the education	3 Ministries of Education supported to prepare concept notes

	sector on Green Climate Fund projects.	sector and the education sector. contributions to national climate resilience building. 2.2.2.2 Development of education sector SAP templates. 2.2.2.3 Development of tools and associated training for DAE. 2.2.2.4 Technical support to DAE to navigate tools and support concept note development.	to access climate finance
Outcome 3: Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector			
Output 3.1: Climate resilient education co-investment coordination platform is established and effective in aligning strategic initiatives and financing	Activity 3.1.1: Support a BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform, including steering committee and core team	3.1.1.1 Establish BRACE coordination steering committee, including production of Terms of Reference and joint work plan 3.1.1.2 Hold quarterly steering committee meetings 3.1.1.3 Bring on board a core team to support implementation of the BRACE coordination steering committee priority activities, and activities in outputs 3.1 and 3.2.	12 meetings of the BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform held 10 joint actions on climate finance taken by the BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform
	Activity 3.1.2: Face-to-face meetings for Ministries of Education and Environment for cross-learning and building political momentum	3.1.2.1 Government officials from Ministries of Education and children in BRACE target countries travel to participate in face-to-face meetings, including COP 30. 3.1.2.2 Production of a roadmap to support implementation of the Declaration on the Common Agenda for Education and Climate Change.	3 countries engaged in Face-to-Face meetings involving Ministries of Environment and Ministries of Education

	Activity 3.1.3: Map and track global finance opportunities in the education sector	3.1.3.1 Mapping of global and country level climate finance and education opportunities. 3.1.3.2 Develop easy to understand and use guides with information by country that is updated regularly and housed on the knowledge management platform site outlined in Activity 3.2.1..	1 site tracking global finance opportunities in the education sector produced
	Activity 3.1.4: Support adjustments to international climate finance reporting to reflect dual-benefit investments in climate and education	3.1.4.1 Recruit a professional firm to lead on the engagement with the OECD DAC and prepare a report on climate finance reporting.	1 report outlining adjustments to international climate finance endorsed by BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform
Output 3.2: Key stakeholders are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through south-south collaboration	Activity 3.2.1: Develop and host information on the CSESI knowledge management platform on climate change and education for improved evidence and learning	3.2.1.1 Develop website content. 3.2.1.2 Coordination with CSEI for website hosting and maintenance. 3.2.1.3 Prepare the structure and functionality of the website. 3.2.1.4 Upload materials to the website and manage the materials.	1 site with information on climate change and education established within the knowledge management platform for climate and education
	Activity 3.2.2: Develop guidance on climate and education for the GCF and the global education sector	3.2.2.1 With the BRACE climate and education coordination platform, produce an education sector guide for the GCF, including layout and production costs and translation. 3.2.2.2 Produce step-by-step guidance for the BRACE countries on how to access further GCF finance. 3.2.2.3 Produce a knowledge product on how to engage in NAPs. 3.2.2.4 Disseminate materials via the	7 guidance materials on climate and education produced

		CSEI knowledge management platform, webinars, thematic sessions, and peer learning events.	
	Activity 3.2.3: Organise webinars, thematic sessions and learning events on climate change and education	3.2.3.1 Organise webinars and cross-country learning events for the education community, climate change and education actors in the three BRACE countries on climate finance and how to engage in UNFCCC processes, including NAPs . 3.2.3.2 Ensure all webinars are translated into different languages and accessible.	12 webinars on climate and education topics completed
	Activity 3.2.4: Develop and share strategic communications materials	3.2.4.1 Prepare strategic communications materials including blogs, articles, knowledge products, including BRACE baseline study report and BRACE midline evaluation report. 3.2.4.2 Produce videos on BRACE implementation experience for dissemination in climate change and education spaces.	Total of 25 communications assets (including blogs, articles, videos) produced

5. Monitoring, reporting and evaluation arrangements (max. 300 words)

Besides the arrangements (e.g. annual performance reports) laid out in Accreditation Master Agreement (AMA), please give a summary of the project/programme specific arrangements for monitoring, reporting and evaluation including a description of the monitoring and reporting system that will be used to assess the climate results of the proposed project/programme. Please also summarize the types of interim and final evaluations. Describe Accredited Entity (AE) project reporting relationships, including to the National Designated Authority (NDA)/Focal Point and between AE and Executing Entity (EE) as relevant, identifying reporting obligations from the EE to the AE.

164. A full M&E plan for BRACE will include detailed information on the roles and responsibilities for data collection and management, information flows and reporting systems, finalized indicators and means of verifications, monitoring protocols and tools, implementation plans and schedules will be defined within 6 months of project inception. Output data will be collected on an ongoing basis as part of monitoring activities to track progress against each output indicator to understand whether the project is hitting key milestones, to be analysed regularly to allow for learning and adaptation and reported annually. Outcome indicators will be reported midline and endline aligning with the cadence of evaluations. Baseline and midline impact evaluations will be conducted by SCI, and at endline impact evaluation will be conducted by an external party, under SCI supervision. An independent

process midterm evaluation will be conducted to assess project progress against the outcome indicators and recommend improvements for the last two years of the project.

165. The monitoring and evaluation activities will questions related to enabling environment and policy change with qualitative methods and employ quantitative approaches including child and school staff surveys from a sample of target schools participating in the project to measure changes in knowledge and attitudes related to climate change and disaster risk management and whether the project mitigated learning loss. A digitized data collection system will be established in this sample of target schools to track student attendance, absenteeism and dropout based on reporting from school administrators and confirmed by MEAL staff on a quarterly basis.

166. USD 2.5 million is budgeted towards generating and collecting data and information needed for evaluations under budget line 'Baseline, Midline and Endline plus monitoring' in the Detailed Budget Plan and in the Detailed Budget Notes (D1 and D2).

F. RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

F.1. Risk factors and mitigations measures (max. 3 pages)

Selected Risk Factor 1 – Low Technical Capacity

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Technical and Operational</u>	<u>High</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

167. Limited technical capacity among local stakeholders, including education authorities and community members, could hinder the effective implementation and sustainability of climate adaptation measures in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga, potentially leading to suboptimal project outcomes.

Mitigation Measure(s)

168. The BRACE initiative will implement a comprehensive capacity-building program targeting government officials, local communities, and project partners across South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga. This program will focus on enhancing technical knowledge in climate-smart education systems, disaster risk reduction, and child protection in schools, aligned with national frameworks like Cambodia's Comprehensive School Safety Framework (CSSF) and the Child-Friendly School Program. To support this, BRACE will establish national and sub-national platforms for knowledge sharing and coordination, particularly through activities such as virtual and offline child-and-youth-led campaigns for climate action and cross-coordination meetings between ministries and relevant actors. Regular monitoring and mentoring mechanisms will be put in place to ensure the application of learned skills and knowledge, with continuous technical support provided to local stakeholders to foster long-term capacity development. Additionally, partnerships with local universities and technical institutes will be sought out and established to strengthen the sustainability of these capacity-building efforts. Operationally lessons learned from the AE's existing GCF portfolio are being incorporated into the systems and process used to oversight and monitor overall project progress. This includes an emphasis on operation frameworks, planning, clarity on accountabilities and regular coordination between AE and EEs.

Selected Risk Factor 2 – Climate Vulnerability

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Other</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Medium</u>

Description

169. High vulnerability to climate change impacts, such as extreme weather events and sea-level rise, could disrupt project activities and threaten the safety and livelihoods of target communities in South Sudan, Cambodia, and Tonga.

Mitigation Measure(s)

170. BRACE will incorporate climate risk assessments into its planning and implementation phases to ensure that interventions are resilient to local climate conditions. In Tonga, for instance, the project will prioritize retrofitting school infrastructure to withstand extreme weather, including improving airflow, drainage, and accessibility. In Cambodia, BRACE will support the establishment of school-based early warning systems linked to national platforms for real-time impact monitoring, enabling schools to better prepare for and respond to climate-related events. The project will also promote adaptive agricultural practices and livelihood diversification to enhance community resilience. Infrastructure improvements, such as climate-resilient WASH facilities, will be prioritized to protect vulnerable populations. Emergency response plans will be developed and regularly updated, with ongoing collaboration with meteorological agencies and climate experts to provide data and insights that inform adaptive management. Regular drills and simulations will be conducted to ensure readiness for climate-related disruptions, and partnerships with local communities will be fostered to strengthen local capacities for disaster risk reduction.

Selected Risk Factor 3 – Fraud and Corruption

Category	Probability	Impact
<u>ML/FT</u>	<u>Medium</u>	<u>Low</u>

Description		
171.The risk of fraud and corruption in financial management and procurement processes could lead to the misallocation of funds, compromising the project's integrity and outcomes.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
172.Key mitigation measures will include strict adherence to anti-fraud and anti-corruption policies, compliance with national institutional structures, and the application of robust monitoring and reporting procedures. BRACE will enforce anti-fraud and anti-corruption policies through rigorous audits and transparent reporting mechanisms, with oversight provided by an independent PIU teams. Digital tools will be employed to track expenditures and procurement processes, reducing opportunities for corruption. Furthermore, all project staff and partners will undergo mandatory training on ethical standards, anti-corruption practices, and the consequences of non-compliance. A whistleblower protection mechanism will be established to encourage the reporting of suspicious activities without fear of retaliation. Regular risk assessments will be conducted to identify and address any emerging vulnerabilities in financial management, and specific procedures, such as the separation of duties between project management and executing entities, will be employed to maintain independent and effective financial oversight.		
Selected Risk Factor 4 – Construction Risk		
Category	Probability	Impact
<u>Technical and Operational</u>	<u>Low</u>	<u>Medium</u>
Description		
173. Lack of design input and requisite supervisory budget results in poor quality of design and poor workmanship.		
Mitigation Measure(s)		
174.Supervision will be carried out by qualified Save the Children Structural Engineers/Construction Managers or a qualified third party. Technical consultations will include the Save the Children Regional Office Construction Advisor to ensure safe programming and appropriate project design. At least 10% of the budget is dedicated to supervision and also covers construction costs, staff supervision, and fleet requirements. Safety and security assessments will be conducted with guidance from the country office safety focal point and GEDSI specialist. The retrofitting design aims to enhance building resilience and will include planning that covers site surveys, water and power supply assessments, site access conditions, hazard risk assessments, environmental impact considerations, building consent acquisition, and market surveys for material availability. Adequate time will be allocated for the recruitment and induction of technical staff, as well as for design/assessment, site selection (including Safety Audit and Accessibility Assessment), tendering, contractor assessment, construction implementation, approval processes, and accounting for potential seasonal interruptions due to weather. The proposed rehabilitation/retrofitting of school buildings will undergo structural engineering assessment by a qualified civil engineer and will incorporate design principles for vulnerable beneficiaries, integrated WASH, and inclusion measures.		

G. GCF POLICIES AND STANDARDS

G.1. Environmental and social risk assessment (max. 750 words, approximately 1.5 pages)

175. The proposed project activities have been screened against the Save the Children Project Program Environmental and Social Sustainability Management System (PESSMS) which is aligned with the GCF Environmental and Social Policy (ESP). Below is a summary of the risks identified during PPF screening, confirming the **risk categorisation of C**. The programme is likely to have minimal adverse environmental or social impacts, as they have been avoided through design or can easily be minimised through implementation of standard management measures.
176. An Environmental and Social Action Plan (ESAP) was developed during PPF to provide detailed guidance during implementation. The ESAP is provided in Annex 6 of this Funding Proposal. The main risks anticipated are summarised against the GCF ESMF standard below along with mitigation measures to address them.

Summary of Risks	Mitigation Factors/Measures or Management Strategies
ESS 2 Labour and working conditions The project proposes activities including the retrofitting of schools to make them more resilient to the projected impacts of climate change.	Project activities will include some small-scale physical works (e.g., retrofitting of WASH facilities or infrastructure to support PV arrays) that may potentially result in exposure to typical physical health and safety risks associated with small scale construction for workers. This risk is assessed as low since all these activities are small-scale and potential for injury would be minimal. <u>There is the potential for small-scale physical works requiring labourers to employ children in some project countries. This risk is assessed as low since the activities will be taking place within known and controllable areas (i.e. schools) where mitigation measures can be readily implemented and effectively monitored.</u>
ESS 3: Resource Efficiency and Pollution Prevention Small quantities of concrete will be required for concrete footings/foundations of some intervention types such as WASH infrastructure or solar panels potentially leading to localised contamination or soils from concrete slurry or wastewater. With concrete use, there will be small quantities of concrete slurry waste which can be caustic to skin.	The ESAP provides management measures for the use of concrete. Concrete will be prepared on bunded and covered hard stand surface. All wastewater from concrete production will be collected to allow particulates to settle out before being discharged. Slurry from concrete production will be collected allowed to harden. Solid and cured concrete waste is considered safe to be reused by the community for infrastructure maintenance. Workers will be provided with appropriate PPE. This is considered low risk given the expected small quantities of concrete required and as the management measures are known to be effective and easily implemented.
ESS 6: <u>Biodiversity Conservation and Sustainable Management of Living Resources</u> The project proposed to develop gardens in South Sudan schools which has the potential to introduce invasive plant species.	Drought resilient seeds will be planted at schools in South Sudan. Under the project's activity exclusion list, only species which do not have the potential to become invasive will be permitted.

	This is considered low risk as the project has put measures in place to avoid the use of invasive species and the gardens are being planted in are within already altered environments.
ESS 7: Indigenous Peoples While Tonga, South Sudan and Cambodia have populations which are considered indigenous or minority ethnic, at the project site intervention level across the program, school communities are considered to be homogenous in language, culture and practices. Therefore, Project benefits or impacts will not adversely affect indigenous people under the GCF definition at the Project site level. All physical activities will take place within existing defined school footprints where the school has documented a lease or secure usage rights of that land. Sub activities linked to policies and strategies proposed by the project relate to education policy and school infrastructure resilience. No lands or resources used by indigenous people other minority groups will be subject to any policies or plans developed by the project. There are no project activities which would require Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)	An Indigenous Peoples Plan (IPP) is not required for this project as there are no activities impacting the lands or resources of indigenous groups and there are no activities for which FPIC is required. To ensure best practice in consultation activities is used, traditional customary processes for each project country are integrated throughout Project design and stakeholder engagement. The project activity design as well as the SEP integrates the inclusion of any identified indigenous, minority, marginalised or vulnerable groups for sub activities: 1.1.1.2.b, 1.1.1.9.b, 1.1.2.5.a, 1.1.2.5.b, 1.1.4.2.a, 1.1.4.1.b, 1.1.4.4.a and 1.1.4.2.b. This is considered low risk as no lands or resources used by indigenous people other minority groups are required for or impacted by this project.
Gender Equity and Women's Empowerment. The project included activities to support Ministries update and improve their National Adaptation Plans and at a subnational level to develop school-base climate resilience and school safety plans.	There is a risk that if engagement of women is not mainstreamed across the implementation of all project activities (particularly: the development of national plans, guidance or strategies related to climate resilience/DDR and education; the formation of working/stakeholder groups; capacity building opportunities), the Project might not fully incorporate or reflect views of women and girls or ensure equitable opportunities for their involvement and benefit. This risk is considered low as measures to avoid this risk are integrated into project design and M&E frameworks through the BRACE Gender Action Plan (GAP).
Accountability and Grievance Mechanism There is a possibility that implementing partners are not adequately aware of their responsibilities under the ESS requirements in implementing the BRACE Project.	The PIU will be trained in the effective implementation of the Environmental and Social Action Plan and responsibilities within that plan will be clearly defined. This is considered of low risk or concern given the limited potential negative impacts associated with the BRACE interventions.

177. Further details about the risks considered in the Project risk screening process are provided in the ESAP in Annex 6. The ESAP shows how these risks have been considered in the fundamental design of the programme and any additional mitigation measures that may be required.

G.2. Gender assessment and action plan (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

178. The Gender Assessment and Gender Action Plan was developed by gender experts across the three countries using primary and secondary data including key informant interviews and focus group discussions. The analysis presented in Annex 8 considers the ways in which gender and social norms intersect with adaptive capacities and climate change impacts across Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. The assessment sets out key data and analysis across five domains and includes recommendations for the project across all components and outputs. The Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Action Plan highlights GESI actions included in the project wide logical framework for the 3 countries as well as Components 2 and 3. The five domains of analysis are:
- Laws, policies and institutions
 - Social norms, roles, responsibilities and time use
 - Participation, leadership and decision-making
 - Access to and control over resources and services
 - Safety, dignity and well-being
179. The project aims to improve the adaptive capacities and climate resilience of children, their communities and schools, recognising that children and their communities are impacted by climate change differently depending on many intersecting factors including, but not limited to, their age, gender, disability, ethnicity, race, economic status, diverse SOGIESC and refugee status.
180. All three countries identified that women, girls, men, and boys are all impacted differently by the socially assigned discriminatory gender roles and responsibilities at the household and community levels because of the traditional social roles and power hierarchies within the family that are deeply ingrained in society. These affect the way marginalized groups are affected by climate change from access to education and climate information (including early warnings), increased gender-based violence and child, early and forced marriage and unions, limited involvement in political and familial decision-making, and reduced control over land and resources.
181. Women and girls are more vulnerable to climate-induced disasters due to economic and social inequalities. In Cambodia, women responsible for managing household resources face challenges accessing food, water, and energy during floods and droughts, while in Tonga, remote communities are particularly vulnerable. The project will implement gender-responsive adaptation strategies, including protecting women, girls, and people with disabilities. School safety plans and climate resilience measures will be developed to address their specific vulnerabilities, ensuring equitable access to support and resources.
182. In South Sudan, patriarchal norms and conflict limit women's participation in public life, particularly in climate and education decisions with displacement due to floods and conflict heightening the risk of violence against women and girls. To mitigate this, the project aims for gender-balanced representation in governance structures, aiming for 50% female participation.
183. In Tonga, extreme weather events, such as cyclones, expose women and girls to GBV in evacuation centers. To mitigate this, the project integrates GBV prevention measures, including safe spaces, psychosocial support, and community awareness campaigns.
184. Climate-related disruptions also jeopardize girls' education. In Cambodia and South Sudan, traditional gender roles often force girls to prioritize household duties over schooling, particularly during and after climate extremes. The BRACE project will retrofit school infrastructure in Cambodia, ensuring access to gender-responsive water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH) facilities. In South Sudan, where schools are frequently closed due to floods and conflict, safety plans will help ensure girls' and other marginalized groups' continued education.
185. Additionally, analysis of historical data by Save the Children shows that a 10% increase or decrease in rainfall is associated with a 1% increase in CEFMU, globally. Globally almost 9 million girls face extreme risk of climate disasters and CEFMU every year and around two-thirds of CEFMU happen in regions with higher-than-average climate risks. Gender inequality is the root cause of CEFMU, but other risk factors increase the likelihood of a girl being married. These include being out-of-school, living in poverty, food shortages, being pregnant or having a baby and exposure to other forms of GBV. Climate disasters and the long-term impacts of the climate crisis can increase these risk factors. For example, disasters can lead to school closures and loss of income for families. GBV also increases during crises and families may decide to remove girls from school or have them marry to keep them safe from violence or to make sure their daughters are provided for by another family.
186. Finally, the exclusion of marginalized groups—including people with disabilities, ethnic minorities, and LGBTQI+ individuals—poses a significant risk. In Tonga, the leiti community faces discrimination, while people with disabilities in Cambodia and indigenous groups struggle to access education and climate services. To address this, the project ensures all activities are inclusive, providing educational materials in accessible formats such as braille, sign language, and multiple languages, enabling meaningful participation for all.
187. For Components 2 and 3, the BRACE project will include GESI in NAP reviews, support child/youth-led and women's organization representatives to engage in the BRACE Coordination Mechanism and ensure this is gender-balanced and include GESI in the development and implementation of the Climate Change and Education Declaration Roadmap.

188. The BRACE project's gender-responsive approach to climate resilience, tailored to the specific needs of Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga, aligns with the GCF's Gender Policy.
189. For more detailed analysis and mitigation strategies related to gender and social inclusion risks, please refer to Annex 8 – Gender Assessment and Action Plan. The project will be monitored through gender-responsive indicators and have budget allocated to GESI activities to ensure equitable outcomes for all stakeholders.

G.3. Financial management and procurement (max. 500 words, approximately 1 page)

190. Save the Children Australia (SCA), as the Accredited Entity (AE), will oversee financial management and procurement for the BRACE project, ensuring full compliance with Green Climate Fund (GCF) fiduciary standards. The project will be implemented in Tonga, Cambodia, and South Sudan through a decentralized structure, with each country having its own Project Implementation Unit (PIU) and Project Steering Committee (PSC). These entities will be responsible for day-to-day financial operations and procurement activities, while SCA provides overall strategic and fiduciary oversight.
191. **Financial Management Arrangements.** The financial management structure for the BRACE project is informed by comprehensive financial management capacity assessments and due diligence conducted on all Executing Entities (EEs). These assessments, detailed in **Annex 20: Know Your Customer AML/CFT Due Diligence Assessment**, reviewed financial systems, procedures, and capacity in each country, resulting in tailored financial arrangements to match their specific needs.
- **Tonga:** Save the Children Tonga (SCTON) is a newly registered legal entity, and its financial and procurement capacity is still in development. SCA's assessment confirmed that SCTON's systems will be aligned with those of Save the Children Australia. During the project's start-up phase, SCA will provide training and capacity building on GCF-specific rules, policies, and reporting requirements to enhance SCTON's capacity and reduce risks.
 - **Cambodia:** Save the Children International Cambodia (SCIKHM) was assessed as having sufficient financial management capacity to handle the project's funds. With a strong track record of managing large-scale projects with international donors, SCIKHM has procurement and financial systems well-aligned with GCF standards, ensuring smooth fund management and reporting processes.
 - **South Sudan:** Save the Children International South Sudan (SCISSD) operates in a more challenging environment. While SCISSD has a well-established financial management system, the due diligence assessment identified potential risks due to political instability and limited capacity within local government entities. To mitigate these risks, financial management will include phased disbursements, strict reporting requirements, and enhanced monitoring by SCA to ensure compliance.
192. In all three countries, funds will be distributed to EEs and implementing partners, based on work plans and budgets approved by the PSCs. The PIUs will collaborate closely with national ministries and implementing partners to ensure efficient use of resources, in line with project objectives.
193. **Financial Reporting and Audits.** Financial reports will be submitted to SCA, detailing the use of funds and ensuring compliance with GCF fiduciary standards. In addition to regular internal financial reviews, external audits will be conducted annually, with results shared with SCA and GCF to ensure transparency and accountability. These audits will ensure adherence to GCF's financial and operational guidelines, ensuring that funds are being used as intended to achieve project goals.
194. SCA will maintain oversight of financial controls across all countries and address any risks related to fund mismanagement through regular reviews, including spot checks, and by implementing corrective actions as needed.
195. **Procurement Arrangements.** Procurement for the BRACE project will be guided by the procurement policies and procedures outlined in **Annex 10: Procurement Plan**. The procurement plan provides a high-level overview of the procurement methods and processes that will be used throughout the project, ensuring transparency and competition.
196. Procurement capacity assessments confirmed that SCI entities in Cambodia and South Sudan have procurement policies that align with SCA and meet GCF requirements. These entities will handle local procurement activities, ensuring procurement processes are competitive and transparent. In **Tonga**, where SCTON is a newly registered entity, procurement policies will be reviewed and aligned with SCA's guidelines during the project's start-up to ensure compliance with GCF standards.
197. These EE will be responsible for executing procurement activities under the oversight of the PSCs, with strategic guidance from SCA. Larger and more complex procurement activities, such as: **School retrofitting** and climate-resilient infrastructure improvements, **WASH infrastructure upgrades**, including borehole rehabilitation and water-efficient systems, Procurement of **solar dryers** for agricultural use to support sustainable livelihoods, will receive close oversight from SCA to ensure adherence to international best practices.
198. Procurement risks were carefully assessed during the project design phase, with particular attention to countries with more challenging environments, such as South Sudan. The assessments identified potential risks related to political instability, logistical challenges, and the potential for procurement delays. To mitigate these risks, a phased approach to procurement will be implemented, with high-risk activities subject to additional scrutiny and prior review by SCA. This will ensure that all procurement activities align with rigorous competitive bidding processes and SCA standards.

199. **Monitoring and Oversight.** SCA will closely monitor the financial and procurement performance of the PIUs through financial reporting, which will provide detailed insights into fund utilization, procurement progress, and any challenges encountered. In cases where procurement or financial management issues arise, SCA will work collaboratively with the PIUs and PSCs to resolve them promptly, ensuring that project implementation remains on track.
200. Procurement activities will also comply with GCF environmental and social safeguards, as outlined in the project's Environmental and Social Action Plans (ESAPs), detailed in Annex 6.

G.4. Disclosure of funding proposal

201. ☐ No confidential information: The accredited entity confirms that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may be disclosed in full by the GCF, as no information is being provided in confidence.
202. ☒ With confidential information: The accredited entity declares that the funding proposal, including its annexes, may not be disclosed in full by the GCF, as certain information is being provided in confidence. Accordingly, the accredited entity is providing to the Secretariat the following two copies of the funding proposal, including all annexes:
- full copy for internal use of the GCF in which the confidential portions are marked accordingly, together with an explanatory note regarding the said portions and the corresponding reason for confidentiality under the accredited entity's disclosure policy, and
 - redacted copy for disclosure on the GCF website.

The funding proposal can only be processed upon receipt of the two copies above, if containing confidential information.

H. ANNEXES

H.1. Mandatory annexes

- ☒ Annex 1 NDA no-objection letter(s) [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 2 Feasibility study - and a market study, if applicable
- ☒ Annex 3 Economic and/or financial analyses in spreadsheet format
- ☒ Annex 4 Detailed budget plan [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 5 Implementation timetable including key project/programme milestones [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 6 E&S document corresponding to the E&S category (A, B or C; or I1, I2 or I3):
[\(ESS disclosure form provided\)](#)
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Impact Assessment (ESIA) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management Plan (ESMP) or
 - ☐ Environmental and Social Management System (ESMS)
 - ☐ Others (please specify – e.g. Resettlement Action Plan, Resettlement Policy Framework, Indigenous People's Plan, Land Acquisition Plan, etc.)
- ☒ Annex 7 Summary of consultations and stakeholder engagement plan
- ☒ Annex 8 Gender assessment and project/programme-level action plan [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 9 Legal due diligence (regulation, taxation and insurance)
- ☒ Annex 10 Procurement plan [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 11 Monitoring and evaluation plan [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 12 AE fee request [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 13 Co-financing commitment letter, if applicable [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☒ Annex 14 Term sheet including a detailed disbursement schedule and, if applicable, repayment schedule

H.2. Other annexes as applicable

- ☒ Annex 15 Evidence of internal approval [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☐ Annex 16 Map(s) indicating the location of proposed interventions
- ☒ Annex 17 Multi-country project/programme information [\(template provided\)](#)
- ☐ Annex 18 Appraisal, due diligence or evaluation report for proposals based on up-scaling or replicating a pilot project
- ☐ Annex 19 Procedures for controlling procurement by third parties or executing entities undertaking projects financed by the entity
- ☒ Annex 20 First level AML/CFT (KYC) assessment
- ☒ Annex 21 Operations manual (Operations and maintenance)
- ☐ Annex 22 Assessment of GHG emission reductions and their monitoring and reporting (for mitigation and cross cutting-projects)¹⁰³

* Please note that a funding proposal will be considered complete only upon receipt of all the applicable supporting documents.

¹⁰³ Annex 22 is mandatory for mitigation and cross-cutting projects.



KINGDOM OF CAMBODIA
Nation Religion King

Ministry of Environment

Nº : 3195 / 0615 MoE

To: The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")

Phnom Penh, 22 April 2025

Re: No-objection letter in respect of the funding proposal titled "Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)" submitted by Save the Children Australia.

Dear Madam, Sir,

We refer to the funding proposal titled Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE) in Cambodia submitted by Save the Children Australia to us on 14 October 2024 (the "Proposal").

The undersigned is the duly authorized representative of the Ministry of Environment, the national designated authority of the Kingdom of Cambodia.

Pursuant to GCF Decisions B.08/10, B.37/22, and B.41/02, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, in my capacity as representative of the national designated authority, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the Proposal.

By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

- (a) The Royal Government of Cambodia has no-objection to the Proposal; and
- (b) The Proposal is in conformity with the national priorities, strategies and plans of Cambodia.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the Proposal has been duly followed.

Notwithstanding the foregoing, we expect Save the Children Australia to take the necessary measures to ensure that the project as described in the Proposal is implemented in a manner consistent with applicable national laws.

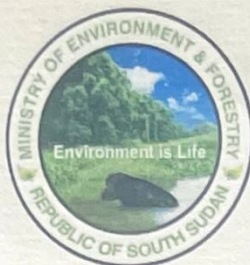
We further confirm that our no-objection to the Proposal also applies to any project preparation facility application made by Save the Children Australia after the submission of the Proposal to the GCF Secretariat.

We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website. 22

Sincerely yours,
Minister



EANG Sophalleth



REPUBLIC OF SOUTH SUDAN
MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT & FORESTRY

Office of The Undersecretary of Environment

28th August 2024

Ms. Mafalda Duarte
Executive Director
Green Climate Fund
175 Art Center- daero
Yeonsu-gu, Incheon 22004
Republic of Korea

To: The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")

South Sudan, 26th August 2024

Re: No-objection letter for Save the Children Australia regarding Submission of the BRACE Project Proposal

Dear Madam/Sir,

We refer to the submission of **BRACE proposal** package for a global education sector climate change initiative, at-scale pilot in **South Sudan** submitted by **Save the Children Australia** to us on 1st August 2024 ("Proposal").

The undersigned is the duly authorized representative of **Joseph Africano Bartel**, the National Designated Authority/focal point of **South Sudan**.

Pursuant to GCF decisions B.08/10 and B.13/21, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the proposal.

By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

- (a) The government of [country] has no-objection to the submitted proposal.
- (b) The Proposal is in conformity with South Sudan's national priorities, strategies and plans; and
- (c) In accordance with the GCF's environmental and social safeguards, the proposed activities is in conformity with relevant national laws and regulations.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the Proposal has been duly followed.

We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website.

Kind regards,



Joseph Africano Bartel

Undersecretary, Ministry of Environment & Forestry

Republic of South Sudan.



MINISTRY OF METEOROLOGY, ENERGY,
INFORMATION, DISASTER MANAGEMENT,
ENVIRONMENT, COMMUNICATIONS AND
CLIMATE CHANGE (MEIDECC)
NUKU'ALOFA, TONGA.

Ref: DCC/10/24
To: The Green Climate Fund ("GCF")
Date: 11 October, 2024.

**Re: Funding proposal for the GCF by Save the Children Australia regarding
Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through
the Education Sector (BRACE).**

Dear Madam, Sir,

We refer to the project titled "*Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector*" (BRACE) in Tonga as included in the funding proposal submitted by Save the Children Australia to us on 7 October, 2024.

The undersigned is the duly authorized representative of Ministry for Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications (MEIDECC), the National Designated Authority of Tonga.

Pursuant to GCF decision B.08/10, the content of which we acknowledge to have reviewed, we hereby communicate our no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal.

By communicating our no-objection, it is implied that:

- (a) The Government of Tonga has no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal;
- (b) The project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with the national priorities, strategies and plans of Tonga;
- (c) In accordance with the GCF's environmental and social safeguards, the project as included in the funding proposal is in conformity with relevant national laws and regulations.

We also confirm that our national process for ascertaining no-objection to the project as included in the funding proposal has been duly followed.

We acknowledge that this letter will be made publicly available on the GCF website.

Yours sincerely,

Mr. Sione Pulotu 'Akau'ola
Tonga NDA to GCF, and
Chief Executive Officer for MEIDECC
Tonga.



Secretariat's assessment of FP274

Proposal name:	Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Countries:	Cambodia, South Sudan, Tonga
Project size:	Small

I. Overall assessment of the Secretariat

- The funding proposal is presented to the Board for consideration with the following remarks:

Strengths	Points of caution
Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE) is the first GCF education-focused project with an integrated and systemic way to enhance climate resilience. By integrating climate resilience measures into education systems, the project ensures educational continuity in the face of climate shocks, establishing a transformative approach to tackling climate change within the education sector.	The sustainability of BRACE's interventions hinges on each country's governance stability and financial ability to scale recommended practices.
With a direct beneficiary base of 608,193 individuals (300,477 women) and an estimated 8.64 million indirect beneficiaries (4.2 million women) across Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga, BRACE demonstrates an expansive reach. The project prioritizes addressing critical challenges in education, including reducing absenteeism, preventing school closures, and mitigating dropout rates due to climate shocks. The combination of retrofitting school infrastructures, upgrading water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) systems, and introducing early warning mechanisms ensures resilience-building at multiple levels, directly benefiting some of the world's most climate-vulnerable populations.	Political instability and low government budget allocations could pose significant challenges in South Sudan. Dependence on the readiness and availability of the respective ministries of education to own the interventions post-project also introduces unpredictability.
The initiative establishes knowledge-sharing platforms and learning spaces that enable cross-country collaboration and long-term	Logistical challenges may exist in remote or conflict-affected areas, especially in South Sudan and Tonga.

scalability. The project's design ensures that the generated insights and materials can be adapted and applied beyond the target countries, enhancing its global relevance.	
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2. The Board may wish to consider approving this funding proposal in accordance with the terms listed in the term sheet agreed between the Secretariat and the accredited entity (AE), and, if considered appropriate, subject to the conditions set out in annex II to document GCF/B.42/02.

II. Summary of the Secretariat's assessment

2.1 Project background

3. Climate change poses an existential threat to education systems globally, with one billion children living in countries at extreme climate risk. The BRACE project brings innovative solutions by introducing the first GCF education-focused project and first comprehensive integration of climate resilience into education systems, combining climate-smart infrastructure improvements (e.g. infrastructure, WASH impacts, etc.), educational continuity management systems, and curriculum reform. The project's unique approach addresses immediate climate impacts while also building long-term adaptive capacity through policy reform and institutional strengthening.

4. The BRACE project will target two least developed countries (LDCs), South Sudan and Cambodia, and one small island developing State (SIDS), Tonga, that are exposed to increasing temperatures, changing rainfall patterns, and extreme events such as droughts, floods and high/extreme temperature events, which result in a range of education-related impacts.

5. The project will achieve climate-resilient education systems through a multi-pronged approach:

- (a) Implement at-scale pilots in target countries: implement climate-resilient education policies, retrofitted schools, safety systems and climate-focused curricula;
- (b) Increased information and finance access: assist education ministries in accessing climate finance, planning adaptation and creating finance road maps; and
- (c) Enhance coordination and learning: build a climate education financing platform, share best practices and promote South-South collaboration.

6. This multilevel approach, combined with the project's USD 46.7 million investment and partnership with Global Partnership for Education (GPE), creates a replicable model for addressing climate impacts on education systems in highly vulnerable countries. The expected outcomes include increased resilience of 608,193 children and teachers in three countries directly and support for the respective ministries of education, linking to the global education community and climate change actors to access climate finance and to lead climate-resilient sustainable development in the education sector, thus benefiting 8,640,844 million people indirectly.

7. The environmental and social safeguards (ESS) category for this project is C.

2.2 Component-by-component analysis

Component 1: Building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems (total cost: USD 38.6 million; GCF cost: USD 36 million)

8. Component 1 of the project is designed to enhance the resilience of the education sector in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga in the face of current and future climate risks. It adopts a comprehensive, multilevel approach—engaging national, subnational, and school-level actors—to establish the conditions necessary for long-term, scalable and sustainable transformation.

- (a) Output 1.1: Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported
 - (i) Activity 1.1.1: Facilitate preparation and endorsement of climate and education policies, plans and guidelines;
 - (ii) Activity 1.1.2: Strengthen coordination on climate change within ministries of education and other relevant line ministries at the national and subnational level;
 - (iii) Activity 1.1.3: Facilitate integration of disaster risk reduction (DRR) into existing and/or new plans with education authorities; and
 - (iv) Activity 1.1.4: Support children to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives.
- (b) Output 1.2: School facilities are safer and greener
 - (i) Activity 1.2.1: Develop a national standard for climate-resilient school facilities;
 - (ii) Activity 1.2.2: Retrofit school facilities, including WASH and internet connectivity, to strengthen climate resilience; and
 - (iii) Activity 1.2.3: Strengthen school communities and education officials to operate and maintain school infrastructure and facilities.
- (c) Output 1.3 School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively
 - (i) Activity 1.3.1: Build capacity of national and subnational education officials to be master trainers on climate-related school safety;
 - (ii) Activity 1.3.2: Build knowledge and capacity of school management, teachers and children to prepare climate-related school safety plans;
 - (iii) Activity 1.3.3: Implement school-level climate-related school safety plans;
 - (iv) Activity 1.3.4: Provide climate resilience tools, equipment and kits to schools; and
 - (v) Activity 1.3.5: Strengthen access to and use of early warning systems and climate information systems in schools.
- (d) Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedded in national systems
 - (i) Activity 1.4.1: Develop teaching and learning materials on climate change ready to implement through national, non-formal, and informal curricula;
 - (ii) Activity 1.4.2: Build knowledge and capacity of teachers and education managers to implement climate change lessons inside the classroom;
 - (iii) Activity 1.4.3: Strengthen the capacity of children's clubs to lead climate change initiatives in their school and community;
 - (iv) Activity 1.4.4: Disseminate climate change teaching and learning materials through e-learning and other platforms of the ministries of education; and

- (v) Activity 1.4.5: Prepare learning materials and hold events with ministries of education and other partners to share experience in integrating climate change into the curriculum.

Component 2: Enhancing access to climate finance for education (total cost: USD 1.1 million; GCF cost: USD 0.7 million)

9. In component 2, the project will support the ministries of education in the three countries – Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga – supporting them to further access climate finance and to lead climate-resilient sustainable development in the education sector. This will include the development of education sector risk analyses on the impact of climate change on the education sector and children’s learning, and the ministries of education engaging in national adaptation plan (NAP) processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). The ministries of education will also be supported in developing and implementing climate finance mobilization road maps, with direct access entities (DAEs) supported in the preparation of concept notes for GCF focused on the education sector. The direct beneficiaries will be 210 officials from the ministries of education and other education and climate change officials from the three countries, with the impact potential to reach children and education personnel in each country.

- (a) Output 2.1: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have access to, and the ability to interpret and utilize relevant climate information as well as participate in decision-making and influence national adaptation planning processes including within the education sector
 - (i) Activity 2.1.1: Development of education sector risk analyses on the impact of climate change and climate risks on the education sector and children’s learning; and
 - (ii) Activity 2.1.2: Support the ministries of education in coordinating with ministries of environment and engaging in NAP processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the UNFCCC.
- (b) Output 2.2: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have increased access to, and the ability to utilize, scaled-up finance for climate action in the education sector to replicate and scale BRACE to a greater percentage of the respective countries
 - (i) Activity 2.2.1: Development of climate finance mobilization road maps; and
 - (ii) Activity 2.2.2: DAE support for working with the education sector on GCF projects.

Component 3: Coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education (total cost: USD 2.4 million; GCF cost: USD 2.2 million)

10. Component 3 aims to foster collaboration between the education and climate change communities, enabling them to share knowledge and build stronger connections, particularly regarding climate finance. The aim is to ensure that both education and climate stakeholders are aligned and learning from each other to benefit the BRACE countries (Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga), while also laying the groundwork for a broader scale-up through other global education and climate funding opportunities, including the GPE.

- (a) Output 3.1: A climate-resilient education co-investment platform is established and effective in aligning strategic initiatives and financing
 - (i) Activity 3.1.1: Support a BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform, including a steering committee and core team;

- (ii) Activity 3.1.2: Face-to-face meetings between ministries of education and ministries of the environment for cross-learning and building political momentum;
 - (iii) Activity 3.1.3: Map and track global climate finance opportunities in the education sector; and
 - (iv) Activity 3.1.4: Support adjustments to international climate finance reporting to reflect dual-benefit investments in climate and education.
- (b) Output 3.2: Key stakeholders are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through South–South collaboration
- (i) Activity 3.2.1: Develop and host information on the Climate Smart Education Systems Initiative (CSESI) knowledge management platform on climate change and education for improved evidence and learning;
 - (ii) Activity 3.2.2: Develop guidance on climate and education for GCF and the global education sector;
 - (iii) Activity 3.2.3: Organize webinars, thematic sessions and learning events on climate change and education; and
 - (iv) Activity 3.2.4: Develop and share strategic communications materials.

Monitoring and evaluation components (total cost: USD 2.2 million; GCF cost: USD 2.0 million)

11. This cost will cover the relevant activities required to monitor and evaluate the project's progress towards the targets set out in the logical framework. The cost is 4.7 per cent of the total project cost.

Project management (total cost: USD 2.4 million; GCF cost: USD 2.0 million)

12. This activity refers to the support provided to a dedicated project management unit, (PMU) which is responsible for overseeing day-to-day execution activities under all components, including procurement and financial management. The PMU also conducts regular monitoring and evaluation of all activities implemented by the project. The cost is 5.1% per cent of the total project cost.

III. Assessment of performance against investment criteria

3.1 Impact potential

Scale: N/A

13. Under the component 1, "Building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems", The total direct beneficiaries through this project will be 608,193 (comprising 299,933 females) and total indirect beneficiaries will be 8,640,844 (comprising 4,266,850 females). It will also address climate impacts and risks in 850 schools. In Cambodia, the project targets at least 240 primary schools across the provinces of Kampong Chhang, Kampong Cham, and Koh Kong, which are particularly vulnerable to extreme weather events. In Cambodia it will directly reach 392,185 beneficiaries (188,373 female), representing 2.3 per cent of the population, and indirectly benefit 4,031,400 people (1,962,128 female), amounting to 24 per cent of the population. In South Sudan, the project targets children in 510 schools, directly benefiting an estimated 201,242 people, including schoolchildren and community members, with over half (52 per cent) being women and girls. Additionally, the project will impact estimated 4,572,682 indirect beneficiaries in South Sudan (50 per cent female),. Direct beneficiaries account for 1.8 per cent of the total population, while indirect beneficiaries make up 41 per cent. In Tonga, the project will enhance the climate resilience of 100 remote schools to address climate hazards. It will directly benefit 13,671 individuals (6,631 female), representing 13 per cent of the total

population, and indirectly benefit 36,762 people (18,381 female), equivalent to 33 per cent of the population.

14. Under component 2, “Enhancing access to climate finance for education”, the BRACE project aims to support the ministries of education in the three target countries by helping them access climate finance and lead climate-resilient sustainable development in the education sector. It will directly benefit 210 ministry of education and government officials across these countries, with the potential to impact children and education personnel. Additionally, the CSESI project will complement these efforts by sharing lessons learned from the BRACE project implementation with 35 other countries.

15. Under component 3, “Coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education”, more than 1,000 education and climate actors and organizations in each of the counties will be benefited.

3.2 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: N/A

16. The BRACE project aims to create a paradigm shift in school safety and climate education by leveraging the Comprehensive School Safety Framework (CSSF). It focuses on improving school infrastructure, safety management systems, and enhancing climate change knowledge and skills among students. The project addresses barriers in governance, gender and social inclusion, and financial, technological and institutional areas. The project contributes to climate-resilient development pathways aligned with sustainable development and educational strategies. It aims to increase climate knowledge and skills among children and teachers, enhance school safety and resilience, and strengthen disaster preparedness. Additionally, the BRACE project fosters collaboration between ministries of education and climate Change to access climate finance and embed climate-related policies.

17. The BRACE project is designed for scalability and replicability, aligning with national policy objectives and complementing other climate-focused projects. It aims to expand the CSSF model to more schools, enhancing infrastructure, safety management systems and climate education. The project will provide materials such as standards, guidelines and plans to facilitate adaptation in different contexts. Additionally, climate finance tools and resources developed through the project will further support its scalability and replicability across various regions.

18. The BRACE project emphasizes knowledge-sharing and learning through dedicated components focused on school safety. It involves annual workshops, a learning agenda shared across three countries, and e-learning platforms for broader dissemination. Components 2 and 3 focus on scaling up climate action in education by applying the CSSF model in various contexts. Component 2 and 3 promote cross-country learning and capacity-building for ministries of education on climate finance, engaging in UNFCCC processes like NAP development. Knowledge products will be disseminated through dedicated platforms, webinars and learning events. The BRACE project is positioned to test new interventions on a moderate scale and share findings widely.

3.3 Sustainable development potential

Scale: N/A

19. The BRACE project aims to deliver significant gender and social inclusion benefits, indirectly impacting over 4.1 million females. It focuses on fostering gender equality and social inclusion (GESI) within the education sector through interventions that promote social attitude and behavioural changes. The project engages stakeholders and facilitates learning opportunities to advocate for gendered climate needs and actions. Key initiatives include providing gendered, age-appropriate, and disability-friendly WASH facilities, which can also

serve the community during extreme weather. The project promotes menstrual hygiene and provides dignity kits for girls and teachers, enhancing community capacity. Improved WASH facilities near schools and communities aim to reduce the burden on women and girls related to water collection and washing. The BRACE project empowers communities by forming DRR committees involving children, women and people with disabilities in remote areas. It incorporates GESI needs into risk assessments, DRR plans and climate-related school safety plans. Early warning systems will use language that is responsive to age, gender and disabilities.

20. The BRACE project also aims to achieve environmental co-benefits by implementing school greening initiatives. These include reducing emissions through improved infrastructure and using photovoltaic (PV) panels for lighting and connectivity, and natural resource management efforts, such as tree planting and water-efficient irrigation systems. Supporting school food gardens can encourage the community to adopt positive environmental practices. Additionally, the project enhances environmental impact through improved WASH facilities, waste management systems and hygiene practices.

21. The BRACE project enhances social co-benefits by promoting locally led adaptation (LLA) at the school level. It engages children, teachers and community members to influence the LLA agenda through school safety plans, children's clubs, and participation in the development and implementation of NAPs. School-led initiatives and knowledge-sharing amplify LLA efforts, offering advocacy opportunities at climate events like United Nations Climate Change Conferences. This ground-up approach empowers children as key stakeholders in climate action and decision-making, aligning with LLA principles.

22. The project also contributes to the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly goals 4 (Quality Education), 5 (Gender Equality), 6 (Clean Water and Sanitation), 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities) and 13 (Climate Action).

3.4 Needs of the recipient

Scale: N/A

23. The climate change vulnerabilities affect school infrastructure, learning and health, and have broader economic and social impacts, highlighting the need for climate-resilient investments. In Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga, climate hazards such as droughts, heatwaves, wildfires, rising sea levels and storms increase vulnerability, exacerbated by insufficient financial investment in education systems. To build a climate-informed society, the education sector must integrate climate resilience into its planning and operations. This includes constructing resilient infrastructure, developing DRR strategies, incorporating climate change into curricula, enhancing teachers' knowledge and capacity, and supporting community adaptation efforts.

24. Cambodia, one of the poorest countries in South-East Asia, is particularly exposed to floods, droughts, heatwaves, cyclones and seawater intrusion, which damage school infrastructure, disrupt education and pose health risks to school communities. Cambodia ranks 46th in UNICEF's Children's Climate Risk Index, indicating a high risk to children from water scarcity, flooding and vector-borne diseases. The Global Climate Risk Index places Cambodia as the 14th most climate risk-prone country globally, highlighting the urgent need for climate-resilient strategies and investments.

25. South Sudan, an LDC, faces significant vulnerability to climate shocks and has urgent adaptation needs. It ranks as the 8th most vulnerable country globally according to the Notre Dame Global Adaptation Index, and 175th in readiness to adapt to climate change impacts. South Sudan's lowland and swampy topography make schools and communities highly susceptible to worsening flooding due to erratic rainfall, leading to school closures and severe infrastructure damage.

26. Tonga's education system faces significant challenges from climate change, including sea level rise, droughts, floods, tropical cyclones and heatwaves, with schools, particularly on outer islands, needing urgent infrastructural support. The lack of climate-specific courses in schools highlights the need to prepare students for climate-related professions. Past climate events have disrupted education and incurred high financial costs, with a missing climate focus in previous projects. Funding sources are insufficient to meet the adaptation needs of the dispersed school system, with international programmes often focusing on immediate development rather than climate change.

3.5 Country ownership

Scale: N/A

27. The BRACE project aligns with the national climate change strategies and educational policies of Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga to support the development of climate-resilient education systems. It aligns with South Sudan's NAP and nationally determined contributions (NDCs), the Cambodia Climate Change Strategic Plan and NAP-DRR, and Tonga's Strategic Development Framework and Joint National Action Plan 2 on Climate Change Adaptation and Disaster Risk Management, emphasizing climate adaptation and resilience in education. This project is also designed to be gender-responsive and inclusive, addressing the needs of girls, children with disabilities, women and internally displaced people. It aligns with South Sudan's National Gender Policy, Cambodia's Gender Mainstreaming Strategic Plan in Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management, and Tonga's national education policy framework, integrating gender perspectives into climate adaptation and DRR. By ensuring equal access to climate-resilient educational facilities, the BRACE project supports inclusive interventions across all genders and children with disabilities in these countries.

28. In each country, BRACE engages local governments, community organizations and school management committees, ensuring that interventions are contextually relevant and sustainable. By fostering a sense of ownership among local stakeholders the project ensures that the benefits of climate resilience are maintained long after the project's completion. Stakeholder engagement has been crucial in the development and implementation of the BRACE project across Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. Extensive consultations with government agencies, local communities, non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and development partners have ensured the project aligns with local needs, focusing on school infrastructure resilience and climate education in South Sudan, identifying key intervention areas in Cambodia, and addressing local climate challenges in Tonga. These participatory processes have shaped the project's design, fostered broad support, and will continue to involve stakeholders throughout implementation, ensuring alignment with national and community priorities and allowing for adaptive management based on feedback.

3.6 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: N/A

29. The BRACE project is expected to directly benefit 608,193 individuals and indirectly benefit over 8.6 million people through improved education infrastructure and system-wide resilience measures. It targets the most climate-vulnerable populations in the education sector, aiming to reduce disruptions to schooling due to extreme weather, enhance the safety and utility of school facilities and embed climate risk awareness and adaptation capacity into the education system. The concessionality of a GCF grant is proposed due to the countries' limited fiscal space, the public-good nature of basic education, and the lack of private sector incentives in this space. The grant allows the pilot countries to implement transformational measures that would otherwise remain unfunded. The project's results are designed to be replicable, contributing to long-term learning and scalability in other climate-vulnerable education systems.

30. The project's cost-benefit analysis shows that investing in resilient school facilities and education system strengthening generates high social and economic returns. The project estimates an economic internal rate of return (EIRR) of 35–36 per cent and an economic net present value of approximately USD 87 million over a 15-year period based on a 9 per cent discount rate. These figures are consistent across both Representative Concentration Pathway (RCP) 4.5 and RCP 8.5 climate scenarios, indicating strong economic viability and resilience to climate uncertainty. The EIRR reflects a combination of increased economic returns from improved human capital, reduced costs associated with school infrastructure damage from climate-related events, fewer missed schooldays and additional benefits from school safety and curriculum training. While some benefit assumptions are based on field interviews and expert inputs, sensitivity analysis was applied to test the robustness of results. Even under conservative scenarios, the project maintains an EIRR well above the generally accepted 10 per cent threshold.

31. The BRACE project proposes concessional financing due to the critical need for such funding in the three pilot countries, which are highly vulnerable to climate change impacts. This financing is essential for implementing interventions that improve the educational environment and foster positive societal change. Basic education, considered a public good, is typically funded by governments, as its attributes make it challenging for private firms to profit, meaning private sector displacement is not a concern. The investment in education is crucial for societal benefit, as it leads to a more educated population and enhances public welfare.

IV. Assessment of consistency with GCF safeguards and policies

4.1 Environmental and social safeguards

32. The project aims to increase the climate resilience of the education sector and its stakeholders in the target countries, both at the national and subnational levels by capacitating existing institutions, enhancing access to finance and climate information, and providing cross-border learning opportunities. The main physical activities of the project that may have minor occupational health and safety risks and/or impacts are related to retrofitting of school facilities including improving the cooling systems and ventilation, installing solar PV systems to improve access to renewable energy for lighting and internet connectivity, improving shade through tree planting within the school area, installing rainwater harvesting structures and upgrading drinking water systems. The AE has developed an Environmental and Social Assessment and Residual Risk Management Plan (ESARMP) to mitigate the risks of the project. The management measures include ensuring workers will be provided with appropriate training on how to use tools, equipment and materials prior to commencement of works and will be provided with appropriate personal protective equipment. A PMU, which will have a combined ESS, GESI and Engagement Specialist to implement the ESARMP, will also be established.

33. The AE has conducted consultations in the target countries involving government ministries, NGOs, civil society organizations, multilateral organizations, donors and the private sector in the development of the project to ensure it aligns with the needs and priorities of each country's education sector as far as climate resilience and disaster preparedness are concerned. A stakeholder engagement plan is developed, and a grievance redress mechanism will also be put in place.

34. **Sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEAH).** The revised GCF Environmental and Social Policy adopted by decision B.BM-2021/18 requires safeguarding from SEAH in GCF-financed activities. The AE provided SEAH safeguarding in its submission to this funding proposal. As a standard practice, the AE conducts SEAH risk assessments for all its projects including country-specific assessment for this project. Key SEAH safeguarding measures have

been included in the SEAH grievance mechanism in alignment with the approach of the AE to child protection and a SEAH/gender-based violence continuum of care, while employing a survivor-centred approach. The rights, needs and wishes of survivors (or victims) will be the foremost priority in this project. The survivors' rights to dignity, privacy and confidentiality, safety, non-discrimination and access to information key aspects of the SEAH protection and response, including violence against children, and gender-based violence cases.

35. **GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy & ESS7 (Indigenous Peoples):** The target countries and project sites have populations considered Indigenous (Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga). The project acknowledges that while there are Indigenous Peoples or minority ethnic groups at the project site intervention level, school communities are homogeneous in language, culture and practices. Thus, project benefits or impacts will not adversely affect Indigenous Peoples under the GCF definition at the project site level. All physical activities will take place within existing defined school footprints where the school has documented a lease or secure usage rights of that land. Therefore, the project does not require free, prior, and informed consent. No lands or resources used by Indigenous Peoples or other minority groups will be subject to any policies or plans developed by the project. The project has integrated traditional customary processes for each project country into the project design and stakeholder engagement. The AE has given assurances that the material developed will be culturally appropriate and sensitive. This approach ensures the careful involvement and consideration of Indigenous Peoples without adversely impacting their lifestyles or resources. The requirements of the GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy are included in the environmental and social action plan and so no Indigenous Peoples plan or Indigenous Peoples planning framework was required. In line with its roles and functions, the Indigenous Peoples Advisory Group is available to provide advice to the AE and executing entities (EEs). In line with the GCF Indigenous Peoples Policy, the GCF Indigenous Peoples focal point will be available for assistance at any stage, including before a claim has been made.

4.2 Gender policy

36. The AE provided a gender assessment and action plan with the funding proposal and therefore complies with the requirements of the GCF Updated Gender Policy. The gender assessment and action plan were prepared by the project feasibility teams and GESI specialists in the target countries of Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. The AE also ensured that this process aligned with their gender mainstreaming guidelines, their gender equality and inclusion policies, and country level Save the Children International gender equality and inclusion action plans. A detailed analysis was made of all five key assessment domains, namely: laws, policies and institutions; social norms, time use; participation and leadership; access to and control over resources and services; and safety, dignity and well-being. The gaps identified in each of the domains have corresponding recommendations in alignment with the BRACE project.

37. The AE submitted a comprehensive gender action plan (GAP) to mainstream gender and social inclusion throughout the BRACE project. Under component 1, "Building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems", among other GESI activities, the project will facilitate the review and adoption of school design that is green, safe, healthy, inclusive and gender-responsive, in alignment with the national guidelines which provide for inclusive approaches; and inclusion of GESI considerations in climate-related school safety training and the differential impacts of climate change on accessing education for different groups. In addition to this, the infrastructure and WASH assessments will include age, gender and disability-specific needs and identify any differentiated risks. Under component 2, Enhancing access to climate finance for education, the project will support various capacity-building initiatives such as gender-related cross-sectoral coordination with key line ministries; and education-focused GESI content in NAPs and NDCs. Regarding component 3, on "Coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education", the project will, among other gender strategic activities, map, track

and promote GESI opportunities within climate finance for education; and the project will include evidence and learning on GESI in all the knowledge management platforms for the project. Each GESI activity has detailed gender indicators for each component in the GAP which will help in monitoring and evaluation of the gender and social outcomes for this project.

4.3 Risks

4.3.1. Overall project/programme assessment (medium risk)

38. The project aims to establish climate-resilient education systems in two LDCs, South Sudan and Cambodia, and one SIDS, Tonga, that are exposed to increasing average temperatures, changing rainfall patterns, and extreme events such as droughts, floods and high/extreme temperature events. The GCF is requested to provide a full grant of USD 46.7 million. GPE, UNICEF and World Bank are contributing co-financing of USD 6 million in the form of grants.

4.3.2. Accredited entity/executing entity capability to execute the current project/programme (medium risk)

39. The AE has an extensive track record and global experience in implementing climate adaptation projects. This funding proposal represents the first GCF-funded project to focus on mitigating climate risk in the education sector.

4.3.3. Project/programme-specific execution risks (medium risk)

40. Political instability: political instability arising from conflicts, governance challenges, and changes in political leadership in South Sudan and Cambodia could deprioritize climate resilience initiatives. Mitigation measures can involve making the project more locally led or better integrated within the local government system, so that even during instances of national-level unrest the project can still operate at the community level, as the PMU is often located within the community or project sites.

4.3.4. Compliance risk (medium risk)

41. The project presents a moderate compliance risk. Procurement and financial management gaps in newly established entities, such as Save the Children Tonga (SCTON), expose the project to risks of misallocation and non-compliance due to underdeveloped systems and insufficient internal controls. To mitigate this, tailored capacity-building efforts are planned to align their processes with GCF-specific requirements, coupled with ongoing monitoring to ensure adherence to financial management standards and regulatory compliance. While no immediate reasons for concern are apparent, thorough due diligence remains essential to mitigate any latent risks that could arise from evolving legal frameworks or geopolitical factors.

42. A multi-layered compliance framework is in place to mitigate these risks, leveraging anti-money-laundering and countering the financing of terrorism (AML/CFT) policies, enhanced due diligence on all partners, real-time sanctions screening, and financial oversight mechanisms. Digital financial tracking tools will be used to enhance transparency, while mandatory fraud prevention and ethics training will strengthen internal controls. Regular audits, spot checks, and ongoing partner assessments will ensure compliance with procurement and financial integrity standards. A whistle-blower mechanism is also in place to encourage reporting of suspicious activities, ensuring accountability across all levels of project execution.

43. Residual risk remains at a manageable level, contingent on continuous oversight and adaptive compliance strategies. Based on the implemented mitigation measures, the residual

compliance risk is assessed as Medium Risk. Continuous monitoring, adaptive risk management, and stringent enforcement of financial compliance policies will be critical in maintaining project integrity and alignment with GCF fiduciary standards.

4.3.5. GCF portfolio concentration risk

44. In case of approval, the impact of this proposal on the GCF concentration risk remains within the monitoring thresholds of the Risk Appetite Statement in terms of results areas, single proposal or AE concentration.

Summary risk assessment	
Overall programme	Medium
Accredited entity/executing entity capability	Medium
Project-specific execution	Medium
Compliance	Medium
GCF portfolio concentration	within the monitoring thresholds

4.4 Fiduciary

45. SCA is the AE for this project. The EEs are SCA, Save the Children International in Cambodia (SCIKHM), SCTON, and the, Save the Children International in South Sudan (SCISSD), Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport (MoEYS).

46. The AML/CFT, financial systems, procedures, and country capacity assessments for the BRACE project had been done by the AE on all EEs, detailed in annex 20 to the funding proposal. In all three countries, funds will be distributed to EEs and implementing partners, based on workplans and budgets approved by the project steering committees.

47. SCA will not manage the co-financing from UNICEF or the World Bank. A joint oversight mechanism in South Sudan will manage the GPE funding. Financial reports will be submitted to SCA, detailing the use of funds and ensuring compliance with GCF fiduciary standards. External audits will be conducted annually, with results shared with SCA and GCF to ensure transparency and accountability.

48. SCA will maintain oversight of financial controls across all countries and address any risks related to fund mismanagement through regular reviews, including spot checks, and by implementing corrective actions as needed.

49. The GCF account for the BRACE project will be managed by SCA as the AE. SCA will transfer GCF funds to project-specific bank accounts in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. These accounts will be managed by the respective project implementation units, which will oversee the use of funds for project implementation, including disbursements to government ministries, implementing partners such as the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, and other procured entities.

4.5 Results monitoring and reporting

50. This is an adaptation project that will contribute to 3 of the 4 GCF adaptation results areas, such as ARA1 (Most vulnerable people and communities), ARA2 (Health, well-being, food and water security), and ARA3 (Infrastructure and built environment). The project is expected to reach 608,193 direct beneficiaries and more than 8.6 million indirect beneficiaries in Cambodia and Tonga in the Asia and the Pacific region, and in South Sudan in the Africa region.

51. The results management arrangements proposed under the project were refined over five rounds of review and engagement with the AE. Specifically, changes were made to the project's theory of change to ensure that it was clear, logically coherent, and linked to the climate rationale and activities proposed under the project.
52. The project's logical framework was also refined over multiple rounds to ensure that the proposed indicators and targets were realistic and linked to the proposed theory of change. In particular, the AE was given feedback to ensure that ARA-level beneficiary targets were accurately articulated against identified adaptation benefits, and that there was low risk of inaccurate or double-counting of beneficiaries. It is positive to note that the AE has defined project-level outcome and output indicators, in addition to the indicators against various GCF result areas.
53. The AE was also provided with advice for refining the supporting annexes to the funding proposal, including the Implementation Timetable, Monitoring and Evaluation Plan, and beneficiary calculations. Guidance was provided to the AE to ensure that the beneficiary calculations, especially for indirect beneficiaries, are realistic and aligned with the proposed project rationale and activities.
54. The AE responded positively to the guidance provided and refined the funding proposal accordingly.

4.6 Legal assessment

55. The Accreditation Master Agreement was signed with the Accredited Entity on 20 December 2019 (the "AMA"), and it became effective on 20 May 2020. The Accredited Entity's five-year accreditation term was lapsed on 19 May 2025 but was extended by Decision B.37/18, paragraph (q) until the earlier of three years from the date of lapse of the five-year accreditation term or the date on which a revised accreditation framework is adopted by the Board.
56. The Accredited Entity has provided a legal opinion confirming that it has obtained all internal approvals and it has the capacity and authority to implement the project.
57. The proposed project will be implemented in the Kingdom of Cambodia, the Republic of South Sudan and the Kingdom of Tonga. The GCF has signed bilateral agreements on privileges and immunities with the Kingdom of Tonga. In the case of the Kingdom of Cambodia and the Republic of South Sudan, GCF is not provided with privileges and immunities. This means that, amongst other things, GCF is not protected against litigation or expropriation in these countries, which risks need to be further assessed. Moreover, the ability of GCF to undertake redress activities and/or investigations in such countries may be hindered due to the absence of privileges and immunities for relevant GCF personnel.
58. Therefore, it is recommended that the Board considers whether disbursements of GCF proceeds should only be made after GCF has obtained satisfactory protection against litigation and expropriation in the country, or has been provided with appropriate privileges and immunities for GCF and its personnel.
59. To address the matters raised in this section, it is recommended that any approval by the Board is made subject to the following conditions:
- (a) Signature of the funded activity agreement in a form and substance satisfactory to the GCF Secretariat within 180 days from the date of Board approval; and
 - (b) Completion of the legal due diligence to the satisfaction of the GCF Secretariat.

Independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment of FP274

Proposal name:	Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Countries:	Cambodia, South Sudan, Tonga
Project size:	Small

I. Assessment of the independent Technical Advisory Panel

1.1 Overview

1. The submission of this funding proposal for the multi-country “Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)” project is under the Green Climate Fund (GCF) standard proposal approval process, for a small-size public-sector adaptation programme in environmental and social safeguards risk Category C.¹
2. BRACE will focus on strengthening climate resilience in the education sector in three countries namely: two least developed countries of South Sudan and Cambodia, and the small island developing State of Tonga.
3. The BRACE initiative was conceived during a climate finance dialogue in the margins of the twenty-eighth Conference of the Parties (COP 28) of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (annex 2, appendix 4).² The dialogue was convened by Save the Children, the GCF and the Global Partnership for Education (GPE)³ and was aimed at accelerating climate action by linking the education and climate agendas. Consequently GPE is providing USD 21 million to support 35 countries to integrate climate change into the education sector through the Climate Smart Education Systems Initiative (CSESI).⁴
4. The three countries participating in the BRACE project are exposed to increasing temperatures, changing rainfall patterns, sea level rise,⁵ and extreme events such as droughts, floods, and high/extreme temperature events, which result in a range of impacts on the education sector. School buildings, water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) facilities, and school materials are damaged or destroyed during extreme weather events or slowly eroded by harsher climate conditions.

¹ The assessment of the independent Technical Advisory Panel (iTAP) is based on the funding proposal received on 16 April 2025 (updated with minor modifications on 12 May 2025) and is informed by a set of written questions and answers further discussed in an online meeting between the iTAP and the accredited entity on 8 May 2025.

² COP 28 refers to the United Nations Climate Change Conference that took place in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, from 30 November to 12 December 2023.

³ The Global Partnership for Education (GPE), a multi-stakeholder partnership hosted by the World Bank, supports governments in low-income countries to transform their education systems through technical support, financial resources, and facilitating collaboration among stakeholders.

⁴ The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization and Save the Children Australia are the implementing partners of the GPE CSESI.

<https://www.globalpartnership.org/node/document/download?file=document/file/2024-06-climate-smart-education-systems-initiative-bi-annual-progress-report.pdf>

⁵ As a landlocked country, South Sudan is not directly affected by sea level rise.

5. School disruptions (from climate and non-climate drivers) can affect children's attendance and learning outcomes, increase the likelihood of children dropping out of schools, and affect physical safety and psychosocial well-being. Girls are likely to face higher risks of permanently dropping out of school, increases in gender-based violence, and early marriage.
6. The funding proposal identifies common barriers to climate change adaptation in the education sector in all three countries to include limited institutional capacities and weak inter-agency coordination, limited access to climate information for decision-making, low levels of technical expertise to support timely action, and financial constraints.
7. The funding proposal aims to integrate climate resilience into education systems, by adopting an approach that addresses immediate climate impacts while building long-term adaptive capacity through policy reform and institutional strengthening. The project will be delivered through three inter-linked components as follows:
 - (a) **Component 1: Building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems** will support enabling climate-resilient education policies, support 850 schools to become safer and greener, strengthen school safety and management, and embed climate-focused curricula in national education systems.
 - (b) **Component 2: Enhancing access to climate finance for education** will assist the education sector to access finance for climate action, create finance road maps, and support climate risk-informed decision-making.
 - (c) **Component 3: Coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education** will build climate-education co-investment platforms and facilitate peer learning and South-South collaboration between the three participating countries.
8. The budget of USD 46,737,340 comprises a request for GCF grant funds of USD 40,751,264 with co-financing of USD 5,986,076, with an implementation period of 5 years and an overall benefit stream of 10 years. Parallel finance through GPE CSEI will complement efforts undertaken by BRACE, specifically for Components 2 and 3, thereby helping to sustain, scale and replicate BRACE approaches for other countries.
9. The accredited entity (AE) is Save the Children Australia (SCA), an international non-governmental organization registered in Australia. SCA will act as the executing entity (EE) for Components 2 and 3. The EEs for component 1 in each country include: Save the Children International, registered in Cambodia as an international non-governmental organization; and Royal Government of Cambodia, acting through the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport (Cambodia); Save the Children International, registered in South Sudan as an international non-governmental organization (South Sudan); and Save the Children Tonga Trust, registered in Tonga as an international non-governmental organization (Tonga).
10. There are separate governance and management arrangements for each of the three countries, including national-level project steering committees with multi-stakeholder participation. Additionally, project implementation units will be overseen by the respective Save the Children entities in each of the three countries.

1.2 Impact potential

Scale: Medium to High

11. **Overview:** BRACE proposes to tackle challenges of climate-related increases in children dropping out of school, absenteeism of children and teachers from school, learning loss and impacts on learning outcomes, gender-related impacts, and the physical impacts climate hazards have on school facilities.
12. **Country selection:** The AE clarified to the independent Technical Advisory Panel (iTAP), that BRACE drew from CSEI's selection of 35 countries that was based on climate risk

and vulnerability using three climate risk indices and the Human Development Index. BRACE further identified the three participating countries from across different geographies and contexts based on government willingness, ability to participate, and the status of the country's GCF pipeline. By successfully demonstrating the approach of integrating climate change in the education sector across different contexts, the AE intends that the BRACE approach could be replicated across other CSESI countries.

13. The iTAP sought clarification on how conflict and fragility informed country selection and project implementation. The AE explained that a Fragility Context Analysis for 2025 has been prepared for South Sudan, which includes an analysis of current political instability and conflict, humanitarian needs, and economic factors that contribute to the country's fragility. The AE proposes to use the Conflict Sensitivity Guider⁶ established by SCA and explained how BRACE will apply a conflict sensitivity approach throughout the project cycle.

14. **Selection of schools:** Target areas in each participating country were selected based on climate and socioeconomic vulnerability, synergies with other interventions, and key stakeholder consultations. This includes three provinces in Cambodia, six counties in six states in South Sudan, and schools across Tonga with a focus on those situated in the outer islands.

15. The selection of 850 schools is based on eligibility criteria and the final list will be verified with the respective governments and with other development partners to ensure there is no overlap. The iTAP also understands that these numbers may be subject to some adjustment as the school selection across the three countries will be confirmed during the inception phase. The eligibility and prioritization criteria for schools selected, as covered in the feasibility study (annex 2), are comprehensive and include: climate risks vulnerability and exposure to multiple climate-related hazards; geographic location; poor/unsafe infrastructure conditions; large student population, especially those from marginalized or vulnerable communities; and high educational needs. BRACE has also considered alignment with stakeholder priorities, ensuring that initiatives are gendered, culturally appropriate and sustainable, supporting equity and inclusivity by targeting schools serving disadvantaged or marginalized populations, including girls and children with disabilities, and by taking into consideration potential for collaboration and complementarity with other initiatives.

16. **Climate change exposure, risk and vulnerability:** The AE has confirmed to the iTAP that climate risk assessments, including geographic information system mapping, have been completed in each project area and are included in the country sections of the feasibility study (annex 2). Further national and site-specific assessments linked to addressing present and projected climate-related vulnerabilities, impacts and risks in each country are planned at early stages of project implementation.

17. The funding proposal clearly sets out the climate-related vulnerabilities in each of the three participating countries under the Shared Socioeconomic Pathways scenarios of SSP2-4.5 from 2020 to 2050. Annex 2, appendix 1, succinctly frames the climate drivers (e.g., high/extreme temperature events, rainfall variability, sea level rise) and the non-climate drivers (e.g., geographic location, poverty, socioeconomic vulnerabilities, deforestation, gender and disability). The types of climate-related impacts affecting school community vulnerabilities (i.e. children, teachers, infrastructure) are outlined in a table (page 10 of the funding proposal).

18. Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga are projected to face significant climate impacts, including rising temperatures, extreme weather, and changing rainfall patterns. In Cambodia and South Sudan, increased heat poses serious risks to school-age children and heighten the risks of heat-related illnesses, dehydration, and reduced concentration. Prolonged exposure to extreme temperatures can also disrupt sleep, affecting children's cognitive function and

⁶ SCA's Conflict Sensitivity Guider is available at:
<https://resourcecentre.savethechildren.net/document/conflict-sensitivity-guider-a-practical-roadmap-to-mainstream-conflict-sensitivity-into-programming/>

academic achievement. Tonga may experience changes in rainfall and more tropical cyclones that could damage buildings and disrupt access during storms while rising temperatures risk increasing heat-related illnesses, and rainfall variability could lead to localized droughts, all of which threaten children's well-being.

19. **Adaptation results areas:** Programme impacts are listed under three GCF adaptation results areas, as follows:

- (a) Most vulnerable people and communities (50 per cent of GCF contribution);
- (b) Health, food and water security (25 per cent of GCF contribution); and
- (c) Infrastructure and built environment (25 per cent of GCF contribution).

20. The project anticipates reaching 607,098 direct beneficiaries and 8,640,844 indirect beneficiaries (see table 1 below for details). This will mainly be delivered through Component 1, includes 210 direct beneficiaries comprising government officials to be reached through Component 2, and 1,000 climate and education actors through Component 3.

Table 1: Expected beneficiaries of the BRACE project by country

Countries	Schools		Beneficiaries		Financing (USD)	
	Number of schools (BRACE)	Total number of schools	Number of direct beneficiaries	Number of indirect beneficiaries	GCF funding	Co-financing
Cambodia	240 schools	8,178 (rural primary and secondary schools)	392,185	4,031,400	16,353,057	1,328,692
South Sudan	510 schools	7,737 (total - all schools)	201,242	4,572,682	14,365,455	4,328,692
Tonga	100 schools	324 (total - all schools)	13,671	36,762	10,032,752	328,692
Totals	850		607,098 people	8,640,844 people	USD 40,751,264	USD 5,986,076

Source: Extracted from annexes 17a and 17b to the funding proposal and from AE responses to the iTAP.

21. **Beneficiaries:** The beneficiary calculations, presented in annexes 17a and 17b, are well detailed, draw on available country school census data,⁷ and explain the underlying assumptions for the calculations. Direct beneficiaries include children, teachers, school management committees, education officials and parents and community members, while indirect beneficiaries are wider coverage of all other remaining school-aged children and communities that could broadly benefit from early warning systems and climate information systems. The iTAP has observed a slight variance in the total numbers of direct beneficiaries as presented in the main funding proposal (which states 607,098 people) compared to the annexes 17a and 17b (which states 608,193 people).

22. The funding proposal sets out how the 850 targeted schools will be supported through output areas under Component 1. Overall, 77 schools will benefit from climate-resilient infrastructure improvements, including water and sanitation facilities (output 1.2), 400 schools will benefit from school safety and educational continuity management (output 1.3), and 800 schools will be targeted for climate change resilience teaching and learning (output 1.4).

23. Tables in the annexes highlight additional adaptation benefits across the components and outputs of the BRACE project, for direct and indirect beneficiaries across all three countries.

⁷ Annex 17b clarifies that data may be subject to change according to updates by the ministries of education in the three countries of their official school census data in their respective Education Management Information Systems.

The benefits include increased safety of children, educational personnel and caregivers in and around school to climate-related impacts (outputs 1.2, 1.3 and 1.4); students, school personnel, government and community at large are better prepared to tackle climate change vulnerability due to information received from the early warnings and climate information system (output 1.3); enhanced integration of actions targeting the education sector in national and subnational adaptation planning (outputs 1.1 and 2.1); enhanced access to climate finance to support more resilient education systems (output 2.2); and enhanced access to and exchange of knowledge on climate change resilience in the education sector (outputs 3.1 and 3.2).

24. The iTAP asked the AE about evidence on the linkages between climate impacts and learning loss, and baselines used by the BRACE project. While acknowledging data limitations, the AE cited a recent study by UNICEF, “Learning Interrupted: Global Snapshot of Climate-Related School Disruptions in 2024”,⁸ which highlights the severe impact of climate-related events on children’s education. The AE explained that in Cambodia, 3,385,799 students were affected by climate-related disruptions in 2024 with heatwaves being the most prevalent. In South Sudan, 2,200,000 students were affected by climate-related disruptions in 2024 with heatwaves being the most prevalent. Data are missing for Tonga.

25. The AE has acknowledged that non-climate drivers of vulnerability also impact the education sector, and notes examples of how climate drivers (floods, droughts, high temperatures) can amplify this situation for children, thereby “creating a disruption of higher magnitude”.⁹ The AE has clarified that the BRACE project will solely focus on demonstrating how the education sector can address climate-related risks.

26. The AE has confirmed to the iTAP that the scope of BRACE will not extend to reaching out-of-school children or incentivizing them to join schools as these strategies fall within the core mandate of national institutions. In the longer term, Components 2 and 3 are expected to contribute to building a climate-resilient education sector and will be complemented by national-level interventions thereby designed to deliver nationwide systemic impact that could reach all schoolchildren in the participating countries. The iTAP understands that the achievement of results will largely depend on the extent to which capacities of the relevant ministries are built, climate change adaptation is integrated into education plans, policies and budgets, and climate finance is successfully leveraged.

27. The iTAP also recommends that the project puts in place adequate safeguards to ensure that, under Component 1, the focus of school infrastructure upgrades remains on achieving positive climate impact for children and that there are no negative spillover effects – such as hidden fees or costs that are passed on to families or communities.

28. Based on the above, the iTAP assesses the impact potential as medium to high.

1.3 Paradigm shift potential

Scale: Medium

29. BRACE is designed on the premise that education is a cornerstone of building human capital and is therefore a vital aspect of building the capacities of individuals, communities and societies to take anticipatory action and adapt to the impacts of climate change. This spirit is embodied in the theory of change which presents the logic of how the three components come together to deliver a climate resilient education sector. The focus is on tackling country-specific barriers associated with governance, social, informational, financial, technological, institutional, and gender and social inclusion.

30. Component 1 aims to achieve a paradigm shift by building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems to enable the education sector to be more resilient to the impacts of

⁸ Available at: <https://www.unicef.org/reports/learning-interrupted-global-snapshot-2024>

⁹ AE responses to questions from iTAP (Q.5)

climate change at national and subnational levels in the three targeted countries. This is to be delivered through four outputs on integrating climate change into education sector policies and plans (output 1.1); safer and greener school facilities through retrofitting schools and strengthening school communities and education officials to operate and maintain school infrastructure (output 1.2); school safety and educational continuity management systems, and strengthening access to and use of early warning systems and climate information systems in schools (output 1.3); and embedding climate change resilience in teaching and learning, and strengthening capacities of children's clubs to lead climate change initiatives in their schools and communities (output 1.4).

31. The AE has clarified that the project will apply the established Comprehensive School Safety Framework to school retrofitting activities in each country. These will be adapted to the specific local contexts and evidenced climate needs to ensure that standards are maintained for these infrastructure-related works. Design will also take into account availability of building material, familiarity with construction techniques, existing vernacular approaches to design and construction and building regulations. Therefore, while the project will standardize the analysis and design processes, the actual design may be different across locations.

32. Component 2 proposes to improve access of education ministries to climate finance in the three participating countries to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change. This is to be delivered through two outputs on climate risk-informed decision-making and influencing (output 2.1), and finance for climate action in the education sector (output 2.2).

33. Component 3 promotes coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education for enhanced climate action in the education sector. This will include establishment of a climate resilient education co-investment platform (output 3.1) and peer learning and exchange (output 3.2).

34. **Contextual factors.** In the view of the iTAP, the three assumptions in the theory of change are significant. The extent to which all underlying assumptions hold true in different country contexts will be critical to the achievement of the intended outcomes and in enabling a paradigm shift in each of the three participating countries. For instance, the assumption in the proposal that safer schools equate to safer communities is only partially true in a context where children may drop out to support families facing climate-driven economic shocks or where other non-climate drivers (as helpfully listed in the proposal) may be significant reasons behind student or teacher absenteeism.

35. The extent to which key education stakeholders can effectively adopt and scale climate-resilient policies and actions, engage with climate information and learning, and leverage additional resources to integrate climate change into the education sector will depend on a number of context-specific factors that may be outside the sphere of control of the project (e.g., fragility and conflict, political stability, economic shocks, willingness of stakeholders to prioritize climate action in the education sector, capacities of stakeholders, and resource availability to meet the enormous needs of the sector). One (of three) participating countries falls under the category of fragile and conflict-affected states which could affect the extent to which project interventions achieve a paradigm shift particularly if instability or conflict affect project progress or sustainability.

36. **Scalability:** The numbers of schools reached, the types of activities across schools in each country, and the proportion of direct and indirect beneficiaries varies significantly by country. Relative to the total numbers of national schools in the three participating countries BRACE's potential impact would extend to approximately 3 per cent for Cambodia, 7 per cent for South Sudan, and 31 per cent for Tonga (information captured in table 1 above). While this may limit the scale of impact to be achieved through this project alone, the iTAP appreciates that BRACE will lay the groundwork for future scaling efforts.

37. The iTAP considers that the planned development of a longer-term financing strategy, proposed under Component 2, will be critical to help unlock finance for sustaining and scaling efforts under this project. The iTAP welcomes the project's early consideration of developing climate finance road maps from the first year of implementation (annex 5). While the project also builds in support to education ministries to develop concept notes for access to GCF finance, the iTAP recommends that wider sources of funding and synergies are also leveraged.

38. **Alignment with CSESI:** The AE has clarified to the iTAP that the intent of both CSESI and BRACE is to show the value of this work and the 'how to' of integrating climate change into the education sector to achieve adaptation benefits and impacts at scale. Alignment of BRACE with parallel financing from the GPE CSESI is valuable and could also help in replicating and scaling up specific project activities in the three participating countries. This approach could help to create an enabling environment, achieve synergies and coordinated action with other donor-funded education projects for sustainability, and enable replication more broadly across the other countries supported by the GPE CSESI.

39. **Knowledge and learning:** All three project components include activities to support knowledge and learning across different stakeholder groups which is a useful way of engaging with stakeholders, building wider knowledge, and deriving lessons from the Comprehensive School Safety Framework model across different contexts. The project will also leverage the CSESI knowledge management platform to facilitate cross-country learning, the development of guidance and knowledge products on climate change and education, and the targeted dissemination of strategic communications materials to key stakeholders in the three countries. The iTAP views this as a useful approach that can help to strengthen learning and support uptake and replication of project activities. Furthermore, lessons learned from the design and implementation of the BRACE programme in three diverse country contexts can inform future GPE climate resilience efforts, including its quality standards and grant design.

40. The BRACE climate and education financing coordination platform, proposed under Component 3, could offer high potential for knowledge-sharing and learning, and climate action in the education sector at global and national levels. The design and institutional arrangements for such coordination are not yet clearly defined, and the AE has clarified to the iTAP that the process will be based on consensus and agreement by climate change and education stakeholders, as well as the willingness of a suitable hosting organization to support the platform.

41. BRACE also proposes to bring together ministries of education and environment in external forums (including COP 30) for lesson-sharing. The proposal envisages that these meetings will result in a road map to support implementation of the "Declaration on the Common Agenda for Education and Climate Change" launched at COP 28. The iTAP suggests that the project considers whether a BRACE-funded platform offers the most suitable avenue, or whether existing platforms, such as the GPE-type funding arrangement which, given its extended reach, may be better placed to facilitate such a process. The AE has clarified that the development of an education sector guide for GCF (activity 3.2.2), drawing on the experience of implementation in the three BRACE focus countries, is in response to a request from GCF.

42. Overall, the iTAP assesses the paradigm shift potential as medium.

1.4 Sustainable development potential

Scale: High

43. BRACE is aligned with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), specifically SDG 4: quality education for all; and SDG 5: achieve gender equality and empower all women and girls. It is also aligned with SDG 6: ensure availability and sustainable management of water and sanitation for all; SDG 11: sustainable cities and communities; and SDG 13: take urgent action to combat climate change and its impacts.

44. BRACE is designed to deliver three co-benefits of gender equity and social inclusion, environmental, and increased locally-led adaptation. Although the funding proposal does not specify economic co-benefits, in the view of the iTAP, investment in human capital could deliver economic benefits to countries in the long term. Fewer school closures due to extreme weather events could enable children to attend school more regularly and improve learning outcomes, thereby improving longer-term human capital development.

45. **Co-benefit 1: Gender equity and social inclusion.** The funding proposal indirectly targets 4,128,574 females during implementation, with the co-benefits to be mainly delivered through activities under Component 1. The iTAP notes some variations in these figures across the funding proposal and understands that these will be clarified during project inception. A gendered approach to design and implementation of retrofitted school infrastructure and WASH facilities is likely to benefit girls and boys, by providing access to separate toilet facilities, also suitable for children with disabilities, as well as menstrual hygiene kits for girls. School facilities are also likely to benefit the wider community – for instance, when these are used as shelters during extreme weather events or during community forums. The integration of gender and social inclusion aspects in school training and management practices, in climate and education policies, plans, and standards, and the provision of additional support to girls and children with disabilities to meaningfully participate in BRACE events and decision-making processes could help to empower schoolchildren and deliver wider gender-inclusive benefits for communities. The Gender Assessment and Action Plan (annex 8), clearly sets out country-level analysis of gender gaps, provides recommendations, and establishes a gender action plan that spans all three component areas.

46. **Co-benefit 2: Environmental.** The co-benefits will mainly be delivered through activities under Component 1, which is focused on promoting a clean and green environment in targeted schools. A broad set of practices for school greening – such as through reduced emissions from school infrastructure through the use of sustainable materials, improvement in WASH facilities and waste management systems, installation of solar panels for lighting and connectivity, and initiatives such as tree planting and water-efficient irrigation systems for shading, windbreak and cooling effects could help to make schools more environmentally sustainable and reduce their carbon footprint. Other initiatives, such as supporting school food gardens, could encourage wider community participation and uptake of environmental management practices.

47. The environmental and social assessment and residual risk-management plan (annex 6) provides an assessment of risks and impacts, confirms an assessment of Category C (low risk), and sets out actions to avoid or reduce any adverse environmental or social risks. It also sets out a list of excluded activities that could entail medium to high risks.

48. **Co-benefit 3: Increased locally-led adaptation (social).** The co-benefits will be delivered by activities across all three components. The project proposes an inclusive approach that will involve engaging with a wide set of local stakeholders, including school children, resident teachers, and parents/community members, through activities such as developing and implementing school safety plans, child-led clubs, and the use of knowledge platforms and dissemination of guidance materials. Devolved decision-making processes can help to empower local stakeholders and provide opportunities for increased voice and participation in taking climate action. Communities also stand to benefit as retrofitted schools sustain less damage and can provide safe shelters for communities during extreme climate and weather events.

49. In its written response to the iTAP, the AE confirmed that BRACE aligns with the Principles for Locally Led Adaptation, in particular, and to varying extents, with Principles 1: devolved decision-making at the school level through clubs; 2: addressing structural inequalities faced by children; 4: investing in local capabilities; 5: building a robust understanding of climate risk; 7: ensuring transparency and accountability; and 8: collaborative action. It also outlines indicators in the monitoring and evaluation framework that capture

relevant information on the perceived value of engagement by children and their families in each country.

50. The sustainable development potential is strong, but the benefits could vary across all three participating countries due to context-specific barriers, social norms, and capacities and responsiveness of school authorities, students and local communities to engage with project activities. The sustainable development potential of the project is assessed as high.

1.5 Needs of the recipient

Scale: High

51. All three participating countries have multiple developmental challenges that compound the obstacles faced by the education sector. Cambodia, a lower middle-income country, has limited educational opportunities, high income inequality and poor job prospects. According to the Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative (ND-GAIN) 2022, Cambodia ranks as the 149th most vulnerable country out of 187, and the Global Climate Risk Index ranks Cambodia as the 14th most climate risk prone country globally.¹⁰ Although Tonga is considered an upper middle-income country, it is experiencing rising rates of poverty and inequality among the most vulnerable groups, and remains reliant on development assistance, foreign aid and loans. According to the ND-GAIN (2021), South Sudan is the eighth most vulnerable country in the world to climate shocks. It also ranks seventh worldwide in children's exposure to climate change and environmental shocks, and most schools in South Sudan are in areas prone to conflict, drought and flood.¹¹

52. Annex 2 of the funding proposal highlights the vulnerability of school children and other community members to climate-related adaptation gaps. It also clearly sets out proposed adaptation actions supported by BRACE towards minimizing the climate vulnerability of schools in Cambodia (pages 79–84), South Sudan (page 175), and Tonga (page 267) respectively. These are responsive to the country context and particular needs of the education sector.

53. The education sector often remains underfunded by public sector resources due to economic challenges and other competing priorities. Limited access to financial resources, and limited institutional capacities hinder the ability of education authorities to take effective climate action. Ministries of education and schools lack resources to develop a holistic approach to planning and operations that can support strengthened resilience of schools to climate risks. Consequently, climate-related education impacts are likely to worsen, contributing to further vulnerability of school children and their school facilities, and the whole education system.

54. The project is designed to be inclusive and follows Save the Children's nine principles for meaningful and ethical children's participation¹² across its global programmes, advocacy, and campaigns. As in paragraph 15 above, the selection criteria will prioritize schools with the highest proportions of students from vulnerable groups and where interventions are likely to reduce inequality and enhance inclusive access to safe, climate-resilient learning environments or emergency shelters.

55. Overall, the iTAP assesses the needs of the recipient as high.

1.6 Country ownership

Scale: Medium

¹⁰ Global Climate Risk Index, 2021

https://www.germanwatch.org/sites/default/files/Global%20Climate%20Risk%20Index%202021_2.pdf

¹¹ UNICEF: The climate crisis is a child rights crisis. <https://www.unicef.org/southsudan/climate-crisis-child-rights-crisis#:~:text=South%20Sudan%20is%20ranked%20number,a%20recent%20global%20UNICEF%20Report>.

¹² The Nine Basic Requirements for Meaningful and Ethical Children's Participation, available at Save the Children, Child Rights Resource Centre. <https://resourcecentre.savethechildren.net/document/nine-basic-requirements-meaningful-and-ethical-childrens-participation>

56. No-objection letters have been received from the national designated authorities of all three participating countries (annexes 1a, 1b and 1c to the funding proposal). Co-finance letters of commitment have been received for a total of USD 5,986,076 from GPE (USD 4,986,076) (annex 13a),¹³ as well as from UNICEF (USD 500,000) (annex 13b) and the World Bank (USD 500,000) (annex 13c). The iTAP understands from the AE that, although not captured within the financial framework, the project will benefit from meaningful in-kind contributions from the ministries of education in each participating country.

57. **Alignment with national priorities.** The funding proposal and annex 2 describe the project's alignment with national climate change strategies and education policies of all three participating countries. This essentially demonstrates that project activities will directly contribute to the broader climate adaptation goals of the three countries by helping to ensure that educational continuity is maintained despite increasing climate risks. It is intended to achieve this by focusing on improving the climate resilience of school infrastructure, integrating climate change education into curricula, and enhancing disaster preparedness.

58. The iTAP has extracted from the main funding proposal, some of the key country priorities with which the project is aligned, as summarized in table 2 below.

Table 2: Alignment with country climate change priorities, gender policies

Country	Country climate change plans and national policies
Cambodia	• Cambodia Climate Change Strategic Plan 2014–2023 • National action plan for disaster risk reduction • Gender Mainstreaming Strategic Plan in Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management • The National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan • The Comprehensive School Safety Framework and the Child-Friendly School Program
South Sudan	• Alignment with the national adaptation plan and the nationally determined contributions, prioritizing climate adaptation in education • Alignment with the National Gender Policy, to ensure that gender perspectives are integrated into all aspects of climate adaptation and disaster risk reduction
Tonga	• Tonga Climate Change Policy: A Resilient Tonga by 2035 • Strategic Development Framework for Tonga 2015–2025 • The Joint National Action Plan for Climate Change Adaptation and Disaster Risk Management 2018–2028, • Alignment with the national education policy framework, to ensure that interventions are inclusive of all genders and children with disabilities.

Source: Summarized from the BRACE funding proposal.

59. Each of the three participating countries reference the education sector in some capacity either in their country national adaptation plans (NAPs) and/or nationally determined contributions (NDCs). The updated NDC (2020) for Cambodia identifies four actions in the education sector related to upgrading school curricula to include climate change, and for delivering training. The support by BRACE to the establishment of a platform for knowledge exchange and coordination across relevant ministries is intended to facilitate the implementation of climate education and disaster risk management within the education sector. The NDC for South Sudan (updated 2021) does not include a special focus on education, but identifies climate change activities, that can be integrated into the school curriculum, such as increasing the understanding of climate change broadly as well as upgrading school

¹³ GPE co-finance includes USD 986,076 for the three participating countries and a GPE multiplier allocation of USD 4 million for South Sudan for an associated programme with an anticipated USD 12 million of planned co-financing from GCF resources.

infrastructure to be more resilient to climate change impacts.¹⁴ In Tonga, school safety and climate resilient education are a priority within the Tonga Education Policy Framework. The second Joint National Action Plan includes a focus on incorporating climate resilience topics into school curricula.

60. A lingering concern for the iTAP is that the integration of climate into the education sector may be relatively nascent, and that other urgent issues may take priority particularly in a resource-constrained environment.

61. The AE has gone on to clarify to the iTAP that all three countries include climate change in their education sector plans, signalling the importance of addressing this issue in the education sector, despite the limited funding available to date. Alongside the GPE-funded CSESI, the BRACE project proposes to address this gap by helping to guide integration of climate change issues in the education sector, by enabling ministries of education to engage in NAP processes, through support for the development and implementation of climate finance mobilization road maps, and by strengthening coordination on climate change within the education ministry and with other line ministries.

62. **Partnerships and stakeholder engagement.** The AE clarified to the iTAP that all activities were identified with and by the ministries of education through CSESI workshops, as well as during consultation meetings with other government agencies and partners during the design of the BRACE project.

63. The proposal has rightly identified that the successful implementation of BRACE depends on strong partnerships with government ministries and local authorities in each country. Counterpart government agencies for each participating country are listed in the funding proposal. For instance, in South Sudan, the Ministry of General Education and Instruction, the Ministry of Environment, and the Ministry of Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Management will provide strategic oversight and ensure alignment with national priorities; in Cambodia, the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sport will lead the project implementation; and in Tonga, the Ministry of Education and Training and the Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications will provide leadership and ensure that BRACE aligns with national climate adaptation goals. However, in the view of the iTAP, the proposal lacks detail on the actual extent of their involvement during project implementation, and iTAP understands that this is intended to be developed during project inception.

64. The iTAP considers the Ministries of Finance as important stakeholders in any process to secure climate finance for the education sector (Component 2). The AE has clarified to the iTAP that Ministries of Finance were engaged in the critical foundational work of CSESI and have signalled support to the BRACE project. The AE also positively acknowledged iTAP's suggestions to further incorporate and integrate Ministries of Finance into project activities, as well as in project oversight and governance structures.

65. Alignment with complementary projects and initiatives for each participating country has been documented in the funding proposal package, showing how BRACE activities could potentially align with wider climate and education related interventions.

66. Annex 7 to the funding proposal summarizes the overall approach to the stakeholder engagement plan. The project categorizes stakeholders into three groups including those directly impacted, indirectly impacted, and other relevant stakeholders. The proposal confirms that design involved consultations between February and July 2024 with government officials, development partners, communities, civil society, and private sector entities.

¹⁴ South Sudan's Second Nationally Determined Contributions (2021).
<https://unfccc.int/sites/default/files/NDC/2022-06/South%20Sudan%27s%20Second%20Nationally%20Determined%20Contribution.pdf>

67. The project has a process in place to continue consultations during implementation, with multiple methods to reach diverse stakeholder groups. This includes consultations with local-level authorities and communities during the project's inception phase, with separate stakeholder engagement plans for each participating country. Separate consultation meetings are planned for women, youth, children and people with disabilities, with sufficient notice for participants to prepare and provide input to the project. The AE has also clarified that regular stakeholder engagement processes will be used to engage with and monitor the continued willingness of country stakeholders to prioritize the project.

68. **Capacities of the accredited and executing entities to deliver.** SCA has been accredited to GCF since November 2019, with cumulative GCF funding of approximately USD 191.34 million.¹⁵ SCA has over 15 years of experience of working with ministries of education to integrate both disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation into education sector policies, plans and programming. Its wide networks within the education and climate sectors make it well placed to lead the delivery of the BRACE project and to leverage the larger GPE CSESI initiative. Governance and project implementation arrangements will be established in each country. High-level project steering committees, co-chaired by SCA and government in each country, will provide strategic direction.

69. Overall, country ownership of the project is assessed as medium.

1.7 Efficiency and effectiveness

Scale: Medium

70. The programme will be implemented over a period of 5 years, with a project lifespan of 10 years. The total project funding of USD 46,737,340 comprises a request for GCF grant funds of USD 40,751,264 with expected co-financing of USD 5,986,076 inclusive of funding from CSESI (USD 4,986,076), the World Bank (USD 500,000) and the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) (USD 500,000).

71. The funding proposal argues that this low co-finance ratio of 1:0.85 is justified given the public nature of these interventions in a context where public finance budgets in all three countries are highly constrained. The allocation of resources across the three participating countries and the three component areas are set out in table 3 below.

Table 3: BRACE project budget by component

Project component	Total component budget (USD million)	GCF grant contribution (USD million)	GCF funds as a proportion of the total GCF budget
Component 1: Building climate-resilient school infrastructure and systems	38,681,711	34,060,896	83.6%
Component 2: Enhancing access to climate finance for education	1,090,903	673,903	1.7%
Component 3: Coordination and knowledge-sharing on climate and education	2,352,105	2,063,905	5.0%
Monitoring and evaluation	2,215,013	1,965,939	4.8%
Project management costs	2,397,607	1,986,621	4.9%
Totals:	46,737,340	40,751,264	100%

Note: The totals represent figures that have been rounded off by the AE.

Source: Data has been extracted from the funding proposal, and budgets in annexes 4 and 17a.

72. **Additionality of GCF resources.** BRACE brings additionality by equipping under-funded education systems in the three countries for climate change adaptation. As education is considered a public good, annex 3a also notes the potential for BRACE to offer economic and

¹⁵ More details available at: <https://www.greenclimate.fund/ae/sca>

developmental benefits in the longer term. Table 1 of the economic and financial analysis (annex 3a) emphasizes the scarcity of public funding for climate adaptation and for the education sector in all three countries, and notes that financing for climate action is heavily reliant on grant funding. All three countries are likely to continue to face significant budgetary constraints, and current resources are unlikely to be able to tackle the climate vulnerabilities faced by the education sector.

73. Approximately 51 per cent of GCF resources will finance climate-proofing of schools as a sub-activity under Component 1. The improvements of school facilities under output 1.2 could include: cooling systems (Cambodia, Tonga); improved ventilation (South Sudan); solar photovoltaic systems to improve access to renewable energy, lighting and internet connectivity (Tonga); providing shade through tree planting within (South Sudan); rainwater harvesting; upgrading of drinking water systems, handwashing stations and latrines (annex 6).

74. As other development partners and national education programmes finance school infrastructure improvements and WASH facilities in these countries, the iTAP sought clarification from the AE regarding the additionality of GCF resources. Specifically in the context of climate-proofing school infrastructure, the iTAP noted that GCF funding should complement and create synergies with the work of other donors to maximize the overall impact and effectiveness of BRACE interventions. The AE has clarified that all BRACE activities will be climate additional and are based on climate impacts, risks, country contexts and stakeholder engagement, as opposed to meeting general educational development needs. The iTAP considers that it will be important for the project to track the additionality of GCF resources during implementation.

75. An ex-ante assessment of economic benefits was conducted for each participating country applying Representative Concentration Pathway (RCP) scenarios RCP 4.5 and 8.5. The economic and financial analysis, based on a 15-year horizon and utilizing a conservative discount rate of 9 per cent, showed economic rates of return of 35 to 36 per cent.

76. **Sustainability and exit strategy.** The overall exit strategy demonstrates a commitment to sustainability by enabling a transition to local ownership, integrating climate adaptation efforts within education sector planning and policy, and scaling of proven practices into national systems. Support to education ministries to develop a road map to access climate finance under Component 2 will be critical to sustainability. Similarly, the platform to be developed under Component 3, could provide an ongoing forum for stakeholder coordination. In the view of the iTAP, given the different country contexts, the project should develop specific exit strategies for each of the three countries with key milestones, else there is a risk that project efforts may stall over time. The institutional readiness of the ministries of education to take on wider shifts and any emerging risks should also be built into the exit strategies.

77. **Operations and maintenance (O&M):** The project envisages equipping local stakeholders to manage ongoing maintenance of project infrastructure. For instance, O&M is envisaged to be undertaken through community-led maintenance committees (South Sudan), by training school staff and linking to broader school safety management systems (Cambodia), and by providing basic training to school staff on problem solving and maintenance. The iTAP recommends that the project develops a fully costed O&M plan that is agreed with local stakeholders so that these are well resourced and implementable.

78. **Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E):** The initial M&E plan is clearly set out (annex 11), with an allocation of USD 2.5 million. A full M&E plan is proposed to be developed during the inception phase in collaboration with project M&E staff in each of the three countries and in compliance with the Save the Children Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning Framework. The establishment of robust baselines, proposed to be done during inception, will be important for assessing project impact across all three countries. The M&E plan will need to take into account risks related to data availability and quality particularly as this spans national

and school levels, institutional capacities, and feedback loops for learning to inform project implementation. The project should also ensure that M&E systems are aligned with data systems of each of the countries to promote ownership and sustainability.

79. Overall, the iTAP assesses the efficiency and effectiveness potential as medium.

II. Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel

80. If approved by the Board, this would be the first GCF climate project in the education sector. The iTAP considers that the BRACE project addresses a critical and underserved area. It offers an opportunity to embed climate adaptation into national education systems and to build the adaptive capacity and climate resilience of communities in the three participating countries that are vulnerable to climate change. As BRACE is piloting this approach in three countries across three different contexts, the alignment with the GPE CSEI initiative is a positive feature of the project and offers the potential for wider learning, scaling and replicability, and to elevate the urgency of addressing climate risks in the education sector at a global level.

81. The iTAP also proposes recommendations to the AE as follows:

- (a) Put in place adequate safeguards to ensure that school infrastructure upgrades achieve positive climate impact for children and that there are no negative spillover effects (see paragraph 27 above);
- (b) Develop a financial sustainability plan that extends beyond a reliance on GCF funding and seeks wider to leverage wider sources of funding (see paragraph 37 above);
- (c) Develop a fully costed O&M plan that is agreed with local stakeholders so that these are well resourced and implementable (see paragraph 77 above); and
- (d) Detail the overall M&E approach, with proper baselines, so that it is fit-for-purpose across contexts, can be used for adaptive management during implementation, demonstrates the value of climate-resilient education systems (see paragraph 78 above), and can track the additionality of GCF resources (see paragraph 74 above).

82. The iTAP recommends that the Board approve this funding proposal.

Response from the accredited entity to the independent Technical Advisory Panel's assessment (FP274)

Proposal name:	Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)
Accredited entity:	Save the Children Australia
Countries:	Cambodia, South Sudan, Tonga
Project size:	Small

Impact potential
Thank you for the medium to high ranking and for your supportive comments. We note that the iTAP has observed a slight variance in the total number of direct beneficiaries. We would like to confirm that the 607,098 refers to Component 1 beneficiaries, whereas the figure of 608,193 (which is stated in Section A of the Funding Proposal) refers to the total beneficiaries across all three Components of BRACE. As you highlight in your comments, these figures will also be verified during the inception phase.
Paradigm shift potential
Thank you for the medium ranking and for your comments. We appreciate your comments across the three components of BRACE and will certainly take these into account throughout the inception phase and implementation.
Sustainable development potential
Thank you for the high ranking and for your comments.
Needs of the recipient
Thank you for the high ranking and for your comments.
Country ownership
Thank you for the medium ranking and for your comments.
Efficiency and effectiveness
Thank you for the medium ranking and for your comments.

We note and thank you for the recommendation to prepare exit strategies for the three countries with clear milestones to mitigate the risk of the project efforts stalling over time. We will certainly take this forward in the inception phase and during implementation.

Overall remarks from the independent Technical Advisory Panel:

We really appreciate your insightful remarks and your recommendations. We have provided the following remarks to your recommendations:

Put in place adequate safeguards

- Thank you for this important recommendation. Negative spillover effects are not expected and not common practice in public good asset upgrades within the Ministry of Educations generally. However, safeguards under the project will be put in place to track this, including within our regular monitoring systems and safeguarding practices.

Develop a financial sustainability plan.

- Thank you for the recommendation. As you highlight above, this will be a key focus of the BRACE project. We see this as taking shape during the climate finance roadmaps developed and implemented in Component 2, and the coordination mechanism in Component 3. It is our aim to ensure that Ministries of Education are enabled under BRACE to continue this work in future and can leverage wider sources of funding.

Develop a fully costed O&M plan.

- We agree for the need of O&M plans for the school that will receive infrastructure support from BRACE. Like cars, buildings require regular maintenance to function as intended for as long as possible. Each school, once retrofitted, will be issued with an operation and maintenance plan developed with school management and Parent Teacher Associations, accompanied by the relevant training. These plans will be collated and provided to the Ministries of Education along with cost estimates for works that surpass the capacity of voluntary contributions of the school communities.

Detail the overall M&E approach

- As you rightly highlight in your comments, a draft M&E plan was submitted and a key inception phase activity will be to develop the final M&E plan and approach, in coordination with M&E teams in each country, as well as with government. We are fully committed to preparing baselines for each country that can also be used to support adaptive management, the value of climate-resilient education systems, and the additionality of GCF resources.



Save the Children

Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE)

Annex 8: Gender Assessment and Action Plan

Accredited Entity: Save the Children Australia

Version for B.42: 2025/05/09

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Acronyms

CCRI	Children's Climate Risk Index
CEDAW	UN Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women
CEFMU	Child, Early and Forced Marriage and Unions
CIS	Climate Information Systems
COP	Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC
CPIA	Country Policy and Institutional Assessment Gender Equality Rating
CPRD	UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities
CRC	UN Convention on the Rights of the Child
CSESI	Climate-Smart Education Systems Initiative
DAC	Disability Action Council (DAC) - Cambodia
DRR	Disaster Risk Reduction
EPP	Emergency Preparedness Plans
ESWG	Education Sector Working Group
EWS	Early Warning System
FGM	Female Genital Mutilation
FPA	Family Protection Act - Tonga
GBV	Gender-Based Violence
GESI	Gender Equality and Social Inclusion
GPE	Global Partnership for Education
IDPs	Internally Displaced Persons
INEE	Inter-agency Network for Education in Emergencies
IPCC	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
IPV	Intimate Partner Violence
KHM	Cambodia
LGBTQI+	Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender, Queer and Intersex
MoEYS	Ministry of Education, Youth and Sport - Cambodia
MoGCSW	Ministry of Gender, Child, and Social Welfare – South Sudan
MoSVY	Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth Rehabilitation – Cambodia
MoWA	Ministry of Women's Affairs - Cambodia
NAP	National Adaptation Plan
NCDM	National Committee for Disaster Management - Cambodia
NDC(s)	Nationally Determined Contribution
ND-GAIN	Notre Dame-Global Adaptation Index
NDSP	National Disability Strategic Plan – Cambodia
NGOs	Non-Governmental Organisations
PTA	Parent, Teacher Association
PVs	Photovoltaic Systems or solar panels
RNPGAD	Revised National Policy on Gender and Development - Tonga
SCI	Save the Children International
SDG	Sustainable Development Goals
SGBV	Sexual and Gender-Based Violence
SMC	School Management Committee
SOGIESC	Sexual Orientation, Gender Identity, Gender Expression and Sex Characteristics
SOPs	Standard Operating Procedures
SRHR	Sexual and Reproductive Health and Rights
SSD	South Sudan
UNFCCC	UN Framework Convention on Climate Change
WASH	Water, Sanitation and Hygiene
WEGET	National Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Tonga Policy 2019-2025

Introduction

- 1) The Building the Climate Resilience of Children and Communities through the Education Sector (BRACE) project aims to improve the adaptive capacities and climate resilience of children, their communities and schools, recognising that children and their communities are impacted by climate change differently depending on many intersecting factors including, but not limited to, their age, gender, disability, ethnicity, race, economic status, refugee status and gender identity.
- 2) The rationale for the BRACE project is to tackle the impacts of climate change on the education sector in three very different countries with diverse climate hazards and social contexts: Cambodia, South Sudan, and Tonga. By implementing an approach in three very different countries, BRACE will be able to demonstrate an adaptable model that can be replicated in other countries. BRACE will also support Ministries of Education to access climate finance, and support the global education community to better coordinate, collaborate and share lessons learned and experience with a focus on climate finance. If this intervention does not happen, the Business as Usual will result in increased climate vulnerability, school closures, children dropping out of school, gender inequality, and learning loss.
- 3) BRACE will be achieved via implementation of activities under three components, each with an associated outcome:
 - **Component 1:** Building Climate-Resilient School Infrastructure and Systems with outputs and activities leading to **Outcome 1** – The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.
 - **Component 2:** Enhancing Access to Climate Finance for Education, with outputs and activities leading to **Outcome 2** – Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change
 - **Component 3:** Coordination and Knowledge Sharing on Climate and Education, with outputs and activities leading to Outcome 3 – Education and climate stakeholders are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector.
- 4) For the BRACE Theory of Change, please see [Appendix A](#).
- 5) This analysis considers the ways in which gender and social norms intersect with adaptive capacities and climate change across Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga. The assessment sets out key data and analysis across five domains and includes recommendations for the project across all project components. The core approach is to embed gender equality and social inclusion (GESI) across project activities and operations. The Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Action Plan highlights GESI actions included in the project wide logical framework for the three countries as well as Components 2 and 3.
- 6) The five domains of analysis are:
 - Domain 1: Laws, Policies and Institutions
 - Domain 2: Social Norms, Roles, Responsibilities and Time Use
 - Domain 3: Participation, Leadership and Decision-Making
 - Domain 4: Access To and Control Over Resources and Services
 - Domain 5: Safety, Dignity and Well-Being
- 7) The Gender Equality and Social Inclusion Action Plan is a strategic framework designed to ensure that gender equality, women and girls' empowerment and social inclusion are systematically integrated into the BRACE project. Its primary goal is to address gender disparities and promote equitable outcomes for all. This plan, which will be further refined at the project's onset and throughout its implementation, provides a foundation for action.
- 8) Based on the assessment, the project will include measures to avoid, minimize, and mitigate any adverse gender impacts or risks. Additionally, it will implement positive actions to promote gender equality and empower children in all their diversity through the

education sector. An initial action plan has been developed, detailing responsibilities, indicators, targets, and a budget.

Methodology

- 9) The gender assessment and action plan were prepared by the feasibility teams located in Cambodia, South Sudan and Tonga as well GESI specialists in the countries and regions. It was developed in line with the GCF Gender Policy, Gender Mainstreaming Guide, Save the Children International (SCI) Gender Equality and Inclusion Policies, and country-level SCI Gender Equality and Inclusion Action Plans. The teams used a combination of primary and secondary data collection methods as explained below.
- 10) The availability of data varied across countries given the different contexts. Where possible, data was collected across countries to show similarities and comparisons to facilitate the development and implementation of the Gender Action Plan.
- 11) **Primary data:**
 - Primary data were collected in South Sudan and Tonga.
 - **South Sudan:** Data were collected through existing gender assessments conducted across ongoing SCI South Sudan projects. This involved direct engagement through key informant interviews with national, state and local Government of South Sudan Ministries of Education and Gender, parents, teachers, civil society organisations and the wider community including girls and women. For ongoing education programs such as the South Sudan Joint Response, Norwegian Agency for Development Cooperation (NORAD), and the Education Cannot Wait (ECW) Multi-Year Resilience Programme rapid gender and needs assessments were conducted with girls, women, boys and men between October 2023 and June 2024. These assessments were carried out through focus group discussions and observations in two project sites: Maban County, Upper Nile State, and Akobo County, Jonglei State. Standard questions were used, adapted for local languages and for people with disabilities. Please see [Appendix B](#) for a consultations overview for South Sudan.
 - **Tonga:** Primary data were gathered through direct engagement using key informant interviews with national government officials, civil society organisations, women-led and gender-diverse groups, youth-focused organisations, international development agencies, donors, and academics. This includes senior officials from Tonga Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications, Ministry of Internal Affairs, Ministry of Education, regional and national academic institutions.
- 12) **Secondary data:**
 - Across the three countries and at global level for Components 2 and 3, secondary data were collected from a variety of sources, including government reports, research reports, websites, academic publications and programme reports and evaluations and are cited throughout the assessment. This includes the inception reports of initial countries under the Global Partnership for Education (GPE) funded Climate-Smart Education Systems Initiative (CSESI) which is linked to Component 2.
- 13) **Gender Action Plan development:**
 - The GAP was developed aligned directly with the overall project logframe. The activities outlined in the GAP correlate to the project logframe. There are no activities for output 1.1 for Tonga as they are not implementing output 1 in the overall project.
 - The budget was calculated by creating an excel sheet that detailed 1) all the staff times for those working on GESI and child protection, and 2) activity costs across countries for all three components. We then estimated what percentage of the

budget would be needed to conduct the GESI activities highlighted in the workplan per country per activity.

- For example , under activity 1.3.1 on capacity building we added up the staff times of those budgeted to be working on GESI (Gender Adviser, GESI Coordinator, Child Participation Adviser) in Cambodia and South Sudan = \$18,933. Tonga doesn't have activities under 1.3.1. The total costs for this activity across the two countries was \$415,282. We assumed about 10% of the budget for this activity would be needed to be allocated to GESI based on the GAP – i.e. \$41,528. This combined with the staff times = \$60,461.
- The staff times and percentage of activities assumed to go to GESI is calculated per activity and varies across them.

Global Findings on Gender Equality and Social Inclusion and Climate Change

- 14) The social impacts of climate change are not distributed equally but depend on intersecting factors such as gender, economic status, cultural norms, age, refugee status, race, ethnic group, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression and sex characteristics (SOGIESC) status etc. Children are shown to be at higher risk than adults of illness, injury and psychosocial trauma, water insecurity, inadequate sanitation and poor hygiene.¹
- 15) Women and children and particularly adolescent girls are more likely to be living in poverty, have less access to knowledge and education, are more likely to be malnourished and may have greater responsibility and difficulty accessing water and other natural resources.² These responsibilities are likely to increase when men are forced to migrate for better work.
- 16) Girls face the double burden of gender- and age-based discrimination. Girls are also more likely to have lower levels of education and fewer financial resources than boys and men³ and discriminatory gender norms mean they are less likely to be involved in political, community, and household decision-making.⁴ Crises can increase sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV), domestic abuse and intimate partner violence (IPV).⁵ Studies have highlighted a spike in gender-based violence (GBV) and sexual assault during and after extreme weather events.⁶
- 17) Girls must therefore adapt and respond to the impacts of climate change in addition to the gender and age-related risks they face every day such as (S)GBV, child, early and forced marriage and unions (CEFMU), lack of access to education, and adolescent pregnancy. Further, other forms of discrimination mean girls with disabilities, Indigenous girls, girls living in poverty, conflict or displaced settings, or girls from ethnic minorities face additional challenges in responding to climate change.
- 18) Gender and social discriminatory norms and stereotypes can dictate the receptivity of policymakers to the engagement and participation of girls, Indigenous Peoples, people with diverse SOGIESC, people with disabilities, and those living in poverty, conflict or displacement. This can result in policies and programmes that do not address the specific vulnerabilities of these groups and can exacerbate inequality.

Education

- 19) Climate shocks can disrupt girls' education which is widely recognised as a protective factor against CEFMU.⁷ Estimates suggest that if climate trends continue, by 2025 climate change would contribute to 12.5 million girls each year not completing their education.⁸ Girls' education has been identified as key to building resilience to the impacts of climate change - for every additional year of schooling for girls on average, a country's Notre Dame-Global Adaptation Index (ND-GAIN) score could be expected to increase by 3.2 points.⁹

¹ UNICEF, 2015. Unless we act now: the impact of climate change on children. Available [here](#).

² Plan International, 2021. Climate Change, Young Women, and Girls. Accessible [here](#).

³ UN WomenWatch, n.d. Factsheet: Women, Gender Equality and Climate Change. Available [here](#).

⁴ UNDP, 2016. Gender and Climate Change. Available [here](#).

⁵ van Daalen, K.R. et al., 2022. Extreme events and gender-based violence: A mixed methods systematic review, *Lancet Planet Health*, 6:6, p.519.

⁶ Rezwana, N. and Pain, R., 2020. Gender-based violence before, during, and after cyclones: Slow violence and layered disasters, *Disasters*, 45:4, p.741

⁷ Girls Not Brides, 2022. Girls' Education and Child Marriage. Available [here](#).

⁸ Malala Fund, 2021. A Greener, Fairer Future: Why leaders need to invest in climate and girls' education'. Available [here](#).

⁹ Kwauk, C & Braga, A., 2017. Three platforms for girls' education in climate strategies. Available [here](#).

- 20) Countries that have focused on girls' equal access to education have suffered fewer losses from droughts and floods than those with lower levels of girls' education.¹⁰

Child, early and forced marriage and unions (CEFMU)

- 21) Analysis of historical data shows that a 10% increase or decrease in rainfall is associated with a 1% increase in CEFMU, globally.¹¹ New analysis by Save the Children shows that globally almost 9 million girls face extreme risk of climate disasters and CEFMU every year and that around two-thirds of CEFMU happen in regions with higher-than-average climate risks.¹² To illustrate this risk, in parts of Ethiopia worst hit by drought and food shortages, rates of CEFMU rose by 119% in 2022 compared to 2021.¹³
- 22) Gender inequality is the root cause of CEFMU, but other risk factors increase the likelihood of a girl being married. These include being out-of-school, living in poverty, food shortages, being pregnant or having a baby and exposure to other forms of GBV. Climate disasters and the long-term impacts of the climate crisis can increase these risk factors.¹⁴ For example, disasters can lead to school closures and loss of income for families. GBV also increases during crises and families may decide to remove girls from school or have them marry to keep them safe from violence or to make sure their daughters are provided for by another family.

Climate Change Risk and Policies

- 23) The Children's Climate Risk Index (CCRI)¹⁵ indicates that almost every child is exposed to at least one major climate change or environmental hazard and 2.2 billion children are exposed to at least two overlapping environmental issues. The same index reveals that children are less able to protect themselves from immediate danger and more vulnerable to heat-related health risk, and lack of access to essential services.
- 24) In terms of gender, according to the 2022 Equal Measures 2030 Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) Gender Index, SDG13 on climate action is one of three goals that is furthest behind on gender equality issues.¹⁶ In 2016, a total of 64 of 190 nationally determined contributions (NDCs) included a reference to women or gender and all 64 countries that included a gender reference were non-Annex I ("developing") countries. Seven of the 14 updated NDCs analysed in 2020 include a reference to women or gender.¹⁷ Analysis in 2019, highlights that only one country's NDC makes a reference to girls' education and only two additional countries refer to girls explicitly, a reflection of the omission of the gendered climate impacts on children and education in climate strategies.¹⁸

¹⁰ Blankespoor, B. et al., 2010 Adaptation to climate extremes in developing countries: the role of education. Policy Research Working Paper 5342, The World Bank. Available [here](#).

¹¹ UNICEF, 2023. Is an End to Child Marriage within Reach? Available [here](#).

¹² Save the Children, 2023. Global Girlhood Report 2023: Girls at the Centre of the Storm – Her planet, her future, her solutions. Available [here](#).

¹³ UNICEF, 2022. Child marriage on the rise in Horn of Africa as drought crisis intensifies. Available [here](#).

¹⁴ Khan Foundation & ARROW, 2015. A Scoping Study. Women's Sexual & Reproductive Health and Rights (SRHR) and Climate Change: What is the Connection?; Bartlett, S., 2008. Climate change and urban children: impacts and implications for adaptation in low-and middle-income countries.

¹⁵ UNICEF, 2021. Children's Climate Risk Index. Available [here](#).

¹⁶ Equal Measures 2030, 2022. 2022 Equal Measures 2030 SDG Gender Index. Available [here](#).

¹⁷ Women's Environment and Development Organization (WEDO), 2020. Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment in Updated and New Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs). Available [here](#).

¹⁸ Kwauk, C., Cooke, J., Hara, E. and Pegram, J. 2019. Girls' Education in Climate Strategies: Opportunities for Improved Policy and Enhanced Action in Nationally Determined Contributions. Available [here](#).

Country Level Findings on Gender Equality and Social Inclusion

Key Findings

Cambodia:

- 25) Climate change disproportionately affects persons who are poor, women, children, and people with disabilities. Female employment in agriculture as share of total female employment is 55.4% in Cambodia¹⁹ with women primarily employed in low-paying manual labour. Because they depend on livelihoods that are sensitive to climate change, they are especially susceptible. Women, girls, men, and boys are all impacted differently by the socially assigned discriminatory gender roles and responsibilities at the household and community levels because of the traditional social roles and power hierarchies within the family that are deeply ingrained in society.
- 26) As more women work at home or in areas vulnerable to natural hazards, particularly floods, discriminatory gender stereotypes prevent them from acquiring the skills needed to adapt to a changing climate and lower the risk of disasters. Women are more burdened than men by issues such as food instability, fuel searching, and gathering clean water for household usage. Cultural norms are one of the main reasons why women are seen as a helpless and vulnerable group that requires protection from climate change and the disasters it brings about, as well as the reason why fewer women hold official positions in the fields of climate change adaptation and mitigation.
- 27) In addition, women's ongoing poverty, restricted access to reproductive and sexual health services related to pregnancy and delivery, lack of decision-making authority, and limited educational possibilities make them more sensitive to climate change than males. Women have less access than men to opportunities for information, education, and training in areas related to environmental preservation and conservation.
- 28) In addition to being less able to adapt to changes in climatic conditions due to their lower socioeconomic status, limited education, cultural norms, and restricted involvement in decision-making processes, women and girls living in poverty, indigenous women, women from ethnic, racial, religious, and sexual minority groups, and women with disabilities are frequently exposed to and vulnerable to climate change and disaster-induced risks.
- 29) The Asia Foundation states that because women are not included in water management decision-making, female-headed households, which make up 20% of rural households, face significant obstacles when trying to access agricultural land and irrigation water.²⁰ When disasters strike, households rely on women's knowledge to find water and properly treat it. In reality, because of their roles and experiences managing households and providing care for others, women possess the knowledge and abilities to adjust to changing environmental situations and find workable solutions. Long-term success in the fight to mitigate the harmful effects of climate change hinges on the acknowledgement of women's significant role and contribution as change agents.

South Sudan:

- 30) In South Sudan, women, men, boys and girls experience different socio-economic conditions. The less favourable situation of women and girls is related to socio-cultural factors, linked to the division of labour, which affect the possibility of access to education, training and technical advice, income generation, credit and land ownership. Women and girls experience the intersection of climate change and conflict in South Sudan in direct and profound ways. Since they are often the ones responsible for providing food, water,

¹⁹ Komatsu, H. et al., 2018. Does women's time in domestic work and agriculture affect women's and children's dietary diversity? Evidence from Bangladesh, Nepal, Cambodia, Ghana, and Mozambique. Available [here](#).

²⁰ The Asia Foundation, 2019. Water, Gender, and Poverty in Cambodia's Stung Chinit Watershed. Available [here](#).

and energy for their families, they face greater challenges in accessing these resources. Climate change has had an outsized impact on South Sudan, most recently with the largest flooding in Unity State in nearly 50 years. These extreme weather events, disaster-related displacement, the destruction or repurposing of educational buildings and the indirect economic pressures on families are having a negative impact on access to education at all levels, especially for young women and girls.

- 31) Conflict, however, adds to the insecurity, as many women and girls face increased risks of violence and insecurity carrying out basic tasks including their education. With greater social capital, men often have greater options for coping with the stresses of instability. Violent conflict tends to exacerbate existing inequalities and vulnerabilities.
- 32) The current peace-building phase in South Sudan offers an opportunity for promoting gender equity, advancing the position of women in the society, mainstreaming women's perspectives in all the pillars of peacebuilding and increasing their participation in leadership. However, the patriarchal nature of the South Sudanese society and the associated customary laws, the background on which peace-building works are to be executed, hinders women's participation in public life. These factors are exacerbated by the underlying lack of political will, limited funding, ethnic politics, weak institutions, and the high illiteracy rate among women. Further, these factors could be aggravated by the current political climate, while some of these issues are associated with the long-term problems of underdevelopment that South Sudan faces, any meaningful change requires immediate progress on all fronts.²¹
- 33) Lower education levels and limited access to specific training and information in turn limit prospects of economic empowerment and possibilities to generate income and make decisions about expenditures and resources. Indigenous women and girls face even greater discrimination. Within their own communities, they have less decision-making power than men over land use and less access to land. Cultural barriers have an enormous impact and are often difficult to overcome. Customs, traditions, beliefs and stereotypes still hamper the exercise of rights that have been explicitly recognised in the legal framework of the country.

Tonga:

- 34) The Kingdom of Tonga has a strong history of promoting gender equality and empowering women in leadership. This is in part due to their strong cultural connections and the important role elder women are given within cultural and community settings.²² This includes the heavy influence of the monarchy and crucial role of the Queen and Princesses of the Kingdom of Tonga being vital voices for gender equality.
- 35) Key informant consultations consistently revealed significant intergenerational shifts in gender equality commitments such as more women in the labour force and more equitable sharing of household and caregiving responsibilities. Notably, this progress has translated into improved family dynamics, and represents a substantial change from the past, where such tasks were traditionally seen as the exclusive domain of women.
- 36) Gender diverse people beyond the binary are part of Tongan socio-cultural systems - and were interviewed. There is broad cultural acceptance of the leiti community, a cultural group who have been at the core part of Tongan society. Leitis is an appropriation of the local word "fakaleiti" literally meaning "like a lady".
- 37) Despite diverse agency priorities, all stakeholders interviewed agree on the critical need to enhance education infrastructure and opportunities for Tongan children. This shared vision positions the BRACE project as a valuable opportunity to leverage existing efforts and evidence-based strategies for systemic improvements in children's educational outcomes.

²¹ Mai N., 2015. The Role of Women in Peace-building in South Sudan. Juba: The Sudd Institute. Available [here](#).

²² UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#).

38) The Ministry of Education and Training is the implementing agency of the Convention on the Rights of the Child has enforced that the age for compulsory education in Tonga is between 4 and 18 years of age in accordance with section 98(2) of the Education Act.²³

²³ United Nations General Assembly, 2023. National report submitted pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21*. *Human Rights Council Working Group on the Universal Periodic Review Forty-third session 1–12 May 2023*. Available [here](#).

Key Data

Demographic Data

Indicator	Cambodia	South Sudan	Tonga
Population	15,552,211 (7,980,374 females) of which 9,417,017 (60.55%) lived in rural areas	Total population is approximately 11.4 million with around 80% living in rural areas.	The population of the Kingdom of Tonga as of November 2021 was 100,179, with majority of the population residing across the islands of Tongatapu, Vavaú, Haápai, Éua and Ongo Niua. ²⁴
Age	Children aged under 15 accounted for 29.4% of the total population, people aged 15-59 accounted for 61.7%.	South Sudan has a youthful population, with 5.1 million (45%) of the population being children under the age of 18 and over 40% below the age of 15. The median age is 18.5 years, indicating a very young population. Approximately 55% of the population is of working age, between 15 and 64 years.	Based on Tonga's 2021 census, nearly 35% of its population is comprised of youth, with a median age of approximately 22. The population is relatively balanced, with approximately 49% identifying as male and 51% as female. The median age of females is slightly higher than males, at 24 and 20.7, respectively.
Gender balance	Of the total population, women and girls accounted for 51.31% ²⁵	South Sudan's population has a slight male majority, with 52% male and 48% female.	Tonga's population leans slightly female, with 51% identifying as female and 49% identifying as male according to the 2021 census.
Head of household	76.4% (or 2.9 million households) were headed by a man, while 23.6% (or 0.9 million households)	Approximately 32% of households are headed by women, largely due to the ongoing conflict and displacement. These women bear significant responsibilities, including both economic survival and caregiving duties.	In 2021, 22.1% of households were headed by women.

²⁴ Kingdom of Tonga, 2021. Population and Housing Census Report. Available [here](#).

²⁵ Kingdom of Cambodia, 2019. General Population Census of the Kingdom of Cambodia 2019 National Report. Available [here](#).

	were headed by a woman		
Gender Inequality Index ²⁶ (1= gender equal. 0 = not gender equal) ²⁷	0.461 116 th out of 170 countries	0.587 150 th out of 170 countries	0.580 149 th out of 170 countries
Country Policy and Institutional Assessment (CPIA) Gender Equality Rating ²⁸ (1=low to 6=high)	Cambodia's CPIA Gender Equality Rating is 4.0 out of 6	South Sudan's CPIA Gender Equality Rating stands at 1.5 out of 6. This rating reflects weaknesses in policy frameworks and institutional measures to promote gender equality, highlighting significant challenges in achieving gender parity across areas such as women's rights, access to education, economic opportunities, and legal protections.	Tonga's CPIA Gender Equality Rating is 3.0 out of 6.
Notre Dame Global Adaptation Initiative ranking (ND-GAIN) ²⁹	Ranks 149th	N/A	Ranks 140th

²⁶ UNDP (United Nations Development Programme), 2023. 2023 Gender Social Norms Index (GSNI): Breaking down gender biases: Shifting social norms towards gender equality. Available [here](#).

²⁷ The Gender Inequality Index (GII) reflects gender-based disadvantage in three dimensions— reproductive health, empowerment and the labour market—for as many countries as data of reasonable quality allow. It shows the loss in potential human development due to inequality between female and male achievements in these dimensions. It ranges from 0, where women and men fare equally, to 1, where one gender fares as poorly as possible in all measured dimensions.

²⁸ World Bank Group, 2023. Country Policy and Institutional Assessment (CPIA) Gender Equality Rating. Available [here](#).

²⁹ Available [here](#).

Education

Cambodia:

- 40) The percentage of female primary school teachers in Cambodia in 2022 was 58.90%, while at the lower secondary school it was 45.33%.³⁰
- 41) In 2021, the net enrolment rate reached 91.9% in primary school, against a target of 98.2%. The completion rate was 87.4%.³¹
- While the primary school *enrolment* rate between boys and girls differed only by 1.3 percentage points, the *completion* rate for girls was 8.2 percentage points higher than for boys.
 - The net admission rate at the lower secondary level was 68.6% and 39.3% at the upper secondary level.
 - Less than half (48.1%) of students completed lower secondary school.
 - Throughout the school cycle, girls achieve higher rates of completion than boys. In 2021, the gap between them was 10.3 percentage points at the lower secondary level, with boys reaching just 43.1% against girls' 53.4%.³²
- 42) According to the 2019 Cambodia Population Census³³ 86.2% of the population aged 15+ were literate in Khmer. This has increased from 67.3% in 1998. Gender parity in literacy was almost achieved in 2019 in this age group, at 89.3% for males versus 83.4% for females.

South Sudan:

- 43) The percentage of female pre-primary schoolteachers in South Sudan in 2021 was 63.5%. There was no further data for other school levels.³⁴
- 44) More girls than boys are out of school across all levels.³⁵ Percentage of girls and boys out of school:
- primary school level was 77% girls vs. 72% boys
 - Lower secondary school was 68.3% girls vs. 59.6% boys
 - Upper secondary school was 60% girls vs. 51.2% boys
- 45) Despite efforts from the Government of South Sudan and the international community, there is still limited access of girls and women to primary and higher education, especially in rural areas.
- 46) Low literacy rates are on the rise, with girls' education considered "taboo" in some South Sudanese states. In South Sudan only 34.4% of the population aged 15+ were literate which is the third lowest literacy rate in the world.³⁶
- 47) A lack of access to information and resources also mean South Sudanese women are largely unaware of their right to education. Girls are often excluded from educational opportunities and asked to take on domestic and caretaking responsibilities.³⁷

Tonga:

- 48) The percentage of female schoolteachers across primary and secondary schools in Tonga is 70%.³⁸
- 49) The out of school rate for primary schools in Tonga in 2023 was 4%. Of these 54% are boys.³⁹ Overall, this is the lowest out of school rate across the three countries.

³⁰ UNESCO Institute for Statistics, 2022. Available [here](#).

³¹ Education Sector Plan, Mid-Term Review.

³² UNICEF, 2023. An Analysis of the Situation of Children and Adolescents in Cambodia 2023. Available [here](#).

³³ Cambodia Population Census, 2019.

³⁴ UNESCO Institute for Statistics, 2022. Available [here](#).

³⁵ UNESCO, 2022. GAL Country Profile South Sudan. Available [here](#).

³⁶ UNESCO Institute for Statistics. Available [here](#).

³⁷ UNICEF, 2023. Getting girls back to the classroom after COVID-19 school closures (South Sudan) Case Study. Available [here](#).

³⁸ Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Available [here](#).

³⁹ UNICEF, 2023. Tonga Country Factsheet. Available [here](#).

50) According to the 2021 census, literacy levels in Tonga were high, with 96% of the population aged five and above able to read and write a simple sentence in Tongan and 89% able to read and write a simple sentence in English.⁴⁰

Sexual and Gender-Based Violence and Child Marriage

Cambodia:

- 51) Approximately 19% of girls and 15.4% of boys in Cambodia are married before they are 18 years old.⁴¹
- 52) Women and girls represent the vast majority of victims of SGBV. Available data gathered from two surveys in 2014 and 2015 cited in Cambodia's National Action Plan to Prevent Violence Against Women 2019-2023⁴² reveals that around 20% of women aged from 15 to 49 have experienced physical violence and around 18% of married women aged from 15 to 49 experienced physical or sexual violence from their spouse. Approximately 4% of girls reported having experienced sexual abuse at least once before the age of 18.

South Sudan:

- 53) CEFMU is alarmingly common in South Sudan, with 52% of girls married before the age of 18, giving the country the world's fifth-highest prevalence of CEFMU.⁴³
- 54) According to a 2013 study,⁴⁴ high levels of GBV are accompanied by high levels of social acceptance of violence:
- 82% of women and 81% of men agreed that "women should tolerate violence in order to keep her family together"
 - Two-thirds of women in South Sudan experience GBV in their lifetime.
 - 68% of women and 63% of men agreed that 'there are times when a woman deserves to be beaten'.
 - Women (47%) were more likely than men (37%) to agree that 'it is okay for a man to hit his wife if she won't have sex with him'
 - Agreement with gender inequitable norms decreased with education.
 - Across sites, 69% of respondents knew at least one woman who was beaten by her husband in the past month and 42% knew at least one man who forced his wife or partner to have sex.

Tonga:

- 55) Approximately 10% of girls are married before the age of 18 in Tonga.⁴⁵ While the minimum age of marriage is 18 years of age, it is permissible from 15 years of age with parental consent.
- 56) Tonga has been identified to have some of the highest rates of violence against children across 40 countries in the Asia-Pacific region with approximately 80% of children experience violent discipline by their caregivers.⁴⁶
- 57) SGBV is a pervasive issue in Tonga with approximately 20.7% of ever-partnered women having experienced physical violence from an intimate partner in their lifetime.⁴⁷
Increasing access to information and gender-inclusive water, sanitation, and hygiene

⁴⁰ Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Available [here](#).

⁴¹ Girls Not Brides, Child Marriage Atlas. Available [here](#).

⁴² Royal Government of Cambodia, 2019. Cambodia's National Action Plan to Prevent Violence Against Women 2019-2023. Available [here](#).

⁴³ South Sudan Ministry of Health and National Bureau of Statistics, 2010. Household Health Survey, South Sudan. Available [here](#).

⁴⁴ All data from: Scott J, Averbach S, Modest AM, Hacker MR, Cornish S, Spencer D, Murphy M, Parmar P., 2013. An assessment of gender inequitable norms and gender-based violence in South Sudan: a community-based participatory research approach. *Confl Health*; 7(1):4. Available [here](#).

⁴⁵ Girls Not Brides, Child Marriage Atlas. Available [here](#).

⁴⁶ Save the Children, 2023. Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific, Available [here](#).

⁴⁷ Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Tonga Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey 2019, Survey Findings Report. Nuku'alofa, Tonga: Tonga Statistics Department. Available [here](#).

(WASH) facilities in schools, which also serve as shelters during disasters, is recognised as a strategy to reduce GBV and family violence incidents.

Marginalised groups

Cambodia:

- 58) Lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer and intersex (LGBTQI+) people in Cambodia face numerous challenges; more than 80% faced family violence, 10% experienced sexual violence or forced to get married, and about 35% had considered committing suicide.⁴⁸
- 59) Children with diverse SOGIESC, children with disabilities, children from low socioeconomic households and children from ethnic minorities have multiple barriers to access education due to language barriers, lack of teaching materials, and support.⁴⁹ Children with diverse SOGIESC have faced critical challenges in accessing education due to different forms of discrimination at homes, school and communities, according to the Save the Children's study on children with diverse SOGIESC in 2020.
- 60) In 2008, 22 different Indigenous Peoples were identified in Cambodia comprising 1.34% of the total population.⁵⁰ Of this number, children aged below 18 accounted for 51%.
- 61) Almost half of Cambodia's Indigenous children do not attend school. Approximately 24% complete primary school, 10% secondary education, and 4% high school.⁵¹
- 62) According to the 2019 Cambodia Labour Force Survey findings, the estimated population aged 5 years or older with a disability was about 9.6% of Cambodia's total population in 2019; the levels of disability varied, ranging from some difficulty to not being able to perform a physical function.⁵²

South Sudan:

- 63) South Sudan faces significant challenges in addressing the needs of marginalised groups, particularly in conflict-affected and rural areas. Women and girls are disproportionately impacted by limited access to education and healthcare, often hindered by early marriage and traditional norms.⁵³
- 64) Persons with disabilities face stigmatisation and a lack of accessible services. Internally displaced persons (IDPs) and refugees, displaced by conflict and climate change, experience barriers to basic services such as education.⁵⁴
- 65) Ethnic minorities, pastoralist communities, and children and youth, especially those out of school, are also marginalised.⁵⁵ The LGBTQI+ community faces societal exclusion, with limited recognition of their rights. These groups are especially vulnerable to the impacts of climate change and conflict, making targeted interventions in education and resilience-building essential for South Sudan's sustainable development.

Tonga:

- 66) Diverse gender identities are much more widely accepted in Tonga than diverse sexual orientations. There is broad cultural acceptance of the *leiti* community, a cultural group who have always been at the core of Tongan society.⁵⁶ LGBTQI+ children can become targets due to the social vulnerability created by their sexuality – or apparent/purported

⁴⁸ Rainbow Community Kampuchea (RoCK) Family Violence towards Lesbian, Bisexual and Transgender (LBT) People in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

⁴⁹ Save the Children. How Save the Children is helping children access safe education in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

⁵⁰ Cambodia Ministry of Planning and the Ministry of Rural Development, 2021. National Report on Demographic and Socio-Economic Status of Indigenous Peoples in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

⁵¹ *ibid*

⁵² *ibid*

⁵³ African Development Bank, 2020. South Sudan: Country Gender Profile. Available [here](#).

⁵⁴ World Bank, 2024. South Sudan: Disability Inclusion Overview. Available [here](#).

⁵⁵ Amnesty International, 2022. Conflict and Human Rights in South Sudan. Available [here](#)

⁵⁶ *Leitis* is an appropriation of the local word “fakaleiti” literally meaning “like a lady.”

sexuality, in that some children are bullied after simply being accused of being “fakaleiti”.⁵⁷

- 67) Interviews with key stakeholders reinforced the need to go to outer islands of Tonga as Tongatapu (main island) house a bulk of development investments.

Poverty, Economic Empowerment and Labour

Cambodia:

- 68) 16.6% of the population in Cambodia is multidimensionally poor while an additional 20.5% is classified as vulnerable to multidimensional poverty. The intensity of deprivation in Cambodia is 42.3%.⁵⁸
- 69) The labour force participation rate of the Cambodia’s working-age population (aged 15 or older) was estimated at 69.3%, 77.2% for males and 62.4% for females. The rate was 67.7% in urban areas and 70.2% in rural areas.⁵⁹
- 70) Women are overrepresented in low paid jobs compared to men and gender pay gap remains a big challenge. In 2019, women represented about 41% of the female workforce compared to men’s 54% for the employed. For the self-employed, the number is slightly different (38.8% for women vs. 36.8% for men).⁶⁰
- 71) By industry, the largest proportion of the employed population was engaged in agriculture, forestry and fishing, at 33.1%, followed by both manufacturing and wholesale and retail trade, at 16.7% each, and then by construction, at 10%.⁶¹
- 72) In late 2023, the Minister of Labour and Vocational Training announced that the total number of formally employed persons with disabilities in Cambodia amounted to only 7,532 of which 3,776 were employed in the public sector, and 3,756 employed in the private sector.⁶² This number is less than 1% of the total persons with disabilities in Cambodia.
- 73) Cambodia established a National Social Protection Council in 2017 to develop the social protection system and to ensure better harmonisation of the different strategies, policies and other social protection activities. Elderly and persons with disabilities are entitled to benefit from the social assistance programs in Cambodia.⁶³ Cash transfer programmes are used to support members of households holding an ID poor card.

South Sudan:

- 74) The unemployment rate of those above 15 years old is 12.04% in South Sudan.⁶⁴
- 75) In South Sudan, land access plays a critical role in sustaining rural livelihoods, especially for communities dependent on agriculture and livestock. However, land ownership is highly unequal, with significant disparities between smallholder farmers and those who control large tracts of land. A large proportion of South Sudan's rural population depends on customary land tenure systems, where communities hold collective rights to land, but these systems are often weakened by conflict and displacement. According to estimates, approximately 80% of South Sudanese households rely on subsistence agriculture for their livelihoods, yet access to land is increasingly under threat due to conflict, displacement, and land grabbing by elites and investors.⁶⁵

⁵⁷ Save the Children, 2024 Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#).

⁵⁸ UNDP, 2023. Unstacking global poverty: data for high impact action Briefing note for countries on the 2023 Multidimensional Poverty Index Cambodia. Available [here](#).

⁵⁹ National Institute of Statistics, 2019. Report on the Cambodia Labour Force Survey 2019. Available [here](#).

⁶⁰ UNDP, 2021. The Gender Wage Gap in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

⁶¹ *ibid*

⁶² Khmer Times, 2023. Ministry to boost employment for disabled people. Article. Available [here](#).

⁶³ National Social Protection Council: Social Assistance. Website. Available [here](#).

⁶⁴ World Bank Data, 2021. Available [here](#).

⁶⁵ Land Coalition, 2024. Uneven Ground – Shocking State of Land Inequality in the World. Available [here](#).

- 76) Large-scale land acquisitions in South Sudan have further exacerbated land inequality. Studies suggest that around 9% of the total land area in South Sudan has been allocated for foreign investment, often at the expense of local communities. As of 2020, an estimated 5.15 million hectares of land have been allocated for agricultural or resource extraction projects, much of which is situated in fertile regions crucial for smallholder farmers and pastoralists.⁶⁶ The displacement of over 4 million people due to civil war has also strained land tenure systems, making it difficult for displaced populations to reclaim their land, contributing to rising tensions over land access.⁶⁷
- 77) Women, who form the backbone of agricultural labour, face additional barriers to land access due to customary practices that favour male landowners. Only 12% of women in rural South Sudan hold secure land rights, which impacts their ability to engage in sustainable agricultural practices or invest in their land.⁶⁸ These issues highlight the urgent need for equitable land reform policies to address the growing inequalities in land ownership and access in South Sudan. Women face severe disadvantages in land tenure due to patriarchal norms and restrictive laws that limit their ability to inherit land, start businesses, or lead in public affairs.⁶⁹ Historically, in the past 20 years, women headed households received only 13.6% of fiscal land allocated to them.⁷⁰ They are also marginalised in access to productive inputs and land-related services.

Tonga:

- 78) Tonga's multidimensional poverty measure, and data collected via the 2015-2016 Household Income and Expenditure Survey, estimates 27% of the population assessed as poor, 14% are vulnerable as a result of deprivation, and 22% are vulnerable in terms of income.⁷¹
- 79) In 2018, the Tongan labour force participation rate stood at 46.7%. Men have a higher labour force participation rate (56.2%) than women (38.4%), which holds for the age groups 15-64.⁷²
- 80) In 2021, 22.1% of households were headed by women. Seasonal-worker schemes and other forms of labour migration to nearby countries such as Australia, New Zealand, and the United States affect the number of households headed by women as men move abroad and leave women to manage households alone.

Climate Change and Disaster Risk Management

- 81) The above statistics highlight the various ways in which discriminatory gender and social norms dictate access to education, work, land and prevalence of CEFMU and GBV. Climate change has differential impacts on children depending on intersectional factors such as their age, gender, disability status, poverty levels, SOGEISC, refugee status, among others. Climate change can further exacerbate gender inequality while gender-responsive climate action can advance gender equality. The following highlight further statistics on climate change and intersectionality, including data from the CCRI.⁷³ The CCRI is structured according to two central pillars: exposure to climate and environmental hazards, shocks and stresses and child vulnerability. Across the two categories, the CCRI brings 57 variables together to measure risk across 163 countries.

⁶⁶ Welthungerhilfe, 2024. Global Land Inequality Report: The Gap with Land Ownership Is Widening Around the World. Available [here](#).

⁶⁷ USAID, 2016. Land and Resource Tenure and Social Impacts. Available [here](#).

⁶⁸ Land Coalition, 2024. Uneven Ground – Shocking State of Land Inequality in the World. Available [here](#).

⁶⁹ IOM, 2021. Customary law, norms, practices and related factors that enable and constrain women's access to housing, land and property in South Sudan. Available [here](#).

⁷⁰ *ibid*

⁷¹ Carroll, M., Greaves, A., Crawford, J., Pradela, J., 2023. Equality Insights Rapid: Report, Tonga Survey 2022, Melbourne: International Women's Development Agency. Available [here](#). This study draws on data from 6,703 respondents from 2,551 households.

⁷² UPR Info, 2023. Tonga Universal Periodic Review Annex 1. Available [here](#).

⁷³ UNICEF, 2021. Children's Climate Risk Index. Available [here](#).

The combination of hazard, exposure and vulnerability aligns with the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) 2014 working definition of risk.

Cambodia:

- 82) Cambodia ranks in the top third of countries at risk for children and young people on climate change and environment stress according to the CCRI (46th of 163).⁷⁴ The report found Cambodian children are highly exposed to water scarcity, riverine flooding and vector-borne disease and require investments in social services, particularly access to WASH, health and nutrition, education and social protection services to safeguard children's futures from the impacts of climate change.
- 83) Implementation efforts of the many plans, policies and programmes, of the government, that look at the mainstreaming of gender equality in climate action, are hampered by many challenges including limited coordination and facilitation, a low understanding of gender concepts, persistent discriminatory social norms and traditional gender roles, limited sex, age and diversity disaggregated data and a big gap between planning and budgeting for climate change and gender mainstreaming implementation at both national and subnational levels.

South Sudan:

- 84) Global data from the IPCC has consistently highlighted the disproportionate impact of climate change on women, particularly in vulnerable regions like South Sudan. Climate change disproportionately affects women and girls in South Sudan, exacerbating vulnerabilities related to poverty, displacement, and food insecurity. Women, primarily responsible for household water and food provision, face increased burdens due to climate-induced droughts and floods. These environmental challenges undermine livelihoods and deepen gender inequalities.
- 85) Women are more vulnerable to climate impacts due to social, economic, and cultural disadvantages that limit their access to resources, decision-making, and economic opportunities. In South Sudan, for example, 70-80% of the agricultural workforce consists of women, yet they face challenges in land ownership and access to resources like water and seeds.⁷⁵ Shifts in weather patterns, such as extended dry seasons and increased flooding, have reduced crop yields or destroyed crops before harvest. Additionally, women face rising threats of theft, necessitating the protection of their harvests and agricultural inputs.
- 86) Climate-induced displacement affects women and girls disproportionately. According to the IPCC's 6th Assessment Report, extreme weather events such as floods and droughts, which are becoming more frequent in South Sudan, increase the risk of displacement. Women and children account for 80% of those displaced globally, and South Sudan is no exception.⁷⁶
- 87) Food insecurity exacerbated by climate change disproportionately impacts women and girls in South Sudan, where recurring droughts and floods have led to a sharp decline in food production. The IPCC Special Report on Climate Change and Land emphasises that women, as primary caregivers and food providers, are hit hardest by food insecurity, often sacrificing their own food intake for the sake of their families.⁷⁷
- 88) Gender-sensitive adaptation strategies: The IPCC AR5 report underlines the importance of including gender in climate adaptation policies. In South Sudan, where women are key to agricultural production, gender-sensitive approaches are crucial for building resilience in climate-affected communities.⁷⁸

⁷⁴ ibid

⁷⁵ Land Coalition, 2024. Uneven Ground – Shocking State of Land Inequality in the World. Available [here](#).

⁷⁶ ibid

⁷⁷ Welthungerhilfe, 2024. Global Land Inequality Report: The Gap with Land Ownership Is Widening Around the World. Available [here](#).

⁷⁸ ibid

89) South Sudan ranks very high on the CCRI at joint 7th of 163 countries at risk for children and young people on climate change and environment stress.⁷⁹

Tonga:

90) A 2018 Analysis of Tropical Cyclone Gita in the Kingdom of Tonga identified heightened vulnerabilities for specific populations, including individuals with disabilities, the elderly, widowed, chronically ill, young children, pregnant or breastfeeding women, female heads of households, single mothers (especially those with many dependents), and people with diverse sexual orientations and gender identities.⁸⁰

91) Women's livelihoods in Tonga are heavily reliant on natural resources, such as mulberry and pandanus trees, which are often impacted by natural hazards like tropical cyclones. This vulnerability is exacerbated by gender-based disparities in aid distribution. Female-headed households, particularly those led by single, abandoned, divorced, or separated women, are frequently overlooked by aid providers, who often require the woman to be widowed to qualify.⁸¹

92) Save the Children's Regional Situational Analysis identified heightened risks of child sexual abuse and violence in the Pacific following natural hazards. Participants attributed this to living in evacuation centres, deteriorating living conditions, and poverty. Socio-cultural norms, poverty, family separation, and climate change were key drivers of violence. Risk factors included gender diversity, disability, family violence, parental absence, substance abuse, and economic hardship.⁸²

93) The extent of women's involvement in disaster preparedness and decision-making in Tonga remains unclear. However, disaster preparedness committees are predominantly male-dominated, excluding women from critical decision-making processes during emergencies. Following Tropical Cyclone Gita, a survey of women in evacuation centres revealed a lack of involvement in decision-making, with many reporting that they were simply following instructions. These findings highlight the exclusion of women from decision-making processes and the need for more inclusive approaches to disaster preparedness and response.⁸³

⁷⁹ UNICEF, 2021. Children's Climate Risk Index. Available [here](#).

⁸⁰ Government of Tonga, 2018. Post-Disaster Rapid Assessment Tropical Cyclone Gita. Available [here](#).

⁸¹ United Nations Capital Development Fund, 2020. Economic Impacts of Natural Hazards on Vulnerable Populations in Tonga. Available [here](#).

⁸² Save the Children, 2024 Regional Child Protection Situational Analysis – Pacific. Available [here](#).

⁸³ UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#); Safety and Protection Cluster, 2018. Safety and Protection Cluster Situation Report and Initial Rapid Assessment Tropical Cyclone Gita. Available [here](#).

Country Analysis on Gender Equality and Social Inclusion

The following section highlights key findings and data in the five domain areas across all three countries. The data are presented for all countries to identify similarities and differences across countries and support shared learning during project implementation.

Domain 1: Laws, Policies and Institutions

Cambodia:

- 94) The Cambodian government has signed and ratified all core international human rights treaties and conventions related to GESI. This includes the UN Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW), UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (CRC), and UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (CRPD). The core principles and numerous provisions of the ratified treaties and conventions have then been integrated in Cambodia's domestic laws.
- 95) Cambodia has taken numerous steps to advance gender equality through laws and policies, including the Constitution, integration into development policies, establishment of the Ministry of Women's Affairs, and creation of new gender equality policies, including a law specifically on domestic violence.

Gender components of national policies
The Constitution of Cambodia (1993)
<i>"Men and women have equal rights before the law and enjoy equal participation in political, economic, social and cultural life (Article 35); equality in employment and equal pay for equal work;"</i> It explicitly prohibits <i>"all forms of discrimination against women (Article 45)"</i> . ⁸⁴
Development policies
Cambodia has mainstreamed gender equality into its national development strategies, plans and reforms. For example, gender equality and women's empowerment are part of the Cambodian government's current 2024-2028 Pentagonal Strategy for Growth, Employment, Equity, Efficiency and Sustainability which recognises gender equality as a key element of <i>Pentagon 4: Resilience, Sustainable and Inclusive Development</i> , and the <i>National Strategic Development Plan</i> to implement this strategy.
Ministry of Women's Affairs
Cambodia institutionalised gender equality through the establishment of the: • Ministry of Women's Affairs (MoWA) in 1997 • Cambodian National Council for Women in 2001 • Technical Working Group on Gender in 2004 • Gender Mainstreaming Action Groups in 2005 across line ministries, and many others.

⁸⁴ Ministry of Women's Affairs, 2014. Cambodia Gender Assessment 2014. Available [here](#).

Gender specific policies

Responding to the Pentagon Strategy, MoWA developed the national policy on gender equality and women's empowerment, known as **Neary Rattanak Strategic Plan**, with the current plan (Phase VI) set for 2024-2028.⁸⁵

- The strategic plan aims to combat GBV in both the private and public spheres and empower women and girls in national policies, strategic plans and development programs across all sectors and at all levels of government institutions.
- The **National Action Plan to Prevent Violence Against Women** was also formulated based on the vision of Neary Rattanak V.

Cambodia used to treat domestic violence as 'family issue' and was acceptable in the Cambodian society, although **Cambodia's Penal Code** prohibits physical and sexual assaults and violence.

This type of violence was no longer tolerated after the **Law on the Prevention of Domestic Violence and the Protection of Victim**⁸⁶ was adopted in September 2005. Domestic violence has since been criminalised.

Education Strategic Plan 2019-2023

Gender mainstreaming in education sector is considered a key action to contribute the implementing the Rectangular Strategy Phase 4 of the Royal Government and Neary Ratanak Strategic Plan, especially eliminating gender gap in educator sector.

The Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports (MoEYS) has been implementing the Gender Mainstreaming Strategic Plan in Education Sector 2016-2020 and mainstreamed some issues into the educational policies of all sub-sectors including Education Strategic Plan 2019-2023 and Teacher Policy Action Plan.⁸⁷

Disability and Social Inclusion Laws and Policies

UN Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (CRPD)

Cambodia signed the CRPD in 2007 and ratified the Convention in 2012.

In 2009, Cambodia passed a **Law on the Protection and the Promotion of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities**.

- Criticisms have been made, suggesting that the law fails to adopt a human rights-based approach" and "uses language that reinforces stigma against people with disabilities rather than ensuring equal access to education, employment, transportation, social and legal services, and independent living.
- As well as "not in full compliance with international human rights laws and standards".⁸⁸
- The Cambodian government then decided to draft a new disability law to fully align with the UN CRPD.

National Disability Strategic Plan (NDSP)

With a strong commitment to promote and protect the rights of persons with disabilities, the Cambodian government has formulated the National Disability Strategic Plan aiming to

⁸⁵ Ministry of Women's Affairs, 2019. Neary Rattanak V: Five Year Strategic Plan for Strengthening Gender Mainstreaming and Women's Empowerment. Available [here](#).

⁸⁶ Available [here](#).

⁸⁷ MoEYS, 2019. Education Strategic Plan 2019-2023. Available [here](#).

⁸⁸ The Phnom Penh Post, 2021. Official: Draft law on rights of persons with disability 'inclusive'. Available [here](#).

improve the quality of life and promote equality of persons with disabilities. It focuses on nine strategic objectives, including:

- increasing access to quality and sustainable services such as health, rehabilitation, vocational training, economic security, social services, accessibility, access to rights, gender equality, and equal participation of people with disabilities.

The current NSDP is for 2019-2023⁸⁹ and the new NSDP 2024-2028 is still in draft, awaiting approval.

Disability Action Council (DAC)

In July 2009, Cambodia established the Disability Action Council (DAC)⁹⁰ to implement Cambodia's Law on the Protection and the Promotion of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities.

Disability rights and inclusion is a cross-ministerial responsibility; however, the Ministry of Social Affairs, Veterans and Youth Rehabilitation (MoSVY) is the core ministry in charge of this work.

MoSVY has officially launched the 'disability identification card' for persons with disabilities in late 2023 as a part of strengthening social protection system to foster equitable and inclusive economic growth in Cambodia.⁹¹

As of October 2023, 288,690 persons with disabilities have been identified by commune focal points across the country, with the ministry having issued 222,148 cards for persons with disabilities.

LGBTQI+ policies

In Cambodia, there is no legislation that criminalises LGBTQI+ people; however, at the same time, there is no explicit law to protect them as well, although the Cambodian Constitution states that all Cambodians have equal rights and entitles to receive protection from the state.

The Cambodian Human Rights Committee has been appointed as a government body to handle human rights issues in the country, including the rights of LGBTQI+ persons.

Climate Change Laws and Policies

Climate change in gender policies

As a government body to promote gender equality and women's empowerment and a member of the Cambodian agencies on climate change and disaster management, MoWA has prioritised gender, and climate is one of the goals for its gender equality strategic plan (Goal 6). MoWA has developed a:

- ***National Strategic Plan on Gender and Climate Change 2014-2023***
- ***Master Plan for Gender and Climate Change 2018-2030***
- ***Action Plan on Gender and Climate Change 2019-2023.***

The MoWA Committee for Gender and Climate Change was established. Several pilot projects have been implemented in four provinces related to gender analysis, capacity building for women and climate change resilience and adaptation, safe WASH, disaster risk reduction (DRR) during flood and drought seasons.

⁸⁹ Cambodia's National Disability Strategic Plan 2019-2023. Available [here](#).

⁹⁰ Disability Action Council: History. Available [here](#).

⁹¹ Ministry of Social Affairs, 2023. Available [here](#).

296 officials (251 women) from the Provincial Department of Women's Affairs and Provincial Women Development Centres received training on gender and climate change adaption, green growth, and disaster risk mitigation, especially the linkages with family economic development for women on saving and renewable energy.⁹²

Climate policies

Cambodia has ratified the **UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC)** in 1995.

In 2006, Cambodia established a **National Climate Change Committee** with the mandate to coordinate and monitor implementation of the Government's policies, strategies, regulations, plans and programs in response to climate change.

The Committee then worked with multi-stakeholders to develop a **10-year Cambodia Climate Change Strategic Plan 2014-2023**,⁹³ which envisions a green, low-carbon, climate-resilient, equitable, sustainable and knowledge-based society.

Within the strategic plan, MoWA is tasked to promote gender in climate change response through increasing women's participation in climate change policy making, establish funding rules for gender and climate change initiatives and make these operational through gender-responsive budget in the current and upcoming projects or policies, identify effective mechanisms for scaling up the proven experiences on gender and climate change, and elicit and analyse lessons and best practices of gender and climate change for sharing and learning in national, regional and global forums.

Cambodia's Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC)

Cambodia's Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) acknowledges the differential impact of climate change on children: *"children and youth play a critical role in the development, implementation, monitoring, and enforcement of climate actions across sectors – they need to be engaged at the national and local levels to participate meaningfully in the development of climate policies, including the NDC and National Adaptation Plan (NAP)"* but also that information on the impact of disasters on women, children, disabled people, and other marginalised groups is largely anecdotal.⁹⁴

Cambodia's NDC and Long-Term Strategy for Carbon Neutrality: Progress Report 2022 revealed gender equality related results in 43 NDC actions. Women engagement rate varied between 10-64 percent in 2022. In the education sector, climate subjects were integrated into the curriculum of schools, and trainings of education officials.⁹⁵

Sustainable Development

The National Climate Change Committee is part of Cambodia's **National Council for Sustainable Development**, established in 2015 and chaired by the Minister of Environment Ministry, along with three other government bodies, including the National Council of Green Growth, the National Biosafety Secretariat, and the National Biodiversity Steering Committee.⁹⁶

⁹² Ministry of Women's Affairs Royal Government of Cambodia, 2024. Cambodia National Review for Implementation of the Beijing Framework for Action+30. Available [here](#).

⁹³ Cambodia Climate Change Strategic Plan 2014-2023. Available [here](#).

⁹⁴ UNICEF, 2023. An Analysis of the Situation of Children and Adolescents in Cambodia 2023. Available [here](#).

⁹⁵ Ministry of Women's Affairs Royal Government of Cambodia, 2024. Cambodia National Review for Implementation of the Beijing Framework for Action+30. Available [here](#).

⁹⁶ The National Council for Sustainable Development in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

The main goal of the National Council for Sustainable Development is to promote sustainable development and to ensure economic, environmental, social and cultural balance within Cambodia.

Disaster Management

Cambodia established a **National Committee for Disaster Management (NCDM)** in 1995 with its structure at both national and subnational levels.

The Committee was established because of the country's experience with regularly occurring natural hazards with the mandate to provide timely and effective emergency relief to the victims of disasters and develop preventive measures to reduce loss of lives and property.⁹⁷

The Guideline for Mainstreaming Gender in Inclusive Disaster Management 2021 developed by the NCDM and MoWA covers the integration of gender and social inclusion across the entire disaster management cycle, including prevention, mitigation, preparedness and response. The policy instruments also mandated the socially representative participation of groups vulnerable to the impacts of disasters, such as women, youth, children, the elderly, and people with disabilities in the National Forum on Disaster Risk Reduction.⁹⁸

South Sudan:

96) The Government of South Sudan has committed to international frameworks related to GESI by ratifying core treaties such as the CEDAW, the CRC, and the CRPD. These international commitments form the foundation of South Sudan's national efforts to advance GESI. While South Sudan's capacity to fully implement these treaties has been hampered by conflict, these conventions guide national policy development.

97) South Sudan has taken significant steps to promote GESI through various laws, policies, and institutions. The Transitional Constitution of 2011 enshrines gender equality as a fundamental principle, mandating the equal participation of women in public life and prohibiting discrimination based on gender. Furthermore, the government established the Ministry of Gender, Child, and Social Welfare (MoGCSW), which plays a key role in promoting women's rights and social inclusion across government initiatives. Key legislative advancements, including the National Gender Policy (2013) and the Sexual and Gender-Based Violence Bill (2019), have also been implemented to combat gender-based violence and promote women's empowerment.

Gender components of national policies

The Transitional Constitution of South Sudan (2011)

The Constitution guarantees gender equality and protection of women's rights. Article 16 explicitly mandates equal participation of women in public life, political representation, and decision-making processes. It also prohibits discrimination against women and encourages affirmative action to redress historical imbalances in education, employment, and leadership.

Article 16 of the Constitution mandates that *“women shall have the right to participate fully in public life and have equal rights with men.”*

⁹⁷ Cambodia's National Committee for Disaster Management: Policy Document. Available [here](#).

⁹⁸ NCDM 2021, Guideline for Mainstreaming Gender in Inclusive Disaster Management 2021. Available [here](#).

The Constitution also addresses GBV, outlining the state's responsibility to protect women from all forms of violence, including sexual exploitation during conflicts.

National Gender Policy (2013)

The National Gender Policy serves as the primary framework guiding gender equality efforts in South Sudan. It emphasises gender mainstreaming across all sectors—education, health, agriculture, and governance—and seeks to promote women's economic empowerment and participation in leadership roles. The policy aims to enhance legal frameworks that protect women's rights and increase women's representation in decision-making.

Sexual and Gender-Based Violence (SGBV) Bill (2019)

The SGBV Bill focuses on addressing violence against women and girls in both public and private spheres. It includes provisions to prevent, punish, and protect victims of GBV. The law aims to reduce the high levels of sexual violence exacerbated by years of conflict, ensuring that GBV survivors receive legal, medical, and psychological support.

National Action Plan on Women, Peace, and Security (2015-2020)

In response to UN Security Council Resolution 1325, South Sudan developed a National Action Plan to increase the participation of women in peacebuilding and post-conflict recovery. The plan promotes women's leadership in peace processes, conflict resolution, and national reconciliation efforts, addressing the disproportionate impact of conflict on women and girls.

South Sudan Women's Empowerment Strategy and Action Plan (2015-2020)

This strategy was developed to promote women's participation in economic activities and leadership. It focuses on creating an enabling environment for women to engage in small- and medium-sized enterprises and addresses barriers like limited access to financial services, skills development, and land ownership.

The National Gender Coordination Forum has also been instrumental in advancing gender mainstreaming across government ministries.

Education Sector Strategic Plan (2017-2022)

The Education Sector Strategic Plan focuses on increasing girls' enrolment and retention in schools, aiming to bridge the gender gap in education. The strategy includes specific actions to reduce early marriage and address gender-based barriers that prevent girls from completing their education.

National Girl's Education Strategy 2024-2028 for South Sudan

This strategy sets out a comprehensive framework to address the persistent challenges hindering girls' access to education in South Sudan. It emphasises the transformational role that education can play in advancing gender equality, social development, and the overall economic growth of the country. The strategy aims to create an enabling environment where girls can realise their full potential and contribute to the nation's development.

Disability and Social Inclusion Laws and Policies

National Disability and Inclusion Policy (2018)

Although focused on persons with disabilities, this policy includes a gendered lens to ensure that women with disabilities receive equal opportunities in accessing education, healthcare, and economic activities. The policy recognises the unique challenges women with disabilities face and emphasises the need for inclusive development program.

Social Inclusion Policies for LGBTQI+ Communities

South Sudan's legal framework remains silent on the protection of LGBTQI+ rights, and there are no explicit laws criminalising or protecting individuals based on sexual orientation or gender identity. LGBTQI+ persons often face discrimination and exclusion, and the lack of a clear legal framework leaves them vulnerable to societal stigma.

Climate Change Laws and Policies

National Climate Change Policy (2016)

South Sudan's National Climate Change Policy integrates gender considerations, recognising that women and children are disproportionately affected by climate change. The policy emphasises the need for gender-sensitive adaptation and mitigation strategies, advocating for women's participation in decision-making related to climate change resilience, especially in rural and vulnerable communities.

The National Adaptation Plan (NAP) (2016)

This was developed in response to the growing impacts of climate change, with a focus on building resilience, particularly for vulnerable populations like women, children, and marginalised communities. The NAP aims to address both immediate and long-term climate adaptation needs, aligned with the country's national development goals and its international commitments under the Paris Agreement. It integrates gender considerations, emphasising the role of women in climate resilience and adaptation strategies. The Ministry of Environment and Forestry works closely with the MoGCSW to ensure that climate change policies are gender-responsive.

Tonga:

98) The Tonga Strategic Development Framework 2015-2025 is underpinned by the motto "*God and Tonga are my inheritance.*" This reiterates the important role of faith and how it is intertwined with national structures across the Kingdom.

Gender Laws and Policies

The National Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Tonga Policy

The **National Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Tonga** policy and its **Strategic Plan of Action 2019-2025** is a key tool to guide national gender policies.

This revised policy continues to promote the concept of ensuring that Tonga's development benefits are distributed and equitably accessible to everyone.

The policy is also consistent with Tonga's Strategic Development Framework 2015-2025 (TSDF II), National Outcome 3 for a more inclusive sustainable and empowering human development with gender equality.

Embedded within this policy is gender mainstreaming in all government plans and services which has been regarded as one of the priority outcomes.

Voluntary National Review 2019

The Tongan Government's Voluntary National Review 2019 provides an overview of progress made on the **Tongan Strategic Development Framework** and the country's capacity to implement its commitments to the SDGs.

During the review process, the government identified 69 key SDG indicators that are most relevant to its development priorities. One such indicator is SDG 5.c.1, which tracks the "*proportion of countries with systems to track and make public allocations for gender equality and women's empowerment.*" This highlights the government's focus on strengthening transparency and accountability in achieving gender equality goals.⁹⁹

UN Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW)

Tonga acknowledges women's importance in development, with gains in leadership roles and education. However, challenges remain, especially in political participation and ratifying CEDAW.

Opposition from religious and community leaders has stalled progress, despite CEDAW's potential to empower Tongan women and girls.¹⁰⁰

Ratification would strengthen legal protections against violence and abuse, fostering a more equitable society.¹⁰¹ Key informants indicated that they continue to work with national leaders on this.

Domestic Violence

Tonga has implemented a multi-faceted approach to address domestic violence. The **Family Protection Act (FPA)** of 2013 offers legal protection for family members, establishes protection orders, clarifies police duties, and prioritises victim well-being. Financial support for non-governmental organisations (NGOs) working on FPA implementation was introduced through the Family Protection Trust Fund in 2017.

Additionally, the **National Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Tonga (WEGET) Policy 2019-2025** recognises domestic violence as a significant societal issue. The accompanying **WEGET Strategic Plan** outlines actions to potentially eliminate or reduce its prevalence. Tangible steps have been taken to support victims and survivors. These include:

- the establishment of the Family Protection Legal Aid Centre in 2018
- a renovated police station with a dedicated safe space for children in the Domestic Violence Unit
- a 24/7 counselling helpline operated by key service providers.

⁹⁹ Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Tonga Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey 2019, Survey Findings Report. Nuku'alofa, Tonga: Tonga Statistics Department. Available [here](#).

¹⁰⁰ UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹⁰¹ Tonga has legal instruments in place that reflect commitment to CEDAW such as The Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Tonga (WEGET) National Policy and Strategic Plan of Action 2019-2025; an amendment to the Criminal Offences Act in 2022 to expand the definition of "rape" to include digital rape; Establishment of the Family Protection Legal Aid Centre (FPLAC) and the Family Protection Trust Fund under the Family Protection Act.

The Women's Affairs and Gender Equality Division within the Ministry of Internal Affairs serves as the national women's machinery, playing a central role in coordinating, monitoring, and providing advisory services related to WEGET implementation.¹⁰²

Marital rape was outlawed in 1999. Additionally, the **Criminal Offences Act** recognises specific offenses targeting women, such as "*enticing a woman to desert her husband*," "*procuring the defilement of females*," and "*abduction of women*." However, the Family Protection Act (2013) criminalises domestic violence and recognises violence against children, or committed in their presence, as an aggravating factor.¹⁰³

Tonga grapples with the tension between cultural norms and legal protections regarding violence.

While corporal punishment is often viewed as an accepted form of parental discipline, the **Criminal Offences Act (1988)** prohibits assault, bodily harm, and cruelty towards children under 16.

Similarly, the FPA criminalises domestic violence and recognises violence against children, or committed in their presence, as an aggravating factor. This legal framework suggests a move towards safeguarding children, even as traditional practices may persist.

Pacific Platform for Action on Gender Equality

Pacific Platform for Action on Gender Equality¹⁰⁴ and the revitalised Pacific Leaders Gender Equality Declaration¹⁰⁵ serve as crucial regional instruments that align with broader global commitments of **Beijing Platform for Action**, as contextualised against the thematic areas of the 2050 Strategy for the Blue Pacific Continent.

It specifically calls for the meaningful participation of all Pacific peoples, **particularly women and girls in all their diversity**, in climate change action including access to climate finance, disaster risk management, the protection of persons affected by climate change-related sea-level rise, climate security and the sustainable management and use of oceans and river resources for development.

National Policy on Gender and Development

Tonga has made contributions toward progressing gender equality through the implementation of the **Revised National Policy on Gender and Development (RNPGAD)** and its Strategic Plan of Action.

The Tonga RNPGAD, launched in May 2014, provides a significant platform to improve the lives of all women and men, girls and boys through strategic objectives and associated interventions. The six priority outcomes of the Tonga RNPGAD are geared toward mainstreaming gender equality and the empowerment of women in Tonga.

The Constitution

The Kingdom of Tonga stands out in the Pacific as a constitutional monarchy that maintained its independence. Its 1875 Constitution established a Westminster-style government with a tiered system of power: the royal family and nobles, ceremonial chiefs, and commoners.

While this system fostered autonomy, it also presented challenges for achieving gender equality.

¹⁰² Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Tonga Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey 2019, Survey Findings Report. Nuku'alofa, Tonga: Tonga Statistics Department. Available [here](#).

¹⁰³ Ibid.

¹⁰⁴ Pacific Community, 2018. Pacific Platform for Action on Gender Equality and Women's Human Rights 2018-2030. Available [here](#).

¹⁰⁵ Pacific Islands Forum Secretariat, 2023. Revitalised Pacific Leaders Gender Equality Declaration. Available [here](#).

The **Legislative Assembly's amendments**, including the introduction of 17 elected seats in 2014, offer a promising path towards a more inclusive political landscape.

Age of Consent

The age of consent for girls is 15, while there's no minimum age of consent for boys.

Under the **Criminal Offences Act 1988**¹⁰⁶ and subsequent Amendments, rape is an offence that can only be committed by a man against a woman or girl.¹⁰⁷

This legal disparity raises concerns about protection from sexual abuse. The legal age of marriage for both men and women is 15, although parental consent is mandatory for anyone under 18.

Disability and Social Inclusion Laws and Policies

National Policy on Disability Inclusive Development

Tonga's **National Policy on Disability Inclusive Development (2014-2018)** promotes a "whole-of-government" approach, meaning different ministries collaborate to improve the lives of people with disabilities. It involves civil society organisations as partners and aims to:

- Develop and implement laws for disability inclusion.
- Expand support services for people with disabilities.
- Increase accessibility in public spaces and transportation.

New Education Act

The **New Education Act (2013)** mandates inclusive education, meaning all children have the right to quality education regardless of ability. It raised the compulsory school age and emphasised that schools should adapt to meet the needs of all learners. Tonga boasts high literacy rates for both women and men, with a substantial majority of adults able to read and write. However, a notable gender gap exists in lower secondary education completion, with boys having a higher completion rate than girls.¹⁰⁸ Despite high literacy rates, child marriage and teenage pregnancy have led some girls to drop out of school, with limited data available on the extent of this issue. Additionally, higher education for young women does not always translate into better employment outcomes due to gender-based barriers, stereotypes, and the expectation of unpaid domestic work.¹⁰⁹

Social Inclusion

There are various laws indirectly impacting social inclusion, like the **Health Services Act (2010)** and the **Employment Relations Bill** (2013, under consultation). These promote access to healthcare and fair labour practices, which can benefit vulnerable populations.

Under Tonga's 1875 Constitution and subsequent Amendments, there is a general guarantee of equality which states that the laws of Tonga shall apply to all people regardless of class. The constitution does not explicitly prohibit discrimination based on sex, sexual orientation, gender identity and expression, and sex characteristics.¹¹⁰

¹⁰⁶ Kingdom of Tonga Criminal Offences Act, 2016. Available [here](#).

¹⁰⁷ UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹⁰⁸ World Bank Group, Gender Data Portal. Available [here](#).

¹⁰⁹ UN in the Pacific, 2018. Joint Submission of the UN Country Team for Tonga for the UN Compilation Universal Periodic Review of Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹¹⁰ Tonga's Constitution of 1875 with Amendments through 2013. Available [here](#).

Climate Change Laws and Policies

Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC)

The Kingdom of Tonga's **NDC** puts a strong emphasis on ensuring the consideration of intersectional and intergenerational aspects such as gender, income, age, etc.¹¹¹

It included domestic institutional arrangements, public participation and engagement with local communities and indigenous peoples, in a gender-responsive manner. The document however remains limited in its reference to implement or progress the Gender Action Plan.

Climate Change Policy

Tonga's **Climate Change Policy (2016)** recognises the differentiated impacts faced by men and women as a result of the varying social, environmental and economic situations and seeks to consider these during planning and implementation processes.

This is also demonstrated in the leadership and technical team of the Department of Climate Change, Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications.¹¹²

The **National Policy on Gender and Development** and Strategic Plan are fully aligned with this policy, however the FPA¹¹³ needs to be reviewed by relevant government agencies for alignment.

¹¹¹ Tonga's Second Nationally Determined Contribution NDC, 2020. Available [here](#).

¹¹² Department of Climate Change, Ministry of Meteorology, Energy, Information, Disaster Management, Environment, Climate Change and Communications, 2016. Tonga Climate Change Policy: A Resilient Tonga by 2025. Available [here](#).

¹¹³ Kingdom of Tonga, 2016. Family Protection Act. Available [here](#).

Domain 2: Social Norms and Roles, Responsibilities and Time Use

- 99) Discriminatory social and gender norms, roles and stereotypes have significant impacts on the way different populations groups across the three countries experience climate change and their capacities to adapt. These socially constructed norms and rules determine access to assets that are vital for climate change resilience.
- 100) These pervasive norms affect many areas of life, covered further in Domains 3-5, with climate change further exacerbating risks faced by girls, women, those living in poverty, indigenous people and other marginalised groups.

Cambodia:

- 101) Cambodia is steeped in patriarchal traditions and discriminatory gender norms are heavily rooted. These societal norms have dictated girls' and women's subordination to men and boys in both private and public spheres.¹¹⁴
- 102) A gender policy assessment by MoWA revealed that traditional stereotypes and norms were the main barriers hindering Cambodia's women from gaining broader opportunities for economic empowerment, reproductive health, participation in family and social decision-making processes, acting against domestic violence, and enjoying an education and career development.¹¹⁵
- 103) According to the UN in Cambodia *"social norms and beliefs that restrict what women can do and be, and give higher value and more power to men, are still pervasive. Gender norms are also embedded in government policies, such as the National Childcare Policy which reinforces the idea of women as responsible for care of children and the household. Social expectations of women and men are evident in day-to-day interactions in workplaces and communities and are frequently cited as barriers to women taking leadership roles. Harmful gender norms, such as the idea that men are entitled to sex regardless of consent, directly contribute to GBV"*.¹¹⁶
- 104) While family is the foundation of social life for most Cambodian people, the roles of women and men are socially and culturally constructed in Cambodian society with men often seen as the head of the household and main income earner, while women are primary caregivers and homemakers.¹¹⁷ According to the 2019 Cambodia Labour Force Survey, 76.4% of households were headed by a man, while 23.6% were headed by a woman. Almost the same gender distribution in household heads emerged across both urban and rural areas.¹¹⁸
- 105) In terms of climate change, these discriminatory gender stereotypes can limit girls and women from developing the necessary skills and capacities to adapt to the changing climate and reduce disaster risk. Women and girls living in poverty, indigenous women, women belonging to ethnic, racial, religious and sexual minority groups, and women with disabilities are less able to adapt to changes in climatic conditions due to their disadvantaged socio-economic status, the lower positions they are in, limited education, cultural norms, and restricted involvement in decision-making processes.¹¹⁹
- 106) Further, due to cultural norms, women are often seen as passive victims rather able to take action.¹²⁰ In reality, women are often responsible for protecting the household's

¹¹⁴ Eng, S., Li, Y., Mulsow, M., & Fischer, J., 2010. Domestic Violence against Women in Cambodia: Husband's Control, Frequency of Spousal Discussion, and Domestic Violence Reported by Cambodian Women. *Journal of Family Violence*, 25(3)

¹¹⁵ Ministry of Women's Affairs Royal Government of Cambodia, 2024. Cambodia National Review for Implementation of the Beijing Framework for Action+30. Available [here](#).

¹¹⁶ United Nations in Cambodia, 2022. Gender Equality Deep-Dive for Cambodia. Available [here](#).

¹¹⁷ National Institute of Statistics Ministry of Planning Royal Government of Cambodia, 2019. Report on the Cambodia Labour Force Survey 2019. Available [here](#).

¹¹⁸ *ibid*

¹¹⁹ UN Women and CDRI, 2021. State of Gender Equality and Climate Change in Cambodia 2021. Available [here](#).

¹²⁰ CEDAW, 2018. General Recommendation No. 37 on Gender-Related Dimensions of Disaster Risk Reduction in the Context of Climate Change. Available [here](#).

property and belongings from climate-induced loss and damage as well as taking care of the children while men are responsible for finding or continuing income generating activities. *“Consequently, women tend to become psychologically stressed, worrying that their children will drown, become seriously sick or be bitten by poisonous insects.”*¹²¹

- 107) The perception of women as victims is also considered a reason why there are fewer women in official roles in the climate change sector. This is exacerbated by women’s persistent poverty, limited educational opportunities, lack of decision-making power, and inadequate access to reproductive and sexual health services linked to pregnancy and childbirth.¹²²
- 108) With climate change negatively affecting water availability and quality, the gender bias in women and girls’ household responsibilities is even more evident in terms of domestic water consumption,¹²³ using dirty water for cooking and cleaning with risk particularly high during menstruation or pregnancy.
- 109) *“Restrictive gender norms are reflected in the vastly unequal distribution of unpaid domestic and care work, with women doing, on average, 90% of that work”* and *“almost 30% of employed women reported that their partners did not provide any additional assistance”*, according to the UN in Cambodia’s 2022 gender equality assessment report.¹²⁴ The report continues to reveal that climate change and disasters add to women’s unpaid work in affected regions. In the absence of other support, unpaid work may be taken on by elder women in the family or girls with possible negative impacts on their education.
- 110) Balancing livelihoods and unpaid domestic and care work can keep women in more vulnerable work, limiting the opportunities to expand businesses, advance their careers or take on leadership roles. Further, this time poverty can affect women’s health, further education, leisure or community engagement. Despite unpaid care and domestic work being one of the biggest obstacles to gender equality, public policies and development efforts rarely target it.¹²⁵

South Sudan:

- 111) In South Sudan, women, men, girls and boys experience different socio-economic conditions. Deep-rooted patriarchal traditions, cultural beliefs and discriminatory gender norms reinforce gender inequalities across the social, economic and political spheres and restrict girls’ and women’s participation in climate change adaptation, education, training and technical advice, decision-making processes, income generation, and credit and land ownership.
- 112) Women and girls experience the intersection of climate change and conflict in South Sudan in direct and profound ways. Since they are often the ones responsible for providing food, water, and energy for their families, they face greater challenges in accessing these resources. Climate change has had a significant impact on South Sudan, most recently with the largest flooding in Unity State in nearly 50 years. These extreme weather events, disaster-related displacement, the destruction or repurposing of educational buildings and the indirect economic pressures on families are having a negative impact on access to education at all levels, especially for young women and girls.
- 113) Conflict, however, adds to the insecurity, as many women and girls face increased risks of violence and insecurity carrying out basic tasks including their education. With greater social capital, men often have greater options for coping with the stresses of instability. Violent conflict tends to exacerbate existing inequalities and vulnerabilities.
- 114) The current peace-building phase can be an opportunity for advancing gender equity and including women’s perspectives in peacebuilding approached and increasing their

¹²¹ UN Women and CDRI, 2021. State of Gender Equality and Climate Change in Cambodia 2021. Available [here](#).

¹²² MoWA, 2014. Women in Public Decision-Making and Politics.

¹²³ Howard, G. et al., 2016. Climate Change and Water and Sanitation: Likely Impacts and Emerging Trends for Action.

¹²⁴ United Nations in Cambodia, 2022. Gender Equality Deep-Dive for Cambodia. Available [here](#).

¹²⁵ *ibid*

participation in leadership. However, the patriarchal customs of South Sudanese society and the associated laws can prevent women's participation in public life and peacebuilding, exacerbated by the underlying lack of political will, limited funding, ethnic politics, weak institutions, and the high illiteracy rate among women.¹²⁶

- 115) Lower education levels and limited access to specific training and information in turn limit prospects of economic empowerment and possibilities to generate income and make decisions about expenditures and resources. Indigenous women and girls face even greater discrimination. Within their own communities, they have less decision-making power than men over land use and less access to land. Cultural barriers have an enormous impact and are often difficult to overcome. Customs, traditions, beliefs and stereotypes still hamper the exercise of rights that have been explicitly recognised in the legal framework of the country.
- 116) Fatalism and adherence to traditional practices influence people's views on their environmental responsibilities and social norms. The belief that the '*will of God*' dictates society means many do not question their environmental actions or behaviours within the family and community. High illiteracy rates and deference to authority perpetuate harmful behaviour patterns and consequences.
- 117) Women and girls suffer time poverty because they bear the brunt of unpaid labour, which limits their time and opportunities for education and skill development. Flooding has increased the time girls and women spend collecting firewood for cooking, often in floodwaters, and must keep the household functioning even during extreme weather events.¹²⁷
- 118) Traditional customs and practices on property limit women's economic power. Women only have access to land through their male relatives. While women cannot inherit land, they have rights and entitlements to land for cultivation upon marriage; these women may encounter problems regaining control of the land when widowed or divorced.
- 119) It is important to note that ethnicity, language, religion, social class and rural/urban living affect gender relations differently, even within the same ethnic group.
- 120) Cattle culture is important across most South Sudanese ethnic groups, with the size of a person's herd being a key marker of wealth. Consequently, cattle-raiding is a common catalyst of inter-communal violence, even before the current conflict. In many areas, cattle are also the bride price required for marriage.¹²⁸
- 121) Participants highlighted the severe impact of climate change on food security. Floods have destroyed crops, making it difficult to meet nutritional needs, particularly for pregnant and breastfeeding women. A participant from Akobo County said, "The floods destroyed our crops, and now we struggle to find food for our families." Pregnant and breastfeeding women noted the increased nutritional needs during their condition, which are hard to meet due to inconsistent food supplies. Additional cultural barriers dictate that men largely make decision on income-generating activities male control over decisions around income-generating activities.¹²⁹
- 122) Girls and women's time is largely taken up with household tasks and agricultural work from a very young age, limiting their ability to continue schooling, resulting in men and women engaging in very different types of economic activities.

Tonga:

- 123) Tongan society presents a complex picture regarding gender roles. Traditionally, the "Fahu" system within families elevated the status of eldest or chosen sisters, granting them significant influence and decision-making power. In some cases, this system even placed sisters above brothers. However, this coexists with persistent gender stereotypes

¹²⁶ Mai N., 2015. The Role of Women in Peace-building in South Sudan. Juba: The Sudd Institute. Available [here](#).

¹²⁷ UN OCHA South Sudan: "Living as a woman is a fight we go through daily" article. Available [here](#).

¹²⁸ CARE International, 2020. Gender in Brief South Sudan. Available [here](#).

¹²⁹ Ensor, M., 2022. South Sudanese women are going beyond gender norms to cope with multiple crises. Africa at LSE. Available [here](#).

and an emerging patriarchal influence. Traditional customs and Christian values have, at times, been interpreted to justify a more paternalistic social hierarchy, creating tension with the historical power dynamics of the "Fahu" system.¹³⁰

- 124) Like Cambodia and South Sudan, traditional gender roles often assign men as the primary providers and decision-makers within the family, while women are typically responsible for domestic duties such as cooking, cleaning, and child-rearing.
- 125) Men may take on roles involving community leadership, including serving as chiefs or elders, while women often play important roles in community gatherings and social events, such as organising ceremonies or contributing to village decision-making processes. Women often play supporting roles in community leadership, providing input during decision-making processes, organising community events, and helping those in need. Both men and women participate in social and cultural activities, although the nature of these activities may differ. For example, men may spend time attending community meetings or engaging in traditional ceremonies, while women may gather for social events or participate in church-related activities.
- 126) Men often allocate time to income-generating activities such as working in the fields, fishing, or engaging in paid employment outside the home. Women continue to be primary carers of children and elderly within homes while also taking on roles outside of the homes for employment or community engagement such as with church groups. Notably key informants have highlighted a shift in attitudes of gendered behaviour with increasing sharing of childcare and household chores. This was attributed to increasing education and interaction with other countries/globalisation.
- 127) Both men, women and gender diverse individuals engage in efforts to promote gender equality and challenge traditional gender norms through education, awareness-raising campaigns, and advocacy initiatives.
- 128) Aligned with local customs, individuals within the diverse SOGIESC community often engage in informal adoption of young people from extended families or communities, assuming parental responsibilities. Alternatively, some establish 'chosen family' units comprised of community members cohabiting and pooling resources. It's anticipated that *leitis* will undertake unpaid labour to garner and uphold social acceptance, including tasks like cooking and providing food to the underprivileged within their local communities.¹³¹
- 129) Around 34% of people are moderately deprived, with a further 20% experiencing severe deprivation. Men were less likely to meet the threshold for Time Use deprivation. People aged 30-59 were more likely than those in other age groups to meet the threshold for any deprivation.¹³²
- 130) The Tongan economy is heavily reliant on remittances from Tongans working overseas as well as foreign aid. The United States is the main source of remittances, followed by New Zealand and Australia.¹³³
- 131) During and after extreme weather events and natural hazards, social norms in Tonga traditionally assign gendered roles. Women, responsible for a larger share of unpaid domestic labour, often take charge of preserving water, food, medicine, and valuables. This aligns with their role in tasks like cooking, cleaning, and water treatment. Additionally, they are more likely to relocate children or themselves to shelters or safer areas. Conversely, men, who are more engaged in agriculture, are expected to reinforce homes and animal shelters, cover crops, save seeds, and move animals to safer locations.¹³⁴ These distinct roles highlight the intersection of gender and disaster preparedness in Tongan society. The education sector is deemed to be feminised, and

¹³⁰ UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹³¹ Pacific Community, 2023. Granting a voice to diverse SOGIESC communities: Tonga Leitis Association leads law reform efforts for inclusive justice. Available [here](#).

¹³² Carroll, M., Greaves, A., Crawford, J., Pradela, J., 2023. Equality Insights Rapid: Report, Tonga Survey 2022, Melbourne: International Women's Development Agency. Available [here](#).

¹³³ Australian Department of Foreign Affairs, 2023. Tonga Country Brief. Available [here](#).

¹³⁴ UN Women, 2022. Gender and Environment Survey 2022 Report, The Kingdom of Tonga. Available [here](#).

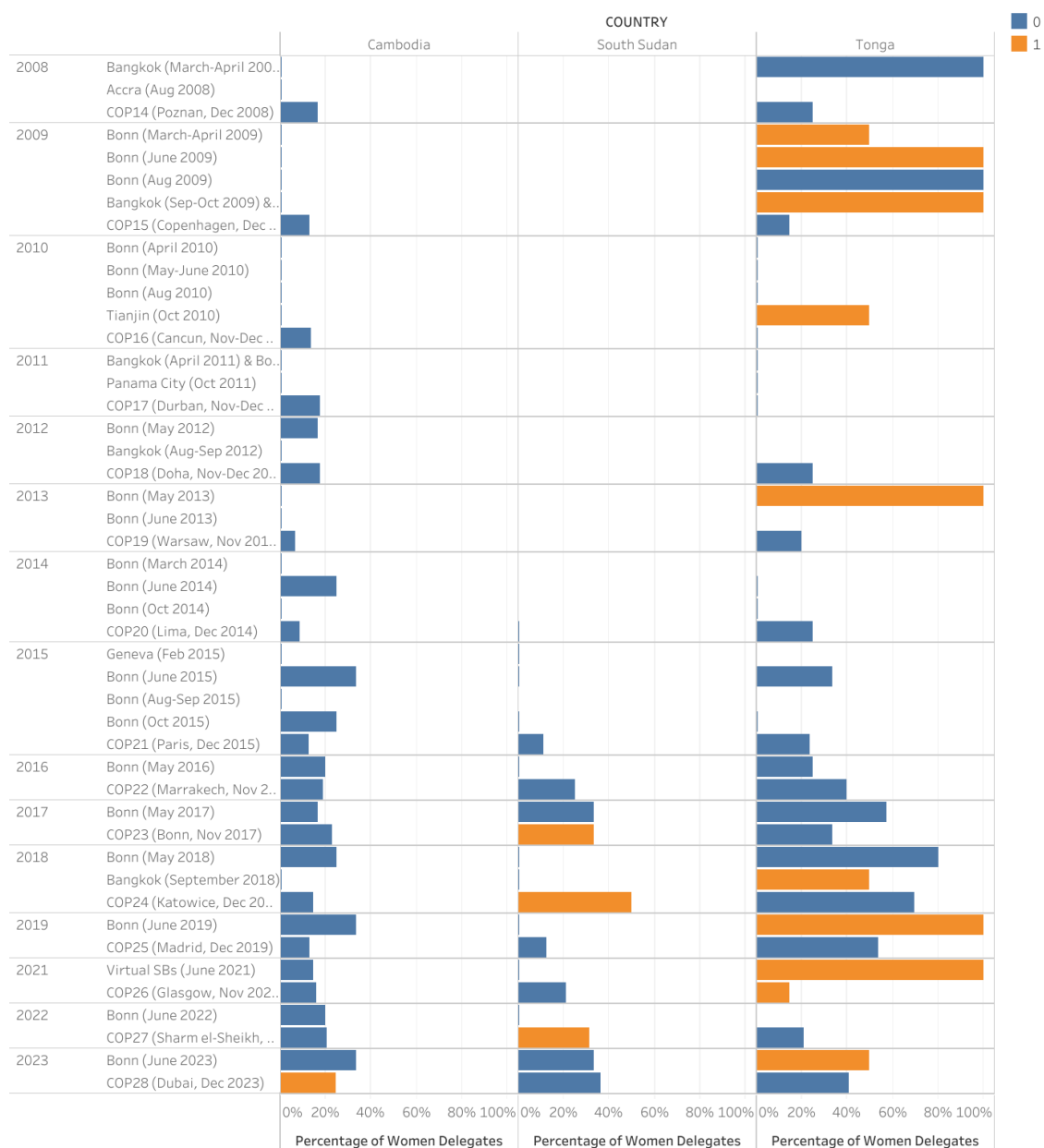
key informants noted that there has been a notable decrease in men undertaking educating roles in Tonga.

Domain 3: Participation, Leadership and Decision-making

132) Globally in UNFCCC processes, delegations are still gender unbalanced. Across countries, 34% of delegations consisted of women, highlighting some way to go to achieve parity. This is important as decisions made in global UNFCCC processes influence national policies, and gender and women's concerns related to climate change are less likely to be considered with fewer women in the delegation.¹³⁵ It is also women's right to have their voices heard in these processes.

133) The below graph¹³⁶ highlights the percentage of women party delegates for UNFCCC Conference of the Parties (COP) and Bonn Intersessionals across the three countries.¹³⁷

Percentage of Women Delegates by Party



¹³⁵ While improving the percentage of women at the table and ensuring their voices may improve gender-specific climate needs and solutions being integrated into the climate negotiations, increasing women's representation and leadership is not the same as developing gender-transformative climate action.

¹³⁶ Gender Climate Tracker, 2024. Women's Participation on Party Delegations. Available [here](#).

¹³⁷ When a Party's percentage is highlighted in orange instead of blue, it indicates that a woman served as Head of Delegation.

Cambodia:

- 134) Women have been found to have less power to voice their opinions and influence decision-making processes in both their families and in wider society.¹³⁸ Further, the engagement of women in climate change actions often depend on the decisions and requirements of donors through the agencies they fund. An analysis by UN Women of the gendered impacts of climate change highlights gender is not evident in these strategic action plans. *“The Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries does not have a sufficient domestic budget for implementing gender activities: in accordance with its mandate, it focuses mostly on the production aspect of the agriculture sector”*.¹³⁹
- 135) In wider politics, women’s participation is far from achieving gender equality in Cambodia as little has been done to address barriers for women to enter politics. In the first national elections in Cambodia in 1993, only 5 out of 120 elected members of parliament were women (4.17%). The nation’s highest number of women in politics was seen in the fourth national elections in 2008 in which the number of women members of parliaments reached 26 out of 123 seats (21.14%). However, the number has then declined from 19 in the sixth national elections (15.45%) to 16 in the latest elections in 2023 (13.6%).¹⁴⁰ Among the 16 women members of the parliament, one of them is currently the President of the National Assembly and two others are Chairs of the Committees. The percentage of Cambodian female senators has increased from 14.75% in 1999 to 16.13% in 2019 of which 2 women hold the position as Chairs of the Committees. Some women’s rights activists believe that political will of the party leaders and patriarchal political leadership are the major factor behind the gender imbalance in politics.¹⁴¹
- 136) There has been a small increase of women in public leadership role and decision-making positions. One woman has been appointed as the Governor of the National Bank (Senior Minister), three women as Ministers, and another woman as National Auditor General. The percentage of female civil servants has increased from 41% in 2018 to 42% in 2022. Women in leadership roles from Deputy Chief of Office to Director General has increased from 24.33% in 2018 to 27% in 2022. At the subnational level, 2 women are Provincial Governors (8% of the total Provincial Governors), and 7 women are District Governors (3.43%). The number of female Commune Chiefs has increased from 130 (7.89%) in 2017 to 176 (10.65%) in 2022 and the percentage of women who are members of the commune councils has increased from 17.7% in 2017 to 22% in 2022.¹⁴² Despite this small increase of women in leadership, gender inequality in decision-making at all levels has persisted and women’s voices in decision-making processes is still very limited.
- 137) In terms of women’s engagement in climate change policy processes at the global level, Cambodia has made some progress on their UNFCCC delegations. COP28 in 2023 marked the first time Cambodia’s head of delegation was a woman. However, the overall proportion of women in the delegation is markedly lower than the global average at 24%.¹⁴³

South Sudan:

- 138) Women and girls have limited representation and voice in community decision-making processes at home including related to income generation, education and climate resilience. At household level, women and men report a high level of male

¹³⁸ Ministry of Rural Development, 2014. Climate Change Action Plan for Rural Development Sector 2014-2018. Available [here](#).

¹³⁹ UN Women and CDRI, 2021. State of Gender Equality and Climate Change in Cambodia 2021. Available [here](#).

¹⁴⁰ Ministry of Women’s Affairs, 2024. Neary Rattanak VI: strategic plan to promote gender equality and empowerment of women and girls. Available [here](#).

¹⁴¹ Heinrich Boll Stiftung, 2023. Reflection: 30 years of Cambodian women in politics. Available [here](#).

¹⁴² Ibid

¹⁴³ Gender Climate Tracker, 2024. Women’s Participation on Party Delegations. Available [here](#).

dominated decision-making. Men are seen as heads of households and social norms privilege male decision-making in traditional, formal and community settings.

- 139) Young people, especially girls, are not adequately involved in planning and implementing climate resilience activities in schools.
- 140) At the community level there are inconsistent and tokenistic levels of inclusion of women in consultations and in decision-making fora, with progress made in certain communities and less so in others. There is widespread social acceptance of decision-making being the responsibility of men and for women to be responsible for accepting the consequences. As such, women's leadership and authority in the community is earned through acquired respect and age.
- 141) There are some reports of young people being included in community consultations, but there is little evidence of systematic inclusion of voices of young women and men across the board.
- 142) South Sudanese women have been advocating for inclusive peace and demanding meaningful participation at all levels of decision-making, especially in politics. The Revitalized Agreement on the Resolution of the Conflict in the Republic of South Sudan includes provisions for a women's participation quota of 35% in various implementing mechanisms and a post for a female vice president. It also addresses the devolution of power to lower levels of governance, the protection of women, children, and people with disabilities, and accountability, justice, and reparations for wartime crimes, including sexual violence.
- 143) Despite these provisions, women's representation at the national level consistently falls below the 35% quota. Among the six Presidency positions, only one is held by a woman, constituting 17%. Out of 35 Ministerial positions, only nine are held by women, making up 26%.¹⁴⁴ Furthermore, among the ten Deputy Minister positions, two are occupied by women, representing 20% of the total. These figures highlight the substantial gap between actual representation and the targeted quota, emphasising the urgent need for measures to enhance gender equality in high-ranking government roles.
- 144) At the state and community levels, there is little awareness of the quota. Several barriers to South Sudanese women's equal representation, influence, and leadership in decision-making processes remain. These include patriarchal ideologies embedded in the culture that have infiltrated modern governance institutions. Women in leadership and decision-making positions are often seen as trivial, despite the unique skills and knowledge they bring to the table.

Proportion of seats held by women in national parliaments and local governments in the public sector	• ~ 24%seats occupied by women¹⁴⁵
Executive Representation	• 1 out of 6 Presidency positions is held by a woman (17%).¹⁴⁶ • 9 out of 35 Ministerial positions are held by women (26%). • 2 out of 10 Deputy Ministerial positions are held by women (28%).¹⁴⁷
Council of State Representation	• 25 out of 100 members are women (25%)¹⁴⁸
Governors Representation	• 1 out of 10 Governors is female (10%) • 3 out of 10 Deputy Governors are women hold (30%)
Local Government Representation	• 2 out of 79 Commissioners are women (3%)¹⁴⁹

¹⁴⁴ Centre for Inclusive Governance, Peace, and Justice (CIGPJ), 2024. January 2024 Report.

¹⁴⁵ World Bank Group, 2023. Proportion of seats held by women in national parliaments. Available [here](#).

¹⁴⁶ UN Women, 2024. Baseline Study on Gender Representation at National and State Levels.

¹⁴⁷ *ibid*

¹⁴⁸ *ibid*

¹⁴⁹ *ibid*

	• 5 out of 50 advisors are women (10%) • 8 out of 60 Chairpersons (13%) • 0 out of 3 Administrators in Administrative Areas are female
State Members of Parliaments (MPs) Representation	• 307 out of 1,000 MPs are female (31%)¹⁵⁰

145) In terms of climate change at the global level, South Sudan has made progress in terms of women on their UNFCCC delegations. Since 2008, South Sudan has had a woman head of delegation three times, and their proportion of the overall delegation has increased to 36% at COP28 in 2023. While more balanced than Cambodia, South Sudan still have a way to go to achieve gender balance.¹⁵¹

Tonga:

- 146) There are no women in the Tongan parliament, and a few factors have been identified that hinder women's participation in Tongan politics. The last four elections in Tonga have never resulted in more than 8% female representation in parliament, the most recent one resulting in none.
- 147) Firstly, the high cost of campaigning is a global obstacle, but in Tonga, it's compounded by the cultural expectation of reciprocity. Voters expect gifts like food, kava, and even infrastructure improvements from candidates, making it difficult for women with fewer resources to compete. Secondly, traditional gender roles persist. Out of a total of 38,500 votes, 34,198 were cast for the male candidates and only 4,352 were cast for the 12 female candidates, down from 14% of total votes in 2017 to 11% in 2021.¹⁵²
- 148) A large-scale study by the Balance of Power program found that 92% of the 1,000 Tongans surveyed believe men possess the necessary skills and experience for parliament.¹⁵³ This perception of male legitimacy as political leaders significantly disadvantages women candidates. Given these challenges, the low number of women elected in recent elections is unsurprising.
- 149) Two major pieces of research on voter's perception of women as leaders conducted in 2016-17 and 2020-21, showed the majority of eligible voters believed key decision-making and leadership roles are best left to men and that roles such as household work and nurturing children are a women's responsibility.
- 150) Across the 178 district and town officers throughout Tonga only 8 are female (4.5%) while 170 are male (95.5%) demonstrating the gendered imbalance in local decision making.¹⁵⁴
- 151) The education sector in Tonga however is known to have more females than males and this is reflected in the various decision-making spaces.
- 152) Despite the gender imbalance in government positions in Tonga, across the three countries, Tonga has the highest rates of women's participation in UNFCCC processes on average. However, when analysing the data it's important to note that at the Bonn conferences, Tonga only sent one delegate, which has often been a woman resulting in 100% of the delegation being women. When focusing on the annual COPs only the picture is less positive, with head of delegation being men on all but one occasion. And the ratio for women in its COP28 delegation a mere 14%.¹⁵⁵

¹⁵⁰ ibid

¹⁵¹ Gender Climate Tracker, 2024. Women's Participation on Party Delegations. Available [here](#).

¹⁵² Guttenbeil-Likiliki, 'O, 2021. No women elected in Tonga: time to change the story. Dev Policy Blog. Available [here](#).

¹⁵³ Dr. Fonua Kata, Lolohea V., 2021, Voters' Perceptions of Women as Leaders in Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹⁵⁴ Data sourced from key informant interviews with senior government officials.

¹⁵⁵ Gender Climate Tracker, 2024. Women's Participation on Party Delegations. Available [here](#).

Domain 4: Access to and Control Over Resources and Services

Cambodia:

- 153) The Cambodia's Education Roadmap 2030¹⁵⁶ envisions that all girls and boys will complete nine years of free, inclusive, equitable and quality basic education and acquire functional literacy and numeracy skills, as well as subject knowledge and cognitive skills that will enable them to develop and reach their full potential.
- 154) A Joint Education Needs Assessment conducted by UNICEF and Save the Children (2020) found a critical gender digital divide in which girls have less access to ICT devices in Cambodia: access to tablets and computers was the most unequal at 28% among boys' vs 18% among girls.¹⁵⁷
- 155) COVID-19 has had gendered and inclusion impacts on learning continuity, furthering the divide between boys and girls, and those children with and without disabilities in Cambodia. Boys, who prior to COVID-19 were already struggling to enrol, stay and perform well in schools, are now (17%) more at risk of dropping out than girls (14%) in the needs assessment,¹⁵⁸ with children from poorer background being more at risk (19%) than those who are not poor (15%).
- 156) Boys are more likely than girls to work full-time and and/or work part-time, while girls are being asked to contribute to household chores more than boys (65% versus 55%). At 78%, girls are still more likely to have additional duties at home or additional working arrangements that may take away from time previously spent learning- compared to 68% of boys.¹⁵⁹
- 157) The gender parity index in primary education enrolment is also remarkably close to the parity line. Lower secondary education enrolment had also expanded rapidly, especially between 2000 and 2008, when the gross enrolment rate in lower secondary schools ballooned from 22.6% in 2000 to 60.6% in 2008. Girls greatly benefited from this education expansion as the gender parity index markedly increased from 0.56 to 0.91. The parity index continued to increase, and by 2013, girls' enrolment started to surpass boys' enrolment for the first time.¹⁶⁰
- 158) Gender stereotypes and attitudes of society and family continue to divide work by sex, which hinders the development of women's roles in modern society. Women have been encouraged to embrace skills and work according to gender stereotype and perspectives of society and family, which has not enabled girls and women to select and decide for jobs following market demands. In addition, this has led to a dearth of women and girls who study or work in Science, Technology, Engineering, Art, and Mathematics (STEAM), which is a severe loss to society.¹⁶¹

South Sudan:

- 159) In South Sudan, access to education, knowledge, and skills is critical to addressing the widespread gender disparities that exist in the country. Climate change exacerbates health risks for women and girls, including increased exposure to waterborne diseases and malnutrition. Access to sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR) services is limited, further affecting girls' ability to stay in school and participate fully in community life.
- 160) Girls in South Sudan face significant barriers to education, including CEFMU, conflict, and poverty. Only 33% of girls complete primary school, and the percentage of girls who

¹⁵⁶ Cambodia's Education Roadmap 2030 Sustainable Development. Available [here](#).

¹⁵⁷ Government of Cambodia, 2020. Cambodia COVID-19 Joint Education Needs Assessment. Available [here](#).

¹⁵⁸ *ibid*

¹⁵⁹ *ibid*

¹⁶⁰ Cambodia Development Resource Institute, 2023. Gender Gap Reversal in Learning and Gender-Responsive Teaching in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

¹⁶¹ Ministry of Women's Affairs, 2021. Cambodia's Five Years Strategic Plan for Strengthening Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment, Available [here](#).

continue to secondary school is even lower. This is exacerbated by factors such as long travel distances to school, inadequate sanitation facilities, and gender-based violence.¹⁶²

- 161) Deeply rooted cultural norms and practices often discourage girls from continuing their education, as many are forced into early marriages. Tackling these issues requires not only legal reforms but also community-based interventions that shift attitudes about girls' education and women's roles in society.
- 162) Boys are also affected by the conflict, with key informants saying, *"we need more schools and teachers who understand our needs,"* said a boy from Akobo County and another from Maban County saying *"we are afraid to go to school because of the dangerous paths, abduction and lack of security."*
- 163) Many schools have been destroyed by conflict, limiting access to basic education services, especially for girls. Programs focusing on education in emergencies are vital to providing continuity for children in conflict-affected areas, ensuring they do not lose out on years of learning.
- 164) South Sudan faces significant challenges in education, particularly in relation to gender, climate resilience, and knowledge sharing systems. Conflict, displacement, and the effects of climate change have disrupted the education sector, limiting access to quality education, particularly for women and girls. This lack of access contributes to vulnerability, as education and knowledge, especially on early warning systems (EWS) and information and climate resilience, are critical to mitigating the adverse impacts of climate change.
- 165) Women and girls in South Sudan, particularly in rural areas, have lower literacy rates than their male counterparts, making it harder for them to access formal education or vocational training opportunities that could build their adaptive capacity. According to UNESCO, the adult literacy rate in South Sudan is approximately 27%, with a significant gender gap where women's literacy rates are just 16%, compared to 40% for men.¹⁶³ This disparity limits their ability to engage in knowledge and skills transfer processes, further exacerbating gender inequalities in education, labour markets and climate resilience.
- 166) Education systems in South Sudan are further strained by the lack of infrastructure and the constant threat of climate-related shocks, such as flooding and drought, which often disrupt schooling. Women and girls are disproportionately affected by these disruptions as they are often expected to stay home to help with household chores or take care of siblings, especially in crisis situations. Data indicates that over 2.8 million children, particularly girls, remain out of school in South Sudan due to these combined challenges.¹⁶⁴
- 167) Key informants further highlighted the need for school meals and additional schools and healthcare facilities - *"We need programs that provide nutritious meals to children at school to keep them healthy and focused,"* said a school management board member from Upper Nile State. *"We have policies in place, but lack of resources and trained personnel hinders effective implementation,"* said an official from Upper Nile State. *"We need more schools and healthcare facilities to support our communities,"* noted an education board member from Jonglei State.
- 168) Key informants stressed the desire to send their daughters to school and be involved in school management. *"We want our daughters to go to school, but there are no facilities for them, especially for those with disabilities,"* woman, Maban County and a parent from Akobo County noted *"We want to be part of the school management to ensure our children's needs are met."*
- 169) Additionally, women's and girls' exclusion from EWS and information severely undermine their ability to respond to climate risks. Early warning systems are often

¹⁶² Land Coalition, 2024. Uneven Ground – Shocking State of Land Inequality in the World. Available [here](#).

¹⁶³ UNESCO, 2020. South Sudan Literacy Rate. Available [here](#).

¹⁶⁴ Global Partnership for Education, 2021. Transforming education in South Sudan. Available [here](#).

based on community alerts, weather forecasts, or government announcements, yet women's access to such systems is limited by gendered barriers such as illiteracy, lack of access to technology, and exclusion from decision-making processes. Climate resilience highlights that less than 20% of women in South Sudan receive timely information on weather patterns or disaster preparedness, a gap that significantly reduces their capacity to adapt to climate shocks.¹⁶⁵

- 170) Empowering women and girls through education and skills development—particularly on topics like early warning systems, climate adaptation, and disaster risk reduction—is crucial for building their resilience and ensuring they can contribute to local and national development. Increasing women's participation in education by just 10% could reduce poverty and boost economic growth significantly, particularly in regions hardest hit by conflict and climate change.¹⁶⁶
- 171) The government has developed a National Girls' Education Strategy (2024-2028) to address the educational needs of girls, focusing on improving enrolment, retention, and completion rates. This strategy includes efforts to provide scholarships for girls, create safe learning environments, and raise awareness of the importance of girls' education through community mobilisation.
- 172) The government and various NGOs have started to promote vocational training and life skills programs targeted at young girls and women to enhance their economic independence. These programs aim to build skills in digital literacy, entrepreneurship, and technical knowledge related to climate resilience, enabling women and girls to have greater control over their lives and futures.¹⁶⁷
- 173) To enhance community preparedness, there are emerging efforts to integrate gender-sensitive early warning systems. These systems involve building community knowledge on climate hazards, disaster risk reduction, and how to respond to emergencies. Women and girls are often the first responders in disaster situations and ensuring that they have access to EWS is essential for protecting vulnerable populations.¹⁶⁸

Tonga:

- 174) Tongan girls are underrepresented in primary education, with a Gender Parity Index of 88 (well below the developing country average of 96). In secondary and tertiary education ratings improve (at 97 and 98 respectively), however, Tongan women still account for only 39% of the non-agricultural workforce.¹⁶⁹
- 175) The monarch owns land in Tonga, and the Land Act prioritises male heirs in inheritance and land allocation. This disproportionately impacts women's access to a crucial resource. A key challenge lies in the disconnect between understanding the principles of gender equality and applying them within the context of Tongan customs, traditions, values, and religious beliefs. Public opinion surveys, for example, may demonstrate broad support for women's access to land. However, this support is often limited to housing purposes, as traditional gender roles dictate that women are not expected to participate in commercial farming.
- 176) Tongan inheritance laws create significant barriers for women, leaving them with limited options in abusive relationships. Women lacking income or assets are often forced to remain in households with violent partners due to the difficulty of securing independent housing. This vulnerability is exacerbated by conflicting legal structures. While a Police Safety Order can exclude a male partner from the home, the Land Act (2016) grants him the right to reside on the property. This essentially forces women to leave their own homes, potentially facing homelessness, rather than escape the

¹⁶⁵ FAO, 2024. Resilience Building in South Sudan. FAO Programme Review. Available [here](#).

¹⁶⁶ World Bank, 2020. Getting it Right: Strengthening Gender Outcomes in South Sudan. Available [here](#).

¹⁶⁷ Land Coalition, 2024. Uneven Ground – Shocking State of Land Inequality in the World. Available [here](#).

¹⁶⁸ Welthungerhilfe, 2024. Global Land Inequality Report: The Gap with Land Ownership Is Widening Around the World. Available [here](#).

¹⁶⁹ UN Women, Tonga Country Profile. Available [here](#).

violence. The rise of informal land leasing further complicates the issue. Women may not have recourse to their own family land, as it might no longer be in their family's possession.¹⁷⁰

- 177) The 2022 disasters inflicted widespread damage on housing and essential infrastructure. Roughly 12% of residents experienced damaged dwellings, and over half (55%) lost access to clean drinking water. Furthermore, 15% of the population resorted to unclean cooking fuels for more than two weeks. Disasters also exacerbated sanitation issues, with 4% of women and 5% of men forced to share facilities with other households. A concerning 1% of women and 2% of men had to revert to unimproved sanitation methods like public latrines or open defecation. Sharing sanitation facilities, using poorly lit facilities, or facilities lacking locks significantly increases the risk of assault, particularly for women. These safety concerns were likely amplified by disaster-related power outages.¹⁷¹
- 178) The eruption of Hunga Tonga-Hunga Ha'apai volcano triggered extensive power outages that continue to plague Tonga a year later. Volcanic ash corroding electrical cables is the culprit behind these repeated disruptions. The lack of electricity and public lighting has exacerbated existing economic instability and social stressors, potentially contributing to safety concerns nationwide.¹⁷²
- 179) Following the eruption of Hunga Tonga-Hunga Ha'apai volcano, there was a notable increase in the number of people utilising e-learning platforms, especially the 'HAMA e-learning platform' for children's home schooling.¹⁷³ The Ministry of Education and Training facilitated a COVID-19 education programme which included offering radio classes for the primary levels and online classes for the secondary and tertiary levels. Non-Government schools also implemented their own COVID-19 education programmes which included zoom classes and online classes.¹⁷⁴
- 180) Impacts of COVID-19 had a devastating impact on the well-being of children and their families. The stopping of schooling significantly impacted the well-being and educational outcomes. Through collaborations with the Ministry of Education, Save the Children has been key in innovating tools and programs that encompass safety and well-being of children and their families.¹⁷⁵
- 181) The National Women's Empowerment and Gender Equality Policy notes that the specific vulnerabilities of women are recognised in programmes relating to natural hazards and climate change. The Department of Climate Change is headed by the Director Lu'isa Tu'i'afitu Malolo, who emphasised increasing gender parity on her team as a result of increased investments in education.
- 182) One in three people met the threshold for experiencing some level of Energy deprivation. A higher proportion of men were severely deprived compared to women. Energy deprivation also varied by location, with rural areas more likely to be deprived.
- 183) Tonga Women in ICT has been an investment that has continued to grow with targeted programs for women and girls. It grew in recognition of the skill gaps that existed within Tongan women and girls, across their diversities, in accessing technology and growing in sectors that are not commonly undertaken by women such as engineering.

¹⁷⁰ UN Women, 2022. Gender Equality Brief for Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹⁷¹ UN Women, Gender and Environment Survey 2022 Report, The Kingdom of Tonga. Available [here](#).

¹⁷² Ibid.

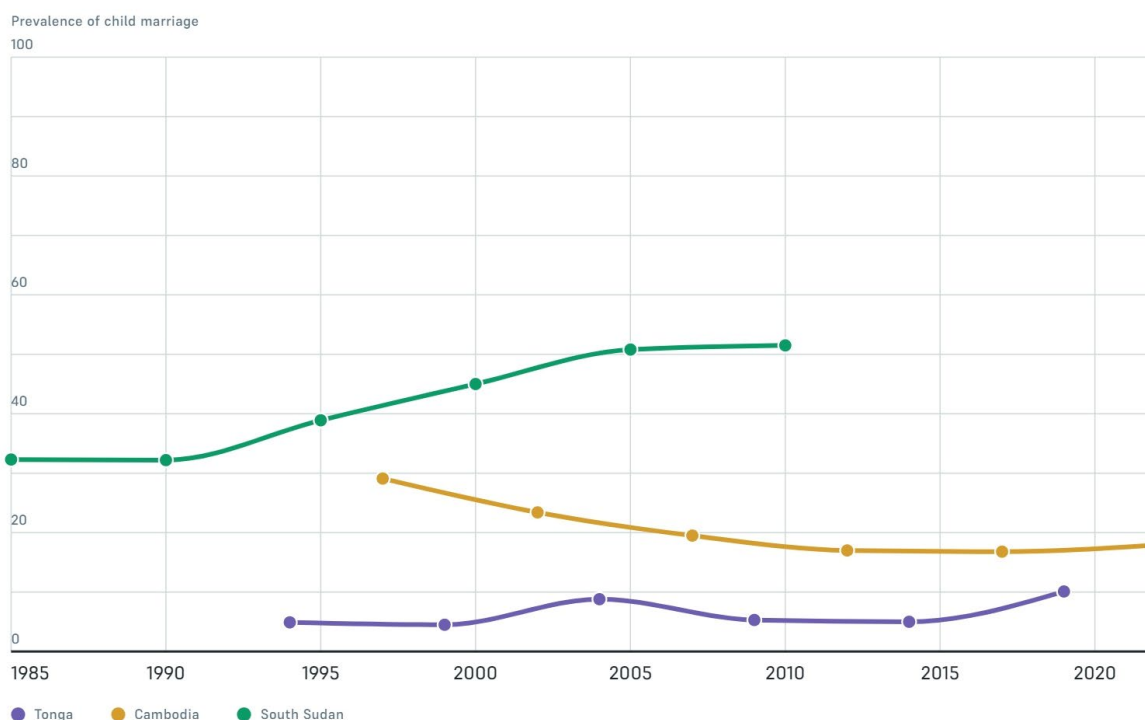
¹⁷³ The Hama distance e-learning program utilises technology to reach outlying islands and remote populations.

¹⁷⁴ United Nations General Assembly, 2023. National report submitted pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21*. *Human Rights Council Working Group on the Universal Periodic Review Forty-third session 1–12 May 2023*. Available [here](#).

¹⁷⁵ Kingdom of Tonga, Ministry of Education and Training.

Domain 5: Safety, Dignity and Well-being

184) There are varying rates of CEFMU across the countries, illustrated by the graph below.¹⁷⁶



Cambodia:

185) In Cambodia, recent data shows that one in five (21%) women aged 15-49 reported having experienced emotional, physical, or sexual violence by their current or most recent intimate partner in their lifetime which has reduced from 29% in 2014.¹⁷⁷ GBV affects women and LGBTQI+ people in both private and in public spaces, including at the workplaces. Forms of GBV include traditional harmful practices such as CEFMU, sexual harassment in the workplace, sexual exploitation and abuse through trafficking and technology facilitated GBV.¹⁷⁸

186) According to a UN Population Fund's (UNFPA) 2023 Situation Report,¹⁷⁹ *“the perpetration of GBV is strongly correlated with harmful gender and social norms which are rooted in gender-inequitable constructions of masculinity, including sexual entitlement. While Cambodia has seen dramatic changes with more women entering the workforce in the past few decades, traditional gender attitudes towards women’s roles in the family and society still impact their access to opportunities, control over their bodies, and risks for GBV. Recent data shows that 37% of women and 16% of men believe there is at least one of six reasons that it is acceptable for a husband to beat his wife/partner”*.

187) Traditionally, many Cambodians rely on their parents to marry. Arranged marriage is still a common practice in Cambodia, influenced by tradition and religion. *“Generally, Cambodians are encouraged to get married before leaving home. While men and women can choose their spouses, parents will organise dates in order to assist their*

¹⁷⁶ UNICEF/Child Marriage Data Portal, 2024. Available [here](#).

¹⁷⁷ The Phnom Penh Post, 2023. Campaigns tackles gender-based violence in Cambodia. Article. Available [here](#).

¹⁷⁸ UNFPA, 2023. Harmful social & gender norms that drive gender-based violence in Cambodia. Available [here](#).

¹⁷⁹ Ibid

*children in finding a suitable partner. One main consideration for parents is the social class of their child's prospective partner and their family".*¹⁸⁰

- 188) Cambodian girls usually marry between the age of 18-25 years old. However, Plan International Cambodia has expressed concerns about CEFMU which still occurs in Cambodia, revealing that 19% of girls and 6% of boys were married before reaching the age of 18 between 2021 and 2022, while 1.8% of girls aged 15 and below were forced to get married.¹⁸¹

South Sudan:

- 189) Girls as young as 10 are often auctioned into marriage for cows, a practice that violates human rights, impedes literacy, and perpetuates poverty. As a result, about a third of girls in the country are pregnant before turning 15.¹⁸² This practice is driven by poverty, cultural traditions, and the belief that marriage offers protection or economic benefits. The consequences are severe, including increased risks of maternal mortality, school dropouts, and lifelong health and social challenges.¹⁸³ To combat this, the government, supported by humanitarian organisations, has implemented strategic plans to end child marriage by 2030. These plans include legal reforms, awareness campaigns, and initiatives to improve girls' access to education and reproductive health services.
- 190) South Sudan ranks 160 of 163 countries in the 2023 Global Peace Index, indicating significant internal conflict and low peace levels.¹⁸⁴ GBV remains a prevalent issue exacerbated by ongoing conflict and socio-economic instability with women and girls being particularly vulnerable to physical and sexual violence, often in the context of armed conflict and displacement.
- 191) According to the 2024 Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan, 9.4 million people need humanitarian assistance, of these, 2.2 million are women and 4.9 million are children and potentially at risk of GBV.¹⁸⁵ This includes rape and sexual assault, abductions of women and children, particularly during cattle rustling, forced sexual favours, domestic violence, psychological and emotional abuse, and CEFMU and can also increase during or after climate-related disasters. According to Save the Children, South Sudan is one of the world's 10 hotspots for both climate change and child marriage.¹⁸⁶
- 192) In 2023, the United Nations Mission in South Sudan documented numerous incidents of violence against civilians, including sexual violence.¹⁸⁷
- 193) Efforts to address GBV include the establishment of special protection units at police stations to enable women and girls to report such cases. However, the enforcement of laws and protective measures remains inconsistent, and cultural norms continue to perpetuate GBV.
- 194) Further, high levels of GBV are accompanied by high levels of social acceptance of violence; two in three women in South Sudan experience GBV in their lifetime.¹⁸⁸ Traditional models of masculinity and femininity promote inequitable relationships and GBV; forms of GBV in South Sudan include IPV, rape, CEFMU and female genital mutilation (FGM).¹⁸⁹ In the traditional South Sudanese context, given the customary practice of paying a bride price, a married woman is seen as the property of her

¹⁸⁰ Ibid

¹⁸¹ National Institute of Statistics, 2023. Cambodian Population and Health Survey 2021- 2022. Available [here](#).

¹⁸² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO), 2023. UK-South Sudan partnership development summary Policy Paper. Available [here](#).

¹⁸³ UNICEF, 2020. Child Marriage Case Studies: Join Hands to End Child Marriage. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁴ Institute for Economics & Peace (IEP), 2023. Global Peace Index 2023. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁵ OCHA, 2023. South Sudan Humanitarian Needs and Response Plan 2024. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁶ Save the Children, 2023. Global Girlhood Report 2023: Girls at the Centre of the Storm – Her planet, her future, her solutions. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁷ United Nations Mission in South Sudan, 2023. Brief on Violence Affecting Civilians. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁸ Global Issues News, 2021. The Real Price of Marriage in South Sudan. Available [here](#).

¹⁸⁹ World Economic Forum, 2024. Global Gender Gap Report 2024. Available [here](#).

husband's family and clan. Marriage is thus a communal affair, and marital problems, including domestic violence and divorce, are seen as community concerns rather than private matters between a husband and his wife.¹⁹⁰ Only men can traditionally obtain a divorce and the wife's family must pay back the bride price.¹⁹¹

- 195) Women and girls in South Sudan face significant challenges in accessing health services, particularly those related to SRHR. Maternal mortality rates are among the highest in the region, and the country also has a high incidence of teenage pregnancies. Women's physical autonomy is often compromised by violence both within and outside the family, and by limited choices regarding sexuality and reproduction.
- 196) Efforts to improve health outcomes include initiatives by the Ministry of Health, which provide comprehensive sexuality education and expand access to reproductive health services. However, progress is hindered by cultural barriers and inadequate healthcare infrastructure. Programs focusing on maternal health, family planning, and addressing harmful practices such as FGM are essential for improving women's health and sexual self-determination.
- 197) Overall, access to healthcare in South Sudan is limited, leading to some of the highest maternal and child mortality rates in the world. The Maternal Mortality Ratio remains critically high, with only minimal reduction over the past five years, currently standing at 1,223 per 100,000 live births.¹⁹²
- 198) Health issues were a major concern for key informants, with limited access to healthcare. Many women, especially pregnant ones, are forced to give birth at home due to a lack of maternal health services. *"Access to healthcare is very limited, especially for pregnant women. Many of us have to give birth at home,"* shared a woman from Maban County. Another echoed this sentiment, emphasising the lack of maternal health services, *"we need more clinics and trained health workers in our communities."*

Tonga:

- 199) Data from the 2019 MICS survey reveals a concerning link between attitudes towards violence and its prevalence in Tonga.¹⁹³ A significant proportion of women (38.1%) believed that violence against a spouse could be justified in certain situations. The most common reasons cited were neglect of children (31.4%), going out without permission (21.8%), and refusing sex (8.3%).
- 200) The survey shows a significant decline (68%) in non-partner physical violence compared to the 2009 National Study on Domestic Violence against Women in Tonga. In the 2019 survey, 3.2% of women reported experiencing non-partner sexual violence since age 15, with a higher prevalence in rural areas (3.6%) compared to urban areas (1.6%). Notably, employers or someone at work were the most frequent perpetrators of non-partner sexual violence (18.7%).¹⁹⁴
- 201) The Safety and Protection Cluster chaired by the Ministry of Internal Affairs oversees gender and protection at a national level.
- 202) The Tonga Police and women's centres have established a two-way referral system. However, there's no integrated referral system across all family violence service providers, impacting survivor assistance. Without such a system, the principle of 'no wrong door' remains unrealised, leaving survivor safety compromised. Ensuring survivor safety and long-term welfare requires a unified priority among services, providing both immediate and ongoing support. NGOs offer counselling, yet frontline responders need training in referral processes. Skilled counsellors are essential for addressing complex

¹⁹⁰ World Economic Forum, 2024. Global Gender Gap Report 2024. Available [here](#).

¹⁹¹ CARE International, 2020. Gender in Brief South Sudan. Available [here](#).

¹⁹² District Health Information System (DHIS2). Available [here](#).

¹⁹³ Tonga Statistics Department, 2020. Tonga Multiple Indicator Cluster Survey 2019, Survey Findings Report. Nuku'alofa, Tonga: Tonga Statistics Department. Available [here](#).

¹⁹⁴ *ibid*

trauma. Tonga's lack of integrated services and support personnel increases the risk of service dropout and harm for women and children.

- 203) The risk of GBV towards women and girls increases in the event of a natural hazard or extreme weather event. Following Tropical Cyclone Gita in 2018, women and girls in Tonga reported feeling unsafe because there was no electricity which restricted access to lighting and phones.¹⁹⁵ Health care providers noted that when women are physically injured through family violence, nothing is reported to the health care system; victims prefer to seek medical treatment in a Tongatapu hospital to avoid the shame and lack of privacy experienced closer to home.
- 204) The rate of child marriage in Tonga is the lower across the countries but has increased in recent years to 10.1% from a low of 4.9% in 1994.¹⁹⁶

¹⁹⁵ The Government of Tonga and World Bank. 2018. Post Disaster Rapid Assessment, Tropical Cyclone Gita February 12, 2018. Available [here](#).

¹⁹⁶ The Child Marriage Data Portal. Child Marriage in Tonga. Available [here](#).

Recommendations

The recommendations are specific to the BRACE project. We would also expect these to be scalable and replicable beyond the boundaries and implementation of the project. GESI has also been included in the wider project logframe.

Component 1: Building Climate-Resilient School Infrastructure and Systems

Domain 1: Laws, Policies and Institutions

Recommendation 1:

- **Strengthen coordination across ministries and wider sectors to support gender-responsive climate change and education policies and programming.** Support coordination across Ministries responsible for gender, climate change and education at all levels. Support the engagement of women's rights and youth organizations in cross-sectorial working groups, coordination mechanisms and multi-stakeholder dialogues.
- **Enhance institutional capacity on gender-responsive climate change, DRR and education policies and practice.** Support relevant government stakeholders and local institutions and organisations with training, mentoring and upskilling in gender-responsive policies and practices.
- **Support the equal and meaningful engagement of children, youth, women, people with disabilities, diverse ethnic and racial groups and other marginalised groups in climate change and education policies** including the development, implementation and monitoring of such policies.

Domain 2: Social Norms, Roles, Responsibilities and Time Use

Recommendation 2:

- **Consider GESI when preparing teaching and learning materials for children and teacher trainer guides.** There is an opportunity to strengthen GESI when developing climate teacher training modules or teaching and learning materials. This includes ensuring they highlight the disproportionate impact of climate change on marginalised groups, the root causes, how to address this, and how to promote climate justice.
- **Recognise children face different barriers in accessing education,** especially during and after extreme weather events. Conduct community awareness campaigns, especially before an identified climate hazards through anticipatory actions, with the aim of supporting girls' access to education and SRHR and reduce (S)GBV. Additionally, implement targeted programs to support girls' education, including scholarships, mentorship, and awareness campaigns about the importance of educating girls. Address boys' diminished completion rates in Cambodia and safety issues in South Sudan where possible.
- **Include GESI when conducting climate-related school safety risk assessments** in schools and developing action plans to ensure these activities address all members of the community.
- **Engage men and boys** in recognising, understanding and promoting gender equality and addressing harmful gender norms and practices and shift toxic notions of masculinity towards more healthy/positive masculinity, through for example teaching and learning materials and awareness raising campaigns.
- **Foster strong partnerships and collaboration** with organisations representing specific groups, including child or youth-led groups, feminist, SOGEISC and women's organisations, and organisations of people with disabilities. Engage with stakeholders

at community, sub-national, national, and regional levels to leverage diverse expertise and resources. Collectively create inclusive, effective strategies that address the unique needs of all community members, promote gender equality, and enhance the resilience and sustainability of initiatives. This collaborative approach can ensure all voices are heard and integrated into decision-making processes, ultimately leading to more equitable and impactful outcomes.

Domain 3: Participation, Leadership and Decision-Making

Recommendation 3:

- **Enhance marginalised groups' participation in decision-making.** Ensure any platform or committee (e.g. school management committee) created or strengthened is inclusive of those often marginalised to participate in decision-making processes at all levels, including community planning and governance.
- **Support the equal and meaningful participation of *all* children** in child clubs related to climate change and the environment.
- **Improve access to climate information and early warning information.** Ensure early warning information is child friendly and gender and disability responsive. This can support inclusive participation in subsequent decisions to address climate change impacts.
- **Conduct participatory risk assessment and climate-related school safety plans.** Support the active and equal engagement of girls and boys in conducting risk assessments and developing climate-related school safety plans.
- **Engage marginalised groups** such as girls, women, people with disabilities and others in trainings such as with sub-national education officials, teachers, child clubs, School Management Committees (SMC), Parent Teacher Associations (PTA), etc. This includes supporting women education officials to be trained as master trainers on climate resilience. Specifically, provide girls and women with training and resources to adapt to climate change.

Domain 4: Access To and Control Over Resources and Services

Recommendation 4:

- **Ensure climate-resilient infrastructure construction or rehabilitation in schools, including WASH facilities, consider the needs of different genders and those with disabilities.** Ensure gender and disability are central to policies on construction, conducting assessments of school infrastructure or directly rehabilitating or retrofitting school infrastructure and WASH facilities. Unsuitable WASH facilities can be a cause of girls or children with disabilities not attending school. Ensure gender and disability responsive facilities such as separate toilets and menstrual hygiene management resources, to increase girls' attendance and retention and support inclusion. When enhancing climate resilience of school infrastructure, ensure it is resilient and accessible for all stakeholders.
- **Identify root causes of school dropout due to climate impacts.** Develop inclusive education continuity/climate-related school safety plans that include provisions and actions to reduce risk for those most marginalised.
- **Consider gender when analysing labour market** to identify current and future climate-related demands to inform relevant curriculum development materials. Additionally, undertake labour market analysis of potential barriers to entry for women and people with disabilities in identified climate-related professions to support targeted development of the curriculum and career pathways.
- **Consider GESI barriers to access when designing training and outreach.** Offer training and outreach sessions at different times of the day (including evenings) to accommodate the availability of both men and women. This should be articulated by project leadership and through project communications.

Domain 5: Safety, Dignity and Well-Being

Recommendation 5:

- **Conduct community awareness campaigns** to inform communities about gender equality, climate resilience and possible increases of GBV due to climate impacts and what to do (i.e. share posters on where to go for support on GBV). Use local media, community meetings, and educational programs to disseminate information. Include these actions in Standard Operating Procedures.
- **Foster community support:** Engage community leaders and stakeholders in advocating for gender-responsive policies and practices. Build partnerships with local organisations to support advocacy efforts.
- **Ensure all project Grievance Redress Mechanisms are child friendly and accessible** in schools and communities.

Components 2 and 3: Enhancing Access to Climate Finance for Education and Coordination and Knowledge Sharing on Climate and Education

Recommendation 6:

- **Strengthen the collection of disaggregated data.** Where possible, identify and advocate for disaggregated data related to education and climate change by a minimum of age, gender and disability status.
- **Include GESI in NAP reviews.** Align the work on including education, children and youth in NAP Global Network priorities on GESI.
- **Engage children in BRACE Coordination Mechanism.** Support child/youth-led and women's organisation representatives to engage in the BRACE Coordination Mechanism and ensure this is gender-balanced.
- **Include GESI in the development and implementation of the Climate Change and Education Declaration Roadmap.** Conduct an intergenerational workshop to facilitate this that includes child/youth-led and women's organisations.
- **Include a 'tag' on gender, disability and children/youth in the proposed knowledge management platform.**
- **Develop guidance that includes GESI.** Ensure any guidance produced for multilateral climate funds or the global education sector includes how climate change affects marginalised group's access to education and how to address this.
- **Support child/youth-led and women's organisations to speak at and join webinars on climate change and education.**
- **Identify and share innovative projects that are gender transformative and inclusive.**

Project Team

Recommendation 7:

- **Monitoring and evaluation:** Develop gender and inclusion sensitive indicators to monitor and evaluate the impact of BRACE and ensure regular reporting on gender and inclusion outputs. Ensure and promote disaggregated data collection.
- **Capacity:** Ensure all project staff are trained in gender equality and social inclusion, including disseminating findings from this gender assessment and action plan with staff and partners. Employ GESI technical expertise supported by central GESI technical advisors and additional technical support on disability inclusion, as required, such as for sign language interpretation and translation. Integrate

consideration of diverse groups' needs into technical staff position descriptions. Equip GESI advisors to mentor and train government counterparts and project personnel at all levels.

- **Representation:** Where possible ensure gender-balance in the project team, including women in leadership positions, training and promotion of people with disability.
- **Inclusive communication and engagement:** Project communications should be designed to challenge harmful social norms. All training materials use clear language, visuals, and practical demonstrations, including where needed, braille, audio recordings, and videos with sign language interpretation. Utilise a range of traditional and new media to ensure inclusivity. For example, by using appropriate language; and showing women, across their diversities, people with disability and youth in active leadership roles. Consider providing childcare options during training sessions to remove barriers for parents, particularly mothers.
- **Safeguarding:** Develop robust reporting and referral protocols to address incidents of violence against children, as well as SGBV. Ensure alignment with Save the Children's Preventing Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Harassment policy, along with adherence to Child Protection guidelines.

Gender and Social Inclusion Action Plan

Component 1

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Project goal statement: IF the education stakeholders in climate-vulnerable countries are better informed of climate risks and adaptation options for the education sector, as well as have access to global knowledge, policy exchange and financing, and IF the target schools are teaching children about climate change and become safer and greener, THEN the school systems of the target countries and beyond, including children and communities, become more resilient, BECAUSE , policies of the education sector becomes more responsive to climate change, there will be increased climate finance for the sector, Ministry of Education staff, students and communities will become more knowledgeable and engaged in climate adaptation actions and advocacy.				
Component 1: Building Climate-Resilient School Infrastructure and Systems				
Outcome 1: The education sector at national and sub-national levels in targeted countries is more resilient to the impacts of climate change.				
Output 1.1: Enabling systems and policies are in place and supported				
Activity 1.1.1: Facilitate preparation and endorsement of climate and education policies, plans and guidelines	(GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Provide technical support to all policy reviews (e.g. Climate and Change and Education Policy and Implementation Guidelines and Inter-agency Network for Education in Emergencies (INEE) Minimum Standards, (South Sudan), National Climate Resilience in Education Framework (Cambodia)) to ensure the explicit consideration of the different needs of girls, boys, men and women, people with disabilities, people with diverse SOGIESC, and ethnic minority people and include clear recommendations to advance GESI. (GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) All consultations in the preparation of these policies will be done in gender responsive ways including consultations with stakeholders, including women's groups, youth groups, girl-led organisations, ethnic minority, LGBTQI+ organisations and education experts with their views represented and highlighted clearly. Indicators: % of policy reviews include GESI analysis, actions and indicators (<i>Target: 100%</i>). % of policy reviews include consultations with women's groups, youth groups, girl-led organisations etc. (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, Education Advisor, Climate DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education and Ministry of Women's Affairs/Gender representatives	USD \$77,837

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Activity 1.1.2 Strengthen coordination on climate change within Ministries of Education and different line ministries at national and sub-national level	(GESI action, Cambodia and South Sudan) Organise a reflective workshop on gender, power, inequality and decision-making to identify how the differential impacts of climate change affect access to quality education and learning. (GESI action, Cambodia) Organise and facilitate an annual multi-stakeholder dialogue event focused on climate change, disaster risk, inclusion and environmental safeguarding that includes the Ministry of Women's Affairs, civil society organisations (including local youth and women's groups), the Local Education Group (including the Education Sector Working Group (ESWG)), alongside the other stakeholders. (GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Include GESI analysis and actions in major/relevant coordination meetings and documents to coordinate gender-responsive climate actions. (GESI action, Cambodia) Establish a national coordination platform on climate-smart education that includes the Ministry of Women's Affairs. (GESI action, South Sudan) Assess and build the capacities of different marginalised groups to engage in climate resilience activities (e.g. marginalised groups identified in the assessment- women, girls, children, youth, pastoralist, farming communities, people with disabilities, internally displaced people, refugees, Indigenous and Ethnic Minority Groups and local groups). Indicators: • % of coordination platforms and processes that include representatives from Ministry of Women's Affairs, youth, disability, Indigenous and women's groups (<i>Target: 100%</i>). • # of coordination platform documents and outcomes which include GESI analysis • Level of integration of GESI in climate-related coordination mechanisms (participatory self-assessment)	Y 1, 2	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, GESI specialist, Education Advisor, Climate DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education and Ministry of Women's Affairs/Gender representatives.	USD \$24,886
Activity 1.1.3 Facilitate integration of DRR into existing and/or new plans with education authorities.	(GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Explicitly include the different needs of girls, boys, men, women, and people with disabilities in sub-national level hazard and vulnerability assessments to identify and address different risks.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, Education Advisor,	USD \$26,947

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
	(GESI action, Cambodia and South Sudan) Support the development of participatory DRR plans with government officials and include clear recommendations to advance GESI. (GESI action, Cambodia South Sudan) Consult marginalised groups, including girls/women, children and people with disabilities, in the testing of the DRR plans to ensure it works for them with their views are represented and highlighted clearly. Indicators: % of new or updated risk assessments and DRR plans including needs and recommendations on GESI <i>(Target: 100%)</i>.		Climate DRR Advisor Externally: Education authorities	
Activity 1.1.4 Support children to participate in climate change and education policy initiatives.	(GESI action, Cambodia) Provide technical support to ensure virtual web-based platform for climate action considers the accessibility needs of all children and that advocacy campaigns consider and action GESI analysis. E.g. use plain language and visuals in awareness materials to enhance accessibility for individuals with cognitive disabilities; feature individuals with disabilities, schools in vulnerable e.g. public and private schools (teachers, students, and parents); materials in local language to cater to diverse populations. (GESI action, South Sudan) Provide mentorship, training and additional support to girls and children with disabilities where needed to participate and meaningfully engage in workshops / events at national and state levels with children and government officials. Recognising they are often excluded from decision making spaces, ensure gender balance and that throughout the process the views of girls and children with disabilities are represented and highlighted clearly. This includes working through the existing child parliament and child participation projects in South Sudan. Indicators: - KHM: Virtual web-based platform is inclusive and accessible. - SSD: % of girls and children with disabilities in workshops/events <i>(Target: 50% girls, 5-10% children with disabilities)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, Education Advisor, Climate DRR Advisor, Safeguarding advisor	USD \$239,807

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.2 School facilities are safer and greener				
Activity 1.2.1 Develop a national standard for climate-resilient school facilities	(GESI action, Cambodia) Review, and where appropriate, adopt a school design that is green, safe, healthy, inclusive, gender-responsive, and sustainable. The national standard developed must explicitly include guidelines on how to consider the needs of girls/women, children, and people with disabilities e.g. ramps, separated latrines, menstrual hygiene considerations, lighting etc. Indicator: National school design standards are inclusive and gender responsive, addressing gender inequality.	Y1, 2	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, Education Advisor, Climate DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education	USD \$22,394
Activity 1.2.2 Retrofit school facilities, including WASH and internet connectivity to strengthen climate resilience	(GESI action, all) Promote handwashing and proper hygiene through organising child-friendly awareness-raising sessions for students. (GESI action, all) Conduct consultations with girls, women, all ages of children in the school and people with disabilities to determine whether there are specific considerations in the retrofitting of school facilities that would impact their use. Ensure equal participation of girls, people with disabilities and women teachers in the assessment, design and implementation process and that their views are clearly represented and responded to. (GESI action, all) Infrastructure and WASH assessments include age, gender and disability-specific needs, and include questions that specifically reference marginalised groups and how they access and interact with physical infrastructure, as well as the separate risks they face. (GESI action, all) Ensure that retrofitted school facilities are gender, age and disability responsive, including WASH facilities include separate toilets for girls, boys, are accessible to students with disabilities and children of all ages and include menstrual hygiene management. Indicators % of infrastructure (inc. WASH) assessments addressing age, gender- and disability specific needs (<i>Target: 100%</i>). % of target schools with gender-segregated, age- and disability-accessible WASH facilities (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager (lead), GESI Advisor, WASH Advisor, Climate & DRR Advisor, Education Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education representatives, school officials	USD \$650,483

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.2 School facilities are safer and greener				
Activity 1.2.3 Strengthen school communities and education officials to operate and maintain school infrastructure and facilities	(GESI action, all) Ensure gender balance in trainings delivered on construction, basic upkeep and maintenance and actively support and provide mentorship for women. Indicators: - Gender-, age- and disability-disaggregated indicator for Output 1.2 (# school staff and community members with reported better skills in maintaining school infrastructure). % of trainers that are women (<i>Target: 30%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor, Infrastructure lead Externally: School officials, infrastructure specialists	USD \$70,968

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.3: School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively				
Activity 1.3.1 Build capacity of national and sub-national education officials to be master trainers on climate-related school safety	(GESI action, Cambodia and South Sudan) Include GESI considerations in climate-related school safety training, including the differential impacts of climate change on accessing education for different groups, and the actions to address this. Indicators: Climate-related school safety training sessions include GESI needs and actions (Evaluation).	Y 1, 2	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor	USD \$60,461
Activity 1.3.2 Build knowledge and capacity of school management, teachers and children to prepare climate-related school safety plans	(GESI action, all) Include GESI considerations in climate-related school safety training, including the differential impacts of climate change on accessing education, and the actions to address this. (GESI action, all) Conduct annual participatory school-level risk assessment that is gender, age and disability responsive, including for example the use of schools as evacuation shelters.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: School officials	USD \$222,383

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.3: School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively				
	(GESI action, all) Ensure school-level committees, including SMCs/PTAs (SSD) or dedicated school safety committees (KHM) meaningfully engage marginalised groups and are gender balanced. Provide training and mentorship for their active participation. When working with the school committees, ensure the voices and views of girls/women and people with disabilities are represented in the process, and they are consulted when agreeing the climate-related school safety roles and responsibilities for the committee. For Tonga, ensure the 150 school focal points are gender balanced where possible and ensure the voices of women are represented in training on climate-related school safety in the 5 regional centres. (GESI action, all) Ensure equal participation of girls/women and people with disabilities in training sessions and their views are represented. Encourage diverse representation of speakers and in videos encompassing a range of genders, ages, geographical locations, and educational backgrounds. Indicators: Gender-, age- and disability-disaggregated indicator for Output 1.3 (# school staff and community members with reported skills in climate-related school safety and educational continuity). <i>(Target: at least 50% women/girls; 5-10% people with disabilities).</i>			
Activity 1.3.3 Implement school-level climate-related school safety plans	(GESI action, all) Involve women/girls and people with disabilities in school needs/risk assessments, and preparation and review of plans. (GESI action, all) Ensure climate-related school safety plans (including DRR, emergency preparedness plans (EPP), Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and contingency plans, etc.) include GESI needs and actions. (GESI action, all) Develop and provide materials in gender-responsive, accessible and child-friendly formats catering to diverse needs, including where needed, braille, audio recordings, and videos with closed captions or sign language interpretation. Indicators: Climate-related school safety plans address GESI-specific needs (Evaluation)..	Y 2, 3, 4	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education representatives, sub-national officials	USD \$107,607

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.3: School safety and educational continuity management systems are operating effectively				
Activity 1.3.4 Provide climate resilience tools, equipment and kits to schools	(GESI action, all) Develop and provide tools, equipment, kits and materials that are gender-responsive, accessible and child-friendly, including those on construction. For materials - cater to diverse needs, including where needed, braille, audio recordings, and videos with closed captions or sign language interpretation. Indicator: % of tools, equipment, kits and materials that are inclusive <i>(Target: 100%)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor	USD \$40,789
Activity 1.3.5 Strengthen access to and use of Early Warning Systems (EWS) and Climate Information Systems (CIS) in schools	(GESI action, all) Ensure early warning information and climate information services are accessible to all ages, genders and persons with disabilities. (GESI action, all) Training and awareness-raising activities include modules or specific information on the differential needs of marginalised groups (girls/women, children and people with disabilities) in terms of early warning and climate information systems. Training materials must be accessible to all. (GESI, all) Design and implement feminist public awareness messages that address harmful social norms that differentially affect how people are impacted by and are able to respond to climate change including gender-based violence (GBV), unequal access to learning and information, and access to SRHR. These messages will be included in training, awareness raising, early warning and Standard Operating Procedures. (GESI action, all) Use inclusive language and communication channels to disseminate information. Indicators: - Early warning information dissemination that includes age-, gender- and disability-responsive language (Evaluation) % of communication channels used that are inclusive <i>(Target: 100%)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Education and DRRM authorities	USD \$189,868

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedding in national systems				
Activity 1.4.1 Develop teaching and learning materials on climate change ready to implement through national, non-formal and informal curriculum	(GESI action, all) , Include in any new teaching and learning content on climate change components that refer to gendered aspects such as GBV, social norms and how inclusive practices have multiple benefits. Also take actions to make sure any new content is inclusive, accessible, depict people from all areas of society and include information and local examples on the disproportionate impacts of climate change. E.g. use plain language and visuals in awareness materials to enhance accessibility for individuals with cognitive disabilities; feature individuals with disabilities, schools in vulnerable e.g. maritime areas, public and private schools (teachers, students, and parents); materials in local language to cater to diverse populations. (GESI action, South Sudan) Adapt learning materials developed under CSESI, and additional learning materials as required, with local input to ensure accessibility in different languages and contexts and consider and include children in the alternative education systems and out of school children in pastoralist and other marginalised communities. (GESI action, Cambodia and South Sudan) Consider Mental Health and Psychosocial support for children within learning materials, offering advice and guidance on how to access support mechanisms. (GESI action, Tonga) As part of the labour market research, identify climate-related professions traditionally categorised as either male- or female-dominated and how people with disabilities are included. Indicators: % of teaching and learning materials with a satisfactory* level of GESI integration (*satisfactory level based on: depicting gender and ethnic diversity and people with disabilities in climate-related actions and professions); including specific career pathways and success stories for women and people with disabilities in the climate change sector; accessible formats) <i>(Target: 100%)</i>. (Tonga) % of students enrolled in the elective climate change subject that are girls <i>(Target: 50%)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Department responsible for curricula and teachers	USD \$224,978

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedding in national systems				
Activity 1.4.2 Build knowledge and capacity of teachers and education managers to implement climate change lessons inside the classroom	(GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Ensure all training packages and modules for teachers include the specific needs and actions for different genders and marginalised groups. (GESI action, all) Ensure equal participation of women teachers and, where possible, women facilitators in training sessions. (GESI action, South Sudan, Tonga) Work with relevant bodies (e.g. higher institutions, other relevant line ministries, civil society, child representatives, education partners, gender experts), to develop and validate a training plan rollout for key actors, considering differing needs for different groups, e.g. pastoralists, women/men, girls/boys, people with disabilities etc. Indicators: % of professional development programs with gender-responsive modules (<i>Target: 100%</i>). - Gender-disaggregated indicator for Output 1.4 (# teachers and education managers with reported skills to deliver on pedagogy for climate change, disaster risk reduction and environmental education). (<i>Target: at least 50%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Department responsible for curricula and teachers	USD \$265,660
Activity 1.4.3 Strengthen capacity of child clubs to lead climate change initiatives in their school and community	(GESI action, South Sudan) Ensure equal representation of girls and boys in leadership activities. (GESI action, South Sudan) Provide leadership training that includes gender-responsive content and targets and mentors marginalised groups to support their active engagement. (GESI action, South Sudan) Train girls and focal point teachers on making menstrual hygiene management kits in schools. Indicators: % of girls and children with disabilities in leadership activities/environmental clubs (<i>Target: at least 50% girls, 5-10% children with disabilities</i>). % of leadership training sessions conducted that are gender-responsive (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: School officials	USD \$1,344,102

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 1.4: Climate change resilience teaching and learning embedding in national systems				
Activity 1.4.4 Disseminate climate change teaching and learning materials through Ministry of Education e-learning and other platforms	(GESI action, South Sudan) Develop and disseminate radio and media content that addresses GESI issues related to climate resilience, including GBV awareness raising. (GESI action, South Sudan) When developing media content consider and include representation of girls/women, boys/men and persons with disabilities (GESI action, all) Strengthen child protection systems and processes and enable easy access to information, including on SRHR and GBV. Indicators: % of radio and media content includes gender-specific and inclusion issues (<i>Target: 75%</i>). % of media content with a satisfactory* level of GESI integration (*satisfactory level based on: depicting gender and ethnic diversity and people with disabilities in climate-related actions and professions)	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education and e-learning stakeholders	USD \$20,986
Activity 1.4.5 Prepare learning documents and hold events with Ministries of Education and other partners to share experience of integrating climate change into the curriculum	(GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Includes GESI-specific impacts of climate change in learning documents. (GESI action, Cambodia, South Sudan) Involve women educators and gender experts in the preparation of the documents and events. Indicators: % of learning documents and events with a satisfactory* level of GESI integration (*satisfactory level based on: inclusion of women educators and gender experts in their development; inclusion of GESI specific impacts of climate change) (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2	SCI: Programme Manager, Education Advisor, GESI Advisor, Climate and DRR Advisor Externally: Ministry of Education	USD \$27,633

Component 2

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Component 2: Enhancing Access to Climate Finance for Education				
Outcome 2: Education ministries of the target countries have improved access to climate finance to increase the resilience of the education sector to climate change				

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 2.1: Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have access to, and the ability to interpret and utilize relevant climate information as well as participate in NAP decision-making within the education sector				
Activity 2.1.1 Development of education sector risk analyses on the impact of climate change and climate risks on the education sector and children's learning.	(GESI action) includes the differential impact of climate change on traditionally marginalised groups including girls, refugees, children with disabilities, those living in poverty in education sector risk analysis etc. Indicator: % of 15 targeted countries in the Climate-Smart Education Systems Initiative (CSESI) risk analyses that include GESI needs <i>(Target: 100%)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: International consultants, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist Externally: Ministries of Education and Environment	USD \$19,105
Activity 2.1.2 Support Ministries of Education to coordinate with climate change Ministries and engage in NAP processes, including those that may feed into global decisions such as those of the UNFCCC.	(GESI action) Support women staff from Ministry of Education to engage in capacity building events. (GESI action) Support ministries responsible for gender to engage in cross-sectoral coordination where possible. (GESI action) Support Ministries of Education to include education-focused GESI content in national UNFCCC processes, including NAPs and NDCs. Indicators: % of participants from target MoEs engaged in capacity building events <i>(Target: at least 50%)</i>. % of target countries including ministries responsible for gender in cross-sectoral coordination <i>(Target: 75%)</i>. % of target countries including GESI in education sections of NAPs <i>(Target: 50%)</i>.	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: BRACE PMU, GESI specialist Externally: Ministries of Education and Environment	USD \$47,068

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
1. Output 2.2 Key stakeholders (in BRACE countries) have increased access to, and the ability to utilise, scaled up finance for climate action in the education sector to replicate and scale BRACE to a greater percentage of the country				
Activity 2.2.1 Development of climate finance mobilisation road maps	(GESI action) Include GESI analysis and actions in roadmaps where possible, including for example how children and women's organizations receive climate funding. Indicator: % of roadmaps including GESI (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4	SCI: International consultants, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist Externally: Ministries of Education and Environment, donors	USD \$38,438
Activity 2.2.2 Direct Access Entity (DAE) support for working with the education sector on Green Climate Fund projects.	(GESI action) Include differential impacts of climate change in awareness raising and training on the impact of climate change on the education sector. (GESI action) Include GESI in all education-focused funding proposals to GCF supported by BRACE. Indicators: % of trainings to target countries include GESI (<i>Target: 100%</i>). % of funding proposals including GESI (<i>Target 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: International consultants, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist Externally: Ministries of Education and Environment, DAE, donors	USD \$68,672

Component 3

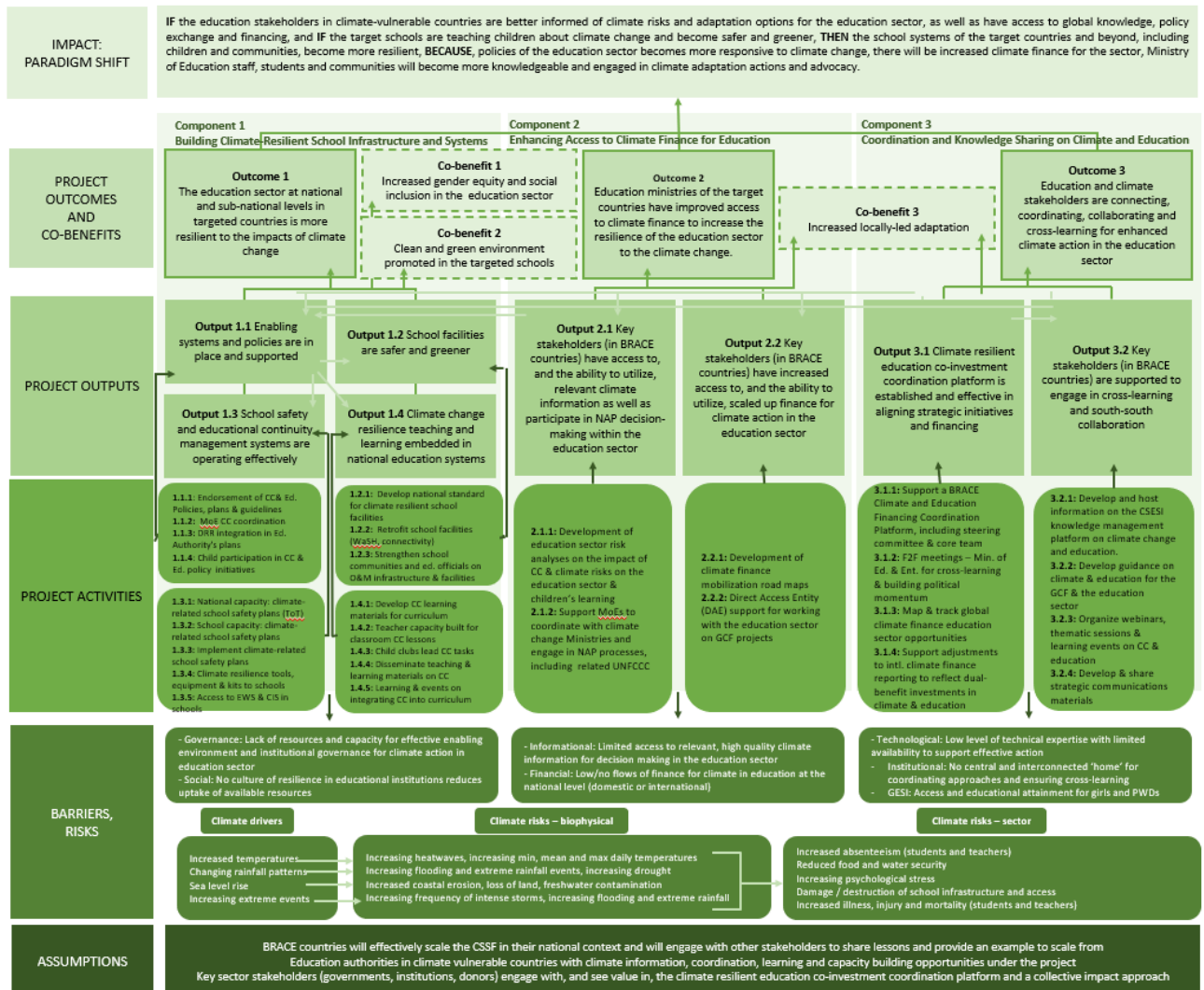
Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Component 3: Coordination and Knowledge Sharing on Climate and Education				
Outcome 3: Education and climate stakeholders globally are connecting, coordinating, collaborating and cross-learning for enhanced climate action in the education sector				
Output 3.1: Climate resilient education co-investment platform is established and effective in aligning strategic initiatives and financing				
Activity 3.1.1 Support a BRACE Climate and Education Financing Coordination Platform, including steering committee and core team	(GESI action) Include child representatives and local organisations in the Coordination Platform. (GESI action) Support equal representation of men/women in Coordination Platform. (GESI action) Link child clubs and training for children to the Coordination Platform where possible. Indicator: # of child/youth representatives and local civil society organisation representatives in the Coordination Platform (<i>Target: 2 children and 2 local organisation representatives (1 women's organisation)</i>). % of girls/women in coordination platform (<i>at least 50% girls/women</i>).	Y 3, 4, 5	SCI: BRACE PMU, GESI specialist, Safeguarding focal point	USD \$17,099
Activity 3.1.2 Face-to-Face meetings between Ministries of Education and Environment for cross-learning and building political momentum	(GESI action) Support women from the Ministries to attend the face-to-face meetings where possible. (GESI action) Consider and address the differential impacts of climate change on marginalised group's access to education in face to face meetings. (GESI action) Include GESI in the Roadmap for implementing the COP28 Declaration on the common agenda for education and climate change. Indicators: % of women from Ministries in face-to-face meetings (<i>Target: at least 50%</i>). % of meeting agendas that consider GESI (<i>Target: 100%</i>). - GESI analysis and actions included in the Declaration Roadmap.	Y 1	SCI: BRACE PMU, GESI specialist, Policy and Communications specialist Externally: Ministries of Education and Environment	USD \$15,225
Activity 3.1.3 Map and track global climate finance opportunities in the education sector	(GESI action) Map, track and promote GESI opportunities within climate finance for education. Indicator:	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: International consultants, Climate Finance Specialist, BRACE	USD \$12,395

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
	% of climate finance opportunities identified in target countries that include GESI (<i>Target: 100%</i>).		PMU, GESI specialist	
Activity 3.1.4 Support adjustments to international climate finance reporting to reflect dual-benefit investments in climate and education	(GESI action) Include consideration of GESI and the possibility for GESI-focused targets and indicators in analysis. Indicator: Analysis report includes section on GESI (<i>Target: 1 section</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: International consultants, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist	USD \$9,829

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
Output 3.2: Key stakeholders are supported to engage in peer learning and exchange through south-south collaboration				
Activity 3.2.1 Develop and host information on the CSESI knowledge management platform on climate change and education for improved evidence and learning	(GESI action) Includes evidence and learning on GESI, and where possible the 'tagging' of gender, disability and children, in knowledge management platform. Indicator: # of resources specifically on GESI (<i>Target: 3</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Knowledge Management Specialist, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist, Policy and Communications Specialist	USD \$16,543
Activity 3.2.2 Develop guidance on climate and education for the GCF and the global education sector	(GESI action) Include differential impacts of climate change, GCF updated Gender policy and utilisation GCF gender guidance in awareness raising and guidance. Indicator: # of guidance including GESI. (<i>Target: 2</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Climate Finance Specialist, BRACE PMU, GESI Specialist	USD \$19,604
Activity 3.2.3 Organise webinars, thematic sessions and learning events on climate change and education	(GESI action) Host webinars on GESI, climate and education in different languages. Indicators: # of webinars on GESI (<i>Target: 2</i>). % of webinars that have interpretation in different languages (<i>Target: 100%</i>).	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: BRACE PMU, GESI specialist, Knowledge Management Specialist	USD \$47,870
Activity 3.2.4 Develop and share strategic	(GESI action) Reflect diversity and inclusion highlighting the differential impacts of climate change on girls, boys, women, men and marginalised groups in case studies	Y 1, 2, 3, 4, 5	SCI: Knowledge Management	USD \$21,853

Project Activities	GESI Actions, Indicators and Targets	Timeline	Responsibilities	Costs
communications materials	and communication materials and translate into different languages and formats (e.g. child friendly). (GESI action) As part of communications, voices of the most marginalised groups must be central and should be included in presentations delivered. Indicator: • % of comms materials that include GESI (<i>Target: 100%</i>).		Specialist, BRACE PMU, GESI specialist, Policy and Communications specialist	

Appendix A: BRACE Theory of Change



Appendix B: Consultations Overview South Sudan

Context and Objective

The consultations for the BRACE project were conducted with the primary aim of gathering comprehensive insights and feedback to inform the project's approach to enhancing climate resilience through the education sector in South Sudan. This initiative is part of a broader strategy to integrate climate resilience into educational frameworks, ensuring that children and communities are better prepared to face climate-related challenges.

Timeline

The consultations spanned six months, from January to June 2024. This period allowed for an extensive engagement process, ensuring that diverse perspectives and experiences were captured from various stakeholders across different regions.

Geographic Scope

The consultations were conducted in four key counties:

1. **Bor (Jonglei State)**
2. **Akobo (Jonglei State)**
3. **Maban (Upper Nile State)**
4. **Magwi (Eastern Equatoria State)**

These locations were chosen to represent a range of climatic and socio-economic conditions, providing a holistic view of the challenges and opportunities for building climate resilience in the education sector. Project locations selected for consultations did not end up being final target locations for BRACE in South Sudan, after further consultations with government stakeholders requesting the specific inclusion of certain areas. The location for consultations were selected based on a range of climatic conditions, and areas that Save the Children were currently operational in or operating through partners, for ease of access.

Levels of Engagement

1. **National Level:**
 - Consultations involved high-level stakeholders, including government ministries, national NGOs, and international development partners.
 - The focus was on aligning the BRACE project with national policies and strategies on climate resilience and education.
2. **State Level:**
 - Engaged state education departments and local NGOs operating at the state level.
 - Discussions centered on state-specific challenges and resource allocations for climate-resilient educational initiatives.
3. **County Level:**
 - County education officials, local leaders, and community organizations were consulted.
 - These meetings aimed to identify county-specific needs and to tailor interventions to local contexts.
4. **Community Level:**

- Direct engagement with teachers, parents, students, and other community members through FGDs and community meetings.
- These sessions provided grassroots insights into the daily challenges faced by communities and schools, particularly in relation to climate impacts.

Methods of Engagement

1. Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):

- FGDs were held in each of the four counties, involving various community groups.
- These discussions were designed to be inclusive, encouraging participation from women, youth, and marginalized groups.
- Topics included the impacts of climate change on education, existing coping mechanisms, and suggestions for enhancing climate resilience in schools.

2. Consultative Meetings:

- Formal consultative meetings were held with stakeholders at national, state, and county levels.
- These meetings provided a platform for detailed discussions on policy, strategic planning, and resource mobilization for the BRACE project.
- Key themes included integration of climate resilience into curricula, teacher training needs, and infrastructural improvements for schools.

3. Workshops and Dialogues:

- Workshops and dialogues facilitated more in-depth discussions on specific aspects of the BRACE project.
- These sessions were instrumental in developing a shared understanding of the project goals and fostering collaboration among stakeholders.

Outcomes of the Consultations

The consultations yielded valuable insights that will inform the BRACE project's design and implementation. Key outcomes include:

- Identification of critical gaps in current educational practices related to climate resilience.
 - Enhanced understanding of regional disparities and specific needs.
 - Stronger alignment of project goals with national and local policies.
 - Improved stakeholder buy-in and support for the project.
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